



Gateshead and Newcastle Councils
Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan
Sustainability Appraisal Report
December 2013

Environmental Report

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Sustainability Appraisal of the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan for Gateshead and Newcastle: Environmental Report

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Environmental Report

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Sustainability Appraisal of the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan for Gateshead and Newcastle: Environmental Report

For and on behalf of
Natural Capital Ltd

Approved by: Dr P J Say

Signed:



Position: Director

Date: 16th December 2013

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1 NON-TECHNICAL SUMMARY

1.1 INTRODUCTION TO THE APPRAISAL

1.1.1 The Joint Core Strategy

Gateshead and Newcastle Councils have together prepared a joint Core Strategy, the 'Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan' (referred to as the 'Plan' throughout this report), that brings together their shared aspirations and sets out the long-term spatial vision and planning strategy for the whole of the area within Gateshead's and Newcastle's administrative boundaries. The two Councils wish to ensure that sustainability principles are at the heart of their Local Plan to ensure that a sustainable approach to future development is adopted.

The Plan will provide the strategic policies for planning future development within Gateshead's and Newcastle's administrative boundaries and will ensure that as well as supporting sustainable economic growth, development is designed to be socially inclusive, reduce health inequalities and encourage healthy lifestyle choices whilst important natural and cultural assets are protected and enhanced.

1.1.2 Sustainable Development Principles

Sustainable development is at the heart of the National Planning Policy Framework¹ (NPPF) and is linked in that document to the concepts of 'positive growth' and 'making economic, environmental and social progress for this and future generations.'

In 2005 the previous Government set out its aims for sustainable development in the sustainable development strategy "*Securing the Future – delivering UK sustainable development strategy*"². The vision was summarised in a single clear goal:

"To enable all people throughout the world to satisfy their basic needs and enjoy a better quality of life, without compromising the quality of life for future generations."

It was considered that the goal should be pursued in an integrated way through:

- *"a sustainable, innovative and productive economy that delivers high levels of employment"*
- *"a just society that promotes social inclusion, sustainable communities and personal wellbeing"*
- *"protecting and enhancing the physical and natural environment and using resources and energy as efficiently as possible"*

The NPPF now stresses a 'presumption' in favour of sustainable development and that it should be the basis for every plan and every decision. Land-use planning will therefore have a key role in achieving sustainable development. Local Plans can clearly help by ensuring that *"we get the right development in the right place at the right time"* and that this development meets the needs of people living and working in the area, whilst at the same time protecting and enhancing the environment.

¹ National Planning Policy Framework, Department for Communities and Local Government, 2012

² "*Securing the Future - delivering UK sustainable development strategy*", 2005

1.1.3 The Sustainability Appraisal Process

Sustainability Appraisal (SA) is a structured approach to predicting and assessing the economic, social and environmental effects that are likely to arise from a plan, programme or strategy. Government favours combining this with Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA) – required under the Environmental Assessment of Plans and Programmes Regulations 2004. This is a complimentary appraisal process that focuses on assessing effects on the environment. This single combined appraisal (referred to as SA) is the approach adopted here and described in this report.

The SA process was previously undertaken in three stages on both the One Core Strategy and the Urban Core Area Action Plan as follows:

One Core Strategy

- Stage 1: the scoping exercise and the production of a Scoping Report (produced in April 2010³);
- Stage 2: the sustainability appraisal (undertaken in 2011); and
- Stage 3: reporting (the Sustainability Appraisal Report produced in September 2011⁴).

Urban Core Action Plan

- Stage 1: the scoping exercise and the production of a Scoping Report (produced in November 2010⁵);
- Stage 2: the sustainability appraisal (undertaken in 2011); and
- Stage 3: reporting (the Sustainability Appraisal Report produced in September 2011⁶).

This process was undertaken at a time when the Plan was made up of two separate plans within Gateshead's and Newcastle's respective Local Development Frameworks (LDFs): the One Core Strategy Development Plan and the Urban Core Area Action Plan. These were prepared under the Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act 2004 and set within the context of the North East Regional Spatial Strategy (RSS).

However since the Consultation Drafts were published in October 2011 there has been a number of significant amendments to the national planning policy context including the Localism Act 2011, the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) and the subsequent revocation of the RSS in 2013. This has led the two Councils into carrying out a revision and update of the Core Strategy, including the incorporation of the Urban Core Area Action Plan. Because of the changes made to the Plan, including revisions and additions to various policies, it was considered appropriate to update the sustainability appraisal. The SA process undertaken for this revision of the Plan is a repeat of Stages 2 and 3 above.

³ NewcastleGateshead One Core Strategy – Sustainability Appraisal Scoping Report, Natural Capital Ltd, April 2010

⁴ NewcastleGateshead One Core Strategy Consultation Draft – Sustainability Appraisal Report, Natural Capital Ltd, September 2011

⁵ NewcastleGateshead Urban Core Area Action Plan – Sustainability Appraisal Scoping Report, Natural Capital Ltd, November 2010

⁶ NewcastleGateshead Urban Core Area Action Plan Consultation Draft – Sustainability Appraisal Report, Natural Capital Ltd, September 2011

1.2 APPRAISAL SUMMARY – KEY CONCLUSIONS

1.2.1 Positive Implications

In general terms the Plan with its Strategic Objectives and suite of policies appears likely to deliver a broad balance of positive economic, social and environmental trends for the combined area.

Policy CS1 – The Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth makes it quite clear that it will:

- have a presumption in favour of sustainable development;
- focus the majority of development in the most sustainable locations, in existing built up areas that are accessible to all (e.g. the Urban Core and other key Neighbourhood sites); and
- enhance the neighbourhoods and sustain villages through a balance of housing provision, employment and local services.

Policy CS1 in its Clause 8 also sets out four key development principles that set the standards for all development. This clause emphasises that all development will be:

- fully inclusive, irrespective of cultural background ethnicity and age, to meet the diverse needs of all residents and communities;
- well-connected and accessible by sustainable modes of transport;
- well designed to promote community cohesion, and wellbeing, and to reflect and enhance the areas character and natural environment; and
- designed to reduce carbon emissions and adapted to the effects of climate change.

The supporting policies behind the spatial strategy attempt to deliver:

Healthier, Thriving and Inclusive Communities

Through:

- promoting improvement to wellbeing and health through positive spatial planning that addresses the key factors influencing health and which promotes active and healthy lifestyles (Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health);
- seeking to support more healthy lifestyles within a healthier environment (pollution free) through promoting walking and cycling (Policies CS13: Transport, UC5: Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes and UC6: Cycling); protecting and where possible enhancing green infrastructure and the natural heritage assets of Gateshead and Newcastle (Policies CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment and UC15: Urban Green Infrastructure), protecting and enhancing the historic environment and cultural heritage (Policies CS15: Place Making and UC14: Heritage); encouraging access to amenity and recreational facilities (Policies CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism and UC16: Public Realm); and
- promoting the concept of 'Lifetime Neighbourhoods' and providing accessible, affordable and safer housing that meets the varied and changing needs of all citizens in Gateshead and Newcastle (Policies CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing and UC4: Homes).

More Sustainable Transport Through:

- seeking to reduce the need to travel by carefully locating development in the most sustainable locations (Spatial Strategy Policies CS1 and CS2); and
- seeking to encourage the use of public transport and more sustainable modes of travel other than the car such as cycling and walking (Policy CS13: Transport, UC5: Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes and UC6: Cycling).

A Healthier Global and Local Environment

It is now broadly accepted that there will be significant climate change consequences over the coming decades arising from greenhouse gases already released as a result of man-made activities, as well as those emissions likely to be associated with planned growth. The sort of activities that contribute towards the release of CO₂ emissions into the environment at the global level (fossil fuel burning by power stations to generate electricity, fossil fuel burning by transport, fossil fuel burning to generate heating for housing, industrial emissions from manufacturing operations) are also those emissions that can impact on local air quality.

The Plan aims to address these emission sources through:

- seeking to mitigate against the effects and also to ensure that new development adapts to the consequences of climate change (Policy CS16: Climate Change);
- seeking to protect and improve where appropriate air quality (Policy CS13: Transport);
- the prevention of waste and better waste management (Policy CS21: Waste);
- seeking to reduce the reliance on fossil fuels (Policy CS16: Climate Change); and
- making best use of land and minimising flood risk (Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management).

Protection and Enhancement of Natural Heritage Assets

The Plan recognises that the natural environment is an essential component of quality of place in Gateshead and Newcastle. The strategic importance of green infrastructure and the many ecosystem services that it offers (such as climate change adaptation, flood attenuation, water management, biodiversity conservation etc) is also fully recognised. The strategic importance of the River Tyne is highlighted.

The Plan aims to address these issues as set out in Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment, through:

- protecting the integrity and connectivity of the strategic Green Infrastructure Network;
- making sure that new developments conserve and enhance green infrastructure;
- maximising the potential that green infrastructure has in adapting to the effects of climate change (e.g. flood water storage, carbon sinks, urban cooling etc); and

- protecting and enhancing biodiversity and geodiversity.

Protection and Enhancement of the Historic Environment

The Plan highlights the fundamental role that 'quality of place' plays in delivering its wider spatial planning objectives. The key to quality of place is successful place making that incorporates high quality urban design. The Core Strategy emphasises that high quality urban design is founded upon an understanding of the area's unique historic environment and cultural heritage.

Through Policy CS15: Place Making, the Plan aims to retain the distinctive character and 'sense of place' that exists in Gateshead and Newcastle through:

- encouraging the recognition of the importance of the historic environment;
- making sure that new development reflects local character and distinctiveness; and
- seeking to encourage the enhancement of the historic environment where possible.

Urban Core, Sub Areas and Sites

The Plan sets out a spatial vision for the Urban Core, the various Sub Areas and Sites (including Neighbourhoods and Villages) that attempts to:

- expand Gateshead and Newcastle Centres (the Urban Core) to accommodate growth through the regeneration of several Key Sites (e.g. Gateshead Quays, Ouseburn, East Pilgrim Street and Stephenson Quarter) that will create employment opportunities and housing in some of the most sustainable locations;
- make the best use of buildings, spaces and places and of Newcastle's historic core whilst preserving their historic features; and
- support development of the key sites and at the same time improve the walkability of the urban core whilst upgrading the green and social infrastructure;
- establish Neighbourhood Growth Areas in key locations;
- allocate Village Growth Areas to secure the long-term sustainability of villages.

It also sets out the policies that will deliver the necessary changes within the Urban Core together with a suite of policies that provide guidance for development in the Sub Areas and Key Sites (Neighbourhoods and Villages).

All of the land allocation policies for housing and employment land were screened against the sustainability criteria and none were found to trigger any adverse effects or pose challenges for future development. Any constraints identified were found to be adequately mitigated by the application of the appropriate Core Strategy policies (CS1 to CS21).

Conclusions

If the policies set out in the Plan are fully implemented it should be possible for Gateshead and Newcastle Councils to achieve their strategic objectives and development goals whilst delivering progress in the economic, social and environmental objectives that make up the Sustainability Framework.

In particular, if the key policies that set out the social sustainability criteria:

- Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth – and in particular Clause 8 with the key development principles that specifically address the social criteria (Clauses 8(i) and 8 (iii))
- Paragraph 5.11 – that makes commitments to the promotion of equality, diversity and fairness
- Policy CS9: Existing Communities
- Policy CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing
- Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health
- Policy CS15: Place Making

are adhered to then the development goals should be achievable whilst maintaining and improving wellbeing, health, social inclusion, equalities and community cohesion.

If the key policies that set out the longer term sustainability goals and high standards of environmental protection for the historic and natural environment:

- Policy CS16: Climate Change
- Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management
- Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment
- Policy CS21: Waste

are adhered to then the development goals should be achievable without causing a deterioration in the environmental quality of Gateshead and Newcastle.

1.2.2 Potential Challenges to Address

Notwithstanding the above positive elements it is highly likely that there will be some environmental implications arising from new development. Some issues are almost inevitable, and would arise as a result of any new development and these include:

- emissions of greenhouse gases from the manufacture and supply of building and construction materials;
- emissions of greenhouse gases from energy use and traffic;
- an increased burden on air quality from any increases in traffic;
- an increased burden on water supply and water treatment for a growing and expanding population; and
- additional waste generation.

The policies within the Plan are worded in ways that would imply that if rigorously applied the above potential negative environmental impacts can be considerably mitigated. Thus the application of Policy CS16: Climate Change should considerably reduce carbon emissions from new developments. The implementation of Policy CS13: Transport should reduce CO₂ emissions from traffic and ensure that local air quality did not deteriorate. The application of good

sustainability design principles (as advocated in Policy CS16) should ensure that both water and waste management are carried out in ways that improve environmental quality.

There are other issues that are highly dependant on the rigorous application of key policies within the Plan and these include:

Biodiversity and Geodiversity Conservation Interests

Including:

- loss of and damage to habitats;
- loss and disturbance to protected species;
- loss of and damage to fauna and flora (both on and off development sites); and
- loss of and damage to geomorphological interests.

Landscape and Historic Character

Including:

- visual impacts;
- damage to local distinctiveness;
- damage to important landscape and historic features; and
- damage to characteristic building styles.

Traffic and Congestion

Including:

- increased emissions;
- increased noise, vibration and disturbance; and
- reduced tranquillity.

Inappropriate Use of Land

Including:

- encroachment into green space;
- inappropriate development in flood plain areas or areas at risk from flooding; and
- inappropriate use of agricultural land.

Section 6.6 of the SA summarises ways in which these impacts can be mitigated through the planning system and the application of the key policies within the Plan.

1.2.3 Addressing the Problems and Monitoring Progress

Mitigation

The precise effects of the broad directional policies within the Plan are clearly going to be difficult to predict at the local level. The effects, whether positive, negative or cumulative will depend on how policies are implemented at the local level, the precise nature of the developments that are being assessed and the economic, social and environmental characteristics of the potential locations of developments.

Mitigation has been possible through further modification of policies in line with the results of the sustainability appraisal and the feedback from previous consultation.

There were no cases where any policy was found to generate an overall negative impact or clear, strong negative impacts on the sustainability objectives. In some cases there were policies that appeared to be generating uncertain effects (particularly in the case of certain environmental objectives and trends) that could have resulted in negative or positive impacts depending on their application and the local circumstances. In these cases the application of Policies CS16: Climate Change, and others of the “umbrella” kind (such as Policies CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) in parallel served to mitigate any potential negative effects.

Strategic Flood Risk Assessments (SFRAs) from both Councils were consulted in gauging policy sustainability against the objectives outlined in Annex E and their findings heavily influenced the safeguarding clauses in Policy CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) to ensure that flood risk is not increased across the Plan area. SFRAs were also used to inform strategic policy and site allocations, and influenced mitigation measures.

The SFRAs for both Councils concluded that while there may be some degree of flood risk present at select sites, it can be sufficiently mitigated through mitigation measures including but not limited to, SUDS, SWMP and micro-siting of a development to avoid high-risk flood areas.

Monitoring

It will be essential that the implementation of the Plan is monitored to make sure that:

- the prediction of effects was accurate;
- that mitigation of effects through the application of specific policies is performing as well as can be expected or whether policies need further modification;
- whether any further modification of policies is necessary to mitigate any adverse effects which had not been identified previously; and
- that the plan is contributing to the achievement of the Sustainability Objectives and targets.

Monitoring will also be necessary to make sure that the Plan is delivering an appropriate strategy for the spatial development of Gateshead and Newcastle that will ultimately help deliver the vision, goals, objectives and targets of the Bridging Document⁷ and of the respective Sustainable Community Strategies of the two Councils.

The monitoring framework for the Plan is based on the establishment of a set of indicators for each of the sustainability objectives that also address the sustainability issues identified.

1.3 STATEMENT ON THE DIFFERENCE THE PROCESS HAS MADE

The SA has been an iterative process whereby the various policies within the Plan and supporting text have been tested against the sustainability framework and revisions/modifications made in a series of stages.

⁷ 'Bridging Document Developing Sustainable Cities – NewcastleGateshead 2030' produced by Gateshead and Newcastle Councils

As a result of this iterative process the Plan with its policies and supporting text has gone through an evolution and revision process. Modifications of policy clauses have been further introduced together with revisions of the Plan text. Some key outcomes of the SA/SEA appraisal process to date and the difference that this process has made are as follows:

- A greater recognition of how spatial planning and the Plan can help address equality of opportunity (particularly in terms of access and accessibility), diversity and some of the social inclusion challenges for the area. Some major adjustments to the Plan text, together with some key policy changes now bring out more clearly how development can and will be made to serve the whole community.
- One of the most significant changes (which also brings the Plan very closely in line with NPPF guidelines) is the revision of Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth). This now has an upfront Clause 1 that states that the main vision will be achieved by '*A presumption in favour of sustainable development*' together with a new Clause 8 that sets out four key 'Development Principles' that require development to be '*fully inclusive*' and '*well designed to promote community cohesion*'.
- The important contribution that the Plan can make in addressing inequalities and social inclusion is now better reflected with the inclusion in Paragraph 5.11 of a specific development principle that states:

'Both Councils are committed to the promotion of diversity, equality and fairness, and expect all development to contribute to this in accordance with the latest equalities legislation.'

- When dealing with accessibility, several of the overarching policies have been strengthened to make quite clear the requirements that will be expected of future development. For example:
 - o Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) includes a clause stating that development will be '*fully inclusive....*' and '*well connected and accessible by sustainable modes of transport*';
 - o Policy CS13 (Transport) includes a clause – '*improving equality of access to transport for everyone*';
 - o Policy CS14 (Wellbeing and Health) with clauses that state – '*providing good access for all to health and social care facilities*' and '*promoting access for all to green spaces, sports facilities, play and recreation opportunities*';
 - o Policy CS15 (Place Making) that states that all development will be required to '*Ensure connectivity, accessibility and legibility*'; and
 - o Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) that emphasises '*Maintaining, protecting and enhancing the integrity, connectivity, multifunctionality and accessibility of the Strategic Green Infrastructure Network*'.
- The vital contribution that can be made towards the wiser use of resources (living within environmental limits) is brought out by a clearer Climate Change policy (CS16) where the need to adopt more sustainable design and construction methods (to promote energy efficiency and conservation) and sustainable sources of energy is clearly set out. The requirement for new

developments to function more effectively in a changing climate and be flexible and resilient to the effects of climate change is also clearly articulated.

- Policy CS15 (Place Making) is much clearer in both how it will require development to create inclusive and accessible environments that will nurture local distinctiveness and sense of place whilst at the same time proactively sustaining the historic environment and valuing heritage assets.
- There is also a clarity in Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) with regard to both protecting and enhancing existing sites valued for their nature conservation interests (both biodiversity and geodiversity) whilst also maintaining and enhancing connectivity, multi-functionality and accessibility.

1.4 CONSULTATION ON THE SA REPORT

The Stage 3 “Reporting” phase in the SA/SEA process, as indicated in the flow chart featured in Section 1.2 of the main report, was completed with the submission of the Plan together with the SA Report for public consultation from the 9th September to 21st October 2013.

The consultation responses have been taken into account and the decision-making process on how comments have been addressed has been documented. This final version of the SA report has been amended as necessary to reflect the agreed changes.

This final version of the SA Report will be submitted to the Secretary of State with the Plan for independent examination.

1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 THE JOINT CORE STRATEGY

Gateshead and Newcastle Councils have together prepared a joint Core Strategy, the 'Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan', that brings together their shared aspirations and sets out the long-term spatial vision and planning strategy for the whole of the area within Gateshead's and Newcastle's administrative boundaries. The two Councils wish to ensure that sustainability principles are at the heart of their Local Plan to ensure that a sustainable approach to future development is adopted.

All the other subsequent Local Plan documents of the two Councils will sit within the framework of the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan (referred to as the 'Plan' throughout the rest of this document) and so it is particularly important, if a sustainable approach to development is to be achieved, that the Plan is based on sound sustainability principles. The two Councils are statutorily obliged to undertake a Sustainability Appraisal (SA) and a Strategic Environmental Assessment (SEA) as part of the process of preparing the Plan, to ensure that it will contribute to the achievement of sustainable development and environmental protection within the Plan area.

1.2 THE STAGES OF THE SA PROCESS

The SA process previously undertaken was carried out in three stages on both the One Core Strategy and the Urban Core Area Action Plan as follows:

One Core Strategy

- Stage 1: the scoping exercise and the production of a Scoping Report (produced in April 2010¹);
- Stage 2: the sustainability appraisal (undertaken in 2011); and
- Stage 3: reporting (the Sustainability Appraisal Report produced in September 2011²).

Urban Core Area Action Plan

- Stage 1: the scoping exercise and the production of a Scoping Report (produced in November 2010³);
- Stage 2: the sustainability appraisal (undertaken in 2011); and
- Stage 3: reporting (the Sustainability Appraisal Report produced in September 2011⁴).

This process was undertaken at a time when the Plan was made up of two separate plans within Gateshead's and Newcastle's respective Local Development Frameworks (LDFs): the One Core Strategy Development Plan and the Urban Core Area Action Plan. These were prepared under the Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act 2004 and set within the context of the North East Regional Spatial Strategy (RSS).

¹ NewcastleGateshead One Core Strategy – Sustainability Appraisal Scoping Report, Natural Capital Ltd, April 2010

² NewcastleGateshead One Core Strategy Consultation Draft – Sustainability Appraisal Report, Natural Capital Ltd, September 2011

³ NewcastleGateshead Urban Core Area Action Plan – Sustainability Appraisal Scoping Report, Natural Capital Ltd, November 2010

⁴ NewcastleGateshead Urban Core Area Action Plan Consultation Draft – Sustainability Appraisal Report, Natural Capital Ltd, September 2011

However since the Consultation Drafts were published in October 2011 there has been a number of significant amendments to the national planning policy context including the Localism Act 2011, the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) and the subsequent revocation of the RSS in 2013. This has led the two Councils to carry out a revision and update of the Core Strategy, including the incorporation of the Urban Core Area Action Plan.

Incorporating the Urban Area Action Plan into the Core Strategy has resulted in the rationalisation and streamlining of policies to remove unnecessary repetition. It has also resulted in the streamlining of the supporting text in order to keep this relevant and focused. Policies concerned with the allocation of housing and employment land are also included. Because of the changes made to the Plan including revisions and additions to various policies it was considered appropriate to update the sustainability appraisal. The SA process undertaken for this revision of the Plan is a repeat of Stages 2 and 3 above. The revision was completed in August 2013 and submitted together with the Plan for a further period of consultation from the 9th September to 21st October 2013. Following this period of consultation there was a further revision made to the Plan to reflect the feedback received. This has led to a 'refresh' of the Sustainability Appraisal Report.

The full SA process is illustrated in Figure 1.1 below.

1.3 STATUTORY AND PLANNING FRAMEWORK

The Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act⁵ sets out the legal framework for planning in England. Under the act an SA is mandatory for Local Plan documents. The purpose of the SA is to help Councils ensure that the developing plans contribute to the achievement of sustainable development.

The National Planning Policy Framework⁶ sets out the Government's planning policies for England and how these are expected to be applied. It provides a framework within which local people and their accountable councils can produce their own distinctive local and neighbourhood plans, which reflect the needs and priorities of their communities. The NPPF must be taken into account in the preparation of local and neighbourhood plans, and is a material consideration in planning decisions. The ministerial foreword to the NPPF stresses that the purpose of planning is to help achieve sustainable development and so the Framework underlines the importance of SA in the plan making process.

SA can be described as 'an iterative process undertaken during the preparation of a plan, which identifies and reports the extent to which the implementation of a plan will achieve the environmental, economic and social objectives by which sustainable development can be defined'⁷.

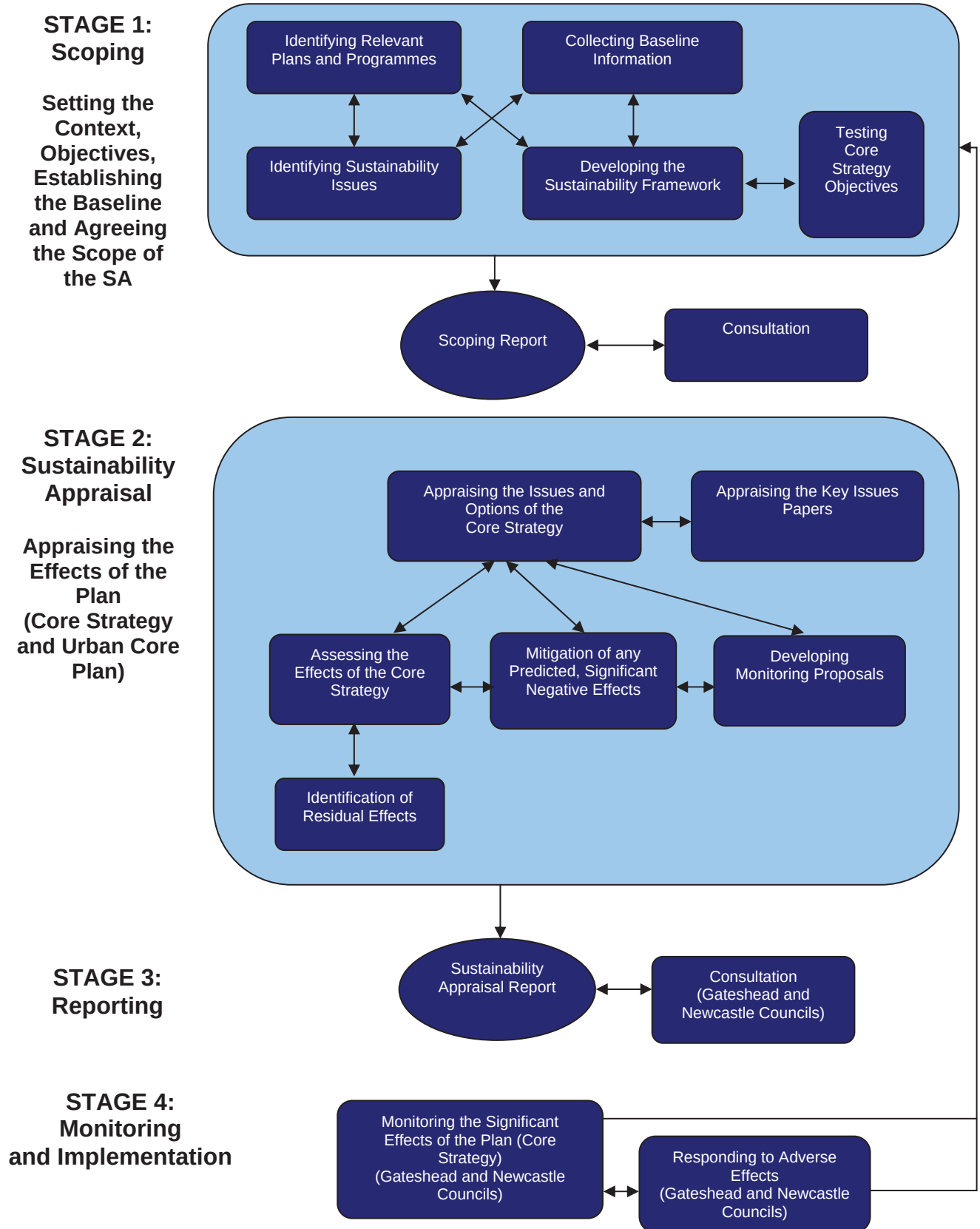
Being an iterative process SA can be used to test each part of the emerging Plan as it is developed to expose any weakness in its contribution to sustainable development. SA can be used to help identify sustainability issues and sustainable planning solutions for the future.

⁵ The Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act, HMSO 2004

⁶ National Planning Policy Framework, Department for Communities and Local Government, March 2012

⁷ Sustainability Appraisal of Regional Spatial Strategies and Local Development Documents, ODPM 2005

Figure 1.1: The Sustainability Appraisal Process: Stages and Tasks



1.4 STRATEGIC ENVIRONMENTAL ASSESSMENT

Planning authorities must also undertake an SEA in accordance with the Environmental Assessment of Plans and Programmes Regulations 2004 which implement the European Directive 2001/42/EC on 'the assessment of effects of certain plans and programmes on the environment' (the 'Strategic Environmental Assessment' Directive or SEA Directive) in England. The Directive describes the objective of SEA as to 'provide for a high level of protection of the environment and to contribute to the integration of environmental considerations into the preparation and adoption of plans...with a view to promoting sustainable development'⁸.

SEA is focused primarily on environmental effects. The Directive defines environment broadly, including population, human health, cultural heritage and material assets as well as biodiversity, air water and soil. SA examines not only the environmental effects of plans but also the social and economic sustainability effects of them.

Although the requirement to undertake SA and SEA is distinct⁸, best practice guidance indicates that it is possible to satisfy both requirements through a single appraisal process as long as the requirements of the SEA Regulations are met. Gateshead and Newcastle Councils have adopted this approach and in this document all future references to SA are taken to mean SA and SEA combined.

1.4.1 Habitat Regulations Assessment

A Habitats Regulations Assessment that includes, where necessary, an Appropriate Assessment (an assessment appropriate to its purpose under the Conservation of Habitats and Species Regulations 2010 as amended) is required to be carried out in parallel to the SA process and will be reported on in advance of the submission of the Plan. Both Gateshead and Newcastle Councils have carried out earlier assessments and both of these have been taken into account during the on-going assessment of the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan.

1.5 SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

Sustainable development is at the heart of the NPPF and is linked in that document to the concepts of 'positive growth' and 'making economic, environmental and social progress for this and future generations.'

In 2005 the previous Government set out its aims for sustainable development in the sustainable development strategy "*Securing the Future – delivering UK sustainable development strategy*"⁹. The vision was summarised in a single clear goal:

"To enable all people throughout the world to satisfy their basic needs and enjoy a better quality of life, without compromising the quality of life for future generations."

It was considered that the goal should be pursued in an integrated way through:

- *"a sustainable, innovative and productive economy that delivers high levels of employment"*
- *"a just society that promotes social inclusion, sustainable communities and personal wellbeing"*

⁸ Article 1 of the Directive

⁹ "*Securing the Future - delivering UK sustainable development strategy*", HM Government 2005

- *“protecting and enhancing the physical and natural environment and using resources and energy as efficiently as possible”*

The NPPF now stresses a ‘presumption’ in favour of sustainable development and that it should be the basis for every plan and every decision. Land-use planning will therefore have a key role in achieving sustainable development.

Local Plans can clearly help by ensuring that *“we get the right development in the right place at the right time”* and that this development meets the needs of people living and working in the area, whilst at the same time protecting and enhancing the environment.

The planning system should play an active role in guiding development to sustainable solutions. Government considers that SA can provide a useful tool to help balance the environmental, social and economic needs that can often be found to be in conflict when developing plans.

1.6 THE VISION AND OBJECTIVES OF THE PLAN

The Plan responds to the needs and ambitions of local residents and businesses across Gateshead and Newcastle. The Local Strategic Partnerships of both Gateshead and Newcastle have worked together to align both authorities’ respective Sustainable Community Strategies (Vision 2030: Sustainable Community Strategy for Gateshead and Newcastle 2030: Taking the city forward) and this has been achieved through the joint bridging document – *‘Developing Sustainable Cities – NewcastleGateshead 2030’*.

This bridging document sets out a shared vision for the future of the two council areas:

‘By 2030 NewcastleGateshead will be prosperous and sustainable cities that are unique and distinctive - places where people choose to live, work and visit because everybody can realise their potential and enjoy a quality lifestyle.’

Underpinning this vision there are a series of challenges and objectives that set out how the vision is going to be delivered. It is therefore these objectives that will shape the Plan policies and give them direction. The broad range of objectives cover the following areas:

1. Securing an increased working population in order to underpin sustainable economic growth.
2. Increasing economic performance, resilience, levels of entrepreneurship, skills and business formation by promoting Gateshead and Newcastle as the strong regional economic focus and by ensuring the supply of suitable, flexible and diverse business accommodation.
3. Increasing competitiveness by improving and expanding the role of the Urban Core as the regional destination for business, shopping, education, leisure, tourism and as a place to live.
4. Strengthening Newcastle’s position as the regional retail centre. Ensuring the provision of quality District and Local centres with a diverse range of shops and services that are accessible, to meet the needs of all local communities.
5. Expanding leisure, culture and tourism providing for all age groups and developing a balanced approach to the night time economy.
6. Ensuring that the residential offer provides a choice of quality accommodation in sustainable locations to meet people’s current and

future needs and aspirations, and improves opportunities to live in the Urban Core and providing a broader range of accommodation which is affordable, offers choice, and has the highest design and environmental sustainability standards.

7. Managing and developing the transport system to support growth and provide sustainable access for all to housing, jobs, services and shops.
8. Improving sustainable access to, within and around the Urban Core by promoting fast and direct public transport links to the heart of the Urban Core increasing walking and cycling and minimising through traffic.
9. Ensuring the development and use of land protects, sustains and enhances the quality of the natural, built and historic environment and ensuring communities are attractive, safe and sustainable.
10. Providing the opportunity for a high quality of life for everyone and enhancing the wellbeing of people to reduce all inequalities.
11. Reducing CO₂ emissions from new development and future growth whilst adapting to the issues, mitigating adverse impacts and maximising the research and business potential emerging from the climate change agenda.
12. Improving the function, usability and provision of green infrastructure and public spaces by providing a network of green spaces and features which are well-designed, connected and accessible for all, maximising the potential of Gateshead and Newcastle's landmarks, environment, riverscape, townscape, heritage and culture.

1.7 THE SUSTAINABILITY APPRAISAL REPORT

1.7.1 Scoping

In undertaking an SA of the Plan it is important that the proposed methodology and scope of the SA is found to be satisfactory to key stakeholders (such as environmental agencies, other relevant bodies and interested members of the public) before the appraisal is undertaken. The preparation of a Scoping Report¹ and subsequent consultation on this was carried out previously in 2010 for both the original Core Strategy and the Urban Core Area Action Plan in order to address this very point (see also Section 1.2).

The following links give the reader access to these Scoping Reports:

One Core Strategy

- <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2572550>

Urban Core Area Action Plan

- <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2572547>

1.7.2 The Sustainability Appraisal Report

The current Sustainability Appraisal Report although drawing on both the earlier Scoping Reports^{1,3} and Sustainability Reports^{2,4} tries not to repeat unnecessary detail and the reader is directed to those reports for some of the relevant detail. This report includes:

- a summary of the 'refreshed' baseline information;
- a review of relevant plans and programmes and how they have influenced the SA with reference to any new documents published since 2011; and
- an update of the key sustainability issues for the two areas.

Then added to this, the report includes summaries of:

- appraisals of the new or modified policies within the Plan;
- a summary of the key findings;
- a description of any mitigation measures;
- consideration of any important residual effects;
- consideration of cumulative effects; and
- an update on monitoring future effects of the Plan.

1.8 LAYOUT OF REPORT

The remainder of the document is structured as follows:

- *Chapter 2*: presents a summary of the methodology adopted;
- *Chapter 3*: summarises the baseline review of information;
- *Chapter 4*: revisits the sustainability issues for the area;
- *Chapter 5*: summarises the results of testing the Plan Policies against the sustainability appraisal framework; and
- *Chapter 6*: considers mitigation, residual effects and any proposals for monitoring.

The following annexes are in a separate document and support the main text:

- **Annex A**: Relevant Plans and Programmes Reviewed
- **Annex B**: Baseline Information in Full
- **Annex C**: Appraisal of the Plan Policies
- **Annex D**: Cumulative Impacts
- **Annex E**: Sustainability Framework and Glossary
- **Annex F**: Bibliography

Table 1.1 summarises the requirements of the SEA Regulations with respect to the content of an Environmental Report (as required by Article 5 and Annex 1 of Directive 2001/42/EC – The Strategic Environmental Assessment Directive) and identifies where in this Sustainability Report the relevant information can be found.

Table 1.1: Matters for Inclusion in the Environmental Report

Requirements	Where covered in the Sustainability Report
a) An outline of the contents, main objectives of the plan, and relationship with other relevant plans and programmes	<i>Chapter 1 and Annex A</i>
b) The relevant aspects of the current state of the environment and the likely evolution thereof without implementation of the plan	<i>Chapter 3 and Annex B</i>
c) The environmental characteristics of areas likely to be significantly effected	<i>Chapter 3 and Annex B</i>
d) Any existing environmental problems which are relevant to the plan including, in particular, those relating to any areas of a particular environmental importance, such as areas designated pursuant to Directives 79/409/EEC and 92/43/EEC	<i>Chapter 4 and Annex B</i>
e) The environmental protection objectives, established at international, Community or national level, which are relevant to the plan and the way those objectives and any environmental considerations have been taken into account during its preparation	<i>Chapter 3 and Annex A</i>

Requirements	Where covered in the Sustainability Report
f) The likely significant effects on the environment, including on issues such as biodiversity, population, human health, fauna, flora, soil, water, air, climatic factors, material assets, cultural heritage including architectural and archaeological heritage, landscape and the interrelationship between the above factors. (These effects should include secondary, cumulative, synergistic, short, medium and long-term, permanent and temporary, positive and negative effects).	<i>Chapters 5 and 6 and Annexes C and D</i>
g) The measures envisaged to prevent, reduce and as fully as possible offset any significant adverse effects on the environment of implementing the plan	<i>Sections 6.2, 6.3 , 6.5 and Annex D</i>
h) An outline of the reasons for selecting the alternatives dealt with, and a description of how the assessment was undertaken including any difficulties (such as technical deficiencies or lack of know-how) encountered in compiling the required information	<i>Chapter 2, 5 and 6</i>
i) A description of measures envisaged concerning monitoring in accordance with Article 10	<i>Section 6.6</i>
j) A non-technical summary of the information provided under the above headings.	<i>Preceding Chapter 1</i>

2 METHODOLOGY

2.1 INTRODUCTION

This Section describes briefly the methodology that has been used for the study which follows best practice guidance⁷.

The methodology has been described in detail in the previous Sustainability Reports of September 2011^{2,4} and was informed and refined through the course of meetings with an SA/SEA Steering Group made up of representatives from both Councils. It incorporates strategic flood risk, health and equalities impact assessment.

The following links give the reader access to the previous Sustainability Reports:

One Core Strategy

- <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2572528>
- <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2572529>

Urban Core Area Action Plan

- <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2572488>
- <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2572500>

2.2 HEALTH AND EQUALITIES IMPACT ASSESSMENT

It was decided that it would be more efficient to fully integrate the Health Impact Assessment (HIA) and the Equalities Impact and Needs Assessment (EINA) into the Sustainability Appraisal rather than treating them as separate studies. Government Guidance on integrating Health into Strategic Environmental Assessment confirms that this approach is appropriate.¹⁰ The six stages set out below can each incorporate key elements of the HIA and EINA and permit the full assessments to be carried out in an iterative way. Reference is made in key tasks outlined below as to where elements of the HIA and EINA can be fully integrated. Both of these assessments require the following stages:

- agreeing the scope;
- consultation with relevant stakeholders (health and equalities);
- reviewing relevant plans, programmes and strategies;
- determining the key issues;
- gathering baseline information (including literature review of relevant evidence);
- ensuring that the topics are reflected in the sustainability objectives to be used in the appraisal;
- ensuring that key question sets are used in the assessment;
- bringing health and equalities out as relevant sections within the sustainability report;
- developing appropriate indicators; and
- inclusion within the monitoring programme.

¹⁰ See: Draft Guidance on Health in Strategic Environmental Assessment, Consultation Document, Department of Health, 2007

2.3 STRATEGIC FLOOD RISK ASSESSMENT

In line with the requirements of Planning Policy Statement 25 (PPS25)¹¹, the results of the borough-wide Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) and Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP) have fed into the Sustainability Appraisal and have been used to determine the baseline conditions.

All Policies in this Sustainability Appraisal have been assessed according to Sustainability Objective 7B, which states:

“Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development”

Under this objective several strategic questions have been answered for each policy assessment, where they are deemed to be relevant:

- Are the flood risks (depths and hazards), prior to mitigation, significant, and could result in a risk of loss life to people using the site?
- Can the development be made safe once developed and are the residual risks acceptable?
- Is the increase in risk posed by climate change easily adapted to and/or can the development build in climate change resilience?
- Can flood risk to adjacent lands stay the same or be reduced as a result of the development and its mitigation measures?

As far as possible, at this borough-wide stage, the map produced for the SFRA has been used to determine the answers to these questions in the assessment.

It is clear that those policies within the Plan which are of a more spatial nature (e.g. Policy CS2 – Spatial Strategy for Urban Core, Policy CS3 – Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area and Policy CS4 – Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area) are more relevant to the SFRA and so the appraisal of these policies contain more detail under Objective 7b than most other policies (see Annex C).

The result of the overall Sustainability Appraisal in-turn fed back into the sequential test for the site specific SFRA, which was undertaken in advance of the final submission of the Plan. This was an iterative process and was continually updated until the sequential or exception tests for the SFRA were completed for all potential development sites, unless otherwise specified within the SFRA. Flood risk is split into several Flood Zones (1, 2, 3) – the higher the grade, the greater the risk of flooding. Detailed probabilities of flooding within these zones can be found in the SFRA reports.

2.4 SA PROCESS

2.4.1 Introduction

The review of plans programmes and strategies, the baseline environment, the sustainability issues, and the sustainability objectives are discussed and presented in relation to the four principle sustainable development themes that have been established for the ‘Bridging Document’¹²:

¹¹ Department for Communities and Local Government (2009) Planning Policy Statement 25: Development and Flood Risk. Available: <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/development-and-flood-risk-practice-guide-planning-policy-statement-25>

¹² Bridging Document Developing Sustainable Cities NewcastleGateshead 2030, 2010

- Economic Growth and Prosperity
- Health and Wellbeing
- Housing and Thriving Neighbourhoods
- Sustainable Quality of Place

The 'Bridging Document' brings together the core aims of the Sustainable Community Strategies of both Gateshead and Newcastle that in turn underpin the key objectives of the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan.

2.4.2 Review of Relevant Plans and Programmes and Strategies (PPS)

This task included revisiting all of the relevant national, regional and local plans, programmes and strategies that had been previously reviewed and filling in any gaps and updating where necessary their relevance to the Plan and how they contribute to further shaping and informing:

- the baseline situation;
- the sustainability objectives to be used for the appraisal; and
- the sustainability issues to be considered.

A review of the most relevant PPS has been included in the main text of this Sustainability Appraisal Report (see Table 3.1). This table shows how each plan, programme or strategy reviewed has been used to inform the baseline, sustainability objectives or sustainability issues. This table is supported by Annex A that gives greater detail on each PPS together with a full list of higher-level strategies that provide further context to the Plan.

2.4.3 Collection of Relevant Baseline Information

Sufficient information about the current and likely future status of the plan area has been gathered to:

- provide the basis for predicting and evaluating effects;
- identify sustainability issues in the area;
- inform the identification of alternative ways of dealing with these issues;
- inform the development of the SA framework including objectives and indicators;
- inform future monitoring proposals; and
- identify where there may be shortfalls in information.

This information is collated as Annex B.

2.4.4 Identifying Sustainability Issues and Problems

The key sustainability issues that the area faces have been articulated in previous SA/SEA work. For this SA the issues previously identified have been re-examined in the context of the relevant baseline economic, environmental and social conditions.

The resulting sustainability issues are outlined in Chapter 4 and summarised in Table 4.1.

2.4.5 Developing the Sustainability Framework

The development of the SA framework has been described in detail in both the previous Scoping Reports^{1,3} and the Sustainability Reports^{2,4}. They are based on the Newcastle and Gateshead Sustainability Charter and refined to take into

account the needs of health, equalities and strategic flood risk assessments. Reference has also been made to relevant plans and programmes that were identified as part of the baseline review (see Annex A). These objectives provide the “sustainability yardstick” against which the social, environmental and economic effects of the Plan can be tested.

The outcome of the appraisals have been fed back and taken into account in the development of the Plan and the policies refined in an iterative way with the overall aim being to deliver more sustainable development. The Sustainability Appraisal Framework is presented in Annex E.

2.5 APPRAISAL OF THE EFFECTS OF THE PLAN POLICIES

2.5.1 Assessing the Effects of the Strategic and Urban Core Policies

The SA framework was used to predict the potential effects of each policy in social, environmental and economic terms. Best practice guidance on evaluation was followed and included an assessment of the likely effects on people and the natural and cultural heritage as well as considering wider sustainability issues. Effects were considered in terms of their scale and the sensitivity of the resource, whether the effects were positive or negative, direct or indirect and whether there was potential for synergistic or cumulative effects to accrue. Wherever the potential for significant sustainability effects was identified the potential for mitigation was considered. The results of each assessment were set out in tables modelled on Table 2.1.

As the appraisal became more detailed checks were made of the interactions between policies in the Plan and the potential for conflict. Matrices such as that set out in Table 2.2 were used where appropriate as a check of the potential for cumulative sustainability effects to accrue from policies in the Plan.

Table 2.1: Example of the Appraisal Table used for the Assessment of the Plan Policies

The Plan Topic: Policy XX:							
Scale: ✓ Broadly supportive or minor positive effect, ✓✓ Clear and major positive effect, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✕ Overall impact likely to be negative, ✕✕ major negative, ✓✕ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✕ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic Objectives							
Social Objectives							
Environmental Objectives							
Summary							

The question sets used with the appraisal table shown in Table 2.1 are presented and explained in Annex E (Table E1).

Table 2.2 Example Matrix for Assessing the Potential for Cumulative Sustainability Effects of the Plan Policies

The Plan Policy	Sustainability Objective (SO) 1	SO 2	SO 3	SO 4 etc
1				
2				
3 etc				
Potential for Significant Cumulative Effects and Recommendations for Mitigation or Capturing the Benefit				
Key: + positive; - negative; o neutral; ? uncertain				

A simple scoring system to assess the options and policies against the SA framework was used as set out in Table 2.3 below.

Table 2.3: SA Framework Scoring System

Major positive effect	✓✓
Positive effect	✓
Neutral effect	0
Negative effect	x
Major negative effect	xx
Uncertain effect	?

A set of questions which was used to test the policies against the sustainability objectives is set out with the sustainability framework in Annex E.

The results of these appraisals are set out in Annex C.

2.5.2 Assessing the Effects of the Sub-Areas and Sites

The SA framework was used to predict the potential effects of each policy in social, environmental and economic terms. The format of the appraisal table together with the question sets for housing and employment land allocations are presented in Annex E in Tables E2 and E3. The results of these assessments are also set out in Annex C.

2.5.3 Mitigation

Mitigation was considered wherever the potential for significant negative effects was identified or if appropriate, where improvements could be made to change a neutral effect to a positive one. Mitigation measures included refinements of options and development and/or rewording of policies to better embrace sustainable development.

2.5.4 Developing Proposals for Monitoring

Proposals to monitor the sustainability effects of implementing the Plan were identified including measures to check:

- that the prediction of significant effects was accurate;

- that the Plan is contributing to the achievement of SA objectives and targets;
- that mitigation measures are performing as well as can be expected or require modifying; and
- whether any remedial measures are necessary to mitigate any adverse significant effects which had not been identified previously.

3 BASELINE REVIEW

3.1 INTRODUCTION

This Section summarises the review of baseline information, which has been undertaken to underpin the SA and to help develop the appraisal methodology. A summary of the baseline data collected and how it relates to the potential sustainability indicators proposed is given in Section 3.3.

3.2 RELEVANT PLANS AND PROGRAMMES INFLUENCING THE PLAN

As part of the Sustainability Appraisal methodology it is recognised that at an early stage (preferably during the baseline review) it is necessary to identify and review briefly any other relevant plans and programmes that will have a bearing on the Plan. The relationships need to be explored to make sure that any synergies are identified and that inconsistencies and constraints can be addressed. This document review, together with the review of baseline information has been used to inform the identification of the key sustainability issues (see Chapter 4) and to inform the development of the sustainability objectives (see Annex E).

In order to focus this review upon those documents that will have a clear and direct link with the development of the Plan, while ensuring that no strategically important documents are overlooked, the review is presented as follows:

- Table 3.1 showing the key plans, programmes and strategies (PPS) used to inform the Sustainability Appraisal and what they have been specifically used for;
- Annex A (Table A1) giving more detailed descriptions of each of the key documents reviewed and what bearing they have on the Plan and the Sustainability Appraisal; and
- Annex A (Table A2) listing all the higher level international, national and local plans, programmes and strategies that have been reviewed and that provide relevant background.

Table 3.1 Key Plans, Programmes and Strategies used to inform the Baseline (B), the Sustainability Appraisal Objectives (SO) and the Sustainability Issues (SI) within the SA/SEA (the complete list of Plans, Programmes and Strategies that have been rescanned are in Annex A)

Document		Used to Inform:			Comments
		B	SO	SI	
Overarching Policies					
National Planning Policy Framework (2012)					This document is a key part of the government's reforms to make the planning system less complex and more accessible by consolidating a lot of the individual Planning Policy documents. The framework acts as guidance for local planning authorities and decision-takers, both in drawing up plans and making decisions about planning applications. At the heart of the NPPF is a presumption in favour of sustainable development and it is expected that this will be seen as a 'thread' running through the plan-making and decision making processes. It provides a set of 12 principles that should underpin these processes that relate to issues such as social inclusion, community wellbeing, the implications of climate change amongst others. The NPPF will play a significant role in shaping the Plan.
	✓?	✓		✓	
Spatial Priorities for Change and Policies for Economy					
NewcastleGateshead 1Plan: An economic and spatial strategy for NewcastleGateshead 2010-2030 (2010)		✓		✓	The issues and objectives identified in the 1PLAN should play a key role in influencing the Local Development Framework for Gateshead and Newcastle and the evolution of the Plan. The 10 Key Steps will shape the operational priorities and investment programmes of Gateshead and Newcastle Councils. Although placed under the heading of 'Economic Growth and Prosperity' the 1PLAN also discusses themes and objectives that embrace the other three sustainable development themes so performs as a crosscutting document.
Sustaine: The Integrated Regional Framework for the North East of England (2008)		✓		✓	The Integrated Regional Framework, although somewhat dated now still nevertheless acts as an overarching strategy that provides some useful regional context. The issues and objectives within the Plan still need to reflect those of the wider regional strategy. This document can still play an influential role across all four of the sustainable development themes even though it is featured here under economic growth and prosperity so performs as a crosscutting document.
The North East of England Plan Regional Spatial Strategy to 2021 (2008)		✓		✓	Although this document was revoked in April 2013, it has been left in for reference purposes. Given that this document acted as an overarching regional strategy it still gives a steer as to where and how new development takes place within the North East region. It's implications for the issues and objectives in this Sustainability Appraisal still need to be taken into consideration. Although it mainly influences thinking on sustainable economic growth within the region it will also have an influence over the other three sustainable development themes so performs as a crosscutting document.

Document		Used to Inform:			Comments
B	SO	SI			
Gateshead/Newcastle Strategic Partnership (2010) Bridging Document Developing Sustainable Cities NewcastleGateshead 2030		✓	✓	SI	The purpose of the Bridging document is to set out the main policy challenges as articulated in Gateshead and Newcastle's SCSSs, to help shape the development of the previous 'One Core Strategy' to 2030, ensuring that together, Gateshead and Newcastle produce an ambitious, deliverable 20 year sustainable development plan. The ongoing SA of the Plan must therefore continue to take full account of this 'Bridging Document' in identifying issues and objectives. Although featured here under economic growth and prosperity this document will play an influential role across all four sustainable development themes so performs as a crosscutting document.
Policies for Homes					
Gateshead Council (2007) Vision 2030; Gateshead's Sustainable Community Strategy; and Newcastle City Council (2010) Newcastle 2030: Taking the City Forward, Newcastle Partnership's Sustainable Community Strategy March 2010		✓	✓		The Sustainable Community Strategies for Gateshead and Newcastle provide the 'community-based' vision of how Gateshead and Newcastle should develop in the future and the key objectives that will help to achieve this. The Plan performs essentially as a 'spatial tool' that can be used to achieve these objectives. The ongoing SA must take full recognition of these documents in identifying issues and objectives. Although featured here under 'housing and thriving neighbourhoods' they will help to inform and shape the other three sustainable development themes as well.
Gateshead Council (2008) Gateshead Local Development Framework – Consultation Towards our Core Strategy 2030; and Newcastle City Council (2004) Newcastle LDF Key Issues Report	✓	✓	✓		These wide ranging consultation documents takes into account the views of Gateshead and Newcastle residents and so will provide context for the baseline underpinning the SA.
Community Safety Unit (2009) Safe Newcastle Strategy 2008-2011; and Safer Gateshead (2009) Safer Gateshead Partnership Plan	✓				'Crime, fear of Crime and Antisocial behaviour' all have a resonance with successful place making and the ability to deliver thriving neighbourhoods. These documents provide important information to inform the baseline that underpins the SA.
NAREC (2012) Newcastle Energy Masterplan; Newcastle Partnership (2010) Newcastle Citywide Climate Change Strategy and Action Plan 2010-2020; Friends of the Earth (2004) Impacts of Climate Change in the North East; and Gateshead Strategic Partnership (2010) Climate Change Strategy Document 2010	✓				Energy efficiency in relation to housing, reducing carbon emissions that contribute to the causes of climate change and adapting to the effects of climate change through appropriately located housing all feature as important issues for building thriving neighbourhoods and these documents provide important information that informs the baseline.

Document		Used to Inform:			Comments
		B	SO	SI	
Newcastle City Council (2012) The Fairer Housing Delivery Plan		✓		✓	Identifies that families cannot find affordable accommodation. Lack of mid-market family houses. Brownfield sites to be prioritised for housing development. Further accommodation for older people and the disabled is needed.
Policies for People					
Newcastle City Council (2005) Air Quality Progress Report		✓			This information is important for the baseline because air quality needs to be monitored in order to establish the effect that spatial development could have on this parameter, the potential for consequential health impacts and the knock-on effects on community wellbeing.
Gateshead Council (2009) Gateshead Joint Strategic Needs Assessment; and Newcastle City Council (2009) Newcastle Joint Strategic Needs Assessment		✓	✓	✓	The health and wellbeing needs of the community are an integral component of the SA/SEA. These two documents provide important information that underpins the baseline as well as informing objective and issues development.
Gateshead Council (2006) Gateshead Open Spaces Strategy, and; Newcastle City Council (2004) Green Spaces...Your Spaces		✓		✓	'Lack of access to and quality of open spaces' has been identified as important issues for the Plan to address. These are now regarded as fundamental attributes for place making and 'sustainable urban design' and are associated with creating a 'quality environment' and 'quality places'. These two documents provide important information for informing the baseline and sustainability issues.
Durham Biodiversity Partnership (2007) Durham Biodiversity Action Plan; and Newcastle City Council (2012) Newcastle and North Tyneside Biodiversity Action Plan		✓			Biodiversity action plans and progress in the delivery of habitat and species plan targets, provide indications on the state of the natural environment and also how well the green infrastructure is performing in its support of wildlife. These two documents provide background information on biodiversity protection in the two council areas.
Gateshead Council (2013) Contaminated Land Strategy Newcastle City Council (2006) Inspection Strategy for Contaminated Land		✓			Derelict and contaminated land (commonly referred to as brownfield sites) historically has been a key issue for the industrialised and urban areas of the North East including Gateshead and Newcastle. Substantial pockets of derelict land have existed in the industrial areas in the near vicinity of the key centres of population as a result of former coal mining, coking and tar works, iron works and steel making, ship building and chemical manufacturing industries. The redevelopment of such areas poses significant challenges.

Document		Used to Inform:			Comments
B	SO	SI			
The Environment Agency (2012) Tyne Catchment Flood Management Plan: Policies and measures for managing flood risk Ouseburn policy unit, Revision 2	✓				Gateshead and Newcastle have the River Tyne a major river and associated floodplain with low-lying estuarine areas, which in a number of cases have become important industrial (port and associated activities) and city/urban centres. The Environment Agency emphasises a partnership approach with the relevant authorities to ensure all future developments within the policy unit are appropriate and reduce surface water runoff, where appropriate, and delivering integrated and co-ordinated flood risk management.
Gateshead City Council (2013) Level 1 and Level 2 Strategic Flood Risk Assessment and Sequential Test Report Summaries	✓	✓		✓	Flood risk in Gateshead and Newcastle is a complex issue and can arise from many potential sources. It is rightly a constraint to development and care is needed over the type and form of new development in high flood risk areas. Level 1 SFRA reviews currently available information on flood risk and Level 2 focuses on the avoidance and reduction of flood risk through careful planning and sustainable mitigation solutions.
Newcastle City Council (2013) Newcastle Strategic Flood Risk Assessment Sequential Test Update	✓	✓		✓	This plan outlines the preferred surface water management strategy to ensure that surface water does not constrain future development across Gateshead and Newcastle. The plan identifies areas at risk and preferred mitigation measures based on their suitability and practicality.
Newcastle Gateshead (2012) Surface Water Management Programme	✓	✓		✓	
Policies for Minerals and Waste					
Newcastle City Council (2005) Waste Management Strategy and Action Plan	✓				Waste entering landfill and low levels of recycling have been raised as key sustainability issue by the two councils. This strategy provides essential baseline information on current waste management activities.
Policies for Transport					
Tyne and Wear Integrated Transport Authority (2011) Keep Tyne and Wear Moving LPT3: The Third Local Transport Plan for Tyne and Wear Strategy 2011-2021	✓			✓	Transport issues within Gateshead and Newcastle must be approached in a way that is as sustainable as possible, connectivity and accessibility of services have been highlighted as issues in the SA and so there is a clear link with the Local Transport Strategy. Transport and its associated emissions clearly play an important role in the context of local air quality and nuisance which in turn will influence health and wellbeing in communities.

3.3 REVIEW OF ECONOMIC, ENVIRONMENTAL AND SOCIAL BASELINE CONDITIONS

3.3.1 Introduction

In order to formulate a sound data set to cover the baseline conditions for the Plan area it is necessary to provide information that will ensure that within the SA/SEA the requirements of the Environmental Assessment of Plans and Programmes Regulations 2004 are met as well as permitting a broader sustainability appraisal to be carried out. From an environmental viewpoint and in order to meet SEA requirements information must include:

- *'The relevant aspects of the current state of the environment and the likely evolution thereof without implementation of the plan or programme.'*
- *'The environmental characteristics of areas likely to be significantly affected.'*
- *'Any existing environmental problems which are relevant to the plan or programme including, in particular, those relating to any areas of a particular environmental importance, such as areas designated pursuant to Council Directive 79/409/EEC on the conservation of wild birds and the Habitats Directive.'*

In order to facilitate a robust SA process there is a need to provide relevant information on the current state of social and economic characteristics and the issues and objectives that it will need to address. The full text review of baseline conditions is contained within Annex B.

In this section of the Sustainability Report we present a summary overview of the key baseline conditions in relation to the four principle sustainable development themes that have been established for the 'Bridging Document' (see Section 2.4.1).

The purpose of this section is to outline the baseline economic, environmental and social topics that are relevant to the Gateshead and Newcastle Council areas and review the extent to which the Plan is likely to have an effect either positively or negatively on these issues. Table 3.2 indicates where the key SEA topics are primarily covered under the four sustainable development themes.

Table 3.2 Where the Key SEA Topics are Covered

Sustainable Development Theme	SEA Topics
Economic Growth and Prosperity	• Population • Human health • Cultural heritage including architectural and archaeological heritage • Material assets
Health and Wellbeing	• Population • Human health • Air • Water • Soil • Climatic factors • Cultural heritage including architectural and archaeological heritage • Landscape

Sustainable Development Theme	SEA Topics
Housing and Thriving Neighbourhoods	• Population • Human health • Material assets • Climatic factors • Cultural heritage including architectural and archaeological heritage
Sustainable Quality of Place (including Environmental Quality)	• Population • Human health • Air • Water • Soil • Climatic factors • Biodiversity (fauna and flora) • Landscape • Cultural heritage including architectural and archaeological heritage

Community regeneration, housing, economic development, retail development, service provision, new facilities, access provision and infrastructure development that are all likely to feature in the Plan, can all create significant impacts on the environment and contribute either positively or negatively to sustainability because they:

- can consume large amounts of natural resources in construction, maintenance and use;
- often relate to fixed assets with a long life (so can influence, for example, energy use and efficiency over a long period of time);
- as a result of the above will contribute to carbon emissions and climate change;
- are central to quality of life and can affect other key areas such as transport (sustainable transport options), health, safety, equalities, employment and community; and
- can affect environmental quality (including biodiversity and landscape) and cultural heritage.

3.3.2 Economic Growth and Prosperity

Background and Current Baseline

The development of the current Plan continues through challenging times. The relatively benign economic climate of the first half of the decade has faded in the aftermath of the banking crisis and as the economic recession worldwide has begun to set in. Sever austerity measures implemented by Government mean that local authorities have had to make drastic cuts in expenditure. Such cuts are usually accompanied by rising unemployment. Years of employment growth in the Plan area have come to a halt and unemployment is rising. Tyneside has long been recognised as the 'driver' of the regional economy with the economic measure of Gross Added Value having increased substantially during the last decade compared with other parts of the region. However, although the Plan area experienced economic growth prior to the recession it nevertheless continued to underperform in comparison with the rest of the UK. Despite experiencing a general rise in living standards, there are still very significant pockets of deprivation across the area.

Whilst the gaps in educational attainment have been narrowing, the area does underperform in general and the situation is significantly worse in the most deprived areas. There are poor levels of entrepreneurship and business formation. There is also a limited suitability and diversity of business accommodation, particularly office development in central locations. There is a threat of continuing decline of Newcastle City Centre's shopping centre and an under performance of Gateshead Town Centre and some of the district centres.

Relevance to the Plan

The Plan clearly plays a key role in the future spatial planning of the area and in future regeneration programmes by determining appropriate development priorities for employment and housing land. It is also likely to play a major role in developing objectives and policies for the provision of appropriate business accommodation in central locations, as well as addressing the transport infrastructure that will improve access and connectivity throughout the Plan area.

3.3.3 Health and Wellbeing

Background and Current Baseline

The UK's Sustainable Development Strategy⁹ suggests that some of the most deprived areas often bear the burden of some of the worst environmental impacts. These include dereliction, contaminated land, lack of green space, industrial pollution, risks of flooding and poor air quality. It goes on to emphasise that thriving sustainable communities are *"places where people want to live and work, now and in the future. They meet the diverse needs of existing and future residents, are sensitive to their environment, and contribute to a high quality of life. They are safe and inclusive, well planned, built and run, and offer equality of opportunity and good services for all."*

Gateshead and Newcastle Council areas continue to have some of the highest levels of ill health and deprivation in England. Reducing health inequalities, particularly around life expectancy is a priority. There is a very genuine threat of long term population decline and changing demographics - decades of population decline have now stopped, but there are low birth rates and an ageing population. A significant proportion of children and young people across Gateshead and Newcastle live in areas with the highest levels of deprivation, which impacts on their health and wellbeing. The health of individuals is linked to age, gender, some inherited factors, as well as deprivation and life style choices. Mortality rates for cancer, coronary heart disease and child health issues all show variations by deprivation category, where generally people in more deprived areas have poorer health. The trend demonstrates a general increase in life expectancy nationally however health in the most deprived areas of the UK improves more slowly than in the more affluent boroughs so the gap between best and worst is actually getting wider.

Local environment plays a key role in the quality of lives. Programmes to support improvements can make an important contribution to environmental justice as the most deprived communities often live in the worst environments. People living in the most deprived areas often experience particular concerns about their local environment and quality of life issues such as vandalism, crime, safety, the behaviour of young people, litter and dereliction. The historic mix and design of housing and subsequently neighbourhoods and communities within Gateshead and Newcastle appears to be out of balance with the needs and aspirations of local communities across the area. Similarly provision of an accessible healthy environment with suitable green infrastructure is vital for a healthy and thriving community. Green spaces clearly need to be accessible to all, as they can

provide distinct health benefits through both opportunities for physical exercise as well as the therapeutic value of parks and gardens. The Plan can clearly help to address these issues.

Another key component in addressing health inequalities will be ensuring that all residents who experience mental health problems or emotional distress are able to easily access a range of support services. This may be very difficult to measure (as are most non-clinical preventative activities) and the types of promotion and support activities that have benefit to those with low level mental health problems, such as improving confidence, self-esteem or therapeutic interventions are often viewed as lacking directly applicable evidence base or tangible evaluation. Also for many communities (BME and faith populations especially) mental health is not acknowledged or recorded well. With regard to healthy lifestyles access to and provision of affordable good quality food will be important and should help to address levels of obesity in children and adults (see Section B8 of Annex B).

There is a need within Gateshead and Newcastle to continue to encourage a shift to public transport, cycling and walking in order to ease traffic congestion and problems associated with community severance, caused by busy roads and to encourage healthier more active lifestyles. Opportunities also exist to increase levels of health and wellbeing through the provision of additional natural environment features through the enhancement of the Plan area's Green Infrastructure Network.

Relevance to the Plan

In its role as the overarching strategic spatial plan that will determine the delivery of future community regeneration and housing projects across the area, the Plan can influence improvements to disadvantaged communities. This can be done through its role in identifying realistic spatial options and progressive policies that can be used to deliver local environmental improvements (e.g. access to quality green space, quality places), access to public transport and more active non-motorised forms of travel (e.g. walking and cycling) alongside improvements in employability, education, health and access to local services. The provision of decent housing can also support improvements in health.

3.3.4 Housing and Thriving Neighbourhoods

Background and Current Baseline

Housing

In the Plan area there is a mix of neighbourhoods each performing different roles and functions within the housing market. Many of these areas are stable and offer a good range of housing options, but some areas experience problems relating to poor-quality housing and living environments. There is a need to look at how existing communities can be improved so that they are sustainable places of quality and choice.

In the Plan area there are over 8000 empty properties, equating to more than 4% of housing stock, which is generally higher than both North East and national averages. Although housing vacancy rates have improved due to interventions since 2001 this still remains an issue, particularly in the regeneration areas. There is a need therefore to better manage the turnover of properties so that empty properties don't have a detrimental effect on otherwise sustainable, safe and pleasant communities.

There is a challenge to address the residential offer across the Plan area that will match the needs and aspirations of people, and deliver the target number of new houses to support the desired growth and ambition of retaining and attracting economically active residents. For communities to be attractive and sustainable, they must offer a variety of good quality homes in terms of types, sizes and tenures. They should also cater for a mix of different households irrespective of cultural background and ethnicity, such as families with children, single person households and older people. Ensuring that the right type of housing continues to be built and that the housing offer is attractive to those wishing to live in Gateshead and Newcastle, is a key aspiration of the Bridging Document. The priority is to create cohesion and choice within communities, particularly in areas dominated by social housing.

Good quality of place will be fundamental in delivering the wider spatial planning objective set out in the Plan. High-quality urban design is a key element of place making and has a major role to play in enhancing the positive features of the plan area. The way places and buildings are planned, designed and looked after has a significant impact on individual lives. The built environment is an important influence on crime, health, education, inclusion, community cohesion and wellbeing. Successful place making is founded upon an understanding and respect for an area's unique built, historic, natural, cultural and socio economic context. Many areas within the Plan area have a distinctive character and sense of place as a result of their setting, historic development and the underlying land form.

The evidence base highlights that a better range and quality of housing is needed to improve the housing offer to support both regeneration and economic growth strategies. Making use of existing housing stock to best effect and securing efficient settlement patterns that include access to affordable and convenient transport will be a key feature.

Communities need a range of local services that are available to them where local shopping, primary healthcare, childcare and education facilities should be in close proximity to homes. This means that not only can travel be reduced, but those with limited mobility are not disadvantaged.

Safety

There is a clear need to address community safety concerns that relate to youth offending and anti-social behaviour. There are significant differences in how safe people feel when out in different parts of the Plan area.

Relevance to the Plan

The Plan can have a strong influence on future development in terms of making sure that the right kind of housing and development takes place in the most appropriate location.

The design and layout of the built environment can help to reduce crime, fear of crime and anti-social behaviour. A contributory factor to improving safety is to create and sustain a 'sense of place', where people take pride in their surroundings. Designing-out crime and designing-in community safety should be a core principle in planning any new development, as well as in helping to reduce crime and the fear of crime in existing developments. The Plan can ensure that developers take the necessary steps to design-in community safety.

3.3.5 Sustainable Quality of Place (including Environmental Quality)

Derelict Land, Water Quality and Floodplain Protection

Background and Current Baseline

Derelict and contaminated land (commonly referred to as brownfield sites) historically has been a key issue for the industrialised and urban areas of the North East including Gateshead and Newcastle. Substantial pockets have existed in the industrial areas in the near vicinity of the key centres of population as a result of former coal mining, coking and tar works, iron works and steel making, ship building and chemical manufacturing industries. The redevelopment of such areas poses significant challenges. Contaminated soils and other materials may be present, derelict infrastructure may need to be removed, there will be a need to ensure safe restoration for alternative uses and to prevent further soil and groundwater pollution.

Many former urbanised or industrial areas in the past have included significant historic interest as well as also sometimes containing biodiversity interests, so a further challenge is to manage the remediation whilst protecting these interests where they exist. In addition the construction of housing estates has the potential to have an effect on water quality, either during construction (disturbance of suspended solids, accidental spill) or via polluted run-off once the estate is in operation (from parking areas and feeder roads).

Within the Plan area there is the River Tyne a major river and associated floodplain with low-lying estuarine areas, which in a number of cases have become important industrial (port and associated activities) and city/urban centres. Intense development in such areas poses new challenges and threats with regard to flood protection and prevention. Similarly flooding is an important natural process and the positive effects as part of natural hydrological and ecological processes needs to be understood and where appropriate safeguarded.

Relevance to the Plan

In undertaking their housing and community regeneration responsibilities, Gateshead and Newcastle Councils have and will play a key role in supporting the careful redevelopment of brownfield sites. They will seek to prevent any further contamination of soils and groundwaters whilst at the same time ensuring that efficient use is made of vacant land. The key role of the Councils in actively supporting regeneration programmes and influencing the behaviour of housing developers and providers is critical with respect to these issues and the absence of clear policies could have an impact on community regeneration, health and safety.

Energy and Climate Change

Background and Current Baseline

Climate change is now widely recognised as the most serious environmental threat facing the planet. Emissions of greenhouse gases (GHGs), from the burning of fossil fuels (e.g. oil, coal, gas), are already making an impact on the world's climate. Latest projections suggest that by the end of this century the UK will have parts of the country that are warmer and drier, other parts that have wetter winters, less snowfall and an increased risk of flooding¹³.

¹³ DEFRA (2009) Adapting to Climate Change: UK Climate Change Projections

The UK Government has set an ambitious domestic target of reducing CO₂ emissions by 80% below 1990 levels by 2050 with an interim target of at least 34% by 2020¹⁴.

Relevance to the Plan

Energy efficiency is a key issue for new or refurbished buildings (housing, retail, office, commercial) and relates to improving the quality of housing and other building stock and promoting measures for increasing efficiency (e.g. insulation, boiler efficiency etc), as well as promoting the use of non-fossil fuel derived energy from renewables and microgeneration.

Traffic and transport is another area where there are growing emissions and there is a need to cut out the reliance on the car and promote more sustainable forms of transport such as cycling and walking.

Policies within the Plan should be able to provide a clear steer for future development both in terms of energy generation and consumption, as well as in transport and accessibility, and assist the Government in achieving the challenging targets.

There is a need for the Plan to address the requirement for mitigation and adaptation measures for the natural, historic and cultural environment to respond to the impacts of climate change. Policies should be developed that emphasise the importance of climate change adaptation both in terms of the natural environment (importance of green infrastructure and 'ecosystem services') and historic environment (impacts from adaptive responses).

Use of Natural Resources

Background and Current Baseline

The UK's Sustainable Development Strategy⁹ highlights that current lifestyle patterns are unsustainable, and discusses their global significance. It also sets out a number of priorities to help reduce the "global footprint". A major challenge is to move towards more sustainable consumption and production i.e. achieving more with less. This will include reducing inefficient use of resources and looking at the impact of products and materials across their whole life-cycle. In the UK as a whole the construction industry uses six tonnes of material per person per year¹⁵.

House building, the construction of industrial premises, commercial units, roads and other infrastructure with the wide range of materials and resources used in both construction and operation have a significant role to play here. Issues that will need to be considered include:

- more sustainable and local sourcing of raw materials (reducing the transportation burden);
- resource consumption and efficiency in particular water and embodied energy;
- more recovery, reuse and recycling of materials;
- replacing environmentally damaging materials with less harmful alternatives;
- minimising waste and maximising energy efficiency in the production and supply of materials;

¹⁴ HM Government (2008) The Climate Change Act (as amended)

¹⁵ The Scottish Government (2008) The Sustainable Housing Design Guide for Scotland

- the way that design and construction affects future use and operation of properties by householders and businesses over the life of buildings (life-cycle thinking); and
- consideration of repairing and adapting existing buildings before progressing with demolition and rebuilding (which will also help to safeguard historic assets and foster a 'sense of place').

Each person in the UK uses 150 litres of water a day. This takes into account cooking, cleaning, washing and flushing. This has been rising by 1% a year since 1930. This consumption level is not sustainable in the long-term¹⁶.

Relevance to the Plan

The encouragement of sustainable urban planning and design (sustainable resource use, energy efficiency and renewables, waste prevention, recovery and recycling) with an appropriate mix of green infrastructure and good place making included, should help to address the social and environmental needs.

Biodiversity and Landscape

Background and Current Baseline

The surrounding countryside and landscape together with the historic environment and cultural heritage have shaped the cultural identity of the Plan area. The area has a mosaic of habitats and diverse landscape character including river, wetlands, estuary, coastline, green spaces, and nearby examples of important conservation areas on a European scale (e.g. the Northumbria Coast Special Protection Area). There are a number of designated nature conservation sites including Sites of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI) and local nature reserves. Nature and wildlife do not, however, belong solely in either just the countryside or in designated sites, the Biodiversity Strategy for England¹⁷ emphasises that – '*An important part of our biodiversity has its home in urban areas, whether inner cities, market towns or suburbs*', and goes on to express a vision of ensuring that – '*biodiversity conservation is integral to measures to improve the quality of people's lives, delivered through other initiatives e.g. Community Strategies, including Neighbourhood Renewal and Cultural Strategies, social inclusion, health and equality of opportunity.*'

Biodiversity in urban habitats can be threatened by industrial development, house building and related activities such as new high density/low green space housing and other built developments on existing green space, infill and brownfield sites, road traffic and inappropriate management of green spaces. In line with the NPPF there is a need to ensure that development on previously developed land, where such sites have significant biodiversity or geological interest or recognised local importance, there is the need to retain this interest or incorporate it into any development of the site.

Relevance to the Plan

The construction of large housing developments could have a number of potential effects on biodiversity including direct damage to habitats and/or protected species, fragmentation or loss of habitats and even damage to designated sites. Both the physical land take and visual appearance of housing developments can cause impacts on the existing landscape. Green infrastructure in the Plan area is not wholly fit for purpose and past development has sometimes impacted negatively by removing or severing green corridors that link to green spaces and

¹⁶ Waterwise (2010) Reducing Water Wastage in the UK

¹⁷ DEFRA (2002) Working with the Grain of Nature, A Biodiversity Strategy for England

nearby countryside. The Plan will have an important role to play in establishing policies to deal with protecting and enhancing biodiversity and in safeguarding green spaces and the provision of green infrastructure throughout the area. The Plan also has an important role to play in protecting and enhancing the landscape character of the area.

Cultural Heritage, Streetscapes and Public Realm

Background and Current Baseline

The Plan area can demonstrate some of the UK's most precious and special historic, cultural and built environments (e.g. Hadrian's Wall, the Grainger Town area, Newcastle and Gateshead Keys etc). The historic environment and cultural heritage have helped to shape the area's cultural identity. The historic environment is nevertheless fragile and vulnerable to damage including impacts that could arise from house building and industrial development. As well as direct impacts, construction of new buildings and infrastructure may affect the wider landscape setting of particular sites or sensitive historic landscapes and traffic calming measures for housing developments may affect the character of townscapes and the public realm. There could also be impacts on gardens and designed landscapes that are present in the area.

Relevance to the Plan

Some communities in the Plan area experience poor quality public realm, land/streetscapes and built environment generally, diminishing the sense of quality of place and ultimately peoples' wellbeing. There are areas where development detracts from the local character of areas. The Plan clearly has a role to play in shaping policies and steering development to the most appropriate locations, in order to safeguard the cultural heritage and where possible enhance streetscapes and the public realm, which can all be part of active place making – the creation of quality places.

Development, over the life-time of the Plan, must be used to enhance the existing unique and diverse heritage assets and landscape characteristics. Development must enhance those characteristics that contribute to local distinctiveness, whilst renewing and improving the building stock, and having particular regard to the environmental performance of buildings and the mitigation of climate change. High quality urban design together with architectural quality and the conservation of the historic environment should ensure that the built environment is developed in a positive manner, enhancing existing positive characteristics.

4 SUSTAINABILITY ISSUES

The sustainability issues listed in Table 4.1 have been identified and informed by:

- careful examination of previous work undertaken by Gateshead and Newcastle Councils during preparatory work towards individual Core Strategies;
- reference to the strategic baseline conditions (see Chapter 3);
- consideration of the outcomes from the NewcastleGateshead Visioning event held by the Strategic Partnerships of both Councils in December 2009;
- review and sense checks carried out by the Steering Group; and
- feedback from the consultation with the Statutory Authorities during the Scoping stage.

They have also been ‘refreshed’ since the production of the SA Report in September 2011 as the current plan has evolved.

The identification of sustainability issues has made sure that the framework includes objectives and indicators relevant to all identified issues. This ensures that the sustainability issues will be adequately considered in the Plan.

Table 4.1 presents a summary of the key sustainability issues that have been identified, arranged under the four principle sustainable development themes. An indication of which section of the baseline provides evidence for each particular issue is also provided.

Table 4.1 Key Sustainability Issues

Sustainability Issue	Section of the Baseline Annex where evidence for this is detailed
Economic Growth and Prosperity	
Housing market weakness and failure	B.13: Housing Standards
Social impacts of the economic downturn	B.5: Employment
Vitality and viability of economic centres	B.5: Employment and B.6: Material Assets
Worklessness	B.5: Employment
Areas of low educational achievement	B.9.6 Education
Lack of higher education graduates working in Gateshead and Newcastle	B.9.6 Education
Health and Wellbeing	
Demand on health and social services caused by an ageing population and changing demographics, particularly relating to spatial distribution of older members of the population	B.9.1: Age Profile and B.10: Current Population Size and Population Projections
Life expectancy below the national average	B.8: Health
Poor mental health	B.8: Health
Poor physical health (with links to obesity), the need to promote healthy active lifestyles and access to fresh and local food ¹⁸	B.8: Health
Unhealthy Alcohol Culture	B.8: Health

¹⁸ NB. The term “obesity” is based on the clinical classification and takes account of the fact that most people overestimate their current levels of activity.

Sustainability Issue	Section of the Baseline Annex where evidence for this is detailed
Housing and Thriving Neighbourhoods	
Shortage of affordable housing of an appropriate standard	B.13: Housing Standards
Growing population needed to sustain economic growth	B.10: Current Population Size and Population Projections
Crime, fear of Crime and Antisocial behaviour	B.15: Crime and Anti-Social Behaviour
Pockets of relative deprivation	B.17: Multiple Deprivation and Social Exclusion
Lack of access to and quality of open spaces	B.21: Green Space, Green Infrastructure Network and Public Realm
Historic environment vulnerable to inappropriate development	B.12: The Historical Environment and Heritage Assets
Areas with lack of reasonable access to services and essential facilities	B.6.1: Transport Infrastructure and B.6.2: Sustainable Transport Infrastructure
Need to continue and encourage shift to public transport, cycling and walking in order to ease traffic congestion and problems associated with severance	B.6.1: Transport Infrastructure and B.6.2: Sustainable Transport Infrastructure
Sustainable Quality of Place (including Environmental Quality)	
Pollution and poor air quality issues	B.24: Air Quality
Rising traffic volumes and associated traffic congestion	B.6.1: Transport Infrastructure
Need to actively promote biodiversity	B.20: Biodiversity
There is a need to protect and enhance biodiversity and geodiversity, and reduce fragmentation of habitat networks	B.20: Biodiversity
Lower levels of energy efficiency and renewable energy usage have been implemented than are required to meet greenhouse gas reduction targets	B.6.5: Energy Production
Need to limit greenhouse gas contributions to climate change	B.25.1: Green House Gas production and Ecological Footprinting
Adaptation to climate change (both natural and historic environment)	B.20.2: Local Biodiversity and B.23.2: Flooding
Amount of waste entering landfill and low levels of recycling	B.6.4: Waste and Recycling
Balance between development on greenfield sites and development on previously developed land	B.21: Green Space, Green Infrastructure Network and Public Realm
Lack of accessible green space	B.21: Green Space, Green Infrastructure Network and Public Realm
The need to protect and enhance local landscape and townscape character	B.26: Landscape and Cityscape

5 SUMMARY OF THE SUSTAINABILITY APPRAISAL OF THE PLAN POLICIES

5.1 INTRODUCTION

5.1.1 General Introduction

The Plan sets out the joint vision, strategic objectives and overall strategy for the spatial development of the Gateshead and Newcastle Council areas as an integrated development area. It contains 12 Strategic Objectives that are the basis for 74 more detailed policies with supporting text. These reflect the incorporation of the original Urban Area Action Plan into the previous One Core Strategy that has now become a single plan – ‘the Plan’.

The 74 policies give direction on how development will take place in the Plan area and are summarised in Table 5.1. They are comprised of:

- 4 Strategic Spatial Policies – CS1 to CS4
- 17 Strategic Policies – CS5 – CS21
- 17 Urban Core Policies – UC1 – UC17
- 17 Sub Area and Sites Policies for Newcastle
- 18 Sub Area and Sites Policies for Gateshead
- 1 Developer Contribution Policy

These were appraised using the sustainability framework in order to test their sustainability. Although the same framework of sustainability objectives was used for assessing policies the question sets were different for the Sub Area and Sites Policies as these were more locational specific (see Annex C for details).

Table 5.1: Policies Subject to Detailed Sustainability Appraisal

Number	Policy Topic
Spatial Strategy	
Policy CS1	Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth
Policy CS2	Spatial Strategy for Urban Core
Policy CS3	Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area
Policy CS4	Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area
Strategic Policies	
Policy CS5	Employment and Economic Growth Priorities
Policy CS6	Employment Land
Policy CS7	Retail and Centres
Policy CS8	Leisure, Culture and Tourism
Policy CS9	Existing Communities
Policy CS10	Delivering New Homes
Policy CS11	Providing a Range and Choice of Housing
Policy CS12	Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Showpeople
Policy CS13	Transport
Policy CS14	Wellbeing and Health
Policy CS15	Place Making
Policy CS16	Climate Change
Policy CS17	Flood Risk and Water Management
Policy CS18	Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment
Policy CS19	Green Belt
Policy CS20	Minerals
Policy CS21	Waste
Urban Core Policies	
Policy UC1	Offices and Business Development

Number	Policy Topic
Policy UC2	New Retail (A1) in Newcastle and Gateshead
Policy UC3	Leisure, Culture and Tourism
Policy UC4	Homes
Policy UC5	Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes
Policy UC6	Cycling
Policy UC7	Public Transport
Policy UC8	Freight and Servicing
Policy UC9	General Traffic
Policy UC10	Car Parking
Policy UC11	Gateways and Arrival Points
Policy UC12	Urban Design
Policy UC13	Respecting and Managing Views Within, and From the Urban Core
Policy UC14	Heritage
Policy UC15	Urban Green Infrastructure
Policy UC16	Public Realm
Policy UC17	Public Art
Sub-Areas and Sites - Newcastle	
Policy NC1	Newcastle Central Sub-Area
Policy NC2	East Pilgrim Street Key Site
Policy C1	Civic Sub-Area
Policy C2	Science Central Key Site
Policy D1	Discovery Sub-Area Policy
Policy D2	Stephenson quarter Key Site
Policy D3	Forth Yards Development Opportunity Site
Policy QO1	Quayside and Ouseburn Sub-Area
Policy AOC1	Newburn
Policy NN1	Lower, Middle and Upper Callerton
Policy NN2	Kingston Park/Kenton Bank Foot
Policy NN3	Newbiggin Hall
Policy NN4	Newcastle Great Park
Policy KEA1	Newcastle International Airport
Policy NV1	Dinnington
Policy NV2	Hazlerigg & Wideopen
Policy NV3	Throckley
Sub-Areas and Sites - Gateshead	
Policy GC1	Gateshead Central Sub-Area
Policy GC2	Gateshead Central Development Opportunity
Policy SG1	Southern Gateway Sub-Area
Policy SG2	The Exemplar Neighbourhood Key Site
Policy SG3	Southern Gateway Development Opportunity
Policy QB1	Quays and Baltic Sub-Area
Policy QB2	Gateshead Quays Key Site
Policy QB3	Quays and Baltic Development Opportunity Sites
Policy AOC2	Metrogreen
Policy GN1	Dunston Hill
Policy GV1	Chopwell
Policy GV2	Crawcrook
Policy GV3	Highfield
Policy GV4	High Spen
Policy GV5	Kibblesworth
Policy GV6	Ryton
Policy GV7	Sunnyside
Policy KEA2	South of Follingsby Lane
Policy DEL1	Infrastructure and Developer Contributions

The appraisal results for each policy are presented as individual tables in Annex C. An overall summary of the sustainability performance of these policies is presented in Section 5.2 below.

5.1.2 Testing the Strategic Objectives of the Plan

In this task the Strategic Objectives of the Plan were checked to ensure that they were in accordance with sustainability principles. This has been done by checking their compatibility with the objectives in the SA framework. The findings are included in Annex E.

5.2 STRATEGIC POLICIES WITHIN THE PLAN

Table 5.2 below sets out the appraisal of the Plan's 21 Strategic Policies. To help with the interpretation of the findings, symbols have been used to capture the main thrust of the appraisal. These are:

- ✓ overall impact broadly supportive towards the sustainability objective,
- ✓✓ clear contribution, strong positive impacts,
- 0 neutral or no discernible effect,
- ✗ overall impact likely to be negative,
- ✗✗ clear strong negative impacts,
- ✓✗ a mix of positive and negative effects
- ? impact uncertain or unclear,
- ? ✓ uncertain possible positive,
- ? ✗ uncertain possible negative

These summary appraisals have been taken from Annex C which presents the full appraisal of each policy against the sustainability framework. The summary assessment is presented together with a column that provides a commentary and any further suggested amendments to policies if appropriate.

The conclusions from this appraisal of the Strategic Policies indicate that there are no further modifications of policies required in order for the sustainability objectives to be delivered. The recent changes made to the policies and their supporting text means that recommendations made in previous sustainability appraisals have been met.

5.3 URBAN CORE POLICIES

Table 5.3 sets out the results of the appraisal of the Plan's 17 Urban Core Policies. As with Table 5.2 to help with the interpretation of the findings the same suite of symbols have been used in the appraisal. As before these summary appraisals have been taken from Annex C which presents the full appraisal of each policy against the sustainability framework. The summary assessment is presented together with a column that provides a commentary and any further suggested amendments to policies if appropriate.

The conclusions from this appraisal of the Urban Core Policies indicate that there are no further modifications of policies required in order for the sustainability objectives to be delivered. Because the Urban Core Area Action Plan has now been merged with the Core Strategy to create the current 'Plan' it is much clearer how the overarching 'Strategic Policies' will work with the more location-specific Urban Core Policies. Much repetition has been removed and the recent changes and streamlining made to the policies and their supporting text means that recommendations made in previous sustainability appraisals have been met.

Table 5.2 Summaries of the Sustainability Appraisal of each of the 21 Strategic Policies within the Plan together with Comments

Core Strategy Policies		Summary of Assessment		Comments and Possible Further Amendments	
Spatial Strategy					
Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth		Social: ✓✓ The focus of this policy is to facilitate through effective spatial planning the growth and development of strategic growth areas to deliver a more prosperous and attractive Gateshead and Newcastle. The policy is framed positively to support the more 'socially orientated' by focusing growth and development in the most sustainable and accessible locations in Gateshead and Newcastle. It also has the addition of a new set of 'Development Principles' in Clause 8 and the Sub-Clauses (i) to (iii) have a particularly strong social focus with an emphasis on inclusive development that respects equality and diversity principles and which promotes community cohesion and wellbeing. There are also references to enhancing neighbourhoods, sustaining villages and the rural economy and support for existing employment areas, and an emphasis on new development areas being in locations that must be sustainably connected and designed to high standards. This is all very supportive of the social objectives and with the simultaneous application of other overarching policies, in particular Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health and Policy CS15: Place Making, the positive effects will be further enhanced, with the opportunity for these positive effects to be felt by all residents of the area. Environmental: ✓(✓) By placing an emphasis on the presumption in favour of sustainable development and to 'directing development to sustainable locations', with an emphasis on the Urban Core, the policy is likely to make positive contributions towards the sustainability objectives that have an environmental thrust. By focusing development on previously developed land in the targeted regeneration areas there is less likelihood of generating adverse impacts on the natural environment. Along with the simultaneous application of Policies CS16: Climate Change, CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management, CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment this will ensure positive implications for the environmental and cultural heritage assets of the area. Economic: ✓✓ With its aim to stimulate the economy through making provision for substantial development in sustainable and accessible locations, this policy is likely to have strong positive effects on the economic objectives. Through the development of the urban core for major development including office, retail, commercial leisure, culture and tourism and supporting expansion and improvement of existing employment areas the policy will have strongly positive implications for providing new jobs and thus boosting the economy of the region.		The principles of delivering: • a fully inclusive society • a high level of community cohesion • a community that is well connected • high levels of accessibility are all now set out in 4 robust Development Principles within Policy CS1. The supporting text at Paragraph 5.11 now makes it quite clear how equality and diversity needs will be met. The role and contribution that the spatial strategy can make to the equalities and wellbeing agendas has also been made stronger with the inclusion of text that refers specifically to these issues within Policy CS14 – Wellbeing and Health. No changes or modifications deemed necessary.	
Policy CS2: Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core		Social: ✓ to ✓✓ The policy is assessed as being likely to generate positive effects on the social objectives, particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered. Improving the strength and vibrancy of the Urban Core will help to improve social conditions within the area. This policy together with other overarching policies seek to tackle social inclusion issues and promote community cohesion. The only risk is that a		No changes or modifications deemed necessary.	

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	major focus on the Urban Core could leave little investment available for other areas; in particular those in more remote rural locations. However delivery alongside other area-wide spatial policies (such as CS3: Neighbourhood Areas and CS4: Rural and Villages Area) and economic regeneration policies (Policies CS5 and CS6) should ensure the economic benefits are shared across Gateshead and Newcastle and should therefore deliver wider social benefits. Environmental: ? ✖ to ✓ The effects of encouraging more office, retail, leisure and tourism developments together with residential development and associated facilities and services in the Urban Core, were considered to be uncertain but possibly negative with regard to impacts on the natural environment with issues like air quality (from e.g. increases in vehicle use associated with industrial/commercial uses), resource use and waste (again from the additional commercial/industrial/retail developments) likely to increase. Impacts on the wider natural environment would be expected to be less significant if development was concentrated in city/town centres within the Urban Core. If the commitment in Policy CS18 - to maintain, protect and enhance the integrity, connectivity, multifunctionality and accessibility of the strategic green infrastructure network is delivered then development within the Urban Core should be broadly positive towards the natural environment. Economic: ✓✓ This policy is likely to have major positive effects on the economic objectives. The provision of retail and expanding office space will make a positive contribution to sustaining the local economy and should therefore also support the creation of new jobs in the future. Social: ✓ to ✓✓	
Policy CS3: Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area	The policy is assessed as having a broadly positive impact on social objectives by identifying those areas which have the greatest need for investment and which present the greatest opportunity to support growth in the population and growth in the economy whilst also reducing current inequalities between Neighbourhoods. The areas mentioned in the policy are accessible from the Urban Core and on the whole are well served by public transport, walking and cycling routes. The policy aims to ensure residential development meets the needs of the current and future communities by providing access to a range of facilities and services, improving accessibility and providing a range of housing options. Environmental: ? ✖ to ✓ The main focus of the policy is to improve the sustainability of existing communities primarily through improving access to a range of sustainable transport modes and links to the wider transport network. It places development largely on previously developed land (regeneration and growth areas). The majority of the areas mentioned for regeneration are in good and potentially sustainable locations; however, one of the areas mentioned in the policy requires additional works to make it more viable as sites for development – Dunston Hill (GN1). Dunston had been shown on the borough wide Strategic Flood Risk Assessment to be in Flood Zone 2 – at risk from tidal flooding – on its northern edge, from	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	the River Tyne. Policy CS18 states that green infrastructure will be expected to maximise the potential for flood water storage. The development of Dunston would be likely to include flood storage measures. The development within the Neighbourhood areas associated with this policy has the potential to impact on environmental assets and infrastructure, however when combined with strategic policies 16, 17 and 18 (the latter stating that development will protect and enhance biodiversity and designated sites) this infrastructure should be protected. Economic: ✓ to ✓✓ In terms of economic objectives it was assessed that this policy is likely to have positive effects. The policy has identified those areas which have the greatest need for investment and which present the greatest opportunity to support growth in the population (via residential development) and growth in the economy. The areas mentioned in the policy are accessible from the Urban Core, are in a Local Enterprise Zone and on the whole are well served by public transport, walking and cycling routes, and are supported by a range of facilities and services. Social: ✓ The policy is assessed as having a broadly positive impact on social objectives by improving conditions in rural areas through increasing accessibility, housing choice and availability, provision of services and facilities. Environmental: ? * to ✓ This policy has a mix of effects ranging from an uncertain but probable negative effect on some sustainability objectives, through to broadly positive implications for others. The negative effects relate to the likelihood that new developments during construction and operation will generate carbon emissions (heating and energy use, etc), will use non-renewable resources (e.g. building materials), will lead to the generation of waste and the possible increase in car emissions, and negatively impact on areas of nature conservation, which are all hard to eradicate completely. They should, however be minimised by the simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making and CS16: Climate Change. The simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment should ensure that new development is built in such a way as to ensure minimal impact on the natural and historic environment and in some cases improve conditions such as creating new green infrastructure and green space. Overall this policy was assessed as having an uncertain but leading towards a positive effect on environmental objectives. In some of the locational assessments it was noted that some sites were in reasonably close proximity to areas of conservation interest, however, it is assumed that appropriate mitigation would be picked up at the EIA stage and through the rigorous application of policy CS18. For example, given the proximity of Throckley to the Hadrian's Wall World Heritage Site and its buffer zone, impacts upon the setting of the World Heritage site will have to be a consideration of any new development or regeneration in this area.	
Policy CS4: Spatial Strategy for Rural and Village Area		No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	Economic: ✓ The policy is likely to have positive effects for the region with regard to the economic objectives because the policy seeks to promote the economy of rural areas through direct measures such as the sustainable growth of rural businesses and increased employment opportunities together with the provision of adequate housing.	
Economic Prosperity Policies - CS5: Employment and Economic Growth Opportunities CS6: Employment Land	Social: Broadly ✓ The commitment to boost economic prosperity through the provision of a flexible portfolio of employment land in appropriate locations to provide local employment opportunities should be broadly supportive of strong and inclusive communities and therefore the sustainability objectives with a social thrust. The economic 'Vision' in Policy CS5 - 'to develop a diverse economy with accessible employment and deliver significant increases in the number of businesses and jobs' – further reinforces the support to the social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ? * to ? ✓ By increasing employment land provision (especially at the airport) with the possible knock-on increase in traffic and transport activity, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption, CO₂ emissions and the further depletion of resources that will all tend to prejudice the delivery of some of these environmental objectives. There is also the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments) depending on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. The application of Policies CS15, CS16, CS17 and CS18 should all serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them in some cases. Economic: ✓ ✓ The broad aim of boosting economic growth to deliver a flourishing economy means that the policies have strongly positive implications towards those sustainability objectives with an economic thrust. By ensuring that the economic prosperity of Gateshead and Newcastle will be achieved by delivering a competitive portfolio of employment land that offers a range and mix of employment uses that are accessible and inclusive means that the policies will encourage economic growth at different scales and levels that should benefit the whole community.	No changes or modifications deemed necessary
Policy CS7: Retail and Centres	Social: ✓ to ✓ ✓ The policy is assessed as having a generally positive impact on social sustainability objectives by focusing on investment and improvement of retail centres, the focus of activity and community life. The policy aims to invest in and improve the provision of facilities and services to enhance the viability and vitality of retail centres, ensuring centres at a local, district and city level are meeting day-to-day needs of residents and visitors to the area. The policy is likely to increase accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services, and invest further in the good transport links that can be found in the identified retail centres, improving access to retail centres as well as to the wider region and countryside.	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	Environmental: 0 to ✓ The policy is assessed as having a mix of either neutral or slightly positive effects on the environmental objectives. Although the policy makes no direct reference to the mitigation or adaptation to climate change, or the enhancement of environmental assets and infrastructure, there are a number of policies, which if simultaneously applied should mitigate against any negative effects. For example Policy CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) will mitigate against issues arising due to the effects of climate change, such as flood risk. Mitigation against flood risk should also be delivered through the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) as well as through the Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP). Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) should mitigate against any adverse impacts on biodiversity and the natural environment. The identified retail centres are sustainable locations for investment and enhancement, in terms of their concentration of services, employment and residential uses and good internal linkages for walking and cycling. They have good transport links via the metro and buses and to the wider region and country by train. Focusing development in these areas is likely to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by minimising the need for additional travel investment and maximising the opportunities for making the best use of the existing infrastructure. Economic: ✓✓ This policy is likely to have positive effects on the economic objectives. The enhancement and investment in retail centres will make a positive contribution to sustaining the economy at a local, district and borough level, and should therefore also support the creation of new jobs in the future.	
Policy CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism	Social: ✓ to ✓✓ This Policy encourages leisure, culture and tourism development that will improve the quality and range of facilities for communities. The Policy will therefore contribute positively to the SA Objectives with more of a social thrust. With the simultaneous application of CS1 with its 'Development Principles' together with the wording in Paragraph 5.11 this will ensure that Policy CS8 more effectively addresses the Councils' equality and diversity obligations which are particularly important in the context of sport, leisure, culture and tourism. Environmental: ? * to ?✓ By increasing the number of leisure, culture and tourism facilities across Gateshead and Newcastle, with the possible knock-on increase in traffic and transport activity, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption, CO₂ emissions and the further depletion of resources that will all tend to prejudice the delivery of some of the environmental objectives. There is also the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments) depending on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. The application of Policies CS15, CS16, CS17 and CS18 should all serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them in some cases.	With the simultaneous application of the newly worded Policy - CS15 Health and Wellbeing, this will ensure that Policy CS9 more effectively addresses the Councils' equality and diversity obligations which are particularly important in the context of sport, leisure, culture and tourism.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	Economic: ✓✓ The promotion of the growth of the tourism sector in Gateshead and Newcastle has strongly positive implications for the economy of the region and the potential to increase the employment market for the region. Arguably the provision of an improved range and quality of leisure, culture and tourism facilities should also boost economic opportunities and make the area attractive for people to live and work.	
Homes		
Policy CS9: Existing Communities	Social: ✓ This is an overarching policy, applying to all existing neighbourhoods so will help to improve communities across the board. The supporting text in Chapter 10 underpins the desire to create sustainable thriving communities. Delivery of this policy and its various measures should act to promote strong and cohesive communities, particularly in the longer term as the policy delivers its ambitions and goals. Although not focusing on health and wellbeing directly, indirect benefits from this policy of better housing security and ongoing support for existing communities should be generally supportive of health and wellbeing in the community. The supporting text of the policy states making improvements to education, employment, transport, the environment and public services is an integral part of regeneration. Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect. Environmental: ✓ Regeneration activities could lead to increased energy consumption, waste generation, fossil fuel consumption, CO₂ emissions and the further depletion of resources that will all tend to prejudice the delivery of some of these environmental objectives. There is also the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments) depending on the precise location of any housing stock renewal and regeneration programmes and how any restoration work was designed and constructed. The application of Policies CS15, CS16, CS17 and CS18 should all serve to mitigate these potential effects. The emphasis of this policy on bringing back empty properties into use and investing in the surrounding local environment should generate positive effects on the environment. Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect. Economic: ✓ Although economic drive is not the emphasis of this policy it is likely to contribute to a sustainable employment market in the region by encouraging people to stay or move to the area because the neighbourhoods are places of quality and choice and their facilities and services should be improved over time, especially through regeneration. Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect.	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy CS10: Delivering New Homes	Social: ✓ The Policy seeks to deliver new housing based on the findings of the Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment (SHLAA) and therefore should help to strengthen the community by providing housing where it is needed, this in turn is likely to have a positive effect on equality, diversity and integration. Although the policy does not deal directly with issues around health and wellbeing, indirect benefits of better housing availability and a mix of housing offer could lead to general improvements in	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	mental and physical health within the community in the longer term. Overall the policy is assessed as being broadly supportive of the social SA Objectives. Environmental: ? ✖ to ✓ There is the possibility for the development of new housing stock to impact negatively on the environment, in terms of generating carbon emissions, use of non-renewable resources, generation of waste and the possible increase in car emissions but this should be minimised by the simultaneous application of Policies CS15 and CS16. The simultaneous application of Policies CS15 and CS18 should ensure that new housing development is built in such a way as to ensure minimal impact on the natural and historic environment and in some cases improve conditions such as creating new green infrastructure and green space. Overall this policy was assessed as having an uncertain but leading towards a positive effect on environmental objectives. Economic: ✓ The provision of housing in the way indicated in Policy CS10 is likely to provide some form of support to the economy through direct benefits to the construction industry, and making more housing available, attracting people into the area, increasing workforce diversity and encouraging communities to be more stable, thriving and sustainable. Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect on the economic objectives. Social: ✓ to ✓✓ The policy is likely to have positive effects on the social sustainability objectives since it seeks to ensure an appropriate mix of housing and a sustainable supply of affordable housing. This mix will help to ensure strong and sustainable communities. Housing will be based on demand and the indirect benefits of better housing availability, appropriate housing densities and a mix of housing offer should be generally supportive of health and wellbeing in the community. In terms of delivering the Councils' equality and diversity obligations a mix of house sizes and prices will help to ensure that a fair and equitable range of housing is available in support of social inclusion. This policy should ensure the social requirements of affordable housing stock is met, and by ensuring buildings are recovered and reused this should ensure long term benefits and sustainability of neighbourhoods. There is also positive supporting text that provides a focus on the Lifetime Neighbourhoods initiative – creating and retrofitting neighbourhoods to provide health and wellbeing to residents of all ages, backgrounds, abilities. Environmental: ? ✖ to ✓ There is the possibility for the development of new housing stock to impact negatively on the environment, in terms of generating carbon emissions, use of non-renewable resources, generation of waste and the possible increase in car emissions but this should be minimised by the simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making and CS16: Climate Change. The simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment should ensure that new housing development is built in such a way as to ensure minimal impact on the natural	
Policy CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing		No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	and historic environment and in some cases improve conditions such as creating new green infrastructure and green space. Overall this policy was assessed as having an uncertain but leading towards a positive effect on environmental objectives. Economic: ✓ The provision of housing in the way indicated in Policy CS11 is likely to provide some form of support to the economy through making more housing available, attracting people into appropriate areas for accessing work and thus potentially increasing workforce diversity. Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect on the economic objectives. Social: ✓ to ✓✓ This policy is assessed as having a positive impact on social objectives, by ensuring appropriate criteria are used to assess site allocation for travelling groups. The policy ensures that allocated sites have good access to jobs, schools, utilities, refuse storage, public transport, local facilities and services, ensuring that the needs of travelling groups are met and they are provided with a safe and healthy environment. The policy gives preference to site allocation within or adjacent to existing settlements, promoting integration of travelling groups into communities. All of this contributes positively towards social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ? ✕ to ✓ There is the possibility for the allocation of sites for travelling groups to impact negatively on the environment, in terms of generating carbon emissions, use of non-renewable resources, generation of waste, and increased traffic but this should be minimised by the simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. There is potential to make a positive contribution towards environmental assets, particularly if site allocation means the redevelopment of brownfield or reuse of sites within urban environments and if the development of green infrastructure is incorporated into the regeneration. Overall this policy was assessed as having an uncertain but leading towards a positive effect on environmental objectives. Economic: ✓ This policy is likely to provide a broadly positive impact on the economy by encouraging the integration of travelling groups into the community, ensuring accessibility to jobs and education, this policy is likely increase the local employment market, diversity of workforce, and ultimately strengthen the economy.	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy CS12: Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Showpeople		
Transport Policy CS13: Transport	Social: ✓✓ Policy CS13 seeks to improve transport infrastructure and connectivity within the Gateshead and Newcastle area and to increase sustainable travel choices as well as improve on accessibility within communities. There are also strongly positive health implications of promoting sustainable transport modes such as walking and cycling. It is therefore assessed overall to have strong positive implications on the social sustainability objectives.	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	Environmental: ✓✓ The policy promotes the use of public transport, walking and cycling over the private car and seeks to invest further in sustainable travel networks. It promotes the use of more sustainable forms of motor transport via the provision of charging points for electric vehicles as well as improving on the infrastructure and facilities for cycling. Therefore the major direction of the policy is on improving environmental conditions through promoting sustainable transport (commitments to tackle climate change, improve air quality and reduce carbon emissions) and therefore it is assessed as likely to generate strong positive effects on the environmental objectives. Economic: ✓ The major focus of the policy is to improve travel connectivity and promote the sustainable transport network. It focuses on improving accessibility throughout the area and the provision of an integrated sustainable network for travel both of which should support improved access to jobs, facilities and services, thus broadly supporting access to employment and therefore indirectly economic prosperity. It is therefore assessed as having a positive effect on the economic objectives.	
People and Place Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health	Social: ✓✓ The key focus of this policy is on improving wellbeing and health of the residents of Gateshead and Newcastle and reducing health inequalities. Ensuring that development contributes positively to health, wellbeing and safety of communities, along with the enhanced provision of social, health, education, leisure and sports facilities and services (provided by supporting policies) mean that this policy will make strong positive contributions towards social sustainability objectives. Improving access to healthy, affordable locally-produced food and controlling the location and access to unhealthy eating outlets further builds upon these positive contributions. Supporting text in Chapter 12 (and alongside the Development Principles in Paragraphs 5.8 to 5.13) strengthens the policy aim to promote healthy communities and reduce health inequalities, stating the Councils' commitment to equality and fairness, the promotion of community cohesion, ensuring health facilities are in sustainable accessible locations that are responsive to the diverse needs of residents. This commitment to demand responsive facilities and services that promote health and wellbeing of Gateshead and Newcastle citizens will ensure positive effects particularly in the long term. Environmental: 0/✓ The policy has the potential to cause negative impacts on environmental objectives through the enhanced provision of infrastructure (new building developments) to support health and wellbeing (e.g. new social, health, education, leisure and sports facilities). These potential impacts can be offset and mitigated by the measures within some of the supporting strategic policies that ensure environmental protection (e.g. Policy CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change, and Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment). There will also be positive contributions made by the	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
Policy CS16: Place Making	encouragement of locally produced food that can help to reduce the carbon footprint generated by the transport of food from overseas or north to south across the country. Overall this policy is assessed as having a neutral to slightly positive effect. Economic: 0 to 0/✓ The policy is focused on improving health and wellbeing rather than economic prosperity and therefore is assessed to be generally neutral in its impact on economic objectives. It could be argued that promoting healthy urban planning, healthy lifestyles and active living should all support a healthier workforce which in turn should make an indirect contribution towards strengthening the economy particularly in the longer term. There also are some potential economic opportunities from increased health and wellbeing infrastructure provision but, as the focus is on equality of access and affordability to all of these facilities, it is unlikely they will have a strong economic impact on the region. Social: ✓✓ The policy is designed to reinforce local distinctiveness and cultural heritage, encourage a sustainable approach towards design and create a sense of place that is safe, inclusive and accessible to all, and therefore should help to promote a strong and inclusive community. Good place making will involve the provision of well-designed public realm, green infrastructure and green spaces that all will provide areas for recreation and exercise both of which will promote social interaction and lead to improved quality of life and health in the area. Overall the policy should have strong positive effects on the social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ✓ The policy is focused on improving environmental conditions of the area (both mitigating and adapting to the effects of climate change, and protecting and enhancing the natural and historic environment) by ensuring that sustainable design and good place making is implemented through all developments. It therefore has a positive contribution to make towards the delivery of the environmental sustainability objectives. The simultaneous application of Policies CS16, 17 and 18 should serve to mitigate any potential effects, and ensure a positive effect on these sustainability objectives particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered. Economic: ✓ The policy is not focussed on improving economic conditions in the area but is unlikely to generate negative effects. In fact there may be job creation and a possible boost for the tourism market through promoting the use, understanding and enjoyment of the public realm, and creating locally distinct, high quality and interactive places across Gateshead and Newcastle. This policy is therefore assessed as having a positive effect on the economic sustainability objectives.	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy CS16: Climate Change	Social: 0 to ✓ In general the policy does not have any clear relationship or influence on most of the social	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	sustainability objectives and is therefore considered to have a broadly neutral effect. The policy focuses on the use of sustainable energy resources and in cutting carbon emissions and although of benefit to the community does not have a direct bearing on many of the social objectives. There is, however, expected to be a positive effect on health and wellbeing since many of the activities or actions taken to cut carbon also have positive impacts on health (e.g. reducing car use and cutting congestion thus reducing vehicle emissions, adopting more sustainable forms of transport such as walking and cycling that are good for health, creating more green infrastructure etc.). The policy also sets out to ensure that in all development proposals appropriate mitigation and adaptation measures for the predicted impacts of climate change (e.g. risks of flooding, etc) are included, thus addressing the potentially adverse health impacts of climate change. The policy is therefore considered to have a broadly positive effect on the long-term health and wellbeing of local communities and therefore on Sustainability Objective 4. Environmental: ✓✓ The policy focuses on climate change adaptation and mitigation through development proposals and ensuring that development can demonstrate a reduction in the potential contribution it makes to the cause of climate change. This combination of both mitigation and adaptation means that the policy has strong positive implications for all of the environmental sustainability objectives. By emphasising carbon reduction, reducing CO₂ emissions, improving energy efficiency, decentralised low carbon networks and increased renewable energy generation these all have strongly positive implications for most of the environmental objectives. Economic: ✓ By ensuring development can withstand the long-term impacts of climate change means that the long-term economic viability of the area is more likely to be assured. Sustainable economic growth will be inextricably linked with locating new development in sustainable locations that not only are not at risk from the effects of climate change (such as increased flood risk) but that also have built in adaptation design features for, for example, combating extreme temperatures, water loss and loss of biodiversity (e.g. green roofs). The promotion of sustainable energy (renewable and low carbon energy sources) may present a slight constraint on development through its specific requirements, however, the potential to provide associated jobs to the area, and a more sustainable energy source for the region in the long term, the impact on sustainability objectives for the economy should overall be positive.	
Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management	Social: 0 to ✓ The policy does not specifically focus on issues relating to inclusive communities, equality and educational achievement but there are no adverse impacts anticipated. There are positive effects anticipated from mitigating against the potential health impacts from flood risks and the impacts to accessibility. Therefore the policy was assessed as having a broadly neutral to positive effect on the social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ✓ This policy has positive implications for environmental objectives as the policy will help to minimise the	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	environmental impacts of flooding and most importantly help to adapt and mitigate against the potential impacts from climate change. Flooding is likely to be one of the major adverse effects of climate change. The promotion of SUDS where appropriate for surface water management has the potential to provide new habitats and amenity space, potentially enhancing environmental assets and infrastructure. This policy therefore has strong implications for meeting environmental sustainability objectives. The consideration of the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) as well as the Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP) should also strengthen the positive effects. Economic: 0 In terms of economic objectives the policy was assessed to be of broadly neutral effect, there are unlikely to be negative impacts on the economy from the implementation of this policy. If anything the avoidance of flood risk and the corresponding negative economic effects that flooding can bring should serve to contribute positively to the economic objectives. Social: ✓ By protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure and natural environment of the region in an inclusive way the policy is likely to have positive effects on those social objectives that relate to strengthening the community, improving health and wellbeing, particularly in the longer term as the measures within the policy start to deliver results. Environmental: ✓✓ The main focus of the policy is on retaining, protecting enhancing the natural environment of the area, increasing the amount of green space and green infrastructure, and protecting and enhancing biodiversity and geodiversity in the area. All of these will make strong positive contributions to most of the environmental objectives. Green infrastructure has a clear role to play in providing ecosystem services that contribute towards climate change mitigation and adaptation. Economic: 0 to ✓ The broad emphasis of this policy is not economic, but by enhancing the environmental conditions of the region and making the natural environment more attractive for residents, workers and visitors there are likely to be indirect positive effects on the local economy in terms of encouraging businesses to locate and people to visit the region. Social: 0 to ✓ The policy commits to preventing the merging of settlements (which should retain local distinctiveness and a sense of place) and unrestricted 'sprawl' together with safeguarding the countryside from encroachment. It also commits to encourage the recycling of derelict and other urban land during development. All of which should ensure an overall neutral to broadly positive impact (in the case of wellbeing and health) on social sustainability objectives. The revision of the Green Belt boundary to allow for residential development at Callerton will include investment in associated facilities and services including additional education provision and improved transport links, promoting accessibility and inclusivity.	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment		
Policy CS19: Green Belt		No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	Environmental: 0 to ✓ Because the policy commits to preventing the merging of settlements and checking unrestricted sprawl together with safeguarding the countryside from encroachment it is therefore assessed as being either neutral or broadly supportive towards the environmental objectives. It also commits to encouraging the recycling of derelict and other urban land during development which is a more environmentally positive solution. Economic: 0 The policy is likely to have a neutral effect on the economic objectives. The policy itself puts a curb on any further encroachment into the countryside but is supportive of urban regeneration in the city region. So whilst it places a partial restriction on development outwith of the centres it fully encourages development within the Urban Core.	
Policies for Minerals and Waste Policy CS20: Minerals	Social: 0 The policy is deemed to have a broadly neutral effect on the social sustainability objectives since this policy is not concerned with social inclusion, equality, education, health, cultural heritage or accessibility. Environmental: ✖ The nature of mineral extraction means that it is likely to have negative impacts on environmental sustainability objectives because the nature of the process contributes to the causes of climate change and does not support the concept of living within environmental limits. There are some benefits of ensuring that mineral extraction is localised to the region and thus reducing transportation impacts but despite this the combined effect of extraction, processing and transportation will have residual negative impacts. Gateshead and Newcastle should seek to promote a greater proportion of more sustainable energy sources and fuels alongside mineral extraction for coal so that gradually more sustainable sources can be phased in. The policy does however commit to a high level of restoration and aftercare on worked land while considering airport safety, biodiversity, woodland and recreational enhancement. This should complement and further safeguard the restoration of worked sites. The addition of fracking, however to the potential list of activities in the region has negative long-term implications for sustainability objectives. Not only is there a focus on extracting and burning a non-renewable fuel source, but the extraction process itself has the potential to contaminate local groundwater. Economic: ✓ In terms of economic objectives it was assessed that this policy is likely to have positive effects for the region because safeguarding mineral wealth will contribute to the economy and mineral extraction and processing is likely to safeguard and perhaps increase associated jobs within the area.	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Core Strategy Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
Policy CS21: Waste	Social: 0 The policy is determined to have mostly neutral effects on the social sustainability objectives although in some areas such as health and social wellbeing there is likely to be a positive effect. Environmental: ✓✓ This policy has strong positive implications for environmental sustainability objectives because improving sustainable waste management is one component of improving and enhancing environmental conditions within Gateshead and Newcastle. It has positive implications for issues relating to climate change, living within environmental limits and general environmental conditions of the region. The policy stresses the need to adopt a waste hierarchy of prevention, preparing for re-use, recycling, other recovery and safe disposal which promotes the concept of sustainable production and consumption and the better management of resources. Economic: ✓ The policy is likely to have positive effects on the economy especially in the longer term since sustainable waste management should present more efficient and cost effective ways of dealing with waste. There may also be further market and employment opportunities in the recovery, re-use and recycling of waste materials.	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Table 5.3 Summaries of the Sustainability Appraisal of each of the 17 Urban Core Policies Together with Comments

Urban Core Policies		Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
Economy			
Policy UC1: Offices and Business Development		Social: ✓ The policy seeks to support new office development within the Urban Core which, if successful, will be able to offer a wide range of employment and skill development opportunities. This should be strongly supportive towards developing and retaining a skilled workforce and in turn to encourage stronger communities. It may also help to improve educational aspirations for young people throughout the Newcastle Gateshead area. The combined application of this policy with Strategic Policies CS1 and CS15 should ensure that these developments promote strong and inclusive communities. The policy is assessed overall to have positive implications on social sustainability objectives. Environmental: 0 to ?✓ The effects of supporting more office-based and SME developments in the Urban Core were considered to be uncertain but possibly negative with regard to impacts on the natural environment with issues like resource use, fossil fuel consumption, carbon emissions and likely increases in waste. The application of a number of associated Strategic Policies (CS15 and CS16) provide effective mitigation and if these policies are rigorously applied in combination with Policy UC1, together with robust planning conditions or obligations, then there is the potential for the residual effects to be improved to become either neutral or even positive. Economic: ✓✓ Growth of office-based and SME businesses is likely to make a significant contribution towards job creation in the Urban Core and therefore of improving access to a more stable and sustainable employment market in Gateshead and Newcastle.	The need for wording that would ensure that inclusive design was embedded within new office build was highlighted in the previous sustainability appraisal because of the absence of overarching policies that addressed this point. This gap has now been filled by the newly worded overarching Core Strategy Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth). The further evolution of this Strategic Policy, in particular the addition of Clause 8 with clear requirements in sub-clause 8(i) that state that all development should be: <i>'Fully inclusive, irrespective of cultural background, ethnicity and age, to meet the diverse needs of all residents and communities'</i> and in Clause 8(ii) to be <i>'well-connected and accessible....'</i> and <i>'well designed to promote community cohesion and wellbeing and to reflect and enhance the areas character and natural environment'</i> together with the supporting text in Paragraphs 5.8 to 5.13 (in particular 5.11 that addresses equality and diversity needs), strongly supports the delivery of the social sustainability objectives. No further changes or modifications deemed necessary. No changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy UC2: New Retail (A1) in Newcastle and Gateshead		Social: ✓ The policy seeks to support the case for new shops and retail development to be located in the main shopping centres within the Urban Core. More buoyant shopping and retail provision, that improves the quality and quantity of retail offer, and caters better for the needs of workers, visitors and residents, will help to boost community confidence and increase community vibrancy. Focusing development on specific areas which possess poor quality built design and a lack of green space should promote user friendly, inclusively designed retail hubs, improving the visitors' experience. Furthermore, development of new shops and an improved retail offer	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Urban Core Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
Policy UC3: Leisure, Culture and Tourism	area should promote increased employment and possible skill development opportunities. This should be supportive towards developing and retaining a skilled workforce and in turn supporting economic prosperity and stronger communities. The policy is assessed overall to have broadly neutral to positive implications for the social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ? ✖ to ✓ The effects of supporting more shop and retail developments in the Urban Core were considered to be uncertain but possibly negative with regard to impacts on the natural environment with issues like resource use, carbon emissions and waste likely to increase. The application of a number of associated Strategic Policies (CS15 and CS16) provide effective mitigation and if these policies are rigorously applied in combination with Policy UC2, together with robust planning conditions or obligations, then there is the potential for the residual effects to be improved to become either neutral or even positive. Economic: ✓✓ Growth of shops and retailing is likely to make a contribution towards job creation in the Urban Core and therefore of improving access to a more stable and sustainable employment market in Gateshead and Newcastle. There should also be an overall contribution to the economic prosperity of the area. Social: ✓ to ✓✓ This policy encourages tourism, culture and recreation development that will improve the quality and range of facilities available. The policy will therefore contribute to the SA Objectives with more of a social thrust, promoting an Urban Core that is socially inclusive and welcoming. The policy makes no direct reference to accessibility for all, or catering for a diverse range of users. However, the combined application of this policy with Policy CS1 should promote strong and inclusive communities and with CS14 which has a focus on equality of access to amenity facilities. The supporting text is also positive about inclusive design of facilities by encouraging complementary uses to group together, for example hubs for evening entertainment, which will improve accessibility and overall positive experience of visitors to the Urban Core. Environmental: ? By increasing the number of leisure and tourism facilities in the Urban Core, with the possible increases in energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption, CO₂ emissions and the further depletion of resources that will all tend to prejudice the delivery of some of the environmental objectives. There is also the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments) depending on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. Through the application of Policies CS16 (Climate Change), CS21 (Waste), UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling), and UC7 (Public Transport) the impacts of the development will be considerably minimised.	Comments were made in the previous sustainability assessment that flagged up the need to make sure that inclusive design and accessibility were embedded within new culture, leisure and tourism facilities. Some suggested wording was offered but the gap has now been filled by the newly worded overarching Strategic Policies CS1, CS14 and CS15 that cover inclusive design and accessibility. See also the above assessment for Policy 1. With the application of these modified overarching policies and their supporting text the equality and diversity obligations of the Councils will be better delivered within this policy. No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Urban Core Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
Policy UC4: Homes	Economic: ✓✓ The promotion of the growth of the tourism sector in Gateshead and Newcastle has strongly positive implications for the economy of the region. Arguably the provision of an improved range and quality of sports, leisure and recreational facilities should make the area attractive for people to live and work, further strengthening the economy of the region by increasing the employment market and boosting economic opportunities. Social: ✓ to ✓✓ The Policy seeks to deliver new housing based on the Core Strategy targets and Policies and therefore should help to strengthen the community by providing housing where it is needed. This in turn is likely to have a positive effect on equality, diversity and integration. The supporting text is positive about meeting diverse housing needs of communities, and if applied simultaneously with Policies CS15 and UC12 (Urban Design) this should ensure that inclusive design principles are picked up by this policy and therefore embedded in any future housing developments. The policy does not deal directly with issues around health and wellbeing, however indirect benefits of better housing availability and a mix of housing offer could lead to general improvements in mental and physical health within the community in the longer term. Overall the policy is assessed as being broadly supportive of the social SA Objectives. Environmental: ? to ✓ There is the possibility for the development of new housing stock to impact negatively on the environment, in terms of generating carbon emissions, use of non-renewable resources and generation of waste materials but this should be minimised by the simultaneous application of Policies CS16, UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling), and UC7 (Public Transport). The simultaneous application of Policies CS15 and CS18 should ensure that new housing development is built in such a way as to ensure minimal impact on the natural and historic environment and in some cases improve conditions such as creating new green infrastructure and green space. By improving housing provision close to the Urban Core, where a large number of employment opportunities are likely to be located, the policy will help to reduce the need for commuting and maximise opportunities for sustainable travel. Overall this policy was assessed as having an uncertain but leading towards a positive effect on environmental objectives. Economic: ✓ The provision of housing in the way indicated in this Policy is likely to provide support to the economy through direct benefits to the construction industry, and making more housing available, attracting people (including students) into the area, increasing workforce diversity and encouraging communities to be more stable, thriving and sustainable. Overall the policy is regarded as having a positive effect on the economic objectives.	Comments were made in the previous sustainability assessment that flagged up the need to make sure that inclusive design and accessibility were embedded within new housing developments. Some suggested wording was offered but the gap has now been filled by the newly worded overarching Strategic Policies CS1, CS14 and CS15 that cover inclusive design and accessibility. See also the above assessment for Policy 1. With the application of these modified overarching policies and their supporting text the equality and diversity obligations of the Councils will be better delivered within this policy. No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Urban Core Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
Policy UC5: Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes Policy UC6: Cycling	Social: ✓ to ✓✓ These policies seek to improve transport infrastructure and connectivity within the Urban Core and to increase sustainable travel choices, as well as improve on accessibility within communities. All of which will make a positive contribution towards promoting social inclusion, community cohesion, quality of life and community wellbeing. The combined application of these policies with CS15 (Place Making) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to create safe and inclusive environments. The policies are therefore likely to generate strong positive support for the social objectives. Environmental: ✓✓ These policies promote walking and cycling over the use of the private car and seek to invest further in the sustainable travel networks. They support commitments to tackle climate change and also to improve air quality. The major direction of these policies is on improving environmental conditions through promoting sustainable transport and therefore are assessed as generating positive effects. Economic: ✓ The major focus of the Policies UC5 and UC6 are to improve travel connectivity and promote more sustainable modes of transport therefore the key direction is not centred on economic prosperity but there are likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall connectivity within the Urban Core is improved, allowing greater access to goods and services and linking businesses with consumers. Therefore the policies are assessed to be of a broadly positive effect.	Comments were made in the previous sustainability assessment that flagged up the need to make sure that equality and diversity needs were addressed by policies for these modes of travel. Some suggested wording was offered but the gap has now been filled by the newly worded overarching Core Strategy Policy CS1 and its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11. With the application of this overarching policy and its supporting text the equality and diversity obligations of the Councils will be better delivered within these two policies. No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy UC7: Public Transport	Social: ✓ to ✓✓ Policy UC7 seeks to improve transport infrastructure and connectivity within the Urban Core, enhancing the service around, and to the edge of the city centre. This policy focuses on increasing sustainable travel choices and the more inclusive forms of transport (i.e. buses and a re-invigorated metro) as well as improvement in accessibility within communities. All of which contribute positively towards quality of life and promoting strong inclusive communities. If combined with the Transport Policy (CS13) – which encompasses equality and safe and inclusive access – this will strengthen the ‘thrust’ of the policy towards equality and integration. It is therefore assessed overall to have positive implications on social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ✓✓ These policies promote the use of public transport over the private car and seek to invest further in the sustainable travel networks. Therefore reducing the output of greenhouse gases in the Urban Core, improving air quality, and reducing our contribution to the causes of climate change. Since these policies are focused on improving environmental conditions through promoting sustainable transport, it is assessed as having strong positive implications on environmental sustainability objectives.	Comments were made in the previous sustainability assessment that flagged up the need to make sure that equality and diversity needs were addressed by policies for public transport travel. Some suggested wording was offered but the gap has now been filled by the newly worded overarching Core Strategy Policy CS1 and its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11. With the application of this overarching policy and its supporting text the equality and diversity obligations of the Councils will be better delivered within these two policies No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Urban Core Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	Economic: ✓ The major focus of this policy is to improve travel connectivity and promote the sustainable transport network. The key direction is therefore not centred on economic prosperity of the region, however, there are likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall connectivity within the Urban Core is improved, allowing greater access to goods and services and linking businesses with consumers. Overarching Policy CS13 (Transport) ensures the support of public transport provision outside of Metro and bus operation hours, therefore enabling the Urban Core to function as a location for activity at all hours, promoting the "8 until late" economy. Therefore the policies are assessed to generate positive effects.	
Policy UC8: Freight and Servicing	Social: ✓ The Policy and its supporting text seek to manage servicing traffic in a way that strikes a balance between accommodating servicing requirements and seeking to minimise their impact. By ensuring freight and servicing does not negatively impact on the public transport service, pedestrian and cycle routes, this will support an inclusive and accessible public realm. The supporting text to this policy promotes the use of more environmentally friendly vehicles (e.g. low emission and electric) as well as freight consolidation measures, which will have a positive impact on air quality, and therefore health and wellbeing. By ensuring freight does not negatively impact on other forms of transport this should have positive implications for accessibility to goods, facilities and services. The policy is therefore assessed as having a broadly positive impact on social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ✓ The policy and its supporting text aims to mitigate against the impact of freight and servicing through freight consolidation measures (the use of smaller vehicles and combining journeys), as well as the use of low emission vehicles (including electric vehicles). The policy will therefore have positive implications on reducing the output of greenhouse gases in the urban core, reducing our reliance on and the consumption of fossil fuels and reducing our contribution to the causes of climate change. The policy is assessed as having a broadly positive contribution to environmental sustainability objectives, particularly in the longer term as the policy is delivered. Economic: ✓ By promoting a more sustainable environmentally friendly freight and servicing sector and freight consolidation measures, the policy will have positive implications for running costs and overall overheads of the freight and servicing sector. Thus strengthening the local economy. Therefore the policy is assessed to generate broadly positive effects.	No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy UC9: General Traffic	Social: ✓ to ✓✓ This policy seeks to minimise through traffic and improve connectivity within the Urban Core, reducing car traffic and congestion and improving the overall pedestrian experience. All of this	No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Urban Core Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	will make a positive contribution towards building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community wellbeing. The simultaneous application of Policy CS13 (Transport) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to 'improve equality of access to transport for everyone' and its other community-friendly measures. It is therefore assessed overall to have positive implications on social sustainability objectives, particularly in the longer term as the policy goal of minimising through traffic and improving the local environment is delivered. Environmental: ✓ to ✓✓ The policy endeavours to manage traffic access in and around the Urban Core. Together with the application of CS13 it will help to support commitments to tackle climate change by reducing through traffic and a reliance on the car and therefore consumption of fossil fuels, reducing greenhouse gas emissions and improving air quality. It is assessed as broadly supportive of the environmental objectives. Economic: ✓ The major focus of the policies is to improve car traffic management and improve ease of getting into and around the Urban Core. Therefore the key direction is not centred on economic prosperity of the region but there are nevertheless likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall connectivity within the Urban Core by more sustainable forms of travel is improved, allowing greater access to goods and services and linking businesses with consumers. Therefore the policy is assessed to generate broadly positive effects.	
Policy UC10: Car Parking	Social: ✓ This policy endeavours to ensure the provision of safe and secure car parking whilst simultaneously minimising the amount available because of the highly accessible nature of the Urban Core. All of this will make a positive contribution towards reducing the reliance on the car and building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community wellbeing. It is therefore assessed overall to have broadly positive implications on social sustainability objectives. Environmental: 0 to ✓ With the emphasis on minimising the amount of car parking available because of the highly accessible nature of the Urban Core, this will effectively encourage the more sustainable forms of transport such as walking, cycling and public transport. All of this will make a positive contribution towards reducing the reliance on the car and hence harmful emissions to the environment. The policy is regarded as being broadly supportive of the environmental objectives.	No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Urban Core Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	Economic: ✓ The key direction of the policy is not focused on economic prosperity but there are no negative effects anticipated so the effect is regarded as neutral.	No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy UC11: Gateways and Arrival Points	Social: ✓ The policy seeks to improve the definition of arrival points and gateways into the city centre, and improve the overall pedestrian experience in the Urban Core. All of this will make a positive contribution towards building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community wellbeing. The simultaneous application of Policy CS15 (Place Making) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to design 'to create safe and inclusive environments' and 'ensure connectivity, accessibility and legibility'. It is therefore assessed overall to have positive implications on social sustainability objectives, particularly in the longer term as the policy begins to deliver its objectives. Environmental: ✓ This policy endeavours to promote the use of more sustainable forms of transport over the private car through improving the transition between sustainable travel modes such as public transport to pedestrian access in and around defined arrival points. In making use of sustainable travel more easy and enjoyable it will promote more use of these modes and so will be supportive of commitments to tackle climate change by reducing reliance on and consumption of fossil fuels, reduce greenhouse gas emissions and improving air quality. Economic: ✓ The major focus of this policy is to enhance the definition of gateways and arrival points and improve ease of getting into and around the Urban Core. Therefore the key direction is not centred on economic prosperity of the region but there are nevertheless likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall connectivity within the Urban Core is improved, allowing greater access to goods and services and linking businesses with consumers. Therefore the policy is assessed to generate broadly positive effects.	
Policy UC12: Urban Design	Social: ✓✓ This policy and its supporting text is focused on enhancing the positive, distinctive qualities of the Urban Core, respecting the positive elements of its context, working with the unique topography and landscape, architecture and public realm to create distinctive quality buildings befitting their setting, which should therefore help to promote a strong and inclusive community. Supporting Strategic Policies (such as CS1 and CS15) make commitments to ensure buildings and spaces make a contribution to promoting socially inclusive and sustainable communities, ensuring accessibility is an integral part of urban design, and ensuring urban design delivers a safer and attractive Urban Core. In terms of contribution to health and wellbeing, good place making will involve the provision of well-designed public realm and public spaces, which will include areas for recreation and exercise, which will lead to improved quality of life and health in the area. Overall the policy should have strong positive effects on the social sustainability	In order to make sure that inclusive design and access together with equality and diversity needs were embedded within urban design some additional wording was recommended in the previous sustainability appraisals. The gap has now been filled by the newly worded overarching Core Strategy Policy CS1 and its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11. With the application of this overarching policy and its supporting text the equality and diversity obligations

Urban Core Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	objectives. Environmental: ✓ The policy is focused on improving environmental conditions of the area by ensuring that excellent design and good place making is implemented throughout the Urban Core. It therefore has a positive contribution to make towards protecting and enhancing environmental assets. This policy is expected to have an overall positive impact. Economic: ✓ Through the delivery of this policy it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across the Urban Core. The creation of an attractive environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. Tourism and shopping will be supported by improvements to the 'gateways' and so business should benefit from this. The policy was therefore assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective. Social: ✓ This policy and its supporting text focuses on protecting views within, from and into the Urban Core, maintaining the positive visual experience for residents and visitors to the area. This will help create an enabling environment for the building of lively and cohesive communities and promote a feeling of community wellbeing. The protection of views should promote local distinctiveness and reinforce local characteristics and therefore a sense of place. This policy is expected to have a positive impact on social sustainability objectives. Environmental: 0 to ✓ This policy is assessed as having no negative impacts on living within environmental limits, or adapting to the effects of climate change. It is assessed as having a broadly positive impact on mitigating against climate change, and protecting environmental assets through its commitment to retain the visual environment and its distinct views and vistas – which should include green space, trees, parks and recreational areas. Economic: ✓ Through the delivery of this policy it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across the Urban Core. The creation of an attractive environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. The policy was therefore assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective.	of the Councils will be better delivered within Urban Design. No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy UC13: Respecting and Managing Views within, from and into the Urban Core		No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy UC14: Heritage	Social: ✓ The historic environment underpins the visual vibrancy of an area, and is therefore key to promoting welcoming and attractive areas. The creation of an attractive urban environment will	No further changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Urban Core Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	promote local distinctiveness, a sense of place and consequently overall community wellbeing. All of these contribute towards promoting strong and inclusive communities. Therefore the policy should have positive effects on the social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ✓ This policy and its supporting text commits to the re-use and restoration of historic building, and together with the application of Policies CS15 and CS16 will require developers to have fully considered sustainable design and construction during development. The creation and retention of environmental assets, mitigation measures to ensure developments are able to adapt to the effects of climate change all underpin sustainable design. This policy should therefore ensure positive implications on the environmental objectives. Economic: ✓ Through the delivery of this policy it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across the Urban Core. The historic environment is considered to underpin the economic vibrancy of an area, and therefore the creation of an attractive, vibrant environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. The policy is assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective.	
Policy UC15: Urban Green Infrastructure	Social: ✓ By protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure and natural environment of the region, his is likely to have positive effects on those social objectives. By enhancing the natural environment, addressing gaps and improving linkages, this will improve access to green space, access to space for recreation and leisure, improvements in air quality, all of which will contribute positively towards health and wellbeing, and ultimately strengthen the community. This policy is expected to have positive impact on social sustainability objectives, particularly in the longer term as the measures within the policy start to deliver results. Environmental: ✓✓ The main focus of the policy is on enhancing the natural environment of the area and where possible increasing the amount of green space and green infrastructure. Green infrastructure provides a number of essential ecosystem services (such as flood attenuation, water management and biodiversity protection and enhancement) which will contribute positively towards mitigating our impact on climate change and adapting to its effects. Protection and enhancement of the green infrastructure has strong positive contributions towards environmental sustainability objectives. Economic: 0 to ✓ The broad emphasis of this policy is not economic, but by enhancing the environmental	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Urban Core Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
Policy UC16: Public Realm	conditions of the region and making the natural environment more attractive for residents, workers and visitors there are likely to be indirect positive effects on the local economy in terms of encouraging businesses to locate and people to visit the Urban Core. Social: ✓✓ The policy is designed to improve the network of linked open spaces and routes that connect them, which should in turn encourage increased outdoor activity and therefore social interaction. The improvement of the open space network and public realm should improve accessibility, enjoyment of the outdoors, opportunity for interaction, learning, recreation and exercise, which all contributes positively towards improved quality of life and community cohesion. This policy has strong positive implications on the social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ✓✓ The policy is focused on improving the public realm "using materials and streetscape products that are sustainably sourced, durable and easily maintained". By enhancing the public realm, and promoting longevity of routes and spaces, and the sustainable maintenance and sourcing of materials, this policy will have strong positive implications on the environmental sustainability objectives. Economic: 0 to ✓ Through the development and enhancement of the public realm locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across Gateshead and Newcastle. The creation of an attractive sustainable environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy.	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.
Policy UC17: Public Art	Social: ✓ to ✓✓ Public art is considered to contribute to a strong sense of place, adding value and bringing distinctiveness to an area, boosting a place's identity, civic pride and inward investment. The use of public art as a tool for community engagement and collaboration projects, promotes opportunity for integration and participation. Encouraging the use of the outdoor public realm for art is likely to increase opportunity for social engagement and increased public activity. All of which is likely to promote a healthy and active lifestyle, a sense of community and feeling of overall wellbeing. This policy is expected to have a positive impact on social sustainability objectives. Environmental: 0 to ✓ This policy is assessed as having no negative impacts on living within environmental limits, or adapting to the effects of climate change. It is assessed as having a broadly positive impact on mitigating against climate change if the development of public art utilises sustainably sourced materials and energy sources. The policy is assessed as having a neutral to broadly positive	No changes or modifications deemed necessary.

Urban Core Policies	Summary of Assessment	Comments and Possible Further Amendments
	impact on environmental SA Objectives. Economic: ✓ Through the delivery of this policy it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across the Urban Core. The use of public art should add value and bring distinctiveness to an area, boosting a place's identity, and civic pride. The use of art to enhance the public realm is likely to promote an attractive environment for investment and business tourism. Investment in and enhancement of art and the creative sector is likely to boost the local economy.	

5.4 SUB-AREAS AND SITES POLICIES

Screening of the Sub-Areas and Sites Policies using the sustainability framework and its supporting question set (see Annex E) has been set out in detail in Annex C. As explained in Annex E the framework has been used with a modified question set that concentrates on the spatial content of these policies since they are primarily location focused.

This suite of policies is based on the Strategic Land Review and Green Belt Assessments for Newcastle and Gateshead which during their preparation have gone through a detailed process of evaluation for the selection of preferred sites. During the present sustainability appraisal process each of the sites has undergone a further screening against the sustainability objectives to identify whether there might be any question marks over their suitability for either housing, business or mixed development. In some cases the location of sites did trigger concerns about either proximity to sites of local conservation and biodiversity interest or sites of cultural heritage interest. However in each case it was found that the simultaneous application of the key Strategic Policies or Urban Core Policies within the Plan would provide any necessary mitigation to satisfactorily deal with those concerns.

The screening set out in Annex C indicates that it is likely that all of the site allocations for housing and employment land if taken forward would meet the identified objectives of the sustainability framework. As any proposal is taken forward detailed consideration of the environmental impacts of that development would need to be given to check that the detailed proposals would continue to meet the sustainability objectives and comply with the policies within the Plan.

5.5 DELIVERY OF THE SUSTAINABILITY OBJECTIVES

Table 5.4 describes how collectively the Strategic Policies contribute to the delivery of each of the sustainability objectives that feature in the sustainability framework. The assessment conclusions are provided and any remaining uncertain or negative effects are discussed and the need for any further amendments to policies is identified.

The conclusions from this appraisal indicate that there are no further modifications of policies required in order for the sustainability objectives to be delivered.

Table 5.4: Overall Sustainability Appraisal of the Plan Policies

Sustainability Objectives and detailed SA questions: “Do the Policies within the Plan support the objective to...”	Assessment/Conclusions	Comments
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities • Work with local communities to promote existing and develop future opportunities • Listen and respond to communities, encouraging participation in local decision making • Decrease opportunities for crime and fear of crime • Tackle the causes of deprivation and narrow the inequality gap • Ensure everyone has the opportunity of living in a decent and affordable home	<div data-bbox="475 1541 574 1639" data-kind="parent" data-rs="2">  </div> <p>The Plan has an ambition to create a sustainable city where ‘everyone can realise their full potential and enjoy a high quality lifestyle’, and the promotion of strong and inclusive communities is at the heart of this ambition.</p> <p>Central to the delivery of this objective is the need to tackle deprivation and inequalities, community safety, the provision of affordable housing, community pride and the involvement of everyone in the process. Clearly the Plan needs to put in place spatial policies that will underpin and facilitate the delivery of these ambitions, and the updated appraisal indicates that the overall contribution of policies to this sustainability objective is positive. In some cases there are strong, clear positive contributions. So for example, Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) sets out the ambitious spatial priorities and indicates that these are focused on the most sustainable and accessible locations.</p> <p>Similarly the goal of an accessible, integrated sustainable transport network that is equitable and caters for all, features in Policy CS13 (Transport). Policy CS15 (Wellbeing and Health) seeks to address inequalities in health, and through spatial planning ensuring that development contributes positively to the health, wellbeing and safety of all communities and reduces health inequalities between individuals and communities. Policy CS11 (Providing a Range and Choice of Housing) has measures that will ensure a balanced mix of housing that includes affordable housing that will meet the needs of a wide range of specific groups (including the elderly and disabled community).</p> <p>Policies CS15 and CS18 that focus on place making and the provision of green infrastructure will individually and cumulatively have positive effects on this objective.</p> <p>The Spatial Growth Policies CS2 (Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core), CS3 (Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area) and CS4 (Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area) seek to provide new development that will support existing local communities through enhancing existing and providing new services, facilities, employment opportunities that are accessible by local communities and improve accessibility between different parts of the Gateshead and Newcastle area. The Urban Core Policies provide the detail on how the location, design and delivery of regeneration and development within this strategic area will create more socially inclusive and cohesive communities.</p>	Any remaining uncertain or negative effects? Possible further amendments? Undertaking the Sustainability Appraisal (SA) of the Plan has been an iterative process and the Core Strategy policies have evolved with feedback from the on-going SA. As a result of this iterative process the Plan now contains stronger references to ‘socially inclusive development’ and has much stronger requirements for accessibility with subtle additions made to the supporting text and the evolution of a number of policies especially Policy CS1 – Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth, with its suite of ‘Development Principles’ in Clause 8.

Sustainability Objectives and detailed SA questions: "Do the Policies within the Plan support the objective to..."	Assessment/Conclusions	Comments
2. Ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future development • Listen to and meet the needs of all in the community • Ensure equal access to essential services and facilities • Accommodate and integrate our diverse communities • Promote development that creates conditions for supporting wellbeing and happiness in all communities	As indicated above, at the heart of the Plan's ambition is a sustainable city <i>'where everyone can realise their full potential and enjoy a high quality lifestyle'</i>. With the emphasis on everyone, Sustainability Objective 2 that focuses on <i>'ensuring that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future planning'</i> is also central to the delivery of this ambition. A measure of the contribution that the policies within the Plan make to this objective is the extent to which they support equality of opportunity, diversity in Gateshead and Newcastle's communities and the elimination of discrimination. The appraisal indicates that the overall contribution of policies to this sustainability objective is positive. Whilst it is accepted that more than just spatial planning is needed to address the inequalities and promote diversity, it is important nevertheless to recognise the contribution that these policies can make. Under the heading of 'Development Principles' there is new text at Paragraph 5.11 that makes a very strong contribution towards this sustainability objective. Here it is made quite clear that <i>'Both Councils are committed to the promotion of diversity, equality and fairness, and expect all development to contribute to this in accordance with the latest equalities legislation'</i>. Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) includes in Clause 8 (i) a key Development Principle that requires all development to be <i>'fully inclusive, irrespective of cultural background, ethnicity and age, to meet the diverse needs of all residents and communities.'</i> This sets the tone for the whole Plan and makes quite clear the role that development will have in delivering this objective. Other policies also support the delivery of this objective including Policy CS14 (Wellbeing and Health) which requires development to <i>'contribute to creating an age friendly, healthy and equitable living environment'</i>. It also includes measures that require development to provide good access for all to both health and social care facilities as well as green spaces and recreational opportunities. Cumulatively the provisions of the Strategic Policies within the Plan should now have a positive effect on ensuring equal access to all and accommodating the needs of everyone in the community by providing accessible facilities and services, affordable mixed housing, provision and enhancement of open space for all and by making a positive contribution to pleasant safe surroundings and a quality built and natural environment.	Any remaining uncertain or negative effects? Possible further amendments? Undertaking the Sustainability Appraisal (SA) of the Plan has been an iterative process and the Core Strategy policies have evolved with feedback from the on-going SA. As a result of this iterative process the Plan now contains stronger references to equality and diversity with subtle additions made to the supporting text and the evolution of a number of policies especially Policy CS1 – Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth, with its suite of 'Development Principles'. The inclusion of the equality and diversity statement at Paragraph 5.11 is a welcome step forward in highlighting and addressing the diverse needs of citizens and communities across Gateshead and Newcastle. This firmly establishes the Councils' approach towards development and the role of the developer in delivering more inclusive communities. Clauses 8 (i) and 8(iii) within Policy CS1 further underline the desire of the Councils' to meet the development needs in a fully inclusive way.

Sustainability Objectives and detailed SA questions: "Do the Policies within the Plan support the objective to..."	Assessment/Conclusions	Comments
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle • Improve educational achievement and create opportunities for education, training and lifelong learning • Develop and retain a skilled workforce • Address barriers that prevent people from getting work	 The Plan has a chapter focused on Economic Prosperity and within this there is an ambition to develop the knowledge-based economy and within the Urban Core to promote higher education and research, healthcare and biotechnology, at Ouseburn, Gateshead Quays and the Baltic Business Quarter the creative, digital and new media industries, and generally across the area to enhance digital infrastructure, ICT and communications. Underpinning this will be the growth of the universities and colleges. There is also recognition that accessible education facilities and skills training available to all will be critical in developing and retaining a skilled workforce. Policy CS5 (Employment and Economic Growth Priorities) aims to improve skills and access for local people to job opportunities. The appraisal indicates that the overall contribution of policies to this sustainability objective is either neutral or broadly positive.	Any remaining uncertain or negative effects? Possible further amendments?
4. Improve health and wellbeing and reduce inequalities in health • Improve access to essential healthcare and social services provision • Promote healthy urban planning (healthy settings, reducing stress) • Provide access to safe and stimulating open spaces and the natural environment • Promote healthy lifestyles and active living (walking, cycling, sport, exercise, active recreation, equitable access to healthy foods)	 Policy CS14 (Wellbeing and Health) has at its core some key provisions that aim to make sure that new development creates an inclusive built and natural environment, provides good access to health and leisure facilities and promotes active and healthy lifestyles. Measures in Policy CS13 (Transport) make provision for sustainable transport and enhanced accessibility by walking and cycling and contains specific requirement to encourage modal shift and enhance opportunities for sustainable transport options through the design of new development. Policy CS16 (Climate Change) requires patterns and location of development that will address the impacts of climate change and thus facilitate more sustainable forms of transport such as walking and cycling. Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment) looks to protect and enhance the strategic green infrastructure network that connects open space and green infrastructure across the area. This policy, together with Clause 1(v) of Policy CS14, should help to provide access to safe and stimulating open spaces that in turn could support more family friendly social and recreational activities. Cumulatively the Strategic Policies within the Plan are considered to have significant positive effects on promoting healthy lifestyles for all residents through enhanced accessibility of services and facilities, provision and enhancement of green open space, making a positive contribution to pleasant surroundings (e.g. quality of the built and natural environment), and a strong emphasis on designing and requiring growth to enable opportunities for access by walking and cycling. This is turn should contribute to reducing health inequalities.	The further evolution of Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth), in particular the addition of Clause 8 with clear requirements for all development to be 'well-connected and accessible...' and 'well designed to promote community cohesion and wellbeing and to reflect and enhance the areas character and natural environment' together with the supporting text in Paragraphs 5.8 to 5.13, strongly supports the delivery of this sustainability objective.

Sustainability Objectives and detailed SA questions: “Do the Policies within the Plan support the objective to...”	Assessment/Conclusions	Comments Any remaining uncertain or negative effects? Possible further amendments?
	The Urban Core Policies provide the detail at the local level of how the strategic measures will be delivered on the ground. There are policies that focus on transport related measures that will encourage walking and cycling (Policies UC 5 and 6) and use of public transport (UC7) together with policies dealing with urban design (UC12) and urban green infrastructure (UC15). All show positive steps towards supporting and encouraging healthier lifestyles.	
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity • Protect and enhance historic and cultural assets and promote a quality and stimulating urban environment • Encourage engagement with and access to culture and heritage • Protect and enhance, where appropriate, the historical integrity, quality and diversity of Gateshead and Newcastle townscape	A strong feature of the Plan is the emphasis on 'People and Place' in Chapter 12, and in turn the promotion of good place-making (Policy CS17) and how this needs to be at the heart of spatial planning in Gateshead and Newcastle.  In this regard Policy CS15 (Place Making) will help achieve the ambition of 'mainstreaming' the concept of good place-making. As an overarching policy it sets out very clear ways in which development will help to protect and enhance historic and cultural assets and promote a quality and stimulating urban environment with local distinctiveness and a strong sense of place. There is a lot of supporting text in the Plan to this policy (Paragraphs 12.11 to 12.20) with very clear recognition of the importance of the historic environment and cultural heritage. The important influence that the built environment can have on crime, health, education, inclusion, community cohesion and wellbeing is strongly emphasised. There is also a commitment that development must be used to enhance the existing unique and diverse heritage assets and landscape characteristics of Gateshead and Newcastle. Although overall many of the Strategic Policies are regarded as having a broadly neutral effect on this sustainability objective, when they are applied in combination with Policy CS15 then the effect becomes positive and in some cases in the longer term likely to become strongly positive. The Urban Core Policies have an uncertain effect that will depend on how they are delivered, but when in combination with Policy CS15 then the effect is seen to be positive. Policy UC 12 (Urban Design) reinforces at the local level how positive cultural and heritage features will be respected and enhanced.	

Sustainability Objectives and detailed SA questions: “Do the Policies within the Plan support the objective to...”	Assessment/Conclusions	Comments
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services • Ensure good access to jobs, facilities, goods and services • Deliver sustainable transport solutions that encourage walking, cycling and the use of public transport and reduce dependency on the private car • Encourage effective use of technology (communications) especially as an alternative to travel	A thread running through many of the policies (especially the economic policies) is the need for good and effective access to the full range of employment opportunities, facilities, goods and services. Therefore cumulatively most of the policies should have a significant positive effect on this sustainability objective. Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) launches the Plan with clear reference to development being in sustainable locations (such as existing built up areas and in the Urban Core) and accessible to all. Policy CS13 (Transport) is the strategic policy that majors on accessibility with an emphasis on the need for development to locate in easily accessible sites for all forms of sustainable transport (and in particular walking and cycling). The new wording in Policy CS14 stresses the need for new development to <i>‘provide good access for all to health and social care facilities’</i>, and also to promote <i>‘access for all to green spaces, play and recreation opportunities’</i>. As mentioned above a core thread in the spatial growth policies CS2 (Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core), CS3 (Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area) and CS4 (Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area) is to provide new development that will support existing local communities through enhancing and providing new services, facilities, employment opportunities that are accessible by local communities and improve accessibility between different parts of the Gateshead and Newcastle area. Cumulatively a number of the policies in the Plan are considered to have significant positive effects on accessibility. Urban Core Policies are targeted at delivering accessibility on the ground and in Policies UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling) and UC7 (Public Transport) demonstrate how accessibility will be provided using more sustainable forms of transport.	Any remaining uncertain or negative effects? Possible further amendments? Chapter 11 is dedicated to Transport and Accessibility and the supporting text to Policy CS13 (Transport) from Paragraphs 11.1 to 11.45 makes regular reference to the importance of accessibility. Indeed the opening statement sets out a clear policy towards accessibility – <i>‘Transport and accessibility are fundamental to the delivery of our spatial strategy. It is important that new development is located in the most sustainable locations, accessible by a choice of travel modes, including walking, cycling and public transport.’</i> It also goes on to explain the importance of sustainable transport and the need to achieve a modal shift in this direction.

Sustainability Objectives and detailed SA questions: "Do the Policies within the Plan support the objective to..."	Assessment/Conclusions	Comments
7a. Adapt to and mitigate against the impacts of climate change - Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change • Promote energy efficiency • Promote sustainable design and construction and the use of clean technologies • Promote use of locally produced energy from low carbon and renewable resources	 Climate change features as a 'major' challenge addressed in the Plan. A specific overarching policy has been developed (Policy CS16: Climate Change) that makes a clear commitment that all development proposals must address the impacts of climate change and reduce the potential contribution they may make to its cause. Paragraphs 12.21 onwards provide supporting text that sets out the context and regulatory framework and also explains the rationale behind the policy. With regard to this sustainability objective to mitigate against the effects by reducing contributions towards the causes of climate change, there are clauses in the policy that focus on energy reduction, promoting the use of renewable energy solutions and the adoption of sustainable building practices as set out in specific Codes of Practice (e.g. the Code for Sustainable Homes). Policy CS16 (Climate Change) will have significant positive effects on reducing the use of non-renewable energy and CO₂ emissions arising directly from new homes, employment sites and other developments. The spatial strategy policies and measures in Policy CS13 (Transport) seek sustainable patterns of development that reduce the need to travel by private car and introduce measures to facilitate cycling, walking and public transport. This is complemented by Policy CS15 (Place Making) which promotes high quality, innovative sustainable design. Whilst a number of policies appear to have very positive effects on this SA Objective there are a number that could generate negative effects (including a number of the Urban Core Policies) depending on how they are delivered (see next column for discussion of this point).	Any remaining uncertain or negative effects? Possible further amendments? The levels of growth anticipated in the Plan are likely to lead to some degree of unavoidable rise in the consumption of energy and the emissions of CO₂. Any rise will be minimised by the sustainable patterns of development arising from the spatial policies in the Plan and the measures to reduce carbon emissions and energy use required by Policy CS16 (Climate Change). Although the Plan makes a clear commitment to helping Gateshead and Newcastle to reduce its carbon emissions beyond the statutory requirements, given the levels of growth anticipated and the potential consequential increases in energy use and carbon emissions there is a possible uncertain negative effect possible. However the policy of reducing carbon emissions within the design for new development has been substantially strengthened by the inclusion of Clause 8 (iv) within Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth). This clause states that all development will be 'Designed to reduce carbon emissions and adapted to the effects of climate change.' A lot will depend on the rigor with which Strategic Policies are implemented. Effects will need to be monitored to fully assess how effective policies have been in delivering carbon reduction.

Sustainability Objectives and detailed SA questions: "Do the Policies within the Plan support the objective to..."	Assessment/Conclusions	Comments
7b. Adapt to and mitigate against the impacts of climate change - Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development • Limit risks and impacts of changing weather patterns, including flooding • Make more use of sustainable urban drainage schemes • Allow the natural environment to adapt to the consequences of climate change • Protect and enhance wildlife networks	 The paramount need to adapt to the effects of climate change is emphasised in the Plan and there is text referring to this under the climate change heading (see Paragraphs 12.24 to 12.26). This has also led to the development of a specific policy to deal with flood risk and water management – Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management. The need to locate development where possible away from areas at risk from either flooding or areas of water shortage is fully recognised as is the need to use sustainable urban drainage systems (SUDS) to more effectively manage surface water. The approach to dealing with these issues has been supported by two major studies the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) and the Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP). Both have helped to inform the spatial policies. Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment) fully recognises the 'multi-functionality' and demonstrates how the Plan helps to deliver many of the 'sub-objectives' within this sustainability objective. Policies CS16 (Climate Change), CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment) will cumulatively have significant positive effects on limiting the risks and impacts of changing weather patterns and flooding that could have been posed by the spatial development policies within the Plan.	Any remaining uncertain or negative effects? Possible further amendments? The SFRA for both Councils concluded that while there may be some degree of flood risk present at select sites, it can be sufficiently mitigated through mitigation measures including but not limited to, SUDS, SWMP and micro-siting of a development to avoid high-risk areas.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally • Minimise the use of non-renewable natural resources, including greenfield sites • Encourage the reclamation and re-use of derelict / previously developed land • Reduce waste production and increase reuse and recycling • Improve air quality and reduce pollution • Encourage sustainable design and construction	 The recognition of the need to conserve precious resources and literally 'live within environmental limits' is brought out in Policies CS13 (Transport), CS16 (Climate Change), and CS21 (Waste). The importance in these of cutting carbon emissions, the use of sustainably sourced resources, the recovery and re-use of materials, recycling and the use of sustainable transport is emphasised. Measures that will help with minimising resource use and promote more sustainable developments appear in a number of policies so for example: • Policy CS9 (Existing Communities) requires that empty properties are brought back into use and that investment is made in existing homes thus maximising the re-use of previously developed buildings and land. • Policy CS13 (Transport) gives a priority to sustainable transport and promotes walking and cycling as an alternative to the more fossil fuel consuming transport	The levels of growth anticipated in the Plan are likely to lead to some degree of unavoidable rise in the consumption of non-renewable resources (such as fossil fuels). Any rise will be minimised by the sustainable patterns of development arising from the spatial policies in the Plan and the measures to reduce resource use (and in turn carbon emissions and energy use) required by Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) and CS16 (Climate Change). Although the Plan makes a clear commitment to helping Gateshead and Newcastle to reduce its carbon emissions (and therefore cut fossil fuel use) beyond the statutory requirements (see Paragraphs 12.22 and 12.23), given the levels of growth anticipated and the potential consequential increases in energy use and carbon emissions there is a possible uncertain negative effect possible. A lot will depend on

Sustainability Objectives and detailed SA questions: “Do the Policies within the Plan support the objective to...”	Assessment/Conclusions	Comments
	modes such as the car. - Policy CS15 (Place Making) promotes sustainable design and UC12 (Urban Design) requires in Clause 5, development to <i>'incorporate high quality, durable and sustainable materials appropriate to the character of the area and the use envisaged for the site.'</i> - Policy CS16 (Climate Change) requires sustainable design and construction techniques (e.g. passive design and following the Code for Sustainable Homes) and promotes energy efficiency and the use of renewable energy. - Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment) affords protection to natural resources such as green spaces and the countryside that will be instrumental in helping development adapt to the impacts of climate change. - Policy CS21 (Waste) advocates waste minimisation and the adoption of the waste hierarchy of reduce, reuse and recycle, thus helping to curb the waste of resources. Whilst a number of policies appear to have very positive effects on this SA Objective there are a number that could generate negative effects depending on how they are delivered (see next column for discussion of this point).	Any remaining uncertain or negative effects? Possible further amendments? the rigor with which the Strategic Policies within the Plan are implemented. Effects will need to be monitored to fully assess how effective policies have been in cutting resource use (and carbon emissions) and the generation of waste and achieving high levels of re-use and recycling.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure - Contribute towards the protection and enhancement of Gateshead and Newcastle's geodiversity and biodiversity including all locally and nationally designated sites - Protect and improve the quality of our groundwater and rivers - Protect and enhance existing green space while promoting the further development of an integrated green infrastructure for Gateshead and Newcastle - Protect and improve the quality of our soils - Protect landscape quality and character	The importance of the natural environment is highlighted from Paragraphs 12.41 to 12.55 and this underpins Policy CS18 which has been developed specifically to focus on protecting green infrastructure and the natural environment. The policy emphasises the importance of protecting the integrity and connectivity of the strategic green infrastructure network, and also in protecting the 'multi-functionality' of green infrastructure (that provides for example climate change mitigation such as flood water storage and water management services etc). The policy also provides protection for countryside and biodiversity.  Cumulatively the provisions of the Plans policies should have a broadly positive effect on the protection and enhancement of environmental assets and infrastructure, however there will still be some degree of uncertainty that relates to how development is implemented at the site level and the rigor with which the mitigating policies (in particular Policy CS18) are applied.	Policy CS4 clearly advocates a development strategy for the rural areas and villages. No direct threats to the natural environment are posed by wording in this policy. However it is possible that development in rural areas could nevertheless generate some impacts on green infrastructure and the countryside. The simultaneous and rigorous application of Policy CS18 should remove any risks and ensure a positive outcome. It is encouraging to see the additional wording in Policy CS18 on 'accessibility' of the strategic green infrastructure which underlines its importance to communities as a 'natural asset'.

Sustainability Objectives and detailed SA questions: "Do the Policies within the Plan support the objective to..."	Assessment/Conclusions	Comments
10. Strengthen our economy - Nurture economic growth and improve opportunities for both new and existing businesses - Enhance the infrastructure required for economic growth - Enhance connectivity (transport and communications) - Promote investment in sustainable leisure and tourism - Raise Gateshead and Newcastle's national and international profile - Attract and retain innovative and talented individuals	 The Plan proposes a number of policies within the strategy to strengthen the Gateshead and Newcastle economy, create new jobs and increase business formation and survival. Chapter 9 sets out in some detail the context and rationale for these policies. The Plan proposes significant employment creation in the Urban Core and Key Employment Areas as in Policies CS5 (Employment and Economic Growth Priorities) and CS6 (Employment Land) that will act as a focus or the main 'hub' for economic development together with existing employment areas and Regeneration Growth Areas in the Neighbourhoods. Developer Contributions' have been formulated and feature in Policy DEL1 and Paragraphs 18.3 to 18.5. This should enhance the positive effects that the Plan policies will collectively have on this SA objective. Access to facilities, services, employment, retail and housing will be enhanced and created under the provisions of the growth policies and supplemented by Policies CS13 (Transport), CS10 (Delivering New Homes) and CS8 (Leisure, Culture and Tourism). Policy CS11 (Providing a Range and Choice of Housing) will have a positive effect on the affordability and provision of the correct size and tenure of housing across Gateshead and Newcastle. All of these measures should serve to attract and retain a diverse workforce. The Urban Core Policies are focused on delivering the investment, infrastructure and connectivity within the Urban Core to benefit sustainable economic growth and with the simultaneous application of key Strategic policies should contribute to attracting and retaining innovative businesses and the corresponding workforce within this strategic area.	Any remaining uncertain or negative effects? Possible further amendments? Policies CS16 (Climate Change) and CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) could be seen as placing a constraint on new development by imposing requirements to mitigate and adapt to the effects of climate change and could therefore serve to restrict options and choices for future development. However this is balanced by the measures seeking to ensure that new developments will be sustainable and present viable opportunities for economic growth in the future.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market - Develop appropriate employment opportunities that are accessible, diverse and plentiful - Contribute towards reducing worklessness - Increase workforce diversity and ensure equality of opportunities	 The main thrust of the economic growth strategy with its focus on new developments in the Urban Core is to make sure that employment opportunities are accessible, diverse and plentiful. This is captured in the text of Chapter 9 and the key economic development and growth policies (Policies CS1 and CS5). Chapter 11 and Policy CS13 (Transport) describe how the strategic approach towards access is designed to support economic prosperity and access to employment opportunities. Cumulatively the provisions of the Plan policies should have a broadly positive effect on this SA objective and in the case of some of the policies make a significant contribution towards reducing worklessness.	
Key	 Positive effect: policies would help in achieving the objective ? Possible negative effect: policies would potentially be in conflict with the objective	 Uncertain effect: depends on how development would be implemented at a site level, or uncertain due to lack of detailed information of effect

6 APPRAISAL CONCLUSIONS

6.1 INTRODUCTION

The Sustainability Appraisal has evaluated the implications of the Plan and its policies for development broadly across Gateshead and Newcastle. The sustainability appraisal of the Strategic Objectives, the 21 Strategic Policies, 17 Urban Core Policies and the 36 Sub Area and Sites Policies has been described in Chapter 5 (with detailed assessments recorded in Annex C). This chapter covers the following:

- the impact that the appraisal process has had on Plan and policies (Section 6.2);
- the likely impact of delivering the Plan and its policies (Section 6.3);
- an assessment of the cumulative impacts (Section 6.4);
- an assessment of the local impacts (Section 6.5);
- mitigation of the impacts (Section 6.6);
- monitoring (Section 6.7); and
- establishing the local sustainability indicators (Section 6.8).

Within the appraisal particular localised sustainability effects have been identified and in line with the requirements of the SEA Regulations the environmental effects set out (Section 6.5).

6.2 APPRAISAL IMPACT

In order to fully appreciate the impact of the appraisal the reader is referred to the previous drafts of the Sustainability Appraisal¹⁹ together with the earlier drafts of the One Core Strategy²⁰.

As a result of this iterative process the Plan with its policies and supporting text has gone through an evolution and revision process. Modifications of policy clauses have been further introduced together with revisions of the Plan text. Some key outcomes of the SA/SEA appraisal process to date and the difference that this process has made are as follows:

- A greater recognition of how spatial planning and the Plan can help address equality of opportunity (particularly in terms of access and accessibility), diversity and some of the social inclusion challenges for the area. Some major adjustments to the Plan text, together with some key policy changes now bring out more clearly how development can and will be made to serve the whole community.
- One of the most significant changes (which also brings the Plan very closely in line with NPPF guidelines) is the revision of Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth). This now has an upfront Clause 1 that states that the main vision will be achieved by '*A presumption in favour of sustainable development*' together with a new Clause 8 that sets out four key 'Development Principles' that require development to be '*fully inclusive*' and '*well designed to promote community cohesion*'.

¹⁹ NewcastleGateshead One Core Strategy Consultation Draft, Sustainability Appraisal Reports, February 2011, and September 2011, Natural Capital Ltd

²⁰ NewcastleGateshead One Core Strategy Consultation Drafts, January 2011 and September 2011

- The important contribution that the Plan can make in addressing inequalities and social inclusion is now better reflected with the inclusion in Paragraph 5.11 of a specific development principle that states:

'Both Councils are committed to the promotion of diversity, equality and fairness, and expect all development to contribute to this in accordance with the latest equalities legislation.'

- When dealing with accessibility, several of the overarching policies have been strengthened to make quite clear the requirements that will be expected of future development. For example:
 - o Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) includes a clause stating that development will be *'fully inclusive....'* and *'well connected and accessible by sustainable modes of transport'*;
 - o Policy CS13 (Transport) includes a clause – *'improving equality of access to transport for everyone'*;
 - o Policy CS14 (Wellbeing and Health) with clauses that state – *'providing good access for all to health and social care facilities'* and *'promoting access for all to green spaces, sports facilities, play and recreation opportunities'*;
 - o Policy CS15 (Place Making) that states that all development will be required to *'Ensure connectivity, accessibility and legibility'*; and
 - o Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) that emphasises *'Maintaining, protecting and enhancing the integrity, connectivity, multifunctionality and accessibility of the Strategic Green Infrastructure Network.'*
- The vital contribution that can be made towards the wiser use of resources (living within environmental limits) is brought out by a clearer Climate Change policy (CS16) where the need to adopt more sustainable design and construction methods (to promote energy efficiency and conservation) and sustainable sources of energy is clearly set out. The requirement for new developments to function more effectively in a changing climate and be flexible and resilient to the effects of climate change is also clearly articulated.
- Policy CS15 (Place Making) is much clearer in both how it will require development to create inclusive and accessible environments that will nurture local distinctiveness and sense of place whilst at the same time proactively sustaining the historic environment and valuing heritage assets.
- There is also a clarity in Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) with regard to both protecting and enhancing existing sites valued for their nature conservation interests (both biodiversity and geodiversity) whilst also maintaining and enhancing connectivity, multifunctionality and accessibility.

6.3 IMPLICATIONS OF THE PLAN ACROSS GATESHEAD AND NEWCASTLE

The appraisal has been able to draw some conclusions about the general implications of delivering the Plan and its supporting policies, and these can be divided into positive implications and where there may still be some potential challenges to address.

6.3.1 Positive Implications

In general terms the Plan with its Strategic Objectives and suite of policies appears likely to deliver a broad balance of positive economic, social and environmental trends for the combined area.

Policy CS1 – The Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth makes it quite clear that it will:

- have a presumption in favour of sustainable development;
- focus the majority of development in the most sustainable locations, in existing built up areas that are accessible to all (e.g. the Urban Core and other key Neighbourhood sites); and
- enhance the neighbourhoods and sustain villages through a balance of housing provision, employment and local services.

Policy CS1 in its Clause 8 also sets out four key development principles that set the standards for all development. This clause emphasises that all development will be:

- fully inclusive, irrespective of cultural background ethnicity and age, to meet the diverse needs of all residents and communities;
- well-connected and accessible by sustainable modes of transport;
- well-designed to promote community cohesion, and wellbeing, and to reflect and enhance the areas character and natural environment; and
- designed to reduce carbon emissions and adapted to the effects of climate change.

The supporting policies behind the spatial strategy attempt to deliver:

Healthier, Thriving and Inclusive Communities

Through:

- promoting improvement to wellbeing and health through positive spatial planning that addresses the key factors influencing health and which promotes active and healthy lifestyles (Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health);
- seeking to support more healthy lifestyles within a healthier environment (pollution free) through promoting walking and cycling (Policies CS13: Transport, UC5: Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes and UC6: Cycling); protecting and where possible enhancing green infrastructure and the natural heritage assets of Gateshead and Newcastle (Policies CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment and UC15: Urban Green Infrastructure), protecting and enhancing the historic environment and cultural heritage (Policies CS15: Place Making and UC14: Heritage); encouraging access to amenity and recreational facilities (Policies CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism and UC16: Public Realm); and

- promoting the concept of 'Lifetime Neighbourhoods' and providing accessible, affordable and safer housing that meets the varied and changing needs of all citizens in Gateshead and Newcastle (Policies CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing and UC4: Homes).

More Sustainable Transport

Through:

- seeking to reduce the need to travel by carefully locating development in the most sustainable locations (Spatial Strategy Policies CS1 and CS2); and
- seeking to encourage the use of public transport and more sustainable modes of travel other than the car such as cycling and walking (Policy CS13: Transport, UC5: Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes and UC6: Cycling).

A Healthier Global and Local Environment

It is now broadly accepted that there will be significant climate change consequences over the coming decades arising from greenhouse gases already released as a result of man-made activities, as well as those emissions likely to be associated with planned growth. The sort of activities that contribute towards the release of CO₂ emissions into the environment at the global level (fossil fuel burning by power stations to generate electricity, fossil fuel burning by transport, fossil fuel burning to generate heating for housing, industrial emissions from manufacturing operations) are also those emissions that can impact on local air quality.

The Plan aims to address these emission sources through:

- seeking to mitigate against the effects and also to ensure that new development adapts to the consequences of climate change (Policy CS16: Climate Change);
- seeking to protect and improve where appropriate air quality (Policy CS13: Transport);
- the prevention of waste and better waste management (Policy CS21: Waste);
- seeking to reduce the reliance on fossil fuels (Policy CS16: Climate Change); and
- making best use of land and minimising flood risk (Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management).

Protection and Enhancement of Natural Heritage Assets

The Plan recognises that the natural environment is an essential component of quality of place in Gateshead and Newcastle. The strategic importance of green infrastructure and the many ecosystem services that it offers (such as climate change adaptation, flood attenuation, water management, biodiversity conservation etc) is also fully recognised. The strategic importance of the River Tyne is highlighted.

The Plan aims to address these issues as set out in Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment, through:

- protecting the integrity and connectivity of the strategic Green Infrastructure Network;

- making sure that new developments conserve and enhance green infrastructure;
- maximising the potential that green infrastructure has in adapting to the effects of climate change (e.g. flood water storage, carbon sinks, urban cooling etc); and
- protecting and enhancing biodiversity and geodiversity.

Protection and Enhancement of the Historic Environment

The Plan highlights the fundamental role that 'quality of place' plays in delivering its wider spatial planning objectives. The key to quality of place is successful place making that incorporates high quality urban design. The Core Strategy emphasises that high quality urban design is founded upon an understanding of the area's unique historic environment and cultural heritage.

Through Policy CS15: Place Making, the Plan aims to retain the distinctive character and 'sense of place' that exists in Gateshead and Newcastle through:

- encouraging the recognition of the importance of the historic environment;
- making sure that new development reflects local character and distinctiveness; and
- seeking to encourage the enhancement of the historic environment where possible.

Urban Core, Sub Areas and Sites

The Plan sets out a spatial vision for the Urban Core, the various Sub Areas and Sites (including Neighbourhoods and Villages) that attempts to:

- expand Gateshead and Newcastle Centres (the Urban Core) to accommodate growth through the regeneration of several Key Sites (e.g. Gateshead Quays, Ouseburn, East Pilgrim Street and Stephenson Quarter) that will create employment opportunities and housing in some of the most sustainable locations;
- make the best use of buildings, spaces and places and of Newcastle's historic core whilst preserving their historic features; and
- support development of the key sites and at the same time improve the walkability of the urban core whilst upgrading the green and social infrastructure;
- establish Neighbourhood Growth Areas in key locations; and
- allocate Village Growth Areas to secure the long-term sustainability of villages.

It also sets out the policies that will deliver the necessary changes within the Urban Core together with a suite of policies that provide guidance for development in the Sub Areas and Key Sites (Neighbourhoods and Villages).

All of the land allocation policies for housing and employment land were screened against the sustainability criteria and none were found to trigger any adverse effects or pose challenges for future development. Any constraints identified were found to be adequately mitigated by the application of the appropriate Core Strategy policies (CS1 to CS21).

Conclusions

If the policies set out in the Plan are fully implemented it should be possible for Gateshead and Newcastle Councils to achieve their strategic objectives and development goals whilst delivering progress in the economic, social and environmental objectives that make up the Sustainability Framework.

In particular, if the key policies that set out the social sustainability criteria:

- Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth – and in particular Clause 8 with the key development principles that specifically address the social criteria (Clauses 8(i) and 8 (iii))
- Paragraph 5.11 – that makes commitments to the promotion of equality, diversity and fairness
- Policy CS9: Existing Communities
- Policy CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing
- Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health
- Policy CS15: Place Making

are adhered to then the development goals should be achievable whilst maintaining and improving wellbeing, health, social inclusion, equalities and community cohesion.

If the key policies that set out the longer term sustainability goals and high standards of environmental protection for the historic and natural environment:

- Policy CS16: Climate Change
- Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management
- Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment
- Policy CS21: Waste

are adhered to then the development goals should be achievable without causing a deterioration in the environmental quality of Gateshead and Newcastle.

6.3.2 Potential Challenges to Address

Notwithstanding the above positive elements it is highly likely that there will be some environmental implications arising from new development. Some issues are almost inevitable, and would arise as a result of any new development and these include:

- emissions of greenhouse gases from the manufacture and supply of building and construction materials;
- emissions of greenhouse gases from energy use and traffic;
- an increased burden on air quality from any increases in traffic;
- an increased burden on water supply and water treatment for a growing and expanding population; and
- additional waste generation.

The policies within the Plan are worded in ways that would imply that if rigorously applied the above potential negative environmental impacts can be considerably mitigated. Thus the application of Policy CS16: Climate Change should considerably reduce carbon emissions from new developments. The implementation of Policy CS13: Transport should reduce CO₂ emissions from traffic and ensure that local air quality did not deteriorate. The application of good sustainability design principles (as advocated in Policy CS16) should ensure that

both water and waste management are carried out in ways that improve environmental quality.

There are other issues that are highly dependent on the rigorous application of key policies within the Plan and these include:

Biodiversity and Geodiversity Conservation Interests

Including:

- loss of and damage to habitats;
- loss and disturbance to protected species;
- loss of and damage to fauna and flora (both on and off development sites); and
- loss of and damage to geomorphological interests.

Landscape and Historic Character

Including:

- visual impacts;
- damage to local distinctiveness;
- damage to important landscape and historic features; and
- damage to characteristic building styles.

Traffic and Congestion

Including:

- increased emissions;
- increased noise, vibration and disturbance; and
- reduced tranquillity.

Inappropriate Use of Land

Including:

- encroachment into green space;
- inappropriate development in flood plain areas or areas at risk from flooding; and
- inappropriate use of agricultural land.

Section 6.6 summarises ways in which these impacts can be mitigated through the planning system and the application of the Plan policies.

6.4 CUMULATIVE IMPACTS

A summary of the assessment of the possible cumulative effects is given in Annex D. Clearly to deal with some of the effects there will need to be supporting action at the national and regional levels, for example to deal with:

- human health;
- equality and diversity;
- energy supply;
- reliance on fossil fuels;
- traffic and transportation alternatives;
- waste management and disposal;
- water supply and treatment and flood prevention; and
- wider nature conservation issues.

However the Plan has a major role to play in contributing to the management and mitigation of these effects. In particular the Strategic Policies can:

- make sure that new development contributes to improved health, safety and wellbeing in its design and location;
- promote social inclusion and ensure that equal opportunities are encouraged;
- address the contribution to more global level issues (e.g. climate change, use of fossil fuels and energy, waste generation, loss of biodiversity) through action at the local level;
- create the right development framework to provide proactive solutions to these problems; and
- influence and change behaviour at the business, community and individual household levels.

Table 6.1 below summarises an assessment of the possible cumulative effects of the Plan's strategic policies. An analysis of this table indicates that with some of the policies there are a number of uncertainties with respect to their effects on two of the sustainability objectives (Objective 7a – climate change mitigation and Objective 8 – living within environmental limits). When these are considered cumulatively the balance of effects tends to even out so that for some of the policies there is a very positive effect on SA Objectives 7a and 8 whereas for others it is uncertain negative if the policy was to be implemented on its own. The uncertainties can translate into areas of opportunity as well as risk with the resultant impact dependant on mitigation provided by other overarching policies.

Under the broad headings of economic, social and environmental effects the following conclusions can be drawn:

- **Economic Risks:** A number of policies intentionally pose some restrictions on where development is likely to be permitted within Gateshead and Newcastle (Policies CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management, CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment). It was felt, however, that because these policies and the thrust of the Plan are supportive of development in the most appropriate sustainable location, that this would counterbalance any slight restrictions. All aim to site development in the most sustainable locations (i.e. using previously developed land and buildings, avoiding flood risk areas, maximising access, avoiding impacts on landscape and biodiversity) that will be clearly beneficial for the longer term.

Economic Opportunities: Any potential constraint on development from these policies will be counterbalanced by the general positive cumulative impact the policies are likely to have on strengthening the local economy. Tourism, culture (historic environment and cultural heritage) and leisure for example have been identified as key growth areas and a number of policies will protect and enhance the assets on which this is based (Policies CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism, and CS15: Place Making).

- **Social Opportunities:** The majority of policies have a positive or in some cases neutral (such as the strategic environmental policy dealing with Climate Change) impact on the social objectives. There is an increased positive cumulative effect on the promotion of strong and inclusive communities (SA Objective 1), ensuring that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in future development (SA Objective 2),

improving health and wellbeing (SA Objective 4), and promoting, enhancing and respecting culture, heritage and diversity (SA Objective5).

The suggested amendments to some of these policies made during previous appraisals have strengthened, in particular, the contribution made towards inclusive design and embedding equalities and diversity considerations into future development.

- **Environmental Risks:** Although it is distinctly possible that development could put pressure on biodiversity in terms of species and habitats (e.g. through land take, disruption and disturbance) the approach to site selection should steer development in the first instance towards previously developed sites or towards greenfield sites of low biodiversity value. With the full and rigorous application of Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) any risks to the countryside and biodiversity should be removed.

Annex D summarises in more detail possible cumulative effects and the local significance of this is discussed in Section 6.5 below. The operation of umbrella policies such as Policies CS16 (Climate Change), CS15 (Place Making) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) should help to mitigate against the possible cumulative effects.

Strategic Flood Risk Assessments (SFRAs) from both Councils were consulted in gauging policy sustainability against the objectives outlined in Annex E and their findings heavily influenced the safeguarding clauses in Policy CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) to ensure that flood risk is not increased across the Plan area. SFRAs were also used to inform strategic policy and site allocations, and influenced mitigation measures.

In some cases site boundaries were changed if the flood risk was deemed too high and potential mitigation measures were not enough to adequately moderate the risk. Alternatives for sites particularly susceptible to flooding (e.g. Metrogreen, Gateshead Quays Key Development Site, Pipewellgate and Millennium Quays/Hawks Road East) were considered as part of the SFRA, but were discounted as they could not provide a reasonable alternative.

The SFRAs for both Councils concluded that while there may be some degree of flood risk present at select sites, it can be sufficiently mitigated through mitigation measures including but not limited to, SUDS, SWMP and micro-siting of a development to avoid high-risk flood areas.

With regard to issues such as the environmental effects of energy use, traffic and transport and waste it is hard to be certain as to whether the mitigation will truly remove all possible adverse effects. New developments for housing and industry will clearly create a demand for energy (gas and electricity) and the creation of more waste and it is difficult to see how the measures set out in Policy CS16 (Climate Change) and Policy CS21 (Waste) will fully mitigate against all the carbon emissions associated with new development. The cumulative effect of the policies on the climate change mitigation and living within environmental limits related sustainability objectives is therefore hard to predict but is likely to be at best neutral or slightly negative.

Environmental Opportunities: The suite of policies broadly have a positive cumulative effect on SA Objective 5 (Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity) and therefore should be positively supportive towards protecting and where appropriate enhancing the historic environment. The policies also have a broadly positive effect on SA Objective 9 (Protecting and enhancing our environmental assets and infrastructure) so should help in protecting and where appropriate enhancing the natural environment.

Application of Policies CS15 (Place Making) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) should have very positive cross cutting effects when applied with other policies in protecting and enhancing both the historic and natural environment.

Table 6.1: Summary Assessment of the Possible Cumulative Effects of the Strategic Policies within the Plan

Rural Development Strategy for the North East of England												
Strategic Policies within the Plan			Sustainability Objectives									
			Social			Environmental				Economic		
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7a	7b	8	9	10	11
Policy CS1 Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth	✓✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓✓	✓✓
Policy CS2 Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓✓	20/✓	20/✓	2*	✓	✓✓	✓✓
Policy CS3 Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area	✓✓	✓✓	✓	✓	✓	✓✓	✓	20/✓	2*	✓	✓	✓
Policy CS4 Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area	✓✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	2*	✓	2*	✓	✓	✓
Policy CS5 Employment and Economic Growth Priorities	✓	✓	✓	0/✓	0	✓✓	2/✗	✓	2/✗	✓	✓✓	✓✓
Policy CS6 Employment Land	✓	✓	✓	0/✓	0	✓✓	2/✗	✓	2/✗	✓	✓✓	✓✓
Policy CS7 Retail and Centres	✓✓	✓✓	✓	✓	✓	✓✓	20/✓	20/✓	✓	✓	✓✓	✓✓
Policy CS8 Leisure, Culture and Tourism	✓	✓	✓	✓✓	✓✓	✓	2/✗	✓	2/✗	✓	✓✓	✓✓
Policy CS9 Existing Communities	✓✓	✓	0	0/✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Policy CS10 Delivering New Homes	✓	✓	0	0	✓	✓	2/✗	✓	2/✗	✓	✓	✓
Policy CS11 Providing a Range and Choice of Housing	✓✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	2/✗	✓	2/✗	✓	✓	✓
Policy CS12 Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Show People	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	2/✗	✓	2/✗	✓	✓	✓
Policy CS13 Transport	✓✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓✓	✓✓	0	✓✓	✓	0/✓	0/✓
Policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health	✓✓	✓✓	✓	✓✓	0/✓	✓	0/✓	0	✓	0	0	0
Policy CS15 Place Making	✓✓	✓	0/✓	✓	✓✓	0	✓	✓✓	✓	✓✓	✓	0
Policy CS16 Climate Change	0	0	0	✓	0	0	✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	✓	0/✓	0
Policy CS17 Flood Risk and Water Management	0	0	0	✓	0/✓	✓	0/✓	✓✓	0	✓	0	0
Policy CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment	✓	✓	0	✓✓	0	0	✓✓	✓✓	✓	✓✓	✓	0
Policy CS19 Green Belt	0	0	0	0	0	✓	2/✗	✓	2/✗	✓	✓✓	✓
Policy CS20 Minerals	0	0	0	0	0	0	✗	0	✗	0	✓	✓
Policy CS21 Waste	0	0	0	0	0	0	✓✓	0	✓✓	✓	✓	0
Overall cumulative effect	✓	✓	0/✓	✓	✓	✓	2/✗	✓	2/✗	✓	✓	✓

✓ Overall effect likely to be positive
 ✓✓ Clear strong positive effects
 ✖ Overall effect likely to be negative
 ?/✖ Uncertain possible negative effect
 ?/✓ Uncertain possible positive effect
 ?/0 Uncertain possible neutral effect
 ? Uncertain effect
 0/✖ Neutral or possible negative effect
 0/✓ Neutral or possible positive effect
 0 Neutral effect

6.5 LOCAL IMPACTS

The Strategic Policies within the Plan are designed to promote positive trends across Gateshead and Newcastle in delivering the sustainability objectives. However it is possible that negative effects may still be felt at the more local level, depending on how Plan policies are delivered.

The Plan focuses on setting broad directional policies across Gateshead and Newcastle. Many of these are non-specific in terms of particular developments and therefore it is difficult to predict and quantify the likely effects on the ground with any precision. The policies are likely to generate different impacts for different localities depending on the discrete characteristics of the locations (i.e. the nature of the community, whether urban or rural site, access to services and facilities, proximity to sensitive environmental receptors e.g. conservation sites, controlled waters, flora/fauna, historic sites/buildings, important landscape etc).

The suite of more locational policies i.e. those addressing the Sub Areas and Sites in Gateshead and Newcastle have been screened using the sustainability objectives but with question sets that have a more specific spatial thrust to them (see Annex C). No sites were found to pose significant threats to the natural and cultural heritage but several were found in the near vicinity of locally important nature conservation sites. As long as the relevant Strategic Policies are followed within the Plan then it is likely that appropriate development can go ahead at these sites since there will be adequate mitigation provided by these policies (e.g. CS18).

Although at this stage it is not possible to predict any local impacts with any detail it is possible to highlight some of the important local sensitive designated areas where future development could impact. Impacts can clearly be negative or positive and both are flagged up in Table 6.2 below.

The possible local impacts identified in this table, particularly those connected with the Northumbria Coast Special Protection Area, flag up the need to undertake a Habitats Regulations Assessment (see Section 1.4.1). This should determine whether the Plan is likely to generate 'likely significant effects' on the integrity of this SPA or any other European Site.

Table 6.2: Summary of Possible Local Impacts Associated with Sensitive Designated Areas

Potential Locality of Development	Significant Receptors and Issues Relevant to the Plan	Potential Negative Impact	Potential Positive Impact
The riverside areas including Gateshead Quays and the Baltic Business Quarter in the Urban Core, and Metrogreen, Dunston and Walker Riverside in the Neighbourhoods.	Possible Site(s) Affected - Northumbria Coast SPA and Ramsar site Key Environmental Conditions that Could be Affected - Coastal sand dunes and sand beaches - Shallow inshore waters - Rocky shores with associated boulder and cobble beaches - Artificial high tide roost sites Site Vulnerability - Rocky reef and sea cave communities are sensitive to operations that may result in their damage e.g. from contamination by oil, sewage or other pollutants arising from development sites (e.g. from accidents or emergency situations). - Features found on sand and mud flats such as eel grass and mussel beds and associated animals that live in the sediment are sensitive to smothering/ deposition of suspended solids or pollution originating from development sites (e.g. from uncontrolled incidents or emergency scenarios). - Threats to all of this can also come from recreational use, fisheries and waste water discharges. Disturbance - Waders are known to be particularly susceptible to human disturbance. There is also strong and understandable pressure for public access to the riverside, for recreational use. There is therefore a potential conflict between conserving wader populations and meeting the demand for public access to the banks of the River Tyne.	Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth), CS2 (Spatial Strategy for Urban Core), CS3 (Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhoods), CS4 (Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area), CS5 (Employment and Economic Growth Priorities), CS8 (Leisure, Culture, Tourism), CS10 (Delivering New Homes) together with major infrastructure requirements – could all initiate changes through: - direct land take; - associated landscaping; - major construction activities; - uncontrolled incidents; and - major emergency scenarios. These could cause damage and destruction of feeding and/or roosting sites lower downstream on the River Tyne and associated habitat, plus disturbance and displacement of migratory species. Any additional discharges or drainage outfalling to the estuary could affect foreshore sediments and biodiversity further downstream. Increased tourism and recreational activities (that may follow from Policy CS8) may result in additional traffic, recreational activities and associated disturbance along the North East coast in general.	The influence of the Plan could be beneficial if policies are used vigorously not only to protect biodiversity but also to enhance it. Application of Policies CS15 (Place Making) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) with specific measures to protect the historic, cultural and natural environment and biodiversity should help to mitigate against any potentially negative impacts of the Plan. Implementation of Policy CS8 (Leisure, Culture and Tourism) may result in additional traffic in the general North East area, however, the policy states that developments will be focused primarily within the Urban Core. This will encourage movement and tourism activity within this urban area as opposed to the wider coastal fringe. It also states that development will not be considered in rural areas if it would undermine the character and environment of the area. The Plan in general takes a proactive stance in protecting all green infrastructure within Gateshead and Newcastle and in preventing development that will impact negatively on open countryside, greenbelt, open space and areas of nature conservation interest (see Policy CS18 and its supporting text in Chapter 12). Existing water pollution control legislation implemented under the Water Framework Directive and administered by the Environment Agency should also provide for adequate protection against water pollution events.

Potential Locality of Development	Significant Receptors and Issues Relevant to the Plan	Potential Negative Impact	Potential Positive Impact
Metrogreen, Dunston and Walker Riverside together with other potential developments in the Rural Neighbourhoods, Areas and Villages.	Possible Site(s) Affected • North Pennine Moors SPA • Sites of Nature Conservation Interest or Local Nature Reserves e.g. Havannah/Three Hills LNR Key Environmental Conditions that Could be Affected • Indirect effects on feeding or roosting areas relevant to waders frequenting the SPA. • Potential loss of unprotected feeding or roosting sites. • Potential disturbance of feeding or roosting sites. Site Vulnerability • Although not impacting directly on the SPA (which is some 22km away at its closest point) there could be impacts on waders moving from the SPA to the Tyne Estuary. • Impacts on unprotected feeding and roosting sites. • Invertebrate food material for waders living in sediment on sand and mud flats is sensitive to smothering/ deposition of suspended solids or pollution that could originate from development sites (e.g. chemicals, oils and suspended solids from uncontrolled incidents e.g. leaks and spills or emergency scenarios).	Policies CS3 and particularly CS4 that could represent potential incursions into rural parts of the borough, may, depending upon how they are implemented, lead to development that could have the potential to impact adversely upon feeding waders. It will be important therefore to ensure that adequate ecological survey information is available, before plans and designs for specific developments are finalised. The screening of policies dealing with the allocation of land for housing and employment (Sub-Areas and Sites) did not suggest at this stage that there would be significant ecological issues associated with the sites considered. Policy CS16 (Climate Change) – encourages possible new renewable energy generation schemes which (as in the case of wind turbines) could be positioned in roosting or gathering sites and which could obstruct bird flight paths and their ability to move from roosting to feeding sites.	Application of Policies CS15 (Place Making) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) with specific measures to protect the historic, cultural and natural environment and biodiversity should help to mitigate against any potentially negative impacts of policies within the Plan. The Plan in general takes a proactive stance in protecting all green infrastructure within Gateshead and Newcastle and in preventing development that will impact negatively on open countryside, greenbelt, open space and areas of nature conservation interest (see Policy CS18 and its supporting text in Chapter 12).

6.6 MITIGATION OF IMPACTS

As indicated in Section 6.5 above the precise effects of the broad directional policies and some of the more general policies that address the Urban Core within the Plan, are clearly going to be difficult to predict with any accuracy at the local level. The effects, whether positive, negative or cumulative will depend on:

- how policies are implemented at the local level;
- the precise nature of the developments that are being assessed; and
- the economic, social and environmental characteristics of the potential locations.

As the Plan has evolved through the various iterations, mitigation has been possible, however, by modifying policies in line with the results of the sustainability appraisal and the feedback from consultation. Mitigation, through the modification of a number of the policies, has been carried out during the specific appraisal of individual policies as set out in Annex C. In this most recent assessment there were no cases where any policy was found to generate an overall negative impact or clear, strong negative impacts on all or most of the sustainability objectives. In some cases there were policies that appeared to be generating uncertain effects (particularly in the case of certain environmental objectives and trends) that could have resulted in negative or positive impacts depending on their application and the local circumstances.

In these cases the application of Policy CS16 (Climate Change) and others of the “umbrella” kind (such as Policies CS17 and CS18) in parallel served to mitigate any potential negative effects. Table 6.3 below summarises the more detailed information in Annex D on the policies within the Plan that provide some mitigation of possible cumulative environmental effects of the Strategy.

Table 6.3 Application of Policies that will help to Mitigate Potential Cumulative Environmental Effects of the Plan

Potential Cumulative Environmental Effect	Policies within the Plan that will help to Mitigate
Water Resources (water use and water quality impacts)	Policies CS17, CS18 and CS19
Impacts on designated sites Loss of Geodiversity and Biodiversity	Policies CS18
Traffic Levels and Congestion	Policies CS1 and CS13
Waste Management	Policy CS21
Emissions of Greenhouse Gases and Energy Consumption	Policies CS13 and CS16
Inappropriate use of land (e.g. development on floodplains, encroaching into greenbelt or open countryside, development on agricultural land etc)	Policies CS1, CS17, CS19, CS20 and CS21
Historic and Cultural Heritage	Policy CS15

The Plan policies that deal with location (such as Policies CS1, CS2, CS15 and CS17 and CS18) have been used to guide development away from sites where there could be potential impacts on sensitive areas and orientate it towards the Urban Core and related Neighbourhoods where the locations will be more sustainable. When allocating land sensitive areas will be avoided and sites sought where development proposals can support and enhance biological and geological conservation interests.

6.7 MONITORING THE DELIVERY OF SUSTAINABILITY OBJECTIVES

It will be essential that the implementation of the Plan is monitored to make sure that:

- the prediction of effects was accurate;
- that mitigation of effects through the application of specific policies is performing as well as can be expected or whether policies need further modification;
- whether any further modification of policies is necessary to mitigate any adverse effects which had not been identified previously; and
- that the plan is contributing to the achievement of the Sustainability Objectives and targets.

The monitoring framework for the Plan is based on the establishment of a set of indicators for each of the sustainability objectives. The selection of appropriate sustainability indicators on which the progress of achieving the sustainability objectives and ultimately the effects of the Plan can be measured, has been undertaken in three stages:

- **Stage 1** – selecting indicators with reference to those used at the national, regional and local levels in related plans and strategies and also in relation to the sustainability issues identified.
- **Stage 2** – sifting the indicators in order to arrive at a suite of indicators that would satisfy the criteria of being simple, relevant in the local context, and with baseline information that was readily accessible.
- **Stage 3** – using comments received by the consultees on the SA Scoping Report to further refine and improve the list of indicators.

The indicators were first put forward in the Scoping Report and the methodology for how they were developed was set out in detail. Following feedback and consultation they have been further refined and updated. Table 6.4 below sets out the framework of indicators after running them through the sifting exercise and taking into account the comments made by consultees on the Scoping Report, and are based on the current baseline information available. The table shows those indicators that have been recommended for monitoring the delivery of each sustainability objective. Additional recommended indicators are added for use in the future when the appropriate information is collected and made available.

6.8 MONITORING THE DELIVERY OF THE PLAN

Monitoring will also be necessary to make sure that the Plan is delivering an appropriate strategy for the spatial development of Gateshead and Newcastle that will ultimately help deliver the vision, goals, objectives and targets of the Bridging Document and of the respective Sustainable Community Strategies of the two Councils. A monitoring framework was finalised for the Plan using the indicator suite featured in Table 6.4.

Ideally it would be preferable to produce a single suite of indicators that can be used to both monitor the delivery of the Plan and also to monitor the delivery of the sustainability objectives. Work is on-going to develop such a set of indicators within the current monitoring framework.

Table 6.4 Possible Sustainability Indicators for Use in Future Monitoring

Sustainability Objectives (taken from Table E1 Annex E)	Sustainability Issues	Relevant Section of Baseline	Possible Indicator
Economic Prosperity			
10. Strengthen our economy	Amount of employment land, floor space, vitality and viability of economic centres	B.5: Employment Material Assets	- Amount of employment land (ha) available by type and location - Amount of employment floor space approved, completed and lost by size (m²), location (including allocated employment land/key employment area), type (use class) and greenfield / brownfield - Business survival rate (annual VAT registrations minus de-registrations /10,000 population)
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market			
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Performance of retail	B.3: Economy and B4: Retail	- Approvals, completions and losses of retail developments, by location (in/edge/out-of-centre, and rural) and gross internal floor space (m²) - Vitality and viability health checks of centres, including: total units and total floor space (m²), and % vacant units and % vacant floor space - Loss of primary retail frontages in Urban Core
	Worklessness	B.5: Employment	- Total number of jobs - Proportion of working-age residents in employment
	Areas of low educational achievement	B.9.6 Education	Proportion of working age population qualified to at least NVQ level 3 equivalent
	Lack of higher education graduates working in Gateshead and Newcastle	B.9.6 Education	Number of targeted recruitment and training agreements linked to development schemes, by type

Sustainability Objectives (taken from Table E1 Annex E)	Sustainability Issues	Relevant Section of Baseline	Possible Indicator
Homes			
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities 2. Ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Shortage of affordable housing of an appropriate standard	B.13: Housing Standards	- Housing approvals, completions and losses by location, type, affordable and greenfield / brownfield (within trajectory showing net additional dwellings per year from the start of the plan period) - Housing land supply (within trajectory showing projected net additional dwellings to the end of the plan period)
	Housing market weakness and failure	B.13: Housing Standards	Number of vacant dwellings, as a proportion of total housing stock. By total vacant and vacant for more than six months
	Growing population needed to sustain economic growth	B.10 Current Population Size and Population Projections	ONS mid-year population estimates
	Travellers and gypsies	No baseline mention	Net additional pitches provided in the reporting year, and total provision as a % of the identified need
Transport and Accessibility			
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Areas with lack of reasonable access to services and essential facilities	B.6.1: Transport Infrastructure and B.6.2: Sustainable Transport Infrastructure	Amount of residential development within 10, 20 and 30 minutes of public transport time to:
			- a GP - a hospital - a primary school - a secondary school - large employers - food stores - a major retail centre

Sustainability Objectives (taken from Table E1 Annex E)	Sustainability Issues	Relevant Section of Baseline	Possible Indicator
	Need to continue and encourage shift to public transport, cycling and walking in order to ease traffic congestion (and air quality problems) and problems associated with severance Need to control freight	B6.1: Transport Infrastructure and B.6.2: Sustainable Transport Infrastructure	• Number of cycling trips, indexed to base year • Weekday traffic flows, river crossings and inner and outer Newcastle cordons • Planning permissions granted with implementation of a travel plan as a condition of development, by location, type and size of development • Number of passengers boarding and alighting the metro and number of passengers boarding buses in the Urban Core • Planning permissions granted within the Freight Management Area with implementation of a Delivery Service Plan as a condition of development
	Air quality due to traffic congestion	B.24: Air Quality	• Mean reading (24hr/annual average) for NO₂ within AQMAS
People and Place			
4. Improve health and wellbeing and reduce inequalities in health	Demand on health and social services caused by an ageing population and changing demographics, particularly relating to spatial distribution of older members of the population	B9.1: Age Profile and Current Population Size and B.10: Population Projections	• Estimate of total population • Population by Broad age group (0-15, 16-64 and 65 and over), as a proportion of the total • Resident satisfaction with (by location): - o Their home as a place to live - o The choice of housing in their area - o The quality of housing in their area • Proportion satisfied with their areas a place to live, by location, age, gender and ethnicity
	Poor physical health (with links to obesity), the need to promote healthy active lifestyles	B.8: Health	• National Indicator: NI 8 (Adult participation in sport) • Rank of health deprivation and disability score, by local authority

Sustainability Objectives (taken from Table E1 Annex E)	Sustainability Issues	Relevant Section of Baseline	Possible Indicator
	Community leisure and tourism developments	B.7: Leisure and Historic Environment Heritage Assets	• Approvals, completions and losses of community, major sport, leisure and tourism developments, by location (in/edge/out-of-centre, and rural), type and size • Number of overnight visitors in Gateshead and Newcastle • Number of visitors to major attractions
7a. Adapt to and mitigate against the impacts of climate change – Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Lower levels of energy efficiency and renewable energy usage have been implemented than are required to meet greenhouse gas reduction targets	B.6.5: Energy Production	• Installed capacity of renewable energy generating development by type • % of new developments above the current CSH requirement of BREEAM 'excellent' rating, or their equivalent • Capacity of decentralised heat networks, by installed capacity, and committed capacity
7b. Adapt to and mitigate against the impacts of climate change – Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Need to limit greenhouse gas contributions to climate change	B.29.1: Greenhouse Gas production and Ecological Footprinting	• National Indicator: NI186 (per capita CO₂ emissions in the local authority area)
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Adaptation to climate change (both natural and historic environment)	B.22.2: Local Biodiversity and B.27: Flooding	• Number of planning permissions granted contrary to Environment Agency advice on grounds of flood risk or water quality
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure			• Number and proportion of completed new developments which will be at risk from fluvial, tidal, surface water and sewer flooding indicated by the SFRA • Completed new developments which: - o Discharge surface water to a watercourse - o Discharge surface water to sewers and combined sewers - o Incorporate SUDS

Sustainability Objectives (taken from Table E1 Annex E)	Sustainability Issues	Relevant Section of Baseline	Possible Indicator
	Balance between development on greenfield sites and development on previously developed land (brownfield sites)	B.23: Green Space, Green Infrastructure Network and Public Realm	% of new dwelling on brownfield sites
	Lack of accessible green space and quality of open spaces	B.23: Green Space, Green Infrastructure Network and Public Realm	- Number of allotment sites and plots % residents satisfied with local parks and open spaces
	Green space valued for biodiversity	B.23: Green Space, Green Infrastructure Network and Public Realm	Changes in areas of ecological importance, comprising areas designated for their intrinsic ecological value, including sites of national, regional or local significance
	Green Belt protection	No baseline mention	- Green Belt additions and deletions - Planning applications and permissions advertised as departures from Green Belt Policies
	Need to protect and enhance local landscape and townscape character – public realm	B.30: Landscape and Cityscape	Significant buildings and housing scheme audit
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Historic environment vulnerable to inappropriate development	B.12: The Environment and Heritage Assets	- Change in the extent and quality of the historic built environment: - Number of Scheduled Monuments, Grade I, II*, II Listed Buildings, Battlefields, Historic Parks and Gardens, Conservation Areas and other heritage assets - Loss of, or addition to, heritage assets - Additions or removals from the risk register - Recorded damage to heritage assets

Sustainability Objectives (taken from Table E1 Annex E)	Sustainability Issues	Relevant Section of Baseline	Possible Indicator
	Public art and the public realm	No baseline mention	Planning approvals for schemes which include provision of public art, by location and type
Minerals and Waste			
	Amount of waste entering landfill and low levels of recycling	B.6.4: Waste and Recycling	- Amount (tonnes) of municipal waste arising, by management type, and percentage of municipal waste sent to landfill - Licensed and projected capacity of waste management facilities (existing and approved), by type
	Non-renewable mineral resources	B.6.3: Mineral Resources and Areas of Extraction	Planning applications and approvals for mineral extraction by type, projected quantity and location

7 CONSULTATION ON THE SA REPORT

The Stage 3 “Reporting” phase in the SA/SEA process, as indicated in the flow chart featured in Section 1.2 of this report, was completed with the submission of the Plan together with the SA Report for public consultation from the 9th September to 21st October 2013.

The consultation responses have been taken into account and the decision-making process on how comments have been addressed has been documented. This final version of the SA report has been amended as necessary to reflect the agreed changes.

This final version of the SA Report will be submitted to the Secretary of State with the Plan for independent examination.

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Gateshead and Newcastle Councils

Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan

Sustainability Appraisal Report Volume 2: Annexes

December 2013

Environmental Report

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Sustainability Appraisal of the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan for Gateshead and Newcastle: Environmental Report

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Sustainability Appraisal of the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan for Gateshead and Newcastle: Environmental Report

Volume 2: Annexes

For and on behalf of Natural Capital Ltd

Approved by: Dr P J Say

Signed:



Position: Director

Date: 16th December 2013

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ANNEX A

RELEVANT PLANS AND PROGRAMMES REVIEWED

A1: Introduction

This task included identifying and reviewing all relevant national, regional and local plans, programmes and strategies, filling in any gaps and updating where necessary, and undertaking an in-depth analysis of their relevance to the Core Strategy and Urban Core Action Plan (the Plan) and how they contribute to shaping and informing:

- the baseline situation;
- the sustainability objectives to be used for the appraisal;
- the sustainability issues to be considered.

The PPS review should also be helpful in the preparation of the Plan itself through its contribution to informing the:

- the sustainable development 'thrust' of the strategy;
- the development of appropriate spatial objectives;
- the framing of policies.

This Annex contains two different levels of detail in reviewing the relevant Plans, Programmes and Strategies:

- more detailed descriptions of each of the key documents reviewed and what bearing they have on the Plan and the Sustainability Appraisal; and
- A list of all the higher level international, national and local plans, programmes and strategies that provide relevant background.

Table A1: Review of Documents that have Key Interactions with Planning for the Future: Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan for Gateshead and Newcastle

DOCUMENT	KEY MESSAGE	IMPLICATIONS FOR THE SA/SEA
DCLG (2012) National Planning Policy Framework	This document is a key part of the government's reforms to make the planning system less complex and more accessible by consolidating a lot of the individual Planning Policy documents. The framework acts as guidance for local planning authorities and decision-takers, both in drawing up plans and making decisions about planning applications. At the heart of the NPPF is a presumption in favour of sustainable development and it is expected that this will be seen as a 'thread' running through the plan-making and decision making processes.	It provides a set of 12 principles that should underpin these processes that relate to issues such as social inclusion, community wellbeing, and the implications of climate change amongst others. The NPPF will play a significant role in shaping the Plan.
NewcastleGateshead 1Plan: An economic and spatial strategy for NewcastleGateshead 2010-2030 (2010)	The 1PLAN is the first economic and spatial strategy for Gateshead and Newcastle. The document has been prepared by the new city development company, 1NG, on behalf of Gateshead Council, Newcastle City Council and One NorthEast.	As the signatories to the 1PLAN, Gateshead Council, Newcastle City Council, One NorthEast and 1NG are determined that it will make a real difference to the way we do things in Gateshead and Newcastle : - the 1PLAN will play a key role in shaping the first local development framework core strategy for Gateshead and Newcastle - the 9 Key Steps will shape the operational priorities and investment programmes of the four partners
Sustaine: The Integrated Regional Framework for the North East of England (2008)	The Integrated Regional Framework (IRF) is the framework for sustainable development in the North East. It presents a shared regional vision and values, signed up to by key regional partners, which will ensure that regional strategies share a common purpose in working towards, and achieving, a more sustainable future for the region.	The creation of a sustainable way of living in the Region to benefit all. The Sustainability Appraisal has drawn on the vision and values of Sustaine in formulating the Sustainability Objectives used. The Sustainability Objectives have evolved to incorporate more subtlety and specific issues, but are founded on the Values set out in Sustaine.

DOCUMENT	KEY MESSAGE	IMPLICATIONS FOR THE SA/SEA
The North East of England Plan Regional Spatial Strategy to 2021 (2008)	The Plan sets out a broad development strategy for the region for the period up to 2021. It covers Northumberland, County Durham, Tyne and Wear and the Tees Valley and addresses matters such as the scale and distribution of provision for new housing, priorities for the environment such as countryside and biodiversity protection, transport, infrastructure, economic development, agriculture, mineral extraction and waste treatment and disposal.	Although this document was revoked in April 2013, it has been left in for reference purposes. Given that this document also acted as an overarching regional strategy it still gave a steer as to where and how new development takes place within the North East region. Its implications for the issues and objectives in this Sustainability Appraisal will need to be fully recognised. Although it will influence sustainable economic growth within the region it will also have an influence over the other three sustainable development themes so performs as a crosscutting document.
Gateshead Council (2007) Vision 2030; Gateshead's Sustainable Community Strategy	Aims to cultivate a Gateshead with the qualities of local people with high aspirations and opportunities to achieve, high rates of emotional and physical wellbeing, sustainable and thriving communities and prosperous communities with a focus on creativity and the environment.	These documents help to define the sustainability issues that will be used in the formation of the Core Strategy and AAP and the carrying out of the Sustainability Appraisal. The documents have shaped the themes which have been taken forward into the Gateshead and Newcastle bridging document.
Newcastle City Council (2010) Newcastle 2030: Taking the City Forward, Newcastle Partnership's Sustainable Community Strategy March 2010	This Sustainable Community Strategy (SCS) outlines key challenges facing the city. It sets out the vision, aims and priorities that partners will deliver together in the coming years. The SCS is not just about people resident in Newcastle now but also those who choose to come to the city to work or visit.	

DOCUMENT	KEY MESSAGE	IMPLICATIONS FOR THE SA/SEA
Gateshead/Newcastle Strategic Partnership (2010) Bridging Document Developing Sustainable Twin Cities of NewcastleGateshead 2030	The purpose of the Bridging document is to set out the main policy challenges as articulated in Gateshead and Newcastle's SCSSs, to help shape the development of the 'One Core Strategy' to 2030, ensuring that together, Gateshead and Newcastle produce an ambitious, deliverable 20 year sustainable development plan. This will enable Gateshead and Newcastle, as the urban core, to maximise its potential in creating a quality place where people choose to live, work and visit.	The 'Bridging Document' brings together the core aims of the Sustainable Community Strategies of both Gateshead and Newcastle that in turn underpin the key objectives of the One Core Strategy. These themes are: • Economic Growth and Prosperity • Health and Wellbeing • Housing and Thriving Neighbourhoods • Sustainable Quality Places (including Environmental Quality)
Gateshead Council (2007) Gateshead Housing Strategy 2007-2012	The strategy sets out the long term vision for housing up to and beyond 2012.	Housing market weakness and failure has been identified as an issue by the two councils and this document gives a steer on the amount of housing needed.
Gateshead Council (2007) Gateshead Town Centre Planning Strategy	The aim of the strategy is to create a successful, attractive and sustainable mixed-use town centre that complements the other regeneration initiatives in the area.	Ensure full coverage of objectives that are relevant to the Borough.
Gateshead Council (2011) Gateshead Local Development Framework – Consultation Towards our Core Strategy 2030	Document presenting the issues & alternatives that will guide future building and development in the area inviting community views.	This wide ranging consultation document takes into account the views of Gateshead residents and so will provide context for the baseline underpinning the SA.
Gateshead Council & Gateshead Primary Care Trust (2011) Gateshead Joint Strategic Needs Assessment	Report presenting the current and future health and well-being needs of the local population. It informs the priorities and targets set within the Gateshead Local Area Agreement.	The health and well being needs of the community are an integral component of the SA/SEA. This document provides important information that underpins the baseline as well as informing objective and issues development.
Newcastle City Council & Newcastle Primary Care Trust (2012) Newcastle Joint Strategic Needs Assessment	Report identifies the current and future health and well-being needs of the local population.	

DOCUMENT	KEY MESSAGE	IMPLICATIONS FOR THE SA/SEA
Newcastle City Council (2004) Newcastle LDF Key Issues Report	A key issues report was published to stimulate a Citywide debate on planning issues. The Key Issues Report concentrates on areas where significant changes of policy or new issues have arisen. Sustainable development is central to the document, including a recognition that new jobs need to be linked to housing, transportation, training, and regeneration strategies thus minimising their need to travel. The report stresses the need to facilitate sustainable accessible travel, providing good links between homes, work, shopping and leisure.	This wide ranging consultation document takes into account the views of Newcastle residents and so will provide context for the baseline underpinning the SA.
Newcastle City Council (2004) The Newcastle Plan 2004-2007 and Local Neighbourhood Renewal Strategy	This, the Newcastle Community Strategy, seeks to make the City safer, cleaner and 'greener', healthier, a nicer place to live, a place where people learn, are better off, good for children and young people, more creative and more accessible. The Neighbourhood Renewal Strategy seeks to narrow the inequality gaps in Newcastle; join up existing neighbourhood renewal activities and build on all the regeneration experience and expertise in the city. Targets have been agreed and progress is monitored.	The objectives and targets must be reflected in the SA and LDDs prepared.
The Environment Agency (2012) Tyne Catchment Flood Management Plan: Policies and measures for managing flood risk Ouseburn policy unit, Revision 2 January 2012	Gateshead and Newcastle have the River Tyne a major river and associated floodplain with low-lying estuarine areas, which in a number of cases have become important industrial (port and associated activities) and city/urban centres. The Environment Agency emphasises a partnership approach with the relevant authorities to ensure all future developments within the policy unit are appropriate and reduce surface water runoff, where appropriate, and delivering integrated and co-ordinated flood risk management.	The future of sites potentially at risk of flooding and the impact of climate change on tidal flooding will have an impact on how development in Gateshead and Newcastle is shaped. The Environment Agency's proposed approach has been reflected in the Plan via the incorporation of SuDS measures were possible.

DOCUMENT	KEY MESSAGE	IMPLICATIONS FOR THE SA/SEA
Gateshead City Council (2013) Level 1 and Level 2 Strategic Flood Risk Assessment and Sequential Test Report Summaries Newcastle City Council (2013) Newcastle Strategic Flood Risk Assessment Sequential Test Update	Flood risk in Gateshead and Newcastle is a complex issue and can arise from many potential sources. It is rightly a constraint to development and care is needed over the type and form of new development in high flood risk areas. Level 1 SFRA reviews currently available information on flood risk and Level 2 focuses on the avoidance and reduction of flood risk through careful planning and sustainable mitigation solutions.	The SFRA identifies areas at risk of flooding (via overtopping of existing watercourses and problems with surface water) and discusses potential flood risk management measures to explore how flood risk could be reduced or avoided through development of Gateshead and Newcastle. This policy will impact on how development in Gateshead and Newcastle is shaped.
Newcastle Gateshead (2012) Surface Water Management Programme	This plan outlines the preferred surface water management strategy to ensure that surface water does not constrain future development across Gateshead and Newcastle. The plan is in a working draft and has begun to identify areas at risk and preferred mitigation measures based on their suitability and practicality. Flood risk maps are yet to be established.	The plan identifies at risk areas and preferred flood risk measures. At this stage, the SA can acknowledge the areas identified at risk, and appraise the preferred mitigation measures posed by the Core Strategy in accordance with the SWMP. Development must ensure the detail of the SWMP is recognised as the working draft is progressed and flood risk maps established.
Durham Biodiversity Partnership (2007) Durham Biodiversity Action Plan; and Newcastle City Council (2012) Newcastle and North Tyneside Biodiversity Action Plan	The plan aims: to protect and enhance local biodiversity and to contribute to regional and national biodiversity action plans wherever possible; to work in partnership with the community and organisations involved in nature conservation to develop and implement the plan, and; to raise awareness of nature conservation and to encourage wider participation in the project.	Biodiversity action plans and progress in the delivery of habitat and species plan targets, provide indications on the state of the natural environment and also how well the green infrastructure is performing in its support of wildlife. These two documents provide background information on biodiversity protection in the two council areas.

DOCUMENT	KEY MESSAGE	IMPLICATIONS FOR THE SA/SEA
The Environment Agency (2005) The Tyne Catchment Abstraction Management Strategy	The Tyne CAMS area encompasses approximately 2,993km ² . It includes the city of Newcastle upon Tyne and the smaller towns of Alston, Bellingham, Haltwhistle and Hexham. The area includes the catchments of the Rivers Tyne, Derwent, Rede, Allens and Team.	The Catchment Abstraction Management Strategies (CAMS) are six-year plans detailing how EA are going to manage water resources in the area. The ability of the catchment to provide a sustainable supply of water to Gateshead and Newcastle is governed by the pace of development and the type of industry that the Gateshead and Newcastle plan to pursue in the future. Decisions in the Plan must therefore bear in mind the capacity of the water resource to meet demand.
Gateshead Council (2013) Contaminated Land Strategy; and Newcastle City Council (2006) Inspection Strategy for Contaminated Land.	To comply with the UK regulations the Council had to produce this strategy fulfilling the following duties: • Prepare a written strategy for the inspection of land in the borough by July 2001 • Develop procedures for implementing the regulations • Establish a database • Determine the priority of sites to be investigated • Carry out a survey of the borough	Derelict and contaminated land (commonly referred to as brownfield sites) historically has been a key issue for the industrialised and urban areas of the North East including Gateshead and Newcastle. Substantial pockets of derelict land have existed in the industrial areas in the near vicinity of the key centres of population as a result of former coal mining, coking and tar works, iron works and steel making, ship building and chemical manufacturing industries. The redevelopment of such areas poses significant challenges.
Gateshead Council (2006) Gateshead Draft Open Spaces Strategy	Strategy for the promotion, protection and enhancement of open space within Gateshead	Provision of open space should be considered as part of sustainable development of the borough
Newcastle City Council (2004) Green Spaces...Your Spaces - Newcastle's Parks and Green Space Strategy	Aims to involve the local community in their green spaces, encouraging them to be involved in their management, have ownership and responsibility for the spaces and act in partnership to get funding to improve them. Overall the green spaces need to be safe, easy to access, attractive and of high quality, providing people with the facilities they need.	The aims and objectives should be reflected in the SA and LDF and contribute to the outcomes sought by the strategy

DOCUMENT	KEY MESSAGE	IMPLICATIONS FOR THE SA/SEA
English Heritage, CABI, Newcastle City Council and Gateshead Council (2003) Urban Landscape Study of the Tyne Gorge	Landscape study of the Tyne Gorge area looking at geographical, historical, visual nature of the gorge and identifying threats and opportunities along with recommendations on protecting the Gorge area.	The landscape character and historic environment of the Gorge should be safeguarded.
Gateshead Strategic Partnership (2010) Climate Change Strategy Document 2010	This strategy helps outline how Gateshead City Council is addressing the huge challenge of climate change. It is designed to be of interest to all staff, officers, councillors, residents, as well as business, the community and voluntary sectors and generally any stakeholder with an interest in the future well-being of the conurbation.	Climate change impacts on the community, historic and natural environment must feature within the SA/SEA
Gateshead Strategic Partnership (2007) Climate Change – We Need to Talk About It	Discussion report aiming to promote the potential impacts of climate change for the community and engender a unified understanding and drive to tackle the potential impacts of climate change.	Climate change impacts on the community, historic and natural environment must feature within the SA/SEA
Newcastle City Council (2008) Climate Change Strategy and Action Plan	This strategy helps outline how Newcastle City Council is addressing the huge challenge of climate change. It is designed to be of interest to all staff, officers, councillors, residents, as well as business, the community and voluntary sectors and generally any stakeholder with an interest in the future well-being of Newcastle upon Tyne.	Climate change impacts on the community, historic and natural environment must feature within the SA/SEA
Gateshead Council (2007) Gateshead Housing Strategy 2007-2012	The strategy sets out the long term vision for housing up to and beyond 2012.	Develop objectives related to housing provision
Newcastle City Council (2006) Newcastle City Housing Strategy and updated in Newcastle City Council (2010) Refresh 2010-2012	Sets out the vision for housing development up to 2012 and beyond for Newcastle City Council. Revises housing numbers in light of adverse global economic conditions.	Develop objectives related to housing provision
Newcastle City Council (2012) The Fairer Housing Delivery Plan	Identifies that families cannot find affordable accommodation. Lack of mid-market family houses. Brownfield sites to be prioritised for housing development. Further accommodation for older people and the disabled is needed.	Helps ensure the Plan and SA objectives sufficiently address the highlighted issues.

DOCUMENT	KEY MESSAGE	IMPLICATIONS FOR THE SA/SEA
Newcastle City Council (2005) Environment, Sustainability and Transport: Newcastle's Environmental portfolio	Assesses whether targets for environment, sustainability and transport indicators to be reached by 2005 have been met, or exceeded and sets yearly targets to 2008.	Plan should help to achieve these targets.
Integrated Transport Authority (2011) Tyne and Wear Local Transport Plan 3 (LTP3) Tyne & Wear 2011-2021	The agreed transport policy priorities are: economic regeneration, greater economic competitiveness and prosperity; reducing inequality, improving social inclusion and community cohesion; stabilising population and reducing out-migration; better environmental quality, sustainability and quality of life; improving participation and attainment in education; and, improving health standards and reducing premature deaths.	Need to ensure that the SA and plan objectives acknowledge transport issues, and associated socio-economic factors including access to jobs and high quality services such as schools and health facilities.
Newcastle City Council (2005) Newcastle Waste Management Strategy and Action Plan	The strategy sets out the short, medium and long-term challenges facing the authority in how it collects and manages the City's municipal waste. It identifies key targets to meet these challenges which form the Action Plan. All new development must contribute to targets of the NBAP and biodiversity must be incorporated into all planning proposals.	The plan should provide ongoing protection for areas of nature conservation recognised in the NBAP. Where development is proposed near nature conservation areas, the impact upon the area should be mitigated and the nature of the conservation value of the site enhanced.
South Tyne & Wear Waste Management Partnership (2007) Joint Municipal Waste Management Strategy	The South Tyne and Wear Waste Management Partnership (STWWMP) is collaboration between Gateshead MBC, South Tyneside MBC and Sunderland CC. The strategy sets out the objectives and targets that the STWWMP will aspire to over the 20 year strategy period (2007-2027). The strategy sets out a number of objectives with regard to: Prioritising waste management; Making decisions about how waste is managed; Reducing waste; Recycling and composting; Disposal / treatment	Ensure full coverage of objectives that are relevant to the Borough

DOCUMENT	KEY MESSAGE	IMPLICATIONS FOR THE SA/SEA
	of waste; Provision of services; and Monitoring and review of the strategy; The strategy also sets targets with regard to recycling and composting, waste recovery and landfilling of wastes	
Newcastle City Council (2008) Safe Newcastle Strategy 2008-2011	A three year strategy to make Newcastle a safer place for those who live, work and visit the city by reducing crime, anti-social behaviour, alcohol misuse and the supply and use of drugs in the city.	Consider strategy objectives during the preparation of the LDF.
Safer Gateshead (2009) Safer Gateshead Partnership Plan	Plan aiming to improve community safety in Gateshead	Ensure community safety is considered in the SA/SEA
Planning Policy Statement 5: Planning for the Historic Environment (PPS5) (DCLG, 2010)	Local development frameworks (LDF) should set out a positive, proactive strategy for the conservation and enjoyment of the historic environment in their area, taking into account the variations in type and distribution of heritage asset, as well as the contribution made by the historic environment.	The Core Strategy and the AAP for the Urban Core Area must therefore respond to the local historic environment in such a way as to preserve and enhance it
North East Regional Information Partnership (2006) State of the North East Region	Provides a review of North East England. Broadly following the three themes of Business, People and Place, it compares the region with the other regions and nations against a wide range of indicators from the economic, social and environmental domains. It also shows how the region has changed in recent years by analysing statistical trends.	Provides useful background baseline data for the SA/SEA of the Core Strategy and AAP
Newcastle City Council (2006) City Centre Area Action Plan: Key Issues and Development of Options	Previously progressed Area Action Plan for Newcastle City Centre.	Identifies a number of key issues for the Newcastle component of the new Urban Core Area.
Gateshead Council (2007) Gateshead Town Centre Planning Strategy	Previously progressed Town Centre Planning Strategy for Gateshead.	Identifies a number of key issues and required actions for the Gateshead component of the new Urban Core Area.

Relevant Plans, Programmes and Strategies Reviewed

These all have a bearing and further help to shape the Plan.

Table A2: International

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Social	
UN-DESA (2012) Back to Our Common Future – Sustainable Development in the 21 st Century (SD21) Project Summary for Policy Makers	Outlines progress and current situation of sustainable development in the world and suggests ways for improvements at a global scale
Johannesburg Declaration on Sustainable Development (United Nations 2002)	Institutionalised framework for sustainable development
Aarhus Convention - Convention to Access to Information, Public Participation in Decision making and Access to Justice in Environmental Matters (UNECE 2001)	Enhance public participation in every sector of decision making
WHO Health 21 (1998)	To promote and protect people's health throughout their lives
Environmental	
European Directive 2000/60/EC Water Framework (EC 2000)	Prevent deterioration in and protect the status of surface water and groundwater bodies
European Landscape Convention (COE 2000)	Conserve landscape
A/RES/42/187 Report of the World Commission on Environment and Development (United Nations 1987)	Protect the environment
Kyoto Protocol (United Nations 1997)	Reduce CO ₂ by meeting objectives at international and domestic levels.
European Directive 79/409/EEC 1979 on the Conservation of Wild Birds (EEC 1979)	To protect all wild birds, nests, eggs and habitats within the EC
The Habitats Directive (Directive 92/43/EEC) (1992)	To protect natural habitats and other species of wild plants and animals

Table A3: National

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Overarching	
DEFRA (2013) Sustainable Development Indicators July 2013	Revised set of indicators to help with monitoring the progress of mainstreaming sustainability efforts at a national level

Document	Key Themes and Influences
DCLG (2012) National Planning Policy Framework	The framework acts as guidance for local planning authorities and decision-takers. At the heart of this document is a presumption in favour of sustainable development and it is expected that this will be seen as a 'thread' running through the plan-making and decision making processes. This document consolidates a lot of the individual Planning Policy documents, which have been left in below for reference purposes.
Building a Greener Future: Policy Statement (DCLG 2007)	Outlines policy on moving towards zero carbon development
Local Development Frameworks – guidance on Sustainability Appraisal (Planning Advisory Service 2007)	To support councils undertaking a sustainability appraisal (SA) of their development plan documents
Planning for a Sustainable Future: White Paper (May 2007)	Sets out detailed proposals for reform of the planning system to make it speedier, more responsive and inclusive
Planning Policy Statement 1: Delivering Sustainable Development (ODPM 2005)	Overarching planning policies on the delivery of sustainable development through the planning system
Securing the Future - UK Government sustainable development strategy (2005)	Sets out the Government's overarching objectives for sustainable development in the UK
The Future of Transport White Paper (2004)	To promote and actively encourage sustainable transport
Planning Policy Statement 12: Local Development Frameworks (2004)	Effective local development frameworks
Economic	
Planning Policy Statement 4: Planning for Sustainable Economic Growth (PPS4) (2009)	Policy framework for planning for sustainable economic development in urban and rural areas
Good Practice Guide on Planning for Tourism (DCLG 2006)	Ensure that planners understand the importance of tourism when preparing development plans and taking planning decisions
Social	
Circular 1/94: Gypsy Sites and Planning (ODPM1994)	Provide for Gypsy sites in planning
UK Fuel Poverty Strategy (DTI 2001)	Set in place a framework to ensure that the number of households in the UK in fuel poverty is consistently reduced to a target of zero

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Planning Policy Statement 3: Housing (PPS3) 2006	Sets out Government's goal to ensure that everyone has the opportunity to live in a decent home, which they can afford in a community where they want to live
Homes for the future: more affordable, more sustainable – Housing Green Paper (DCLG 2007)	Increase the supply of housing, to provide well designed and greener homes that are supported by infrastructure
Home Energy Conservation Act (HECA) (HMSO 1995)	Make provision for the drawing up of local energy conservation reports in relation to residential accommodation
Draft Guidance on Health in strategic Environmental Assessment, Consultation Document (Department of Health 2007)	Step-by-step guide to the incorporation of health impact assessment into Sustainability Appraisal and spatial planning as a whole
Environmental	
Air Quality Strategy for the UK (2007)	Sets out a way forward for work and planning on air quality issues
UK Biodiversity Action Plan (BAP) (DEFRA 1994)	Establishes a series of 78 species and 10 habitat action plans and recovery targets for the most threatened farmland species and habitats
Working with the Grain of Nature: A Biodiversity Strategy for England (DEFRA 2002)	Provides further detail on how the UKBAP priorities can be achieved and how biodiversity should be included in development
Guidance for Local Authorities on Implementing the Biodiversity Duty (DEFRA 2007)	Guidance on effective implementation of the biodiversity duty
DEFRA (2011) Biodiversity 2020: A strategy for England's wildlife and ecosystem services	Sets out long term high-level strategies for reducing environmental pressures, improving data gathering and monitoring and delivering a more integrated landscape scale approach to land and sea conservation
The Conservation of Habitats and Species Legislation (as amended) 2010	UK legislation covering the conservation of natural habitats and of wild fauna and flora
Wildlife and Countryside Act (as amended) 1981	Act to prohibit certain methods of killing or taking wild animals
Planning Policy Guidance 2: Green Belts (2001)	The safeguarding of green belts
Planning Policy Statement 9: Biodiversity and Geological Conservation (2005)	The protection of biodiversity and geological conservation through the planning system
...and accompanying Circular 06/05: Biodiversity and Geological Conservation - Statutory Obligations and Their Impact Within The Planning System (ODPM 2005)	

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Government Circular: Biodiversity and Geological Conservation – statutory obligations and their impact within the planning system ODPM 06/2005	Guidance on the application of the law relating to planning and nature conservation as it applies in England
Planning for Biodiversity and Geological Conservation: A Guide to Good Practice ODPM 2006	It provides good practice guidance on the delivery of the national policies in PPS9
Countryside and Rights of Way Act 2000 OPDM	An Act to make new provision for public access to the countryside
Green Belts a Greener Future (Natural England 2010)	The current and new evidence and ideas to inform the ongoing debate on the future of land designated as Green Belt in England
No charge? Valuing the Natural Environment (Natural England 2009)	The benefits of a healthy natural environment
Natural England Green Infrastructure Guidance (Natural England 2009)	Promote green infrastructure strategic planning and delivery, understand its relation to Natural England's wide remit and its strategic objectives
'Nature Nearby' Accessible Natural Greenspace Guidance (Natural England 2010)	Ensure access to greenspace
England's Peatlands: Carbon Storage and Greenhouse Gases (Natural England 2010)	Safeguard English Peatlands
ODPM (2009) Marine and Coastal Access Act 2009	An Act to make provision in relation to marine functions and activities
Minerals Policy Statement 1: Planning and Minerals (2006) Also published with MPS1 is a Practice Guide, which sets out how the policies in the statement might best be implemented.	Ensures the need by society and the economy for minerals is managed in an integrated way against its impact on the environment and communities
Minerals Planning Guidance 3 (MPG3) Coal Mining and Colliery Spoil Disposal (ODPM 1999)	Ensure that the extraction of coal and disposal of colliery spoil only takes place at the best balance of community, social, environmental and economic interests
Landscape Character and Assessment Guidance for England and Scotland, Countryside Agency and Scottish Natural Heritage (2002)	Guidance on how to identify and express the different elements of landscape which give a place its unique character
Landscape Character Network (Natural England 2010)	Promote Landscape Character Assessment as a tool for understanding and managing all landscapes

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Planning Policy Statement 7 (PPS7) (DCLG 2007)	Planning policies for rural areas, including country towns and villages and the wider, largely undeveloped countryside up to the fringes of larger urban areas
The Rural Strategy (DEFRA 2004)	Sets out the Government's approach to policy delivery in rural areas
Natural Environment and Rural Communities Act 2006 (ODPM)	Act to make provision the natural environment and rural communities, make provision in connection with wildlife and sites and rights of way
Energy White Paper - Our Energy Future - Creating a Low Carbon Economy (DTI 2003)	This white paper sets out a strategy for the long term reduction in CO ₂ in industry and domestically
Environmental Quality in Spatial Planning (English Heritage 2005)	Consider environment in spatial planning
Valuing Places: Good Practice In Conservation Areas (English Heritage 2010)	Constructive conservation best practice examples
The Nottingham Declaration on Climate Change (DETR 2000)	Preparation for climate change impacts
UK Programme for Climate Change (DETR 2000)	Preparation to address the potential climate change impacts
Conserving Biodiversity in a Changing Climate: Guidance on Building Capacity to Adapt (DEFRA 2007)	Current thinking on how to reduce the impacts of climate change on biodiversity and to adapt existing plans and projects to climate change
Climate change and biodiversity adaptation: the role of the spatial planning system. (TYLDESLEY. D. 2009, Natural England Commissioned Report)	The context for Natural England's engagement with climate change and the opportunities for biodiversity adaptation through spatial planning
Planning Policy Statement: Planning and Climate Change (Supplement to PPS1) (DCLG 2007)	Ensure that the plan process takes into account potential climate change impacts
Water Resources for the Future: A Strategy for England and Wales (2001)	Conserve water resources in England Wales for future generations
Waste Strategy for England and Wales (DEFRA 2000)	Minimise waste in England and Wales so to reduce the negative environmental impacts
Planning Policy Statement 10: Planning for Sustainable Waste Management (DCLG 2005)	Sets out the Government's policy to be taken into account by waste planning authorities
PPG13 Transport (DETR 2001)	Sets out the objectives to integrate planning and transport at the national, regional, strategic and local level

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Planning Policy Guidance 14: Development on Unstable Land (1990)	Sets out the broad planning and technical issues to be addressed in respect of development on unstable land
Planning Policy Statement 5: Planning for the Historic Environment (PPS5) (DCLG 2010)	Sets out the Government's planning policies on the conservation of the historic environment. Makes clear that documents within the LDF should set out a positive, proactive strategy for the conservation and enjoyment of the historic environment in their area
The Historic Environment: A Force for Our Future (DCMS 2001)	Conserve the historic environment for future generations
Heritage Counts (English Heritage 2010)	Provides wider social and economic role of heritage and assesses the state of the historic environment
Heritage at Risk Register (English Heritage 2010)	Identifies England's historic assets that are at risk of loss through neglect, decay, or development, or are vulnerable to becoming so
Climate Change and the Historic Environment (English Heritage 2009)	Discusses the implications of climate change for the historic environment, sets out key impacts, discusses importance of understanding mitigation and adaptation
Planning Policy Guidance 17 (PPG17) Planning for Open Space, Sport and Recreation (ODPM 2002)	Sets out the policies needed to be taken into account by regional planning bodies in the preparation of Regional Planning Guidance
Planning Policy Guidance 20: Coastal Planning (1992)	Covers the character of the coast, designated areas, heritage coasts and the international dimension
Planning Policy Statement 25 Supplement: Development and Coastal Change (DCLG 2010)	Replaces the policy on managing the impacts of coastal erosion to development set out in PPG20
Planning Policy Statement 25 (PPS25) Development and Flood Risk (DCLG 2001)	Aims are to ensure that flood risk is taken into account at all stages in the planning process
Planning Policy Statement 25: Development and Flood Risk - Practice Guide (2009)	Provides guidelines on how to implement development and flood risk policies by the land use planning system
Planning Policy Statement 22: Renewable Energy (DCLG 2004)	Sets out the Government's policies for renewable energy, which planning authorities should have regard to when preparing local development documents and when taking planning decisions

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Planning Policy Statement 23: Planning and Pollution Control (DCLG 2004)	Complements the pollution control framework under the Pollution Prevention and Control Act 1999 and the PPC Regulations 2000
Planning Policy Guidance 24 (PPG24) Planning and Noise (DOE 1994)	Guides local authorities in England on the use of their planning powers to minimise the adverse impact of noise
Sustainability Appraisal of Regional Spatial Strategies and Local development Documents (ODPM 2005)	Guidance on how to carry out a sustainability appraisal for regional spatial strategy revisions and local development frameworks

Table A.4: Regional

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Economic	
Integrated Transport Authority (2011) Tyne and Wear Local Transport Plan 3 (LTP3) Tyne & Wear 2011-2021	Contains plans relevant to transportation and transport development in the Tyne and Wear area
Tyne and Wear Rights of Way Improvement Plan 2007/11	Statement of the actions proposed for the management of local Rights of Way, and for securing an improved network of local Rights of Way
Building a Healthy and Productive Labour Market: The framework for Regional Employment and Skills Action (FRESA) in the NE (FRESA NE 2002)	Enhance job market and build on existing training
Building in Sustainability: A Guide to Sustainable Construction and Development in the North East. (Sustaine 2003)	Ensure construction is sustainable in the North East
North East Tourism Strategy 2005-2010 (ONE NE and NE Tourism Board 2004)	Promote tourism to the benefit of the north east economy
North East of England Regional Spatial Strategy (GONE 2008)	Effective spatial planning for the North East area
North East Regional Information Partnership (2006) State of the North East Region	Provides a review of North East England. Broadly following the three themes of Business, People and Place
The Integrated Regional Framework for the North East: Achieving a better Quality of Life. (Sustaine 2004)	Improving quality of life for all: Part 1 - Setting the Scene, Part 2 - First annual monitoring report, Part 3 - Integrated Regional Matrix
Here Today Here Tomorrow' Gateshead's Local Agenda 21 Strategy (2001)	Ensure sustainable development of the region
Moving Forward - The Northern Way First strategy report (The Northern Way Steering Group 2004)	A 20 year strategy to transform the economy of the north of England

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Social	
Building Bridges Newcastle Gateshead Cultural Strategy 2002-2012 (NCC & Gateshead Council 2002)	Promote the unique and diverse culture of Newcastle and Gateshead
A New Housing Strategy for the North East, July (2005)	Sets out targets and guidelines for housing provision in the North East
North East Sports Strategy 2001-2006 (NorthEast Sport 2001)	Promote sport and healthy lifestyles in the North East area
Turning Ambition into Reality - The North East Regional Plan for Sport and Physical Activity 2004-2008 (Sport England 2004)	The promotion of sports and healthy lifestyles
Environment	
Regional Forestry Strategy - Trees, Woodlands, Forests...and People (NEFAG 2005)	Protection of trees and wooded areas for environmental as well as social benefit
Natural Commitment: Working together for wildlife in the North East. (English Nature/GONE 2003)	Wildlife protection in the North East area
North East Climate Change Adaptation Study (Sustaine 2008)	Study into the preparation needed for climate change impacts
North East Climate Change Adaptation Plan (Sustaine 2008)	The Climate Change Action Plan for North East England recommends what is needed to do to tackle climate change in North East England
North East Climate Change Action Plan (Sustaine 2008)	Actions to tackle climate change in North East England
North East Strategy for the Environment (consultation draft) (NEA 2007)	Environmental protection and enhancement in the north east region
Countryside Character Vol 1: North East Countryside Agency (now Natural England)	Describes the landscape character of the North East of England
Countryside Character Volume 1: North East (Natural England 2005)	Highlights the influences which determine the character of the landscape in the different National Character Areas
A Biodiversity Audit of the North East (Biodiversity Forum 2001)	Provides an overview and detailed statistics on the regions biodiversity
Biodiversity Indicators and Targets for the NE of England (North East Biodiversity Forum 2004)	Protect biodiversity through the use of indicators and targets in the North East of England
A Biodiversity Audit of the North East (North East Biodiversity Forum 2001)	This audit provides information on those species and habitats which occur within the North East Region that are regionally, nationally or internationally important

Document	Key Themes and Influences
State of the Natural Environment (2008, North East Region – Natural England)	The report brings together a selection of evidence about the natural environment in the North East including the most important issues
'State of the Environment Report for the North East of England', commissioned by ONE North East working with regional Partners (2004)	Reporting the environmental conditions in the North East
'Natural Commitment: Working together for wildlife in the North East', EN & GONE (2003)	Protect the Wildlife in the North East
Northumberland National Park Management Plan 2009-2014 (Northumberland National Park 2009)	Management plan for the protection of the Northumberland National Park environment
North Pennines AONB Management Plan 2009-2014 (North Pennines AONB 2009)	Management plan for the protection of the North Pennines AONB environment
Action for Change, Strategy for Sustainable farming and food in the NE Region (GONE 2003)	Sustainable farming and food production in North East England
And the Weather Today is...The Regional Climate Change Impact Study (Sustaine 2002)	Prepare for climate change and addressing the potential impacts
Impacts of Climate Change in the North East (Friends of the Earth 2004)	Prepare for climate change impacts in the North East
North East Renewable Energy Strategy (RANE 2005)	Improve renewable energy provision in the North East region
Towards a Waste Management Strategy for the North East (NEA 2003)	Improve waste management
Tyne and Wear Rights of Way Improvement Plan 2007/11 (LTP Tyne and Wear 2007)	Plan for improving the network of public rights of way across Tyne and Wear
Tyne Gorge Study Interim Policy Advice 4 (Gateshead Council 2006)	Protect the landscape and historic character of the Tyne Gorge
Yorkshire and North East Region, Catchment Abstraction Management Plan (Environment Agency 2008)	Set out the management for the water resources of a catchment and contribute to implementing the Water Framework Directive
Water for Life and Livelihoods, River Basin Management Plan Northumbria River Basin District (Environment Agency 2009)	The plan is about the pressures facing the water environment in the Northumbria River Basin District, and the actions that will address them
Duties on relevant authorities to have regard to the purposes of National Parks, Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty (AONBs) and the Norfolk and Suffolk Broads (DEFRA 2005)	Guidance to clarify the duties on authorities with relation to protected areas

Table A.5: Local

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Economic	
Gateshead International Strategy 2010-2013 (Gateshead Strategic Partnership 2010)	Development at international level for Gateshead
Gateshead Local Agenda 21 Strategy – 'Here Today, Here Tomorrow' (2007)	Sets a framework for integrating the principles of sustainable development into the day to day working of the Council
Gateshead Sustainable Modes of School Travel Strategy (August 2008)	Sustainable transport to schools in the region
Gateshead Cultural Strategy 2005-2010 – 'Spreading Our Wings' (Gateshead Strategic Partnership 2005)	Cultural development in the Gateshead region
Park and Ride Strategy (Nexus 2004)	Provision of park and ride facilities
Gateshead Draft Parking Strategy (Gateshead City Council 2007)	Ensure that there is adequate parking provision in Gateshead
Newcastle Best Value Performance Plan/Corporate Plan 2005-2006 (Newcastle City Council 2005)	Enhancing corporate performance for Newcastle City Council
The Corporate Asset Strategy and Management Plan 2012 -2015 (Gateshead City Council 2012)	Lays out Gateshead council's priorities and action to achieve Vision 2030
Gateshead Cultural Strategy Action Plan 2005-2007 (Gateshead City Council 2005)	Focuses on growing cultural life of the area and integrating the communities that make up Gateshead
'Fit for a City' – Gateshead Centre Regeneration Delivery Strategy (December 2008)	City centre regeneration strategy
Gateshead Council Retail Centres Health Checks, February 2010	Retail development for Gateshead Council
Newcastle City Wide Retail and Leisure Study (NCC / GVA Grimley 2005)	Promote retail and leisure in Newcastle
Newcastle City Council Retail Centres Health Checks, February 2010	Assesses the current vitality and viability of retail development centres
East Pilgrim Street Interim Planning Guidance, prepared by Newcastle City Council, July 2009	Regeneration and retail development
GVA Grimley (2007) Newcastle City Centre Baseline Retail Study July 2007	Background on retail development, assessing vitality and viability
Newcastle Centre Future Retail Capacity Forecasts, prepared by Donaldsons, October 2007	Retail development projections
Social	
Newcastle City Council (2013) Newcastle Statement of Community Involvement	Increase community involvement in decision making

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Newcastle City Council (2002) Community Participation Plan	Increase community participation within the decision making process
Community Safety Unit (2009) Safe Newcastle	Improving community safety within Newcastle
Newcastle City Council (2008) Safe Newcastle Strategy 2008-2011	Gives the strategic background and context for future work, outlines the actions the partnership will undertake and the targets to achieve
Newcastle City Council (2004) Housing Market Renewal Pathfinder	Long-term initiative aimed at tackling the most acute problems of low demand housing
Newcastle City Housing Strategy (Newcastle City Council 2006)	Framework for housing activity in the City
Gateshead Council's Housing Strategy for Older People 2007-2012 (Gateshead City Council 2007)	Strategy to ensure adequate housing provision for older people
Gateshead Council's Housing Area Profiles 2007 (Gateshead City Council 2007)	Profiles housing areas in Gateshead
Newcastle City Council (2012) The Fairer Housing Delivery Plan	Identifies and prioritises current housing-type needs in Newcastle
Newcastle City Council (1998) Newcastle UDP	Former document to guide land use in Newcastle
Northumbria University (2008) Equality and Diversity in the North East, A Statistical Profile	Presenting statistical figures for the equality and diversity of the north East
Newcastle City Council (2002) Newcastle upon Tyne Playing Pitch Strategy: A study of Playing Pitch Needs 2002-2011	Sports pitch provision and assessment of needs
Gateshead Play Strategy 2007-2010 (Gateshead City Council 2007)	Summarises the key objectives to achieve, bringing together children, families, professionals and communities
Gateshead Cycling Strategy (Gateshead City Council 2003)	Ensure that Gateshead accommodates cycling interests and promotes this mode of transport
Gateshead Social Care & Involvement Strategy (Gateshead City Council 2005)	This strategy aims to build on our previous work and to help to develop a more consistent approach to continuing involvement

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Gateshead Strategy for Special Education Needs Inclusion – Raising Standards for all Children 2004-2008 (Gateshead City Council 2004)	Social inclusion for special education
Safer Gateshead Partnership Plan (Safer Gateshead 2009)	Gateshead Council is working in partnership with the police and a number of other agencies to improve the local area
Gateshead Community Cohesion Strategy 2008-2011 (Gateshead Strategic Partnership 2008)	To improve community cohesion in Gateshead
Gateshead Equality Strategy 2006-2010 (Gateshead City Council 2006)	Community equality for priority groups in Gateshead
Gateshead Domestic Violence Strategy 2005-2008 (Gateshead City Council 2005)	Reducing and targeting against domestic violence in Gateshead
Gateshead Fuel Poverty Strategy 2001-02 (Gateshead City Council 2001)	Tackling the issue of fuel poverty so that individuals at risk can be aided
Gateshead Fuel Poverty Strategy addendum to Local Agenda 21 Strategy for Gateshead 2004 (Gateshead City Council 2004)	Addendum to the above strategy tackling fuel poverty
Gateshead Homelessness Strategy 2008-2013 (Gateshead City Council 2008)	Reducing homelessness issues within the community of Gateshead
Gateshead Homelessness Strategy Action Plan Update May 2007 (Gateshead City Council 2007)	Action Plan for the above strategy for reducing homelessness issues
Frontiers of the Roman Empire World Heritage Site Hadrian's Wall Management Plan 2008-2014 (UNESCO 2008)	Conserve and promote the world heritage site
Environmental	
Green Spaces...Your Spaces - Newcastle's Parks and Green Space Strategy (Newcastle City Council 2004)	Greenspace protection and provision within Newcastle
Our Countryside: Gateshead Countryside Strategy (Gateshead City Council 2003)	Protection of the countryside around Gateshead
Newcastle City Council (2001) Your Wildlife: The Newcastle Biodiversity Action Plan	Biodiversity conservation in Newcastle protecting habitats and specific species
Newcastle City Council (2002) Trees Newcastle - Tree Strategy for Newcastle upon Tyne	Conservation of trees within the Newcastle area for the community
Newcastle City Council Energy Centre (2005) Affordable Warmth in Newcastle: Accelerating to 2008 - Strategy and Action Plan	Improve energy efficiency and tackling issues of fuel poverty
Newcastle City Council (2005) Newcastle City Council Energy Strategy	Energy conservation for the future conditions of Newcastle
Newcastle City Council PHEP (2005) Air Quality Progress Report 2005	Measuring air quality within Newcastle

Document	Key Themes and Influences
Newcastle City Council Air Quality Research Group (2005) Draft Air Quality Plan for Newcastle City Centre AQMA	Improving air quality within designated AQMA sites in Newcastle
Newcastle City Council (2002) Carbon Neutral Strategy	Reduce carbon emissions so that the city can aim to become carbon neutral
Newcastle City Council (2001) Newcastle Charter for the Environment	Protect the Newcastle environment
Gateshead Assessment of Open Space provision (prepared by White Young Green 2006)	Analysis of the levels of provision of open space within the Gateshead area
Gateshead council (2006) Gateshead Draft Open Spaces Strategy	Open space provision and protection strategy
Newcastle City Council (2005) Newcastle Waste Management Strategy and Action Plan	Sustainable waste management within Newcastle and the specific actions to achieve this
South Tyne & Wear Waste Management Partnership (2007) Joint Municipal Waste Management Strategy	Sustainable waste management in South Tyne & Wear
Gateshead Council (2013) Gateshead Contaminated Land Strategy	The reclamation and remediation of contaminated land within Gateshead
Newcastle City Council (2006) Inspection Strategy for Contaminated Land	Sets out how the Authority will take a "strategic" approach to the inspection of its area and reviews the previous inspection strategy
Newcastle Partnership (2010) Citywide Climate Change Strategy and Action Plan 2010-2020	Document demonstrating how Newcastle is addressing the huge issue of climate change
Gateshead Strategic Partnership (2007) Climate Change – We Need to Talk About It	Preparation for the effects of climate change encouraging dialogue and preparation for the impacts
Gateshead Strategic Partnership (2010) Gateshead Climate Change Strategy	Strategy demonstrating how Gateshead are preparing for the impacts of Climate Change
Gateshead Strategic Partnership (2009) Climate Change Discussion Document	Discussion document on Gateshead's preparation for the impacts of climate change

ANNEX B

CORE STRATEGY AND URBAN CORE PLAN – BASELINE CONDITIONS

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B.1 INTRODUCTION

This baseline will seek to give an overview of the Gateshead and Newcastle area, using information gathered from the individual authorities as well as national statistics. The baseline will be presented under the broad headings of:

- Economic Growth and Prosperity
- Health and Wellbeing
- Housing and Thriving Neighbourhoods
- Sustainable Quality of Place (including Environmental Quality)

The information contained within this baseline represents a 'snapshot' of Gateshead and Newcastle and is intended to perform the specific function of providing enough information to base an assessment of the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan (the Plan) upon. The current baseline represents the policy development process for the period 2008-2013. Given the constantly iterative procedure of data gathering and policy development this baseline will have to be updated on an ongoing basis.

For more information on the wider regional context, this baseline should be read alongside the North East Regional Information Partnership's (which no longer exists) 2008 State of the Region report¹.

¹ This report can be accessed by visiting: <http://www.nerip.com/library/view.aspx?id=564> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

ECONOMIC GROWTH AND PROSPERITY

The following section covers the economic growth and prosperity of the Plan Area looking specifically at Economy, Retail, Employment and Material Assets:

B.2 REGIONAL OVERVIEW

Sited within the North East region Gateshead and Newcastle are closely interconnected with the overall economic context of the larger area.

The North East region contributed 3% of UK gross value added (GVA) in 2007 – a key measure of the economic performance of a region. The region had the lowest working-age employment rate in England, at 67.7% in May to July 2009. The region's unemployment rate (for those aged 16 plus), 9.4%, was the second highest of the English regions and had increased significantly since the start of the recent economic downturn, reaching a level last seen in 1999.

The North East had the highest rate of economic inactivity of the English regions, 25% of the working-age population in May to July 2009.

GVA per head in the North East at £15,700 was the lowest among the nine English regions in 2007, 21% below that of the UK. Gross disposable household income (GDHI) per head at £12,200 was also the lowest and 15% below the UK average. Within the North East, GDHI per head, expressed as a percentage of the UK, ranged from 99% in Northumberland to 80% in Sunderland.

Although at a low level compared with other regions, the North East's exports expressed as a percentage of GVA were the highest of all English regions at 24% in 2007, compared with the UK average of 18%².

After a recession during 2009, the North East economy is expected to be in recovery in 2010/11. But while this means the worst impacts of the global downturn may be over, significant challenges will remain for the business community. The recovery could be long and slow³. These economic impacts will have a bearing on social issues such as worklessness and economic inactivity. This assertion is borne out by the recent closure of Corus Teesside Cast Products in the Tees Valley and subsequent loss of 1,600 jobs in the region. An estimated 1,000 more sub-contractors will be directly affected, with an estimated 8,000 people further down the supply chain also at risk of losing business or their livelihoods.

Further regional economic and material assets information can be found in "Equality and Diversity in the North East: a Statistical Profile"⁴.

B.3 ECONOMY

Newcastle City Centre acts as the single largest economic driver and concentration in the region and is consequently the major source of employment in the area. Employment in the City is dominated by those working in Consumer Services (retailing, hotel, catering) Business Services (finance, insurance) and the Public Sector. The city centre provides over 60,000 jobs, offers excellent shopping

² Office for National Statistics (2009) North East Regional Profile: Economy

³ North East Chamber of Commerce (2010) Delivering the recovery, the North East Chamber of Commerce's Manifesto 2010

⁴ North East Equality and Diversity Partnership (2008) Equality and Diversity in the North East: a Statistical Profile

and leisure opportunities and is the hub of the major transport networks⁵. Newcastle has had less business start-ups in the last decade than other core cities, with a growth in number of businesses of 3.7% compared with a national average of 12.1%⁵.

Gateshead town centre, suffers from poor quality retail and commercial offer, the predominantly secondary or tertiary retail and commercial offer primarily serves a low-income local population. This makes it difficult to attract high value tenants and the low rental levels provide little incentive for investment. The retail area is too strung out from north to south, and needs to be made more compact⁶.

Gateshead town centre has an ageing building stock, which, in most cases, has had low levels of investment in recent years. A number of properties are either vacant or under-used and are unattractive for modern town centre uses⁶.

The Economic Topic Paper for the Area Action Plan identified the following key issues for the economy of Gateshead and Newcastle:

Poor levels of entrepreneurship, skills, business, business formation and longevity: There is excess dependency on the public sector and a need to revitalise the regional economy through supporting small and medium enterprises. Worklessness and exclusion remain a large problem for Newcastle and Gateshead, particularly concentrated in a number of inner city wards.

Addressing the suitability, flexibility and diversity of business accommodation in the urban core: The urban core suffers from generally poor quality of the office stock combined with limited parking, generally poor public realm and competition from suburban and out of town locations.

Tackling the economic competitiveness of NewcastleGateshead as the regional capital: Increasing the qualifications and skill base of workers in the urban core is critical in order to revitalise the area.

The 1Plan identified the following business related issues for Gateshead and Newcastle:

- Gateshead and Newcastle need to translate scientific excellence into economic growth. There is a need to mobilise the knowledge, skills and creativity of scientists and entrepreneurs, with the support of the universities, local authorities and development agencies: this is the triple helix (science, academia and government) in action.
- A need to grow clusters of businesses and specialist infrastructure in a number of knowledge hubs, building on key assets including the Centre for Life, Science Central and the Northern Design Centre.
- There is a lack of vitality in the business base. The performance of the private sector has been disappointing and some of the high performers in the first half of the decade have been hit hard by the recession.
- Gateshead and Newcastle have some outstanding companies in manufacturing and services, but the record in business start-ups and growth is disappointing, and an indifferent record of product and

⁵ Newcastle City Council (2006) City Centre Area Action Plan, Key Issues and Development of Options. Available at: <http://www.newcastle.gov.uk/www/fileroot/legacy/regen/plantrans/ccaaakeyis.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁶ Gateshead Borough Council (2007) Town Centre Planning Strategy. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/Building/Strategies/towncentre/planningstrategy.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

process innovation. Knowledge intensive business services (KIBS) have been an important source of growth in the UK economy in the past decade, but they are under-represented in Gateshead and Newcastle.

- The commercial property market has stalled, and there is little development activity.
- The urban core was already facing strong competition from out of town locations, and the benefits of enterprise zone status appear even more attractive in the current market.
- In Newcastle city centre, the traditional business district in Grainger Town has been superseded by modern offices at East Quayside. In recent years development activity has gravitated to new locations such as the Stephenson Quarter, Gallowgate and the Discovery Quarter.
- Gateshead town centre has not previously been a major office location, but there are new developments at Baltic Business Quarter and Baltic Place. The former is anchored by Gateshead College and the Open University, and will be the site of the Northern Design Centre.
- There are sufficient approved schemes to meet demand for office space in the city centre over the next few years. With 2 million ft² of city centre office development in the pipeline there is a nominal risk of over-supply in the urban core, but it is unlikely that all these projects will proceed. There is equally a risk of a shortage of space unless key schemes at Gallowgate and the Stephenson Quarter are “ready to go” when the economy moves out of recession.
- The prime retail offer is concentrated in two locations: Newcastle city centre, and the Metrocentre. In the city centre, the prime retail pitch is the area around Grey’s Monument, including Northumberland Street and Eldon Square. Rents in this area peaked at around £330 per ft², reportedly higher than in Manchester city centre, but there have been a number of recent store closures. There is 2.4 million ft² of retail space in Newcastle city centre; the Gateshead Metrocentre, extended in 2004, has an area of about 2 million ft², including leisure.
- Until 2008, demand for retail space at the MetroCentre was strong, with rents broadly in line with Newcastle city centre. Gateshead town centre is a local shopping centre with an estimated catchment population of 88,000. Quoted Zone A rents in the town centre are around £33 per ft².
- The recession has had a major impact on the retail sector, reflected in an increase in voids, especially in secondary locations, and a drop in reported requirements. Despite this, demand remains strong in prime locations. Eldon Square South, a £170 million, 410,000 ft² retail development was almost fully pre-let when it opened in March 2010.
- The urban core and the periphery both have vital and complementary roles to play in the life of the city but zone-based planning which separates business parks and shopping malls from residential areas is not sustainable. Continuing with a strategy which will increase car-dependency is not an option if we are serious about achieving a low-carbon economy.
- The urban core of Gateshead and Newcastle needs to re-establish its reputation as the prestigious central business district of the city region.
- The poor quality of the office stock in the urban core, combined with competition from suburban and out of town locations has resulted in a damaging drift, with occupiers who should be in the urban core receiving taxpayer subsidies to move to secondary locations.

- The Northern Way reports that this trend has had a negative effect on the economic performance of the whole city region.

B.4 RETAIL

Newcastle is the regional shopping centre; it is the primary focus of retail activity in North East and has a wide catchment area. Recent developments include regeneration of retailing in Grainger Street and Grainger Market which has extended and improved the retail offer in this area and planning permission has been granted for major redevelopment and improvement of the Eldon Square Shopping Centre⁵.

Within the defined retail core there is a concentration of major stores on Northumberland Street and in the northern half of Eldon Square. This creates an imbalance in retail activity between the areas to the north and south of Blakett Street to the detriment of the vitality and viability of the Southern shopping area, Grainger Town and adjacent areas⁵.

The Retail Topic Paper for the Area Action Plan identified the following key issues for the retail market:

The decline of Newcastle city centre as a regional shopping destination and under performance of Gateshead town centre: To maintain and enhance Newcastle's position as a UK regional centre there is a need to enhance the retail facilities in order to compete with the likes of Leeds and Edinburgh. Gateshead, although having the main retail outlet the Metro Centre, suffers from a restricted potential to attract other uses, including leisure and food.

The provision of and access to convenience retailing is lacking in Gateshead Town Centre: Gateshead Town Centre has a limited offer of convenience goods shopping, limiting residents' opportunity for choice and quality of food shopping.

The extent of primary and secondary shop frontages and the flexibility of uses within them: There is a risk that too many non-retail or uses which don't complement the retail function can have a detrimental effect on the streets of the Urban Core Area.

B.5 EMPLOYMENT

Percentage employment rate in Newcastle upon Tyne and Gateshead in 2011-2012 was 71.4% and 76.1% respectively, compared to the North East rate of 74.1% and Great Britain rate of 76.7%.⁷

Newcastle is one of six local government areas identified as having areas with the worst unemployment related deprivation in the region.⁸

In 2009, 31% of children in Newcastle were in poverty^{9,10} compared with 22% for England as a whole. This equates to 14,250 children. 25% of children in Gateshead are in poverty, equating to 8,705 children.

⁷ NOMIS Labour Market Statistics. Economically Active. Available at: http://www.nomisweb.co.uk/reports/lmp/la/2038432094/subreports/ea_time_series/report.aspx Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁸ Government Office of the North East (2007) North East of England Regional Spatial Strategy. Available at: <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2575664> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁹ % children (under 16) in families receiving means-tested benefits and low income, 2009

¹⁰ Public Health Observatories. Health Profile for Gateshead and Newcastle. Available at: http://www.apho.org.uk/resource/view.aspx?QN=HP_RESULTS&GEOGRAPHY=C2 Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

Table B.1 Key Benefit Claimants

	Newcastle (numbers (%))	Gateshead (numbers (%))	North East (%)	Great Britain (%)
Total claimants	34,130 (17.8)	24,830 (19.2)	19.3	14.8
Job seekers	9,900 (5.1)	6,990 (5.4)	5.6	4.0
Incapacity Benefits	14,820 (7.7)	11,090 (8.6)	8.3	6.4
Lone Parents	3,460 (1.8)	2,160 (1.7)	1.8	1.5
Carers	2,680 (1.4)	1,970 (1.5)	1.6	1.2
Other on income related benefits	1,100 (0.6)	820 (0.6)	0.6	0.4
Disabled	1,870 (1.0)	1,540 (1.2)	1.2	1.1
Bereaved	290 (0.2)	250 (0.2)	0.2	0.2

Source: NOMIS Labour Market Statistics

Gateshead and Newcastle's urban core reflects the unemployment related deprivation¹¹ that the region suffers from, the 1Plan identified the following issues in terms of jobs:

- A skilled workforce is an essential precondition for a knowledge economy. The impact of recession has been most severe on unskilled jobs and the manufacturing sector. The Work Foundation reports that the recession "has intensified the structural shift towards a service based, more knowledge intensive and skills-hungry economy". There is a need to generate challenging jobs that will retain and attract highly skilled people.
- Key workers also need attractive housing choices that will encourage families to return to the urban core.
- There is a persistent problem of worklessness and poverty in many communities, with a big gap between rich and poor. In some places worklessness is endemic and cross-generational. There is a need to break this vicious circle by investing in key business locations, many of which are located close to the most disadvantaged areas.
- There is the need to ensure that people have the skills and motivation they need to find work, and that this serves businesses' need for productivity and innovation.

B.6 MATERIAL ASSETS

The following section covers the transport context of the region including transport infrastructure, future transport developments and sustainable transport infrastructure. It then goes on to cover mineral resources and areas of extraction, waste and recycling and energy production.

B.6.1 Transport Infrastructure

The Tyne and Wear Local Transport Plan gives an overview of the major transport areas in Newcastle and Gateshead¹². A summary of these transport areas is given in Table B.2 and B.3 for Gateshead and Newcastle respectively.

¹¹ Government Office of the North East (2007) North East of England Regional Spatial Strategy. Available at: <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2575664> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

¹² Integrated Transport Authority (2011) Local Transport Plan 3 (LTP3) Tyne & Wear 2011-2021. Available at: <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2575614> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

Table B.2 Major Transport Areas in Gateshead

Transport Area	Description	Issues
A1/A194(M) Corridors	The A1 and A194 (M) through Gateshead are critical roads link for the borough, providing connections to existing and proposed employment areas of strategic importance for the area's regeneration.	Congestion. The A1 around Gateshead is one of the most heavily trafficked and congested routes in the region, experiencing significant delay at peak hours. Although more lightly trafficked, congestion problems exist on the A194(M), notably at the junction at White Mare Pool Severance. The routes represent major barriers to movement in a number of locations, especially pedestrians and cyclists. The A1 acts as a barrier between various urban communities, with severance problems on the A194(M) concentrated at White Mare Pool, where the major employment area at Follingsby is effectively cut off from nearby residential areas by the motorway.
East Gateshead Transport corridor	Important transport routes passing through the area include Metro and rail lines, as well as the Felling By-pass. The latter is the main route for traffic passing through the area, and carries over 46,000 vehicles per day on some sections, with serious congestion at Park Lane, immediately to the east of the town centre, and Heworth roundabout.	Congestion, accessibility and supporting continued regeneration in the area.
Gateshead Town Centre	It is situated at the hub of the main traffic routes into central Tyneside with exceptional levels of public transport accessibility.	Gateshead town centre is currently relatively run down, with a significant level of vacant premises. From the south the centre suffers from a poor environment and severance from surrounding areas and has recently been declared an air quality management area.
Metro Centre	It is well served by public transport and is a key, and very attractive, location for future sustainable development within Gateshead. Bus routes serving the area are focused on the MetroCentre Interchange, which is served by around 100 buses per hour. The MetroCentre Interchange is also served by heavy rail on the Tyne Valley Line, with almost 100 trains per day.	Suffers from some of the worst congestion in the conurbation, particularly related to the adjoining A1 trunk road. There are also considerable traffic flows on the local distributor roads serving the MetroCentre and Metro Retail Park.
Team Valley Trading Estate	The A1 provides the southern and eastern boundary to the area, with junctions at Kingsway south and Loble Hill. Public transport is entirely bus based, principally through the 93/94 service.	Congestion and accessibility issues.

Transport Area	Description	Issues
Blaydon town centre	Blaydon town centre provides a service centre for the local area. It is an important focus for local bus services, and has a rail station on the Tyne Valley Line.	Severance of the area by the River Tyne from the developing major employment site at Newburn Riverside. Provision of a new pedestrian/cycle bridge linking Newburn Riverside to Blaydon town centre, including the bus and rail stations, would remove the current severance, significantly expanding the catchment for employment at Newburn south of the river. The development of public transport, pedestrian and cycle links as part of the proposed development at Stella to the west of Blaydon. Significant development proposals exist in this area, most notably for 500+ houses (granted on appeal). However currently it is extremely poorly served by public transport, and access for pedestrians and cyclists is also in need of major improvement. Newburn bridge. This local road crossing of the Tyne to the west of Blaydon is severely substandard, and proposals are under development for its replacement. As part of this work consideration may be given to alternative locations for a bridge, and approaches towards its future management to give greater encouragement to cross river public transport. Any proposals for the creation of a new crossing of the Tyne for strategic traffic will, however, only be acceptable if the impacts of traffic on local roads, communities and the environment can be mitigated successfully. It is not currently anticipated that a bid for funding of this scheme will come forward before 2011.

Source: Local Transport Plan Tyne and Wear Website (2010)

Gateshead Town Centre lies on the Tyne and Wear Metro system and at the heart of the local bus network, making it one of the most accessible locations within Tyne and Wear by public transport. It is bounded by major roads and railways leading into Central Tyneside, which sever the centre from its immediate surroundings. Although pedestrian routes to adjoining residential areas have recently been improved, with the replacement of a number of subways by light-controlled crossings, significant difficulties remain in linking the town centre effectively to its surroundings on foot, by cycle, and by public transport. In addition to this, the road network, especially in the Oakwellgate area which has a fragmented character with sites isolated by highway infrastructure, restricts opportunities for development. This makes it difficult to bring about the necessary development to create a contiguous, enlarged town centre area linking the existing town centre and the Quays⁶.

Despite recent improvements, the town centre core is poorly connected with surrounding areas, especially to the north and east, with a major barrier created by the volume of traffic bypassing the town centre. This means that the town centre in its current form is unlikely to achieve maximum benefit from the range of commercial, arts and leisure, and residential developments taking place around its periphery⁶.

The main roads, both around the edge and through the town centre, carry a high volume of traffic, to the detriment of pedestrians and cyclists. Traffic heading for other destinations passes through the heart of the town centre along Regent Street and Charles Street as well as around the edges. There is an aspiration to separate through-traffic from access traffic in the town centre, though recent traffic modelling work may establish that significant change would need to occur to the surrounding distributor road network prior to removal of through-traffic from the town centre⁶.

Table B.3 Major Transport Areas in Newcastle

Transport Area	Description	Issues
City Centre	Newcastle City Centre is the prime retail and employment location in the North East region and the focal point for public transport and road networks throughout Tyneside.	Congestion and accessibility issues
Discovery Quarter	Transportation issues are critical to the area, which is adjacent to one of the City's main strategic routes and close to the Redheugh Bridge across the Tyne.	Improved highways (especially the Redheugh Bridgehead major scheme), enhanced traffic management and access to public transport services being paramount.
Shields Road / Byker / Ouseburn	Shields Road is an important shopping and community focus for the east end of Newcastle.	Accessibility
Newburn and Lemington	The Council is keen to ensure that this site exploits its favourable location close to the A1 Western bypass, by providing sustainable economic growth opportunities for commerce, research and light manufacturing industries.	The challenge is to ensure that the local communities of Lemington, Newburn and Blaydon benefit from access to greater opportunities for employment.

Source: Local Transport Plan Tyne and Wear Website (2010)

Newcastle has a compact City Centre with a tight inner ring road, known as the Inner Distributor Road. This aims to provide priority circulation for public transport and delivery vehicles. Within it space is prioritised for pedestrians and public transport. General and through traffic is directed to roads outside the IDR. At present Newcastle has a very condensed peak hour which is showing a tendency to spreading, however congestion is lower than other UK cities⁵.

Newcastle City Centre is served by 5 metro stations and 150 bus stops and has a number of metro based park and ride schemes which are mainly to the North, South and East of the City⁵.

There were a number of key issues identified in the Urban Core Movement Topic Paper:

The impact of an increase in demand for movement into and within the Urban Core: There is a risk that travel conditions will significantly worsen as demand for access grows, congestion will be far more extensive particularly in the vicinity of the river crossings. This will negatively impact on the efficiency of the public transport network, as well as pedestrians, cyclists and delivery vehicles making the Urban Core less attractive for residents, visitors and further development.

Maintain and improve accessibility by sustainable modes to the Urban Core: There are some difficulties for both cyclists and pedestrians in accessing and travelling through parts of the core area. Evidence shows that there are very high pedestrian flows through parts of Newcastle's core area on particular routes which connect the major transport hubs with the retail areas, universities and Civic Centre. These well used lines compensate for the poor connectivity in areas such as Barras Bridge/Haymarket and Central Station. However difficulties for pedestrians such as indirect crossings and inadequate footways will serve to discourage walking as demand for these routes rise through additional development.

Gateshead's significant highway infrastructure schemes from the 1960's/70's have resulted in a very poor pedestrian environment creating many barriers to pedestrian movement, particularly between Gateshead Town Centre and Gateshead Quays.

Maintain and improve the attractiveness of public Space in the Urban Core: In order to create an Urban Core which is easy to walk around it will be necessary to balance public space and good pedestrian routes with the need for vehicular access. Central Gateshead is particularly affected by a number of dual carriageways carrying large amounts of traffic directly through the centre in an east-west and north-south direction, affecting pedestrian movement both within and to surrounding areas.

The 1Plan identifies the following issues for Gateshead and Newcastle in terms of infrastructure:

- Major roads and ill-judged developments from a previous era have damaged the urban fabric in places, and the quality of the public realm in much of the urban core is poor – especially in comparison with recent transformational projects in Sheffield, Liverpool, Nottingham and other cities.
- A more competitive and equitable urban core. Gateshead and Newcastle need a new approach to access and mobility. Access to the city by rail and air is generally good, but there are threats. Air services are under review as passenger numbers fall and it is vital that Gateshead and Newcastle is part of the new high speed rail network.
- Congestion on the A1/A19 continues to be a problem, and too much traffic passes through the urban core.
- There is a major challenge to establish a sustainable movement strategy for the heart of Gateshead and Newcastle and the wider urban area, linked to planning policies designed to stem the tide of suburbanisation.

B.6.2 Sustainable Transport Infrastructure

The 1Plan makes the following key points about walking and cycling in Gateshead and Newcastle:

- The urban core is a compact, walkable area. It is less than 2km from Central Station to the Town Moor or Gateshead town centre. Walking through Grainger Town is a great experience; broad pavements, gracious buildings, legible form and pedestrianised areas encourage walking. The Quayside is a notable piece of townscape, and the Quayside is an attractive environment for pedestrians with memorable views. By contrast, the area around Swan House Roundabout is fragmented, illegible and hostile. Over-engineered roads and a network of bridges and underpasses make this a place to avoid.
- There are two attractive river crossings for pedestrians and cyclists: the elegant sweep of the Gateshead Millennium Bridge connects the BALTIC Centre for Contemporary Art to the Quayside. The High Level Bridge offers sheltered walking and wide views.
- The Tyne Bridge carries heavy traffic flows and both the bridge and the approaches are inhospitable places.
- Gateshead is not a walkable town. Heavily trafficked major roads sweep through the space between the riverside and the town centre. Pedestrian routes zigzag across this area, signalling that the car is in charge.
- The Council recognises that this has to change, and the regeneration delivery strategy will reclaim sites for development by reconfiguring major roads as city streets.

The Tyne and Wear Local Transport Plan (LTP) includes a Walking Strategy and a Cycling Strategy. Walking is identified as one of the major ways in which the region can meet the shared priorities of the LTP, namely:

- A reduction in traffic congestion
- An improvement in road safety
- An improvement in accessibility for those in most need
- Improvement to air quality
- Improvement in quality of life in the North East

Walking will be encouraged through the provision of safe, direct, continuous and aesthetically pleasing walking routes along streets and between attractors across the conurbation, thus making walking a more attractive option. Land use and transport planners will work closely together with a presumption in favour of high quality pedestrian access to key services such as health, retail and recreation. Schemes will give full consideration to pedestrians. Pedestrian zones, street layouts, signs and crossings will be designed to enhance the quality of life of those who live and work in or visit the area. Such emphasis will contribute directly to the built environment becoming progressively more attractive and to ensuring that all development provides for easy walking accessibility.

The Cycling Strategy identifies the following partnership aims:

- Continue working in partnership with neighbouring authorities to develop a network of integrated, direct and coherent cycle routes.
- Provide resources necessary to achieve the targets.

- Improve safety on the network through education, engineering and enforcement.
- Ensure high quality design and inclusion of cycling needs and facilities in new land use and transport developments.
- Improve accessibility for cyclists by providing direct routes, end of trip facilities (e.g. appropriate cycle parking), and better integration with public transport.
- Ensure that cycling facilities and training are given priority in school and work place travel plans.
- Ensure that cycle training is to the National Standard.
- Increase public acceptance of cycling through a programme of promotional events and activities as well as maintaining partnerships with relevant stakeholders.

The development of an off-road cycle network in Tyne and Wear has proved to be very popular. Monitoring has shown that it has been the principal cause of cycle trip growth in our area. Therefore, continued commitment will be given by the partners to further develop off-road cycling, building on the success of LTP1. Strong commitment will also be given to the development of on-road cycling. The five local authorities will give consideration to the spatial planning approach adopted in the LTP as well as to the “Hierarchy of Provision”, which is outlined by the Department for Transport nationally as being best practice. This hierarchy consists of the following considerations:

- Traffic reduction. Can traffic volumes be reduced sufficiently to achieve the desired improvements in attractiveness and safety? Can heavy lorries be restricted or diverted?
- Speed reduction. Can speeds be reduced and driver behaviour modified to achieve the desired results?
- Junction treatment and traffic management. Can the problems that cyclists encounter, particularly accident locations, be solved by specific junction treatment or other traffic management solutions such as contraflow cycle lanes and priority traffic signals?
- Redistribution of the carriageway. Can the carriageway be redistributed to give more space to cyclists, perhaps in conjunction with bus lanes?
- Cycle lanes (on-road) and cycle tracks (off-road). Having considered and, where possible, implemented the above, what specific cycle lanes or tracks are now necessary?
- Shared use of the footway. This should normally be discouraged as it has proven to be an unsatisfactory solution for both cyclists and pedestrians. The DfT has repeatedly stated in guidance that shared use of the footway by cyclists should be considered only as a last resort.

The Tyne and Wear Rights of Way Improvement Plan (RoWIP) has been produced to meet the requirements of the Countryside and Rights of Way Act 2000 (CROW Act). The full report is available at <http://www.tyneandwearltp.gov.uk/documents/rowip/> and includes survey results of able-bodied users and users with disabilities, landowners, businesses, neighbouring authorities and other interested parties.

B.6.3 Mineral Resources and Areas of Extraction

Historically, the North east region has been associated with rich deposits of coal and coal mining, which drove the regions development during the industrial

revolution. During the latter part of the 20th century, many coal mines were closed and this created many areas of brown-field in need of regeneration. The NorthEast is still rich in deep coal deposits, the value of which could be realised in the future as the process of gasification becomes more economically viable.

Newcastle has some superficial sand and gravel deposits in the North East of the area, on the border of Newcastle and Gateshead there is Gateshead Marine aggregates Plant, a plant for processing marine gravel and salt. Gateshead has superficial sand and gravel deposits along the western side there are 2 sand and gravel processing sites Crawcrook and Blaydon¹³. There are also two sites classified as dormant, and six sites safeguarded for future sand and gravel extraction. In addition, aggregates are landed at Gateshead Wharf, located in the East Gateshead Primary Employment Area, whilst brick-making clay is safeguarded for future extraction at Lamesley¹⁴.

B.6.4 Waste and Recycling

The total municipal waste collected by Newcastle upon Tyne from 2011 to 2012 was 148,872 tonnes, of which 111,896 tonnes was from household waste, and 36,976 tonnes was commercial¹⁵. Nationally, the amount of municipal waste collected has been growing at approximately 3% per annum.

Of the 148,872 tonnes of municipal waste collected in 2011/12, 41,361 tonnes (27%) was sent for recycling, composting or reuse.

Newcastle upon Tyne has formulated a waste management strategy and action plan. The vision of the City's waste management strategy is to achieve zero waste by treating waste as a resource and not a problem.

The Strategy has 3 key objectives to meet this vision:

- To seek to reverse the trend in waste growth;
- To meet the Council's commitment of cutting landfill to 50% by 2006/07 by expanding recycling and composting activities; and
- To meet and exceed statutory Government or EC targets for recycling and diversion from landfill.¹⁶

The total municipal waste collected by Gateshead Council from 2011 to 2012 was 94,202 tonnes, of which 84,505 was from household waste and 9,697 tonnes was from commercial sources¹⁵. Of the 94,202 tonnes of municipal waste collected in 2011/12, 33,263 tonnes (35%) was sent for recycling, composting or reuse.

The South Tyne and Wear Waste Management Partnership, made up of Gateshead, South Tyneside and Sunderland councils, is working together to reduce the amount of waste sent to landfill sites every year and dramatically increase recycling. Gateshead are working towards a target of 50% recycle by 2020, this will be achieved by improving recycling banks and household recycling systems across the borough.

¹³ British Geological Survey (2008) North East England Region Aggregate Mineral Resources. Available at: www.bgs.ac.uk/downloads/start.cfm?id=1376 Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

¹⁴ Gateshead Council (2008) Gateshead Local Development Framework – Consultation Towards our Core Strategy 2030. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/Building/Strategies/LDF/LDF%20Strategy.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

¹⁵ DEFRA (2012) Local Authority Waste Management Statistics for England – Final Annual Results 2011/12. Available at: <http://www.defra.gov.uk/statistics/environment/waste/wrfg23-wrmsannual/> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

¹⁶ Newcastle City Council (2005) Waste Management Strategy and Action Plan, April 2005

South Tyne and Wear Waste Management Partnership have produced a joint municipal waste management strategy. This strategy has the following key objectives:

- reduce the amount of waste that is generated;
- reuse waste;
- recycle and / or compost waste as far as this is practicable within economic and environmental constraints; and
- recover energy from the remaining waste and finally dispose of residual waste safely.

B.6.5 Energy Production

One NorthEast (ONE) has identified energy as one of three key areas for development over the next 20 years, with the potential to generate around £2bn of new economic growth for the region's economy. Already estimated to be worth around £900m, the energy sector is also one of the most productive sectors in the region, employing around 30,000 people and with more than £6bn currently being invested in novel energy projects over the next few years. ONE has invested over £100m in recent years and public sector investment will continue; ONE has committed a further £100m of public funds to energy R&D over the next five years¹⁷.

Newcastle City Council's energy strategy identifies the following key energy issues¹⁸:

- Newcastle City Council is the largest employer in Newcastle and had a gross expenditure on services in 2004/05 of £792,620,910.
- The City Council has an annual energy bill of £6million (2004/05), approximately corresponding to £2.5million each for electricity and gas, plus £1million for water. Rising energy prices represent a significant challenge, with total energy costs rising to potentially £9.9million in 2006/07.
- The City Council manages 500 buildings, including central office accommodation, leisure centres, schools, social services, libraries and museums. These buildings produced 78,000 tonnes of CO₂ in 2004/05. They use 500,000m³ of water per annum.
- Housing accounts for 41% of Newcastle's energy use, with 120,000 domestic properties in the City. These properties produce approximately 600,000 tonnes of CO₂ per annum.
- An estimated 29% of residents are living in fuel poverty, equivalent to 34,800 households (2003). Fuel poverty is when a household needs to spend 10% or more of income to meet fuel costs.
- Your Homes Newcastle, the arm's length management organisation (ALMO) for the local authority housing stock, manages 32,000 properties.

¹⁷ Sir Joseph Swan Institute for Energy Research, Newcastle University. Available at: <http://www.ncl.ac.uk/energy/business/index.htm> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

¹⁸ Newcastle City Council (2006) Energy Strategy. Available at: <http://www.newcastle.gov.uk/wwwfileroot/legacy/ns/energy/NewcastleCityCouncilEnergyStrategyfinal2.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

There are a number of examples of renewable energy technology installed on City Council commercial properties, contributing to reducing the City's carbon emissions.

- Ouseburn Farm. The environmental training centre at Ouseburn Farm in Byker contains a number of sustainable and renewable technologies including solar water heating (co-funded by Clear Skies), a 5kW solar photovoltaic system (co-funded by the DTI), rainwater recycling and a green (sedum) roof.
- Newburn Green Waste Recycling. The office building at the City's green waste recycling site in Newburn is a sustainable building of timber construction, and incorporates an under floor heating system fed by solar thermal panels and a ground source heat pump (GSHP).
- Elswick Park and Pool. A large scale renewable energy project is being developed for this site. Elswick Pool has conditions which could best utilise solar water heating. Match funding for the project has been secured from the Government's Clear Skies scheme which is being run by the Building Research Establishment (BRE). This project will be monitored through design, installation and energy production stages. The project will give Newcastle a second large scale renewable energy installation, the first being Newbiggin Hall photovoltaic project which produces electricity (see below).

In the domestic sector, the potential use of renewable energy in Newcastle includes photovoltaics (the generation of electricity from solar energy), solar hot water, ground and air source heat pumps, micro wind turbines, and biomass boilers connected to district heating. The Newcastle Warm Zone project will also look to work with its partners to facilitate the funding and delivery of appropriate domestic renewable energy technologies, particularly in those homes where fuel poverty will not be alleviated by traditional insulation/heating methods.

- Newbiggin Hall Photovoltaics The photovoltaics (pv) scheme, located on a block of NCC/YHN properties in Newbiggin Hall, was awarded a grant of £250,000 from the DTI. In 2004, 25 solar arrays were installed on the roof of a block of 25 flats, with the capacity to generate 28,097 kWh of electricity per annum. It is estimated that the residents will save a total of £2,300 each year from their electricity bills and 13,000 kg of CO₂ per annum will also be saved. This project was officially opened in 2004 by David Green, Chief Executive of the UK Business Council for Sustainable Energy.

Gateshead is one of the first Cities with 30% of energy provided by low carbon or renewable energy generated locally¹⁹. But at the other end of the scale the high proportion of manufacturing jobs and industries accounts for about 43% of carbon emissions (1,567,000 tonnes of CO₂)⁸⁹.

Gateshead may have particular potential for the production of low carbon energy using meso and micro hydropower, wind power and ground source heat pumps. It is understood that there is great potential to take advantage of geothermal energy in light of the location of the Town Centre in relationship to the Tyne gorge. This area has been identified as one which potentially has the appropriate geology to support viable geothermal energy initiatives. The Council is particularly keen to

¹⁹ Gateshead Council (2010) Sustainable Community Strategy for Gateshead

see how this is source could be harnessed to the benefit of developments within the town centre⁶.

There is an example of renewable energy technology installed on City Council commercial properties within the Urban Core, contributing to reducing the City's carbon emissions¹⁸.

- Ouseburn Farm: The environmental training centre at Ouseburn Farm in Byker contains a number of sustainable and renewable technologies including solar water heating (co-funded by Clear Skies), a 5kW solar photovoltaic system (co-funded by the DTI), rainwater recycling and a green (sedum) roof.

In the domestic sector, the potential use of renewable energy in Newcastle includes photovoltaics (the generation of electricity from solar energy), solar hot water, ground and air source heat pumps, micro wind turbines, and biomass boilers connected to district heating. The Newcastle Warm Zone project will also look to work with its partners to facilitate the funding and delivery of appropriate domestic renewable energy technologies, particularly in those homes where fuel poverty will not be alleviated by traditional insulation/heating methods²⁰.

The 1Plan describes the vision of Gateshead and Newcastle in terms of renewable energy:

- *"Our vision for the north east is of a low-carbon region enabled by renewable energy, intelligent networks and design. Areas of the north east have been designated as the UK's first low-carbon economic area for ultra-low-carbon vehicles, and businesses in Gateshead and Newcastle will form an important part of the automotive supply chain. Local businesses are already playing an important role in the developing renewable energy sector, and there are opportunities for other firms to diversify into low-carbon production. The national centre of excellence, Narec, is a vital asset."*

²⁰ Newcastle Warm Zone (2005) Newcastle Warm Zone Project Website

HEALTH AND WELLBEING

The following sections look at the health and wellbeing of Gateshead and Newcastle specifically leisure provision and levels of health within the Urban Core.

B.7 LEISURE

The leisure topic paper for the joint area action plan identified the following key issues:

NewcastleGateshead is not fulfilling its full potential in terms of leisure, culture and tourism sectors – there is a need to identify gaps in current provision and to widen the offer, including provision for families and a more diverse night-time economy

Specific issues which have been identified to date include:

- competition from other major cities, including Leeds and Edinburgh;
- the lack of suitable city centre spaces for major events;
- the lack of space of exceptional quality comparable with other cities (e.g. Peace Gardens in Sheffield);
- the lack of an integrated approach to provision of new accommodation and attractions;
- the poor retention of graduates;
- negative perceptions of the area and quality of place; and
- lack of critical mass to support additional facilities.

Some of the key conclusions from the study include:

- Casino – fall in market in recent years, due in part to smoking ban and the current economic climate impacting on discretionary spend. Gateshead currently lacks a casino facility.
- Cinema – future capacity will be driven by consumer appetite and trends. The study notes the lack of mainstream and/or independent cinemas within Gateshead Town Centre.
- Health & Fitness – there are no health and fitness facilities within Gateshead town centre at present. Additional provision could be linked to hotel developments.
- Bowling – spend on bowling set to grow nationally – additional provision will be market driven.
- Eating Out – Based on survey results, visits to restaurants and cafes are a large part of the leisure market in Newcastle and Gateshead. Current market trends indicate that eating out is set to become an even more important part of leisure activity which could have important implications to help diversify the evening economy. It may be appropriate to encourage the development of more independent restaurants (or gastro pubs) alongside national chains within both Newcastle and Gateshead as part of a strategy to help create more of a “prestige offer”, and help to diversify the evening economy
- Drinking Establishments/Nightclubs – significant part of the leisure market and party capital reputation attracts visitors but is too narrowly focused. Broader approach being looked at with potential for additional facilities in Gateshead.
- Museums/Art Galleries – significant improvements in quality of provision in recent years including at the Baltic and Great North Museum. Further developments likely to be linked to public sector funding.

- Live Music/Theatre – popular among visitor market and potential for diversifying the evening economy. Provision primarily focused in Newcastle, but good level of satisfaction with existing facilities generally.
- Hotels – occupancy levels across the area have remained steady despite the wider downturn, the most popular categories being economy hotel chains and 4 star chains. Provision and pipeline proposals are focused in Newcastle whilst new provision is likely to be more successful when accompanied by other uses (retail, offices, conference and leisure).

Gateshead is deficient in a number of facilities which contribute to a vibrant, mixed use town centre and encourage 'linked' visits, in particular leisure, health and community facilities. This limits the range of people who wish to visit the town centre and the number of hours per day when activity is taking place, as there is little to attract people during evening hours⁶.

The quality of recent architecture and urban design in Gateshead and Newcastle has been very mixed. In addition to the BALTIC Centre for Contemporary Arts, The Sage Gateshead and the Gateshead Millennium Bridge, there have been other high quality projects on a smaller scale, including Dance City, i6, Hotel du Vin and Live Theatre. But most modern office and retail development in the urban core is mediocre or worse, and the treatment of the public realm has generally been perfunctory²¹.

The 1Plan identified the following issues in terms of culture for Gateshead and Newcastle:

- A need to improve the performance of the tourism sector. Gateshead and Newcastle are a popular short break destination. Gateshead and Newcastle have a long standing reputation as a party place, and a rich cultural offer. Gateshead and Newcastle have a good platform to build on but they are not yet a competitive business tourism destination.
- There is no modern convention centre and the quality of shops, restaurants and hotels does not always meet the expectations of discerning visitors, although there has been a big improvement in recent years.
- More full service hotels are required, and there is a need to strengthen the high-end and speciality retail offer.

B.8 HEALTH

Gateshead Joint Strategic Needs Assessment identified the following major issues for the health of the community in Gateshead:

- Mental health services, with particular attention to promoting health and wellbeing, and a range of service improvements. Specific areas emerging are: child and young person mental and emotional well-being; preventing isolation and loneliness in old age; and dementia. Clear links with housing developments to support independent living are required.
- Circulatory disease, healthy lifestyles (including children and young people), working with those at high risk, early identification and treatment working closely with the PCT-led initiatives in risk reduction, and obesity.

²¹ 1NG (2010) NewcastleGateshead 1Plan. Available at: <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2573917>
Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

- Alcohol and drugs, working to address the cultural and social aspects alongside community safety, regulatory services, children's services and the PCT-led development of treatment services.
- Tobacco, working to address the cultural and social aspects alongside regulatory services, children's services, ante-natal services and the PCT-led development of treatment services.
- The ageing population of family carers of people with learning disabilities. In particular, working to provide supported accommodation options.
- Teenage pregnancy²².

Newcastle upon Tyne Joint Strategic Needs Assessment Identifies the following key issues for the community in Newcastle:

- The 2001 Census records 55,962 which equates to 21.6% of the population has having a Limiting Long Term Illness (LLTI). In some wards (Walker) the levels of LLTI is as high as 30.9%.
- Male life expectancy in Newcastle is at an all-time high, but Newcastle lags behind the national average by 2 years – 75.7 years compared to 77.8 years. Also England is improving at a faster pace than Newcastle so the gap is actually widening.
- Lung cancer is by far the greatest contributor to the male life expectancy gap, accounting for a quarter (24.6%) of the gap between Newcastle and the England average. Smoking accounts for 87% of deaths from lung cancer. Respiratory diseases and other cancers are also significant contributors to early deaths, as are mental and behavioural disorders, coronary heart disease and chronic liver disease, including cirrhosis.
- Female life expectancy in Newcastle also lags behind the England average (80.6 compared to 82.0 years) but improvement in Newcastle has taken place at a faster pace than the national average, so the gap is narrowing.
- Lung cancer accounts for a higher proportion of the gap in female life expectancy than any other single disease – 26.3%. Respiratory and circulatory diseases are also important contributors to the gap.
- Within Newcastle there is significant variation in life expectancy between different parts of the city. Men from the least deprived areas of the city live about 10 years longer than those from the most deprived areas, and for women it is nearly seven years longer²³.

Newcastle has one of the highest rates of binge drinking in England, with a high prevalence of 'harmful' or 'dependent' drinkers. It has higher rates of alcohol-related deaths, fewer treatment services and longer waiting times than the rest of the country. In the local alcohol profiles published in October 2007, it ranks poorly for a number of indicators, including:

- Binge drinking and alcohol specific deaths in men
- Alcohol specific hospital admissions in men
- Chronic liver disease in men – harmful drinking.

Consultation findings have also shown that local people consider alcohol-related disorder and anti-social behaviour in neighbourhoods a major cause for concern⁵⁷.

²² Gateshead City Council (2011) Gateshead Joint Strategic Needs Assessment

²³ Newcastle City Council (2009) Newcastle Joint Strategic Needs Assessment

A key component in addressing health inequalities will be ensuring that all residents who experience mental health problems or emotional distress are able to easily access a range of support services. This may be very difficult to measure (as are most non-clinical preventative activities) and the types of promotion and support activities that have benefit to those with low level mental health problems, such as improving confidence, self-esteem or therapeutic interventions are often viewed as lacking directly applicable evidence base or tangible evaluation. Also for many communities (BME and faith populations especially) mental health is not acknowledged or recorded well.

In Gateshead 71.5% of people felt that their health is good or very good²⁴ and 72% felt they were in the good or very good bracket of health in Newcastle²⁵.

Further regional health statistics can be found in "Equality and Diversity in the North East: a Statistical Profile"²⁶.

Table B.4 and B.5 summarises key health data for Newcastle and Gateshead:

Table B.4 Key Health Data, 2009

Health Indicator	Newcastle	Gateshead	English Worst	English Average
Life Expectancy Males (years)	75.7	75.8	73.2	77.7
Life Expectancy Females (years)	80.5	80.4	78.1	81.8
Physically Active Children ²⁷	91.6	86.6	77.5	90.0
Obese Children ²⁸	10.9	11.9	16.2	9.6
Physically Active Adults ²⁹	11.3	10.8	4.4	10.8
Obese Adults ³⁰	22.6	26.0	31.2	23.6
Over 65s 'not in good health' ³¹	27.8	29.2	32.5	21.5
Early deaths: heart disease & stroke ³²	94.2	96.4	130.5	79.1
Early deaths: cancer ³²	145.6	133.7	164.3	115.5

Source: Association of Public Health Authorities Health Profiles for Newcastle and Gateshead 2009

²⁴ Gateshead Council (2009) Place Survey 2008, Background and Summary of Results. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/council/strategy/PlaceSurvey2008Nresultsforwebsite.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

²⁵ Newcastle City Council (2009) The 2008/9 Newcastle Place and Residents' Surveys. Available at: [http://www2.newcastle.gov.uk/condiary.nsf/all/79B7E1D37534B2F1802574D30048393C/\\$FILE/FINAL%20REPORT%202008-09%20Place%20Survey%20&%20Residents%20Survey.pdf](http://www2.newcastle.gov.uk/condiary.nsf/all/79B7E1D37534B2F1802574D30048393C/$FILE/FINAL%20REPORT%202008-09%20Place%20Survey%20&%20Residents%20Survey.pdf) Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

²⁶ North East Equality and Diversity Partnership (2008) Equality and Diversity in the North East: a Statistical Profile. Available at: http://www.equality-ne.co.uk/downloads/267_EandDstat.pdf Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

²⁷ % 5-16 year olds who spent at least 2 hours per week on high quality PE and school sport 2007/08

²⁸ % of school children in reception year 2007/08

²⁹ % aged 16+ 2007/08

³⁰ %. Modelled estimate from Health Survey for England 2003 -2005

³¹ % who self-assessed general health as 'not good' (directly age and sex standardised) 2001

³² Directly age standardised rate per 100,000 population under 75 2005-2007

Table B.5 Key Health Data, 2012³³

Health Indicator	Newcastle	Gateshead	English Worst	English Average
Life Expectancy Males (years)	76.8	76.7	73.6	78.6
Life Expectancy Females (years)	81.1	80.9	79.1	82.6
Proportion of children in poverty ³⁴	31.4	25.4	50.9	21.9
Obese Children ³⁵	24.9	23.2	26.5	19.0
Physically Active Adults ³⁶	9.6	8.0	5.7	11.2
Obese Adults ³⁷	23.9	30.7	30.7	24.2
Hip fracture in 65s and over ³⁸	480	549	655	452
Early deaths: heart disease & stroke ³⁹	84.8	82.3	123.2	67.3
Early deaths: cancer ⁴⁰	141.4	126.6	159.1	110.1

Source: Association of Public Health Authorities Health Profiles for Newcastle and Gateshead 2012

³³ Public Health Observatories. Health Profile for Gateshead and Newcastle

³⁴ % children (under 16) in families receiving means-tested benefit and low-income, 2009

³⁵ % of school children in year 6 (aged 10-11), 2010/11

³⁶ % aged 16+ October 2009 – October 2011

³⁷ %. Adults, modelled estimate from Health Survey for England 2006 -2008

³⁸ Directly age and sex standardised rate for emergency admissions, per 100,000 population aged 65 and over, 2010/11

³⁹ Directly age standardised rate per 100,000 population under 75 2008-2010

⁴⁰ Directly age standardised rate per 100,000 population under 75 2008-2010

B.9 EQUALITY AND DIVERSITY

The following section examines the demographics of the population relevant to equality for the community.

B.9.1 Age Profile

12.3% of the Newcastle population is aged between 20 and 24, reflecting the large student population at the city's two universities⁵. There are 62,800 children and young people aged 0-19 living in Newcastle, 23% of the population. Since 2001, the numbers of children and young people has reduced year on year, from 24.4% to 23.2% in 2006. The 5-9 and 10-14 age groups show the biggest drop, reflecting a fall in birth rates in the late 20th century.

30% of the city's population is aged 50 and over. Of these 83,400 older people (defined by Government as those aged 50 and over), 36,100 (43%) are under pensionable age (60 for women and 65 for men), 26,600 (32%) from pensionable age to 74, and 20,600 (25%) aged 75 and over⁵.

Table B.6 Percentage Age Brackets for Gateshead

	England		North East		Gateshead	
Age Group	No.	Percent	No.	Percent	No.	Percent
0-19	12353.3	24.2%	604.5	23.6%	44.2	23.2%
20-64	30579.4	59.9%	1526.9	59.5%	112.7	59.2%
65+	8159.4	16.0%	433	16.9%	33.7	17.7%
75+	3966.9	7.8%	204.1	8.0%	15.7	8.2%

Source: Gateshead Joint Strategic Needs Assessment (2011)

According to ONS projections, the population of Gateshead is expected to decline over the next few decades. At the same time, the age profile will become more skewed towards older residents. By 2021, 28% of the population will be 60 or over, compared with 22.8% in 2003. This is a huge challenge for future housing strategies, in particular developing appropriate support services for older people and developing a range of housing solutions⁵⁶.

In Gateshead there are higher concentrations of elderly people in the rural west of the borough creating the issues of transport availability and access to healthcare and services. The aging population links with the access to health and social care services and is potentially a large issue for the NHS and local authorities who are in a period of efficiencies likely to last for the next three to five years, within a context of increasing demand⁴¹.

B.9.2 Gender

Of the 270,500 people living in Newcastle, 51% are female and 49% male.⁵ Within the Gateshead population 49% are male and 51% are female, matching the percentage distribution of Newcastle⁵⁰.

B.9.3 Disability

For the 2001 Census records of Newcastle 55,962 (21.6% of the population) having a Limiting Long Term Illness (LLTI). In some wards (Walker) the levels of LLTI is as high as 30.9%⁵.

Residents in Gateshead are marginally more likely to have a limiting long-term illness compared with the North East, and noticeably more than for England as a

⁴¹ Personal communication with Gateshead Council (19.02.10)

whole. Of all residents, 23.4% have a limiting long-term illness, compared with 22.1% of the North East and 17.3% for England. Overall, 66.3% of over 75s have a limiting long-term illness. The proportion in 'good health' is lower for most age groups compared with the North East and England⁵⁶.

B.9.4 Ethnicity

The latest school census information shows that of the school population in Newcastle (37,030), 16% are from black and ethnic minorities and 14% have a first language which is other than English. Of the people aged 55 to 64 living in Newcastle, 3.6% are from BME groups compared to 3.1% for the 65-74 age bracket. This figure drops significantly to 1.46% for people aged 75-84 and only 47 people in Newcastle are from black and ethnic minorities and aged 85 and over, 0.9% of the total population in this age bracket.⁵

Within Gateshead population survey of 2006 97% were White British, 0.7%, White Irish, 1.0 Black/Black British, 0.2% Mixed Race, 0.3% Asian/Asian British, 0.3% Chinese and 0.5% described as other. At the moment, 2.4% of the 46,308 young people aged between 0 and 19 living in Gateshead borough are part of a minority ethnic group. Of Gateshead's 1000 asylum seekers, around 216 are school age children⁴².

From 2001 to 2006 there was an increase by 116% of Black and Minority Ethnic (BME) groups in Gateshead, whereas there was an increase of 49% in Newcastle upon Tyne³.

B.9.5 Faith

Table B.7 Religion in Newcastle

Religion	Percentage of 2001 Census
Christian	70.64%
Buddhist	0.27%
Hindu	0.64%
Jewish	0.32%
Muslim	3.63%
Sikh	0.45%
Other	0.19%
No Religion	16.02%
Not Stated	7.84%

Source: Newcastle upon Tyne Joint Strategic Needs Assessment (2009)

In addition, Gateshead has a large Orthodox Jewish community, also located in Bensham and Saltwell. These two wards became home to what is now one of the largest orthodox Jewish education complexes in post-war Europe following the destruction of many centres of Jewish scholarship during World War Two⁴².

⁴²Gateshead Council (2006) Gateshead's Equality Strategy. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/council/strategy/EqualitiesStrategy.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

B.9.6 Education

In Gateshead the percentage of children at least 5 A* to C grade in GCSE's was 60.3% compared to England average of 58.4%⁴³. Newcastle has a value of 52.6% almost 6% lower than the England average⁴⁴.

Table B.8 Key Education Data, 2010/11

Health Indicator	Newcastle	Gateshead	England Worst	England Average	NorthEast England Average
% at Key Stage 4 achieving the equivalent of 5+ A* to C at GCSE (including English and Maths) ⁴⁵	52.6	60.3	40.1	58.4	56.8
% aged 16+ qualified to degree level or above (level 4 qualifications and above) ⁴⁶	27.2	21.5	14.2	27.4	22.2

Further regional equalities and diversity information can be found in "Equality and Diversity in the North East: a Statistical Profile"⁴.

⁴³ Association of Public Health Authorities (2012) Gateshead Health Profile. Available at: http://www.apho.org.uk/resource/view.aspx?QN=HP_RESULTS&GEOGRAPHY=C2 Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁴⁴ Association of Public Health Authorities (2012) Newcastle Health Profile. Available at: http://www.apho.org.uk/resource/view.aspx?QN=HP_RESULTS&GEOGRAPHY=C2 Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁴⁵ % at Key Stage 4, 2010/11

⁴⁶ ONS 2011 Census. Higher Education Skills and Qualifications

HOUSING AND THRIVING NEIGHBOURHOODS

In these sections the housing and community neighbourhood conditions are examined.

B.10 CURRENT POPULATION SIZE AND POPULATION PROJECTIONS

This section provides information on the current population size of Newcastle City and Gateshead Borough Council's, and uses Office for National Statistics (ONS) for projections up until 2023.

From the 2011 Census, the population of Newcastle city is 280,177⁴⁷, an approximate 3% increase from the 2007 mid-year estimate of 271,300²². According to Office for National Statistics (ONS) projections, the total population is set to grow at a steady rate over the next 3 to 5 years. 2010-based population projections anticipated a rise to 284,000 in 2011 which is higher than actual figures indicate in the 2011 census⁴⁸. 2010-based projections anticipate a further rise of 4,000 (1.4%) from 2011 to 2016, to 288,000. These figures are based on projections that recent trends in the city, relating to the number of births and international migration, will continue.

From the 2011 Census, the population of Gateshead is 200,214⁴⁹, an approximate 4.5% increase from the 2007 mid-year estimate of 191,500⁵⁰. 2010-based population projections anticipated a rise to 193,000 in 2011 which is lower than actual figures indicate in the 2011 census. 2010-based projections anticipate a rise of 3,000 (1.5%) from 2011 to 2016, to 196,000. Again these figures are based on assumptions that current trends in population dynamics will continue. While the population is aging generally in Gateshead there are higher concentrations of older people in the rural west of the borough. Particular issues presented by this are related to access to shopping, transport and hospital services.

Both councils have a population density within the 1,000-2,499 people per sq km, the second densest band of 6⁵¹. 2011 census population figures have shown population growth in Newcastle to be lower than that projected, whereas Gateshead has shown growth greater than that projected according to 2010-based population projections.

The Policy Research Group (PRG), through close liaison with both Councils, produced a draft update for population projections in July 2013⁵². It outlines the emerging preferred scenarios for population growth, housing allocation and in-commuting in each Council.

Based on past experience planners at Gateshead Council have concluded that for the period 2010-2030 the total population will increase by 13,600 and the number of households will grow by around 9,500 due to a reducing trend in average

⁴⁷ Office for National Statistics. 2011 Census Data. Available at: <http://www.ons.gov.uk/ons/interactive/vp2-2011-census-comparator/index.html>

⁴⁸ Office for National Statistics. 2010-based subnational projections by sex and five year age groups for Local Authorities in Regions NW, NE and Y&H. Available at: <http://www.ons.gov.uk/ons/taxonomy/index.html?nscl=Sub-national+Population+Projections> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁴⁹ Office for National Statistics. 2011 Census Data. Available at: <http://www.ons.gov.uk/ons/interactive/vp2-2011-census-comparator/index.html> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁵⁰ Registrar General's Population Estimates - Office for National Statistics (updated October 2004)

⁵¹ Northumbria University (2008) Equality and Diversity in the North East, A Statistical Profile. Available at: <http://www.nerip.com/Download/1059/Equality%20in%20the%20North%20East%20-%20a%20statistical%20profile%201%20aug%20version.pdf.aspx> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁵² Policy Research Group (2013) Long Term Employment and Demographic Projections Update (Jul 2013). Available at: <http://onecorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2573879> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

household size. This trend means household numbers would grow even if there were no growth in the population. This is largely in line with the ONS 2011 baseline predictions. The in-commuting rate is also predicted to fall by around 2.3% over the 2010-2030 period, meaning more people are living in either Gateshead or Newcastle instead of commuting in which indicates an increase in sustainability and more active neighbourhoods.

Newcastle utilised the report's Demographic Projection Model (DPM) to revise the baseline figures for three main reasons:

1. Influence of international migration, namely from student numbers, is targeted to decrease (reduction of 500 persons per annum, 35% decrease);
2. Improvements in housing choice should lead to reduced net loss from local migration (some 750 persons per annum ~40% of historic level of loss); and
3. Shift from student occupation of private rental sector to dedicated student housing (windfall increase of 2,000 to housing supply).

In light of these changes, the projections for population (total increase of 36,200) and households (growth of 19,600) are slightly lower than the ONS 2011 baseline. Population growth over the 2010-2030 period is down by 2,500 while household growth is 1,400 lower.

B.11 HOUSING

Housing provision exists as an issue for Gateshead and Newcastle and the Urban Core exhibits some of these issues itself. The Housing Topic Paper for the Joint Area Action Plan identified the following key issues for housing:

The housing requirement set out in the The Plan (approximately 30,000 new homes 2010-30) will be difficult to meet: Newcastle City Centre has experienced a growth in the development of residential flats, the Government's drive to provide more sustainable communities and accommodate new housing growth has encouraged the incorporation of housing within mixed use developments in City Centres. A drawback in this approach is most residential development will be dependent on the programming of the development's lead use, whether it is offices, leisure or retail.

Some demands on sites in Newcastle City Centre are more profitable to a developer than residential as property markets change this can be seen from recent amendments to planning applications that have been submitted. Recent viability testing has concluded that residential development in Newcastle City Centre is not viable on some sites, even before any affordable housing is factored in.

The balance of the residential offer across the urban core needs to be improved to meet people's current and future aspirations and increase the population. In order to support sustainable economic growth and increase in population the urban core must deliver a housing that offers a variety of house types at different prices levels to a range of residents. Gateshead aims to provide medium/higher density homes, in an urban environment, that is attractive to families, older people, graduates etc.

B.12 THE HISTORIC ENVIRONMENT AND HERITAGE ASSETS

An overview of Historical and Cultural Designations is displayed in Figure C.1. The following table describes the heritage assets in Newcastle and Gateshead respectively:

Table B.9 Heritage Assets

Type of Heritage Asset	Newcastle	Gateshead
World Heritage Sites	1	-
Scheduled Monuments	42	16
Listed Buildings	765	236
Parks and Gardens	7	3
Historic Battlefields	1	1
Marine Heritage Sites	-	-
Conservation Areas	11	22

Source: English Heritage, Heritage North East

B.12.1 Heritage Assets of Newcastle City and Gateshead Town Centres

Newcastle City Centre has a legacy of important historic buildings and has areas of significant townscape importance including the historic core of Grainger Town and the Quayside. Four conservation areas cover a large part of the City Centre, Summerhill, Leazes, Framlington Place and Central. Within Grainger Town Area 57% of the actual addresses are listed as, or as being within, 'buildings of architectural or historic merit'. Of those, 13% are Grade I, 16% Grade II* and the remaining 71% are Grade II listed⁵³. The historic core of the City Centre and line of Hadrian's Wall, ditch and vallum are identified in the former UDP as being 'Areas of known or Potential Archaeological Importance.' There are 5 Scheduled Ancient Monuments (SAM) of national importance in the City Centre, namely Hadrian's Wall, the Swing Bridge, the Castle Garth, Blackfriars and the Town Wall⁵.

Hadrian's Wall was inscribed as a World Heritage Site in 1987, meeting three of the UNESCO criteria as:

- Bearing an outstanding testimony to a past civilisation;
- Being an outstanding example of a building and technology which illustrates a significant stage in human history; and
- Being an outstanding example of landuse which is representative of a culture.

It now forms part of the UNESCO World Heritage Site of the "Frontiers of the Roman Empire", which also includes two sections in Germany and the Antonine Wall in Scotland⁵⁴. Hadrian's Wall is protected by a management plan which is available at: <http://www.hadrianswallheritage.co.uk/page.aspx//Managing-the-World-Heritage-Site/Management-Plan>.

There are historic buildings throughout Gateshead town centre area but concentrated in, although not exclusive to, the Old Town Hall and associated buildings within the Bridges Conservation Area and, on the western side of the town centre, Regent and Walker Terrace Conservation Area. Uses that are compatible with old buildings and guarantee their long-term care and maintenance will need to be encouraged⁶.

⁵³ Durham University (2010) Sustaining Regeneration, Grainger Town Review 2010

⁵⁴ UNESCO Website. Available at <http://whc.unesco.org/en/list/430> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

Full records of the heritage assets for Gateshead and Newcastle can be found at <http://www.twositelines.info> which holds the historic environment record for Tyne and Wear.

B.12.2 Conservation Areas

Conservation areas are places designated for their special architectural and historic interest. There are 11 conservation areas in Newcastle:

- Central
- Summerhill
- Leazes
- Framlington Place
- Brandling Village
- Northumberland Gardens
- South Jesmond
- Jesmond Dene
- St Nicholas Hospital
- Lower Ouseburn Valley
- Gosforth

There are 22 conservation areas in Gateshead:

- Axwell Park
- Bradley Park
- Clara Vale
- Gibside
- Lowfell
- Ravensworth
- Saltwell
- Whickham
- Birtley
- Bridges (Gateshead)
- Coatsworth
- Lamesley
- Marley Hill
- Rowlands
- Sheriff Hill
- Blaydon Bank
- Chowdene
- Crowhall (Felling)
- Lintzford
- Path Head
- Ryton
- Walker Terrace/ Regent Street (Gateshead)

B.12.3 Heritage Assets at Risk

There are a number of heritage assets in Gateshead and Newcastle that are recorded on English Heritage's Heritage at Risk register. The following table describes these interests:

Table B.10 Heritage at Risk

Name	Location and Details	Risk
Newcastle		
The Keelmen's Hospital	City Road Designation: Listed Building Grade II* Condition: Poor Occupancy: Vacant Priority: C (C) Ownership: Local authority	Almshouses constructed in 1701 for keelmen and keelmen's widows. The building was last used as student accommodation but is now vacant and disused. There are signs of water ingress and the building is a target for vandalism.
West Front of Grainger Market	43 Clayton Street Designation: Listed Building Grade I, CA Condition: Poor Occupancy: Part occupied Priority: C (C) Ownership: Unknown	Shops and houses forming west front of covered market built in 1835 by John Dobson for Richard Grainger. Number 43 Clayton Street is on a corner site adjoining Number 1 Nun Street, and appears structurally sound but is in a poor state of repair, with evidence of stone damage and decay on the main facade. Ground floor in use but upper floors used for storage or vacant.
4 Eldon Square	4 Eldon Square Designation: Listed Building Grade II* Condition: Poor Occupancy: Part occupied Priority: C (C) Ownership: Local authority	Four-storey town house built 1825-31 by Thomas Oliver and John Dobson for Richard Grainger (one of his earliest enterprises and preludes his ambitious remodeling of Newcastle's town centre, which began in 1834). Last occupied as shops but now largely disused. The vacant nature of the building makes it highly vulnerable and there are signs of a lack of maintenance.
5-13 Grey Street	5-13 Grey Street Designation: Listed Building Grade II*, CA Condition: Poor Occupancy: Part occupied Priority: C (C) Ownership: Private	Four-storey shops and houses (now offices) built circa 1835, probably by John Wardle for Richard Grainger. The property is now largely vacant and starting to show signs of a lack of maintenance; including extensive water-staining below the top cornice of the front elevation.
55 and 57 Westgate Road	55 and 57 Westgate Road Designation: Listed Building Grade II*, CA Condition: Good Occupancy: Vacant Priority: E (E) Ownership: Private	House of circa 1750 which was an art shop before becoming vacant. The interior, which contains high-quality plasterwork, needed restoration and repair after some vandalism and neglect. English Heritage offered a grant towards a package of urgent repair works that commenced in 2008 and were completed in 2009. However, no end use has been identified for the building, which remains vacant.
1-17 Bolam Coyne, Byker	1-17 Bolam Coyne, Byker Designation: Listed Building Grade II* Condition: Poor Occupancy: Vacant Priority: A (A) Ownership: Housing Association	Block of flats and houses built 1976-78 to design by Ralph Erskine and widely regarded as one of the most imaginative and remarkable single developments within the Byker Estate. The complex has been vacant for many years and is a consistent target for vandalism. There are areas of water ingress.

Name	Location and Details	Risk
Woolsington Hall	Woolsington Designation: Listed Grade II*, RPG Grade II Condition: Very bad Occupancy: Vacant Ownership: Company	A compact late C17 country house, with later additions. Has service buildings, all set in fine gardens and parkland. House is vacant and showing signs of roof failure. In need of urgent repair
Dewley Hill round barrow and associated features	Designation: Scheduled Monument Condition: Generally unsatisfactory with major localised problems Trend: Declining	Principal Vulnerability: Extensive animal burrowing
Newcastle and Gateshead		
Battle of Newburn Ford,	Ryton / Newburn Designation: Registered Battlefield Trend: Stable Ownership: Private	The Battle of Newburn Ford (1640) was the only battle of the Second Bishops War. The Scottish Army took Newcastle by defeating the English at this river crossing rather than attacking the northern defences of the city. The effect of the Scottish campaign was to force Charles I to raise an army against them and after the loss of Newcastle, to pay them off. This expense spelt the end for Charles' period of rule without Parliament and proved to be a critical step towards the English Civil War. The battlefield has been subject to piecemeal, peripheral development
Gateshead		
Bowes Railway Incline	Birtley Designation: Scheduled Monument Condition: Poor Occupancy: Not applicable Ownership: Local authority	Part of 1826 Stephenson rope-hauled colliery railway. Suffering from severe erosion and loss of track bed. The Black Fell Hauler House is vacant and is suffering from extensive vandalism, both externally and internally. The Wardley Locomotive Shed suffered storm-damage in 2005 and emergency repairs were completed in 2006 but it remains particularly vulnerable.
Dunston Staiths	Dunston Designation: Listed Grade II, SM Condition: Poor Occupancy: Not applicable Ownership: Trust	Built by the North Eastern Railway Company and opened in 1893. Closed in the 1970s after being the last working staiths on the River Tyne. Serious fire damage in November 2003 resulted in 8% of the monument being lost. A conservation plan and feasibility study to identify a future for the structure were completed in 2006. Work is now underway to develop a repair scheme and provide public access to the staiths

Name	Location and Details	Risk
Ravensworth Castle (Nash House)	Lamesley Designation: Listed Grade II*, CA Condition: Very bad Occupancy: Not applicable Ownership: Private	Nash house of 1808 for Sir Thomas Liddell. House completed in 1846 but now a ruin with only one remaining upstanding tower at the north end. Immediately adjacent to Ravensworth Castle (scheduled monument).
Ravensworth Castle	Cross Lane, Lamesley Designation: Listed Grade II*, SM, CA Condition: Very bad Occupancy: Not applicable Ownership: Private	Medieval castle of which two C14 corner towers and part of curtain wall survive. Later modifications include major C19 house by Nash and stable block. House largely demolished in the 1950s; remaining fragments in poor condition. Stables more complete, but roofless and in very bad condition. Feasibility study for re-use of stables, consolidation of castle and house prepared by North of England Civic Trust.
Gibside Hall	Gibside Estate, Rowlands Gill, Whickham Designation: Listed Grade II*, SM, CA, RPG Grade I Condition: Very bad Occupancy: Vacant Ownership: Trust	Large house/hall, 1603-20, enlarged C18 and altered early C19. Fell into disrepair in early C20 and now a roofless shell in poor condition. Set in early/mid C18 park. Building requires major stabilisation and consolidation works. The National Trust has undertaken works to improve public access to the immediate setting of the building but there remains a huge amount of remedial work to do on the actual building.
Whinfield Coking Ovens,	South east of Low Spen Farm, Whickham Designation: Scheduled Monument Condition: Poor Occupancy: Vacant Ownership: Trust	Remains of what was originally a bank of 193 bee hive coke ovens dating back to the mid-C19. Part of an extensive former mining landscape that is now largely cleared and landscaped. The remaining ovens represent a rare example of intact bee hive coke ovens. Currently under severe attack by vandals. Initial repairs carried out in 2003 but further works are required.
Coal mining remains at Dunston Hil	Designation: Scheduled Monument (No. 30928) Condition: Generally satisfactory but with significant localised problems Trend: Declining	Principal Vulnerability: Road construction
Site of Ravensworth coalmill, 600m north east of Ravensworth Castle	Designation: Scheduled Monument (No. 21662) Condition: Generally satisfactory but with significant localised problems Trend: Unknown Ownership: Private	Principal Vulnerability: Scrub / tree growth

Name	Location and Details	Risk
Washingwells Roman fort, Whickham	Designation: Scheduled Monument (No. 32057) Condition: Extensive significant problems i.e. under plough, collapse Trend: Declining	Principal Vulnerability: Arable ploughing
Ravensworth	Designation: Conservation Area Condition: Very bad Trend: Expected to show some improvement	Vulnerability: Medium

Source: *The Heritage at Risk Register, English Heritage, North East Region. 2010 Register*

STRONG AND INCLUSIVE COMMUNITIES

The baseline for Strong and Inclusive Communities is provided using housing standards; homelessness; crime and anti-social behaviour levels; electoral turnout; overcrowding and affordability; multiple deprivation and social exclusion.

B.13 HOUSING STANDARDS

In Newcastle upon Tyne over a quarter (27%) of all private sector households and nearly a half (47%) of private rented households are estimated to live in fuel poverty⁵⁵. Overall, 37% of private housing and 80% of Council homes do not meet the Government's minimum standard (the Decent Home Standard) and a significant programme of investment is under way to address this.

The Gateshead Housing Needs Survey (2006) states that analysis of survey information indicates that a total of 2,248 or 2.6% of existing households in Gateshead are in housing need (as at January 2006) and wanting to move to offset that need. Of these households, 750 are currently living in affordable (i.e. social rented) housing and 1,498 are living in other tenures⁵⁶.

B.14 HOMELESSNESS

The number of homeless acceptances is higher in Gateshead than Newcastle, Gateshead figure is 0.9% of the homeless acceptances for England as a whole, whereas Newcastle is 0.8% of the English total. Table B.11 summarises this information.

Table B.11 Homelessness Trends

Location	Homeless Acceptances	Average Temporary Accommodation Use Per Night	Temporary Accommodation Use per 1,000 Households Per Night
Gateshead	648	13	0.2
Newcastle upon Tyne	564	54	0.5
North East	4,790	595	0.5
England	73,360	91,803	4.4

Source: DCLG Statutory Homeless Statistics 2006/7

B.15 CRIME AND ANTI-SOCIAL BEHAVIOUR

Newcastle

Anti-social behaviour is a key concern for those who live and work in Newcastle. Anti-social behaviour can take many forms including noise nuisance, dumping rubbish, verbal abuse and harassment. At its most serious and persistent it can ruin the quality of lives for individuals, families and communities. Since 2004 the number of anti-social behaviour incidents reported to the police and other organisations has increased. For instance the number of anti-social behaviour-related incidents reported to the police increased from 55,147 in 2005 to 65,649 in 2007. In Newcastle the most common types of anti-social behaviour are noise, youth and alcohol-related disorder, harassment and vehicle-related disorder. In 2009 there were 2041 early intervention warnings for anti-social behaviour.

Newcastle City Council has a statutory partnership set up called "Safe Newcastle", made up of the Council, the police and fire services and Newcastle Primary Care Trust. The Government requires Safe Newcastle to develop a separate Anti-

⁵⁵Newcastle City Council (2006) Newcastle City Housing Strategy (2006-2021)

⁵⁶Gateshead Council (2006) Gateshead 2006 Housing Needs and Support Survey. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/housing/Leaflets/housingneedsresearchoct06.pdf> Accessed on 1st Feb 2013

Social Behaviour Strategy. This Strategy states Newcastle's commitment to support communities in tackling anti-social behaviour. The Strategy will direct partners working with residents to strengthen and develop social and community networks and deliver services that build strong communities. These networks and services enable people from different backgrounds to develop strong and positive relationships and respect each other⁵⁷.

Gateshead

Between 2008 and 2009 there was a 17% fall in the number of reported Anti-Social Behaviour incidents within the Gateshead borough; with youth- related Anti-Social Behaviour decreasing by 26%. The perception level of Anti-Social Behaviour (being a big problem in Gateshead) has remained stable.

The majority of Anti-Social Behaviour issues continue to relate to Rowdy and Inconsiderate Behaviour – despite incidents falling by over a fifth (22%) on last year; although the number of Anti-Social Behaviour issues linked to Noise and Nuisance Neighbours increased collectively by 8%⁵⁸. Safer Gateshead is a dedicated team from the Council, police and fire services and Gateshead Primary Care Trust working across the borough. The partnership reported that in 2008-2009 police incidents of Anti-Social Behaviour decreased by 24%. There was a decrease of 11% of Place Survey respondents who thought ASB was a problem in their local area⁵⁹.

The following table presents the reported crime incidents for various offences in Newcastle and Gateshead against the English average:

Table B.12

Incident Type	Newcastle upon Tyne Council ⁶⁰	Gateshead Council ⁶⁰	English Average
Violence Against the person	18.1	11.4	15.0
Sexual Offences	0.8	0.7	0.9
Robbery Offences	1.0	0.4	1.0
Burglary Dwelling Offences	6.1	3.7	4.3
Theft of Motor Vehicle Offences	2.5	2.0	2.3
Theft From a Vehicle Offences	7.7	6.8	6.3

Source: Home Office 2008/2009

19% of respondents to the Gateshead Place Survey felt that anti-social behaviour was a problem in the area. This was a decrease from the 2006 score of 30% and just below the English average of 20%⁶⁷. In the Newcastle Place Survey 30% of respondents agreed that the police and other public services are successfully dealing with anti-social behaviour in the area, whereas 21% disagreed with this statement⁶⁶. Within Gateshead 32.5% agreed that police and other public services are successfully dealing with anti-social behaviour in the area⁶⁷.

⁵⁷ Safe Newcastle (2008) Safe Newcastle Strategy 2008-2011. Available at: [http://www2.newcastle.gov.uk/www/fileroot/safenewcastle/SafeNewCastlestrategy_2008_to_2011.pdf](http://www2.newcastle.gov.uk/www/fileroot/safenewcastle/SafeNewcastlestrategy_2008_to_2011.pdf) Accessed on 22 August 2013

⁵⁸ Safer Gateshead Partnership Plan 2010 Refresh

⁵⁹ Safer Gateshead (2009) Safer Gateshead Partnership Plan. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/People/Strategies/communitysafety/PartnershipPlan.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁶⁰ Crime statistic per 1000 of the Population within the Area

In Newcastle 24% felt that people using or dealing drugs was a fairly big problem in the area⁶¹. The figure for Gateshead was considerably higher at 59.0% who felt that drug use and dealing was a problem and the English average was 30.5%⁶⁷.

B.16 ELECTORAL TURNOUT

The electoral turnout for the general election of 2005 for Gateshead East and Washington West was 56.4%, whereas Newcastle upon Tyne Central was 57.3%, Newcastle upon Tyne East and Wallsend was 55.7% and Newcastle upon Tyne North was 59.5%⁶¹. The Percentage turn out for England as a whole was 61.3% therefore Gateshead and Newcastle Councils were both below the English average.

B.17 MULTIPLE DEPRIVATION AND SOCIAL EXCLUSION

Newcastle has 43 Super Output Areas (out of 173) in the most deprived 10% of Super Output Areas in England. Therefore, the index illustrates Newcastle upon Tyne as a relatively deprived City. However, it remains important to note that the City has become less deprived since the equivalent index was produced in 2004, when 53 Super Output Areas were in the 10% most deprived.

Within Newcastle it is evident from the index that some areas of the City are considerably more deprived than others. Traditionally deprived areas include the East and West ends of the City, which fall almost completely within the 10% most deprived areas in England. However, there are also other pockets of deprivation within the City which fall into the 10% most deprived super output areas in England. These include parts of the Fawdon, Kenton and Blakelaw wards as well as small sectors of Denton, Woolsington and Newburn wards. Conversely, other parts of the City are significantly less deprived. The majority of Dene, East Gosforth, North Jesmond, Parklands and West Gosforth fall within the least deprived group (50-100% range)⁶².

There are 126 SOA's in Gateshead, 22 of which fall within the top 10% of most deprived areas nationally, this equates to 33,300 or 17.5% of Gateshead residents. Extending this to the top 20% of deprived SOA's this figure rises to 66,300 people or 35% of residents. The overall picture is positive however with improvements evident between 2004 and 2007. Gateshead's IMD rank has improved from 26th in 2004 to 52nd in 2007 – a rank of 1 representing the highest level of deprivation nationally⁶³.

The life expectancy in Gateshead is still below the national average despite trend increases, due to health in deprived areas improving more slowly than in affluent boroughs therefore the gap between poor and affluent areas is increasing⁶⁴. A large area of the Newcastle proportion of the Urban Core falls within the top 20% most deprived areas in the country in the 2007 index of multiple deprivation⁶⁵. There is a smaller proportion that falls within the top 10% most deprived areas in the country, where the Ouseburn quarter meets Byker area.

⁶¹ UK Political Info. Available at: <http://www.ukpolitical.info/Turnout05.htm> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁶² Newcastle Primary Care Trust (2011) Pharmaceutical Needs Assessment. Available at: <http://www.newcastlepct.nhs.uk/publications/publications-files/NPCT%20PNA%202011.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁶³ Gateshead Council (2008) Gateshead Council UDP Annual Monitoring Report 2007-2008. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/Building/Strategies/AMR/AMR2007-2008.pdf> Accessed on 1 Feb 2010

⁶⁴ Personal communication with Gateshead Council (19.02.10)

⁶⁵ Communities and Local Government (2007) Index of Multiple Deprivation. Available at: <http://webarchive.nationalarchives.gov.uk/+http://www.communities.gov.uk/communities/neighbourhoodrenewal/deprivation/deprivation07/> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

A large proportion of Gateshead component of the Urban Core falls into the category of within the 10% most deprived areas in the country⁶⁵.

B.18 RESIDENT SATISFACTION

There has been an increase in the proportion of residents satisfied with their local area as a place to live in Newcastle, rising from 76% in 2006/7 to 79% in 2008/9. 86% of respondents were satisfied with their home as a place to live and 52% felt strongly that they belonged to their neighbourhood. However, Newcastle in comparison to the other metropolitan authorities was in the bottom quartile for 'people who feel they belong to the neighbourhood'⁶⁶.

There has been an increase from 67% to 81.3% in resident satisfaction with their local area to live in Gateshead from 2006/7 to 2008/9. This figure was just above the England average of 79.7%. In Gateshead 86.2% of residents 65 years of age or older were satisfied with both their home and neighbourhood, which was above the English average of 83.9%⁶⁷.

Statistics for the North East region on housing and thriving neighbourhoods can be found in "Equality and Diversity in the North East: a Statistical Profile"⁷⁴.

⁶⁶ Newcastle City Council (2009) The 2008/9 Newcastle Place and Residents' Surveys. Available at: [http://www2.newcastle.gov.uk/condiary.nsf/all/79B7E1D37534B2F1802574D30048393C/\\$FILE/FINAL%20REPORT%202008-09%20_Place%20Survey%20&%20Residents%20Survey.pdf](http://www2.newcastle.gov.uk/condiary.nsf/all/79B7E1D37534B2F1802574D30048393C/$FILE/FINAL%20REPORT%202008-09%20_Place%20Survey%20&%20Residents%20Survey.pdf) Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁶⁷ Gateshead Council (2009) Place Survey 2008, Background and Summary of Results. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/council/strategy/PlaceSurvey2008Nireultsforwebsite.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

SUSTAINABLE QUALITY OF PLACE (INCLUDING ENVIRONMENTAL QUALITY)

The following sections examine the environmental conditions of the area including place, biodiversity, the green network, water quality, flooding, air quality, historic and cultural heritage and landscape.

B.19 PLACE

The Topic Paper for Place for the Joint Area Action Plan identifies the following key issues:

There are a growing number of vacant, underused sites and buildings, many of which are showing signs of neglect: In Newcastle large areas of vacant land, such as Science Central site and Forth Yard are predominately located in the Discovery area. There are also smaller derelict sites located throughout Newcastle including sites in the Ouseburn, East Pilgrim Street and in the Stephenson Quarter.

Parts of Gateshead Town Centre suffer due to large areas of vacant land such as sites along Askew Road, areas of High Street and much of the Town Centre. Other cleared areas form part of redevelopment sites that either haven't commenced or are in early phases such as the Freight Depot site and parts of Baltic Business Quarter. High Street South is notable due to the poor condition and physical appearance of many of its buildings and sites cleared through demolition as part of site assembly programmes.

There are buildings that do not respond positively to their context: Although Newcastle has retained many of its historic buildings and street pattern, there are many examples of poor quality buildings which have a negative impact on the character of streets as they pay little regard to the surrounding streetscape. Similarly in Gateshead some buildings and structures have a particularly damaging impact on the townscape and visual amenity.

There is a shortfall in green spaces and public open spaces and those that are not wholly fit for purpose, linked or accessible: Newcastle City is lacking in areas within:

- 5 minutes of a green space over 0.1ha;
- 10 minutes walk of a green space over 2ha;
- 15 minutes walk of a local park over 6ha;
- 20 minutes walk of a local park over 10ha; and
- 15 minutes walk of allotments.

The areas identified as being deficient in green spaces are in existing built up areas and former industrial areas. Similarly Gateshead lacks easily accessible usable green space in the town centre.

There are areas of poor quality public realm: There are many more examples of poor quality streets and spaces that are poorly linked with the surrounding area. Percy Street has been identified as a key pedestrian route, however it is an area dominated by traffic and the excessive guardrail prevents east / west movement. It also contains large areas of inactive frontage and a major service entrance to Eldon Square Shopping Centre, all of which contribute to the poor pedestrian environment. The Quayside, west of the Swing Bridge is an area that requires regular maintenance with much of the street furniture and footway surfacing in

poor condition. There are examples of physically damaged bins and seats and also of where tarmac has been used for repairs on paving damaged by tree roots. Within Gateshead there are many grassed areas which are just 'left over' verge areas from the large, heavily engineered highway schemes of the past.

Gateways to the action plan area are poorly defined; and clearance, insensitive redevelopment over time and highway infrastructure has resulted in areas of fragmented urban fabric: There is a need to define the edge of the action plan area and the respective areas to help people feel they have "entered" the City and town and to help them navigate their way around.

B.20 BIODIVERSITY

In this section the protected sites, local biodiversity action plans, areas of woodland and green network are described.

B.20.1 Protected Sites

There are 2 key sites of international importance; Durham Coast (SAC) and Northumbria Coast (SPA and Ramsar); and 12 sites of national importance. The distribution of Natural Heritage Sites is shown in Table B.13.

Table B.13 Designated Sites

Site Name	Importance	Features
Site of International Importance		
Durham Coast SAC	SACs	Durham Coast is the only example of vegetated sea cliffs on magnesian limestone exposures in the UK. Vegetation is unique in the British Isles and consists of a complex mosaic of paramaritime, mesotrophic and calcicolous grasslands, tall-herb fen, seepage flushes and wind pruned scrub.
Northumbria Coast	SPA and Ramsar Site	1.7% of the GB breeding population of Little tern <i>Sterna albifrons</i> 2.6% of the East Atlantic Flyway population of Turnstone <i>Arenaria interpres</i> 1.6 % of the East Atlantic Flyway population of Purple sandpiper <i>Calidris maritime</i> Ramsar criterion 6 – species/populations of the above species occurring at levels of international importance
Site of National Importance		
Big Waters	SSSI	Large body of open water fringed by reedswamp and associated fen, backed by areas of herb-rich damp grassland and old ridge and furrow pasture. Important roost for migratory swallows and supports wintering wildfowl.
Brenkley Meadows	SSSI	An important representative of a grassland type now scarce in Northumbria due to drainage and agricultural intensification. Supports a number of breeding bird species.

Site Name	Importance	Features
Gosforth Park	SSSI	Contains a shallow man-made lake with associated reedswamp, herb-rich fen, willow carr, broad-leaved woodland and remnants of heathy grassland. It provides a valuable refuge for wildlife on the northern fringe of the Tyneside conurbation and is of importance for the invertebrate populations it supports and because it includes the largest reedbed in the east Northumberland area.
Hallow Hill	SSSI	The steep south-facing slope of Hallow Hill supports remnants of flushed neutral grassland, merging into tall, fen vegetation towards the base of the slope. These communities were excluded from a short period of arable production over the rest of the site, which has, more recently, been reseeded with a special grassland mix with a view to encouraging a herb-rich sward to develop.
Pockerley Farm Pond	SSSI	Pockerley Farm Pond comprises a small body of open-water surrounded by tall fen, damp grassland and, locally, willow scrub. It is thought to have formed as a result of mining subsidence. It is the most important amphibian site within the counties of Durham and Tyne and Wear, and supports large populations of spawning frogs and toads, as well as all three British species of newt, smooth, palmate and great crested
Prestwick Carr	SSSI	Prestwick Carr, part of a low lying peat basin to the north west of Newcastle, supports a variety of wetland habitats including tall fen, carr woodland and a raised mire which is now located within a coniferous plantation.
Causey Bank Mires	SSSI	The site identified as Causey Bank Mires comprises a series of species-rich flushes with scrub in acid and neutral grassland, a habitat of restricted distribution in County Durham. The site supports a number of locally rare species.
Ridley Gill	SSSI	Ridley Gill is a long narrow valley supporting three types of deciduous woodland.
Gibside	SSSI	Gibside, a landscaped estate established in the late eighteenth century, is now of considerable conservation interest because of the important assemblages of amphibia, reptiles and invertebrates which it supports. It is one of the best herpetological sites between the Tees and the Scottish border being important for five species of amphibian and four species of reptile, including a viable population of grass snakes. An interesting and diverse invertebrate fauna has also been well recorded at Gibside and abandoned buildings provide roosts for bats.

Site Name	Importance	Features
Thornley Wood	SSSI	Thornley Wood is one of the few remaining areas of semi-natural woodland in the Lower Derwent Valley and is representative of a type widespread in the Durham coalfield, though many examples have been heavily modified by management practices including planting of conifers.
Shibdon Pond	SSSI	Shibdon Pond is one of few large open water sites between the Tyne and Tees, and is important as a wetland habitat within the industrial conurbation of Tyneside. It is thought that mining subsidence led to the formation of the pond, which is fed by a spring issuing from old mine workings. The pond is fringed by extensive reedswamp with associated tall fen, willow scrub, damp grassland, dry grassland and hawthorn scrub.
Strother Hills	SSSI	The shallow valley on the southern side of Strother Hills supports wet alder woodland, with associated flush plant communities and dry acidic woodland, of a type which is uncommon in North East England.
Ryton Willows	SSSI	The site known as Ryton Willows includes three ponds. The Gut is believed to occupy part of an old meander of the River Tyne, whilst the Curling Pond and Glebe Pond occupy flooded borrow-pits which date from the construction of the Newcastle-Carlisle railway. They represent one of the few open-water sites in Tyne and Wear/eastern Durham and support associated wetland habitats of reedswamp, tall fen and alder/willow carr.
Hallow Hill	SSSI	The steep south-facing slope of Hallow Hill supports remnants of flushed neutral grassland, merging into tall, fen vegetation towards the base of the slope. These communities were excluded from a short period of arable production over the rest of the site, which has, more recently, been reseeded with a special grassland mix with a view to encouraging a herb-rich sward to develop.
Lower Derwent Meadows	SSSI	Two meadows beside the River Derwent support plant communities of unimproved acid-neutral grassland with associated flush, pond scrub and bankside vegetation. Traditional management for hay production followed by winter grazing has maintained a herb-rich sward.

Source: Natural England, Available at:

<http://www.naturalengland.org.uk/ourwork/conservation/designatedareas/default.aspx>

The following table demonstrates the condition of SSSI's in the Gateshead and Newcastle region:

Table B.14 SSSI Sites at Risk in Gateshead and Newcastle

District	SSSI Name	Main Habitat	Condition
Newcastle Upon Tyne	Big Waters	Standing open water and canals	Unfavourable recovering
Newcastle Upon Tyne	Brenkley Meadows	Neutral grassland - lowland	Unfavourable recovering
Gateshead	Gibside	Broadleaved, mixed and yew woodland - lowland	Unfavourable recovering
Newcastle Upon Tyne	Hallow Hill	Neutral grassland - lowland	Unfavourable recovering
Gateshead	Lower Derwent Meadows	Neutral grassland - lowland	Favourable
Gateshead	Pockerley Farm Pond	Fen, marsh and swamp - lowland	Unfavourable declining
Newcastle Upon Tyne	Prestwick Carr	Fen, marsh and swamp - lowland	Favourable
Newcastle Upon Tyne	Prestwick Carr	Bogs - lowland	Unfavourable declining
Gateshead	Ridley Gill	Broadleaved, mixed and yew woodland - lowland	Favourable
Gateshead	Ryton Willows	Standing open water and canals	Unfavourable recovering
Gateshead	Shibdon Pond	Standing open water and canals	Favourable
Gateshead	Strother Hills	Broadleaved, mixed and yew woodland - lowland	Favourable
Gateshead	Thornley Wood	Broadleaved, mixed and yew woodland - lowland	Favourable

Source: Natural England, Sites of Special Scientific Interest Reports and Statistics (2011)

B.20.2 Local Biodiversity

Newcastle Council has its own biodiversity action plan (LBAP) “Your Wildlife – The Newcastle Biodiversity Action Plan 2001”. The Biodiversity Action Plan⁶⁸ includes species action plans for:

- Red squirrel (*Sciurus vulgaris*)
- Otter (*Lutra lutra*)
- Brown hare (*Lepus europeus*)
- Great crested newt (*Triturus cristatus*)
- Barn owl (*Tyto alba*)
- Skylark (*Alauda arvensis*)
- Song thrush (*Turdus philomelos*)
- Grey partridge (*Perdix perdix*)
- Tree sparrow (*Passer montanus*)

And Habitat action plans for:

- Dene Woodland
- Gardens And Allotments
- Scrub, Shrub And Hedgerows
- Industrial Land
- Man-Made Structures
- Lowland Raised Mire
- Parkland
- Parks, Open Space And Roadside Verges
- Ponds And Lakes

The Gateshead area is included in the Durham LBAP⁶⁹. This is an extensive biodiversity action plan covering Darlington Borough, Durham County, Gateshead, South Tyneside and Sunderland Borough Council. It therefore covers many habitat and species plans for the different areas. The main species action plans for:

- 12 mammal Plans
- 19 bird Plans
- 5 herpetile Plans
- 3 fish plans
- 15 invertebrate plans
- 4 plant plans

And habitat action plans for the major areas of:

- 8 woodland habitats
- 6 wetland habitats
- 7 upland habitats
- 11 lowland habitats

Gateshead Council was a partner in the successful “Northern Kites Project” which brought the red kite back to the North East of England. The main kite watching area is Lower Derwent Valley Gateshead and the kites can also be seen at the other Gateshead sites of Barlow and Barlow Fell, Derwent Walk Country Park, Gibside Estate and Sherburn Towers Estate Viewpoint, Rowlands Gill.

⁶⁸ Newcastle City Council (2001) Your Wildlife, Newcastle Biodiversity Action Plan

⁶⁹ Durham Biodiversity Partnership (2007) Durham Biodiversity Action Plan

In Gateshead of the 8 Sites of Special Scientific Interest 4 are managed by the Council. There are also 13 designated Local Nature Reserves, a United Nations Man and the Biosphere site and over 100 Sites of Nature Conservation Importance (now called Local Wildlife Sites over 20% of which are managed by the Council).

The Council is actively involved in nature conservation through a number of measures. Firstly the Council cares for over 20 Nature Reserves across the Borough and actively manages and monitors these sites to conserve and encourage opportunities for wildlife.

The Council is also involved directly in a number of habitat creation projects which aim to help wildlife. A good example of this is the creation of new sites such as Lamesley Pastures and Burdon Moor and a major project to help otters to expand their range in Gateshead by providing additional habitats, artificial holts and safe crossing points under road bridges⁷⁰.

Climate Change and Biodiversity

Gateshead and Newcastle's biodiversity will be affected by climate change and such changes will need to be recognised in how biodiversity is managed. Natural England, operates large number of long-term wildlife monitoring schemes that have provided crucial evidence for the effects of climate change⁷¹.

Examples include:

- Earlier laying dates of many of our common birds and spawning dates of amphibians (frogs, toads and newts).
- Earlier arrival and later departure dates of migrant birds.
- Earlier appearance of butterflies in spring.
- Earlier leafing and flowering dates of many trees, shrubs and flowering plants.
- Later leaf-fall of many broadleaved trees in autumn.
- Earlier appearance of mushrooms and toadstools in the autumn.

B.20.3 Areas of Woodland

Newcastle City Council has produced a trees, hedges and woodland strategy⁷². This strategy has the 3 key aims of "protecting the existing trees, caring for them and planting more trees". The progress report noted that in 2008 14,218 trees were planted at 2 of the city's countryside sites. The council have a dedicated tree team which inspect and maintain council tree stock and have completed a revised action plan for 2008-2012.

Within the Gateshead borough, 60% of the land area is rural in character and much of this is an attractive mixture of farmland and woodland. The woodland component is particularly significant, as Gateshead contains two thirds of the woodland in Tyne and Wear. This is not only valuable in the landscape and for recreation but the deciduous woodland along the banks of rivers and streams is also important for its very considerable wildlife interest⁷³.

⁷⁰ www.gateshead.gov.uk

⁷¹ Natural England (2010) How is climate change affecting England's natural environment? Available at: <http://www.naturalengland.org.uk/ourwork/climateandenergy/climatechange/vulnerability/effectonnaturalenvironment.aspx> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁷² Newcastle City Council (2002) Newcastle Tree Policy

⁷³ Gateshead Council (2003) Countryside Strategy. Available at:

<http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/Leisure/Strategies/countrysidestrat.pdf> Accessed 7 Feb 2011

A new initiative launched to run in Gateshead this winter aims to 'green' parts of the Borough by encouraging schools, community groups, residents and other organisations to get involved in planting trees. This initiative provides free sapling trees for interested parties and there are woodland grants available for landowners⁷⁴.

Chopwell Wood is a large ancient woodland on the fringe of Gateshead⁷⁵. This 360-hectare mixed woodland was designated as a Woodland Park in 1993. More recently Chopwell Wood has been recognised as a PAWS (Plantation on Ancient Woodland Site). This means it was an ancient forest but in more recent times it has been planted with modern timber crops. Most of the ancient trees, predominantly oak, were felled in the 17th and 18th century for ship and bridge building the remnants of these still survive on the steep crags above the river Derwent. The Forestry Commission now has a national policy that means that now only native trees will be planted on PAWS sites.

B.21 GREEN SPACE, GREEN INFRASTRUCTURE NETWORK AND PUBLIC REALM

Newcastle's oldest green space is the Town Moor, which has been used for centuries mainly for agriculture but also for coal mining and horse racing. Many public rights of way within Newcastle and the surrounding countryside were established centuries ago but are still in use today. Historically the "denes"- steep sided valleys with streams flowing to the Tyne – served as recreational space for the towns' population. Some have been filled in but several remain and are still used by the public. Jesmond Dene, Walbottle Dene and Sugley Dene are still valley landscapes with remnants of ancient woodland⁷⁶.

Newcastle has many Victorian and Edwardian parks and during the twentieth century the numbers of parks increased. Post World War II, Newcastle started to reclaim contaminated and infertile land abandoned by the industries of the previous century. It has been gradually restored to support trees, shrubs, grass and wildlife. Government grants supported this work, public open space and wildlife habitat being an acceptable and beneficial end use on land that was generally unsuitable for building on. Some of these sites are now our larger "countryside" style green spaces and green routes, for example, the riverside cycleway, Newburn and Walker riverside parks, Percy Pit and Havannah Local Nature Reserve. These have value for wildlife as well as people. In the last 20 years there have been a number of new green spaces created either through development, redevelopment or following demolition. There has also been investment in park improvement at Walker, Elswick and Kenton Parks. There has also been a move toward city centre renewal through partnerships, in particular Graingertown and the Quayside. For the first time in decades Newcastle has gained high quality inspiring buildings within new public spaces.

Newcastle's Green Space Strategy⁷⁶ has identified a lack of quality access to green spaces as an issue in certain localities.

⁷⁴ www.gateshead.gov.uk Accessed 27 Jan 2010

⁷⁵ Forestry Commission (2013) Chopwell Woodland Park Website. Available at: <http://www.forestry.gov.uk/website/Recreation.nsf/LUWebDocsByKey/EnglandTyneandWearNoForestChopwellWoodlandPark> Accessed on 27 Jan 2010

⁷⁶ Newcastle City Council (2003) Green Spaces... Your Spaces. Newcastle's Parks and Green Space Strategy Consultation Draft

Gateshead Council is currently developing an open space strategy, the draft version identifies the following types of green spaces which contribute to Gateshead's green network⁷⁷:

- Parks and Gardens
- Natural and semi-natural urban green spaces
- Green corridors
- Outdoor sports facilities
- Amenity Green space
- Provision for children and teenagers
- Allotments, community gardens and city farms
- Cemeteries and churchyards
- Accessible countryside in urban fringe areas
- Civic spaces

Newcastle City Centre has 2 parks; the recently refurbished Leazes Park and Exhibition/Brandling Park. The majority of City Centre spaces are small, civic spaces where the area is predominantly hard surfaced e.g. Quayside Promenade, Thornton and Times Squares, Blue Carpet, Monument area etc. Although these civic spaces have an important role to play in creating a sense of place, some areas of the City would benefit from tree planting to create attractive Boulevards⁵.

There has also been a move toward city centre renewal through partnerships, in particular Ouseburn and the Quayside. For the first time in decades Newcastle has gained high quality inspiring buildings within new public spaces⁷⁶.

The 1Plan makes the following key points about Green space in Gateshead and Newcastle:

- The quality of the public realm in Gateshead and Newcastle – streets, open spaces and parks – is generally disappointing. There are, of course, attractive and valued places. A recent audit of civic spaces in Newcastle showed that people enjoy the Quayside, Eldon Square and other spaces but dislike areas like Pilgrim Street and Manors. In Gateshead, the Council has invested in the popular Baltic Square and the spaces around the Town Hall.
- There is a strong need for urban spaces that match the best of Gateshead and Newcastle's architecture. There isn't enough comfort and tranquillity in the urban core and the quality of the public realm is mixed. Too many streets and spaces are dominated by cars and buses – even Grey Street is invaded by traffic; elsewhere, good intentions are undermined by cheap materials and poor maintenance; streetscapes are cluttered and badly managed.
- A regular complaint is the lack of quality green space. There is very little in the urban core, but a lot in the area surrounding it, including the restored Saltwell Park and Leazes Park, and the informal open spaces of Town Moor. The lack of attractive green space is one of the reasons why people have fled for the surrounding suburbs and countryside.

Gateshead and Newcastle as a Growth Point⁷⁸ is required to develop a Green Infrastructure strategy to protect and enhance key existing environmental

⁷⁷ Gateshead City Council (2006) Gateshead Draft Open Spaces Strategy

features⁷⁹. This Green Infrastructure Strategy is currently in development. Extensive information on the Green Infrastructure of the North East region is available at:

http://www.naturalengland.org.uk/regions/north_east/ourwork/green_infrastructure.aspx.

B.22 SOILS AND GEOLOGY

This section describes the general soil quality of Gateshead and Newcastle, pressures on the soil resource, contaminated land and vacant and derelict land.

B.22.1 Soil Character and Geodiversity

The nature and quality of soil within the Gateshead and Newcastle area is governed to a degree by the nature of the bedrock and drift deposits, by historical and current vegetation cover, by existing and chronological land use and by factors such as industrial activity and physical influence from engineering and development.

The bedrock below the superficial glacial deposits relates to the Coal Measures of Upper Carboniferous Age. Strata in this succession comprise principally sandstone and mudstone with widely spaced productive coal seams. This succession is generally known as the Durham Coalfield, and Gateshead is situated in a part of the coalfield where worked seams and coal can occur close to the surface⁸⁰.

Glacial deposits (clay, sand, and gravel) of variable thickness and character overlie the Coal Measures strata across the majority of the Borough. A prolific thickness of glacial material occurs in the valleys of the Tyne, Team and Derwent, whilst higher ground areas may have limited cover or a complete absence.

B.22.2 Pressures on the Soil Resource

Our soils have degraded over the last 200 years due to intensive agricultural production and industrial pollution. Soils in England continue to face three main threats:

- Soil erosion by wind and rain. Erosion affects both the productivity of soils but also water quality and aquatic ecosystems.
- Compaction of soil reduces agricultural productivity and water infiltration, and increases flood risk through higher levels of run off.
- Organic matter decline. The loss of soil organic matter reduces soil quality, affecting the supply of nutrients and making it more difficult for plants to grow, and increases emissions to the atmosphere⁸¹.

B.22.3 Contaminated Land

Historically, Gateshead's main activities have involved mining and heavy industry which have left a substantial legacy of contamination. The availability of cheap

⁷⁸ Growth Point status was awarded in July 2008 and £20m funding proposed by the Department for Communities and Local Government (DCLG) to have accelerated, additional and at the same time more sustainable housing growth.

⁷⁹ Natural England Green Infrastructure Guidance. Available at <http://www.naturalengland.org.uk/ourwork/planningtransportlocalgov/greeninfrastructure/default.aspx> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁸⁰ Gateshead Council (2013) Gateshead Contaminated Land Strategy. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/Environment/Strategies/contaminatedlandstrat.pdf> Accessed 22 Aug 2010

⁸¹ DEFRA (2009) Safeguarding our Soils a Strategy for England. Available at: <http://archive.defra.gov.uk/environment/quality/land/soil/documents/soil-strategy.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

coal gave rise to a range of industries including coke, gas and electricity production, chemical manufacture, glass production, iron and steel production, locomotive building and other heavy industry. Other industrial activities included mining and quarrying.

Within Newcastle City Council area in addition to the elements cited above, enhanced levels of lead are also recorded, particularly in the areas around former lead works. During much of Nineteenth Century Newcastle was one of the main lead processing centres of the UK. The industry developed primarily due to its proximity to the North Pennine Orefield, a major world producer of lead during the Nineteenth Century. Some enhanced lead levels may also be due to years of vehicle emissions, previous use of lead paint, lead water pipes, coal fire ash etc. Colliery waste is common within the City Council area, either as original spoil heaps or as landfill where the heaps have been remediated and used as landfill⁸².

B.23 THE WATER ENVIRONMENT

This section discusses the general water quality of Gateshead and Newcastle along with the flood risks in the region.

B.23.1 Water Quality

The regional hydrology of Gateshead is influenced primarily by the Tyne, the Derwent and the Team rivers which feed through a network of tributaries (generally known as denes) that outlet water into the main channels from higher ground catchments.

The main watercourses in the Newcastle-upon-Tyne area are the River Tyne and the Ouse Burn. The Tyne is tidal throughout the City. The quality of the tidal estuary is improving and the river supports a large population of migratory salmonids. The Ouse Burn originates at Callerton Pond and has its confluence with the River Tyne at Byker, the burn is tidal for several hundred metres. It is culverted for 665m where it passes under the City Stadium landfill site. The General Quality Assessment (GCA) shows the burn to be C (fair). There are many smaller culverted streams flowing under the City, some of these are combined with sewer systems, others discharge into the River Tyne. Examples of these burns are Pandon Burn, Skinner Burn, Lort Burn.

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⁸² Newcastle City Council (2006) Inspection Strategy for Contaminated Land. Available at: http://www.newcastle.gov.uk/wwwfileroot/legacy/regen/phep/Cont_Land_Strategy_July_2006.pdf Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

Within Newcastle upon Tyne there are no groundwater abstractions within the area used for drinking water supplies, and therefore no Groundwater Protection Zones have been made by the Environment Agency. There are two ground water abstractions for industrial use in the north of the area at Brunswick Village and North Gosforth.

Newcastle City Council's Inspection Strategy for Contaminated Land states that the ground water level in the coal measures has not yet recovered to its natural state, following the cessation of the Coal Authority's Minewater Pumping 16 Programme. Groundwater levels are currently rising and it is not known what their eventual level will be. Rising groundwaters could result in the emergence of potentially polluted minewater outlets in the area, or increased flow in the existing outfalls.

As part of the joint Core Strategy a Water Cycle Study and Surface Water Management Plan have been commissioned by Gateshead and Newcastle in order to provide a sound evidence base for formulating policies that relate to water quality.

The Environment Agency have prepared "The River Basin Management Plan" for Northumbria River Basin District. The Plan looks at pressures facing the water environment in the river basin district and the actions which will address them, providing a more detailed overview of the water environment in the wider Northumbria area. It is available at: <http://wfdconsultation.environment-agency.gov.uk/wfdcms/en/northumbria/Intro.aspx>.

B.23.2 Flooding

Gateshead and Newcastle are included in the Tyne Catchment and are included in the River Tyne Catchment Flood Management Plan⁸³. Within this Plan, the two council areas are included under the Lower Tyne' sub-area. This is the most urban part of the catchment and within it, flooding comes from the Rivers Tyne and Ouseburn and tributaries. There is also the risk of tidal flooding from the Tyne Estuary, including tide-locked drains. Surface water flooding has also been reported. From The Environment Agency's broadscale modelling there are currently 5081 properties at risk which could rise to 6014 in the future assuming no defenses.

A Strategic Flood Risk Assessment will be carried out for the Core Strategy which will include zoned flood maps. The Level 1 SFRA identifies all potential sources of flooding including surface water flooding, ground water and mine water, sewers and localised historic flooding, artificial sources, fluvial and tidal flood risk and takes account of climate change, in order to avoid new development in these areas. Level 2 considers the nature of flood hazards in more detail and assesses potential for mitigation of flood risk where development cannot be avoided.

The Environment Agency have prepared Catchment Flood Management Plans (CFMPs) for major regions and Gateshead and Newcastle is included in the Yorkshire and North East Region. The region includes a Tyne Catchment Flood Management Plan, along with management plans for the other major rivers in the region. The plan provides detailed explanation of Flood Risk for the Tyne area and is available at:

⁸³ The Environment Agency (2009) The River Tyne Catchment Flood Management Plan. Available at: publications.environment-agency.gov.uk/pdf/GENE1109BRCJ-e-e.pdf Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

<http://publications.environment-agency.gov.uk/pdf/GENE1109BRCJ-e-e.pdf>.

Gateshead and Newcastle are also undertaking a Water Cycle Study, which has the function of determining what sustainable water infrastructure is required and where and when it is needed⁸⁴. This will help in building a stronger understanding of the water environment in the study area in the future.

B.24 AIR QUALITY

The following table shows the Air Quality Management Areas located in Gateshead and Newcastle:

Table B.15 Air Quality Management Areas

Local Authority	Location	Status of AQMA
Newcastle	City Centre	Declared April 2004
	Jesmond Road	Declared June 2005
	Blue House Roundabout	Declared June 2005
	Quayside	Declared June 2005
Gateshead	Gateshead Town Centre and Dryden Road/Durham Road Junction	Declared April 2005 (extended to include Dryden Road/Durham Road Roundabout 2008)

Source Tyne and Wear Local Transport Strategy, Air Quality Delivery Plan

Newcastle upon Tyne has declared 4 Air Quality Management Areas at City Centre, Quayside, Jesmond Road, and Blue House⁸⁵. As pollutant emissions within the City are predominantly linked to road transport, the City Council intends to incorporate its AQAP into the Local Transport Plan. In addition, the City Council has been working closely with the other metropolitan authorities in the Tyne and Wear region, and with transport engineers and planners, to prepare a Local Air Quality Strategy at City Centre and Quayside⁸⁵.

Gateshead declared the city centre an AQMA in 2005. The further assessment in 2006 recommended that the current AQMA should remain, as declared, but additional monitoring should be carried out around the Dryden Road site.⁸⁶

Further monitoring and modelling of nitrogen dioxide concentrations within and around the AQMA indicated that most locations achieved the Government's objective for annual mean nitrogen dioxide concentrations during 2005, but that there were some isolated exceedences, both inside and outside of the AQMA. The exceedences inside the AQMA were at the Gateshead Highway / Park Lane junction; at the new residential development near to the Tyne Bridge; and at the junction of High Street with Charles Street. The exceedence outside of the AQMA was on Durham Road (A167) opposite the junction with Dryden Road. It was estimated that the emissions from local roads would need to have been some 12% lower in order for the air quality objective set in 2005 to be met at the worst receptor site in 2006.

⁸⁴ The Environment Agency (2009) Water Cycle Study Guidance. Available at: <http://www.environment-agency.gov.uk/research/planning/33368.aspx> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁸⁵ Newcastle City Council (2005) Air Quality Progress Report

⁸⁶ Air Quality Consultants Lt (2007) Air Quality Action Plan For Gateshead AQMA. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/DocumentLibrary/Environment/Strategies/AirQualityActionPlan.pdf> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

Table B.16 Potential AQMA Sites in Gateshead and Newcastle

Local Authority	Location	Status of Area
Newcastle	Haddricks Mill Roundabout	Detailed Assessment. To be declared an AQMA
	Westgate Road	Risk Area
	Shields Road/Chillingham Road	Risk Area
Gateshead	Portobello Terrace on Portobello Road	Detailed Assessment. Classified as an AQMA in January 2008 – To be declared AQMA by Gateshead Council in the near future

Source Tyne and Wear Local Transport Strategy, Air Quality Delivery Plan

An air quality action plan has been produced for Newcastle City Centre in order to monitor and control emissions. Large parts of the city centre fall within the Air Quality Management Areas, where traffic especially large/heavy vehicles including buses are major contributors⁵.

Gateshead declared the city centre an AQMA in 2005. The further assessment in 2006 recommended that the current AQMA should remain, as declared, but additional monitoring should be carried out around the Dryden Road site⁸⁶.

The air quality in parts of the town centre is predicted to exceed statutory limits and as a result an Air Quality Management Area has been declared in the Town Centre and an Air Quality Action Plan adopted. The Local Transport Plan (LTP) also addresses air quality issues. Emissions from traffic need to be reduced⁶.

Further monitoring and modelling of nitrogen dioxide concentrations within and around the AQMA indicated that most locations achieved the Government's objective for annual mean nitrogen dioxide concentrations during 2005, but that there were some isolated exceedances, both inside and outside of the AQMA. The exceedances inside the AQMA were at the Gateshead Highway/Park Lane junction; at the new residential development near to the Tyne Bridge; and at the junction of High Street with Charles Street. The exceedance outside of the AQMA was on Durham Road (A167) opposite the junction with Dryden Road. It was estimated that the emissions from local roads would need to have been some 12% lower in order for the air quality objective set in 2005 to be met at the worst receptor site in 2006.

B.25 CLIMATIC FACTORS

It is predicted that by the 2080s, the average annual temperature in the region will increase up to 4°C, with average winter temperature increasing up to 3°C and average summer up to 4.5°C⁸⁷. By the 2080s, average winter precipitation may increase up to 30% and average summer precipitation may reduce up to 50%. The trend towards wetter winters, as the proportion of annual rainfall that falls during the winter season, has increased, with a greater proportion of winter rainfall delivered by "intense" events. Snowfall reduction by the 2080s is predicted to reach 100%.

Sea level is predicted to increase by up to 66cm. Between 1900 and 2000 the North Shields tide gauge recorded a sea level rise of approximately 20cm. Beaches such as Alnmouth, in Northumberland, are eroding rapidly. Predictions

⁸⁷ Friends of the Earth (2004) Impacts of Climate Change in the North East

suggest that coastal property may be damaged. Further predictions include that cliff and beach erosion may further increase, as will costs of maintaining sea defences.

Flooding events may become more common. The erosion of riverbanks may increase. Already, flash flooding is becoming more common as a result of increasing precipitation intensity. In the July 2001 thunderstorm at Hexham, Northumberland, a gauging station that had been in place for 30 years was washed away. Recent river flooding events in the region include, 1995 (River Tyne and River Wear), June 2000 River Gaunless (1 in 100 year flood event, 400 properties flooded at South Church and West Auckland), November 2000 River Pont (1 in 16 year flood event, 147 properties flooded at Ponteland), River Tees, and River Gaunless and in February 2001 River Tees, River Gaunless. Other issues include concerns that sewers may not have the necessary capacity and could overflow in the future.

The Urban Core is centred around the River Tyne which is affected by both rainfall and the pattern of the tides. Therefore the predicted effects of climate change on rainfall and sea levels will both impact on the urban core. The implications of this are that areas previously considered for development may be sterilised, or additional flood defence may be needed. The Urban Core AAP will be subject to a Strategic Flood risk Assessment, which will select those areas in which flood risk is apparent and so steer development accordingly.

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B.25.1 Greenhouse Gas Production and Ecological Footprinting

Newcastle City Council, as the major partner in CarbonNeutral Newcastle has set an ambition to become the world's first carbon neutral city. Although no date has

been specified, the project has been a key driver in climate change work across the council⁸⁸.

Using Government coordinated Carbon Emissions data from 2004 and the South East Climate Change Partnership Emission methodology, we are able to estimate that the geographical area of Newcastle upon Tyne emitted approximately 1.8 million tonnes of CO₂ in 2004 (direct emissions). Plans to develop a more detailed and informative citywide carbon footprint are underway. This will include modelled scenarios towards a low-carbon city and are being developed in partnership with Newcastle University.

Table B.17 Breakdown of Carbon Footprint for Newcastle

Source	Tonnes CO ₂ and (Percentage of Total)
Total CO ₂ Emissions	1,852,451.18
Emissions per head of population	6.87 per capita
Emissions from transport	440,584.10 (23.78%)
Emissions from Domestic Sources	621,665.91 (33.56%)
Emissions from Industrial Sources	677,675.84 (36.58%)

Source: Newcastle City Council Climate Change Strategy and Action Plan (2008)

Gateshead Strategic Partnership (GSP) has produced the discussion document 'Climate Change – We Need to Talk About it' as the first step towards tackling climate change issues. The GSP is made up of local people, community partnerships and networks, public bodies, business and voluntary organisations. It identifies the Council context as:

- Emissions of around 1,567,000 tonnes of CO₂ into the atmosphere
- The high proportion of manufacturing jobs and industries (which are high energy users) accounts for about 43% of carbon emissions
- 25% of emissions come from road transport. There are increasing numbers of vehicles on our roads leading to congestion, poorer air quality and more carbon emissions⁸⁹

B.26 LANDSCAPE AND CITYSCAPE

Much of the Newcastle City Council's land area is taken up by residential housing. The City Centre area is mainly occupied by retail and commercial activities, although an increasing number of housing developments are being encouraged. Land scheduled for industrial purposes is situated mainly along riverside areas, principally Walker Riverside and the industrially reclaimed area of Newburn Haugh. Considerable areas of agricultural land occupy the western and northern areas of the district. The airport occupies a large area of land west of Kingston Park. The Northern Development Area comprising of 'Newcastle Great Park' located to the north of Kingston Park is currently under development and is to consist of housing and commercial use on this 'Greenfield' site.

In Newcastle, the streets and market places of the pre-industrial town are still largely intact, and many historic buildings and townscapes survive. The Georgian town laid out by Grainger is remarkably complete. Grand streets converge on the Monument, contrasting with the organic form of the old town. The centre of Newcastle has a dignity and uniformity that only breaks down in places where late

⁸⁸ Newcastle City Council (2008) Climate Change Strategy and Action Plan. Available at: <http://oncorestrategyng.limehouse.co.uk/file/2575670> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

⁸⁹ Gateshead Strategic Partnership (2009) Climate Change – We Need to Talk About It. Available at: <http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/Environment%20and%20Waste/climatechange/cando.aspx> Accessed on 22 Aug 2013

20th century development has compromised its integrity. The area around Swan House suffered particularly badly in the 1960s and 1970s from big roads and mediocre development. Enclosed shopping malls have sapped the vitality of city streets.

One of the most distinguishing features of Gateshead is the topography. From the Quayside the land rises some 70 metres to the town centre and it continues to rise from the northeast to the southwest. This dramatic change in level has influenced the form and character of Gateshead and is a major hindrance to safe and easy pedestrian connections from town centre to the Quayside. It also creates some challenging issues in relation to comprehensive redevelopment in the town centre. The slope does however present opportunities to create interest and exploit views to the north and also to create greater variety in built form⁶.

Gateshead has a rich history, but many of the physical traces of the past have been lost and most of the surviving pockets of coherent urban form are surrounded by tracts of derelict land and major roads. Gateshead's history as a railway town is preserved at Greenesfield. The old Town Hall has been restored, but occupies an isolated site. The town centre bears the scars of its long decline. The most striking features of the 21st century are the Sage Gateshead, Gateshead Millennium Bridge and BALTIC Centre for Contemporary Arts, but work is needed to improve connections between the town and the river⁶.

The 1Plan describes the following features and issues relating to the landscape of the urban core:

Landmarks and gateways The Sage Gateshead, Gateshead Millennium Bridge, BALTIC Centre for Contemporary Art and the Angel of the North; the three great 19th and 20th century bridges; the sweep of Grey Street and the Monument form a group of iconic images unmatched in any English city. They are not the only landmarks in the urban core. In Newcastle, the cathedral, the castle keep and the tower of the Civic Centre punctuate the skyline, and St James' Park forms a dramatic backdrop to the north side of the city. Landmarks define a city's image and help pedestrians to navigate their way around. The gateways – the points of arrival by road and rail – are less satisfactory. The experience of arrival by rail from the south illustrates the point: the view as the train crosses the Tyne is inspiring – one of the most dramatic entrances to any European city. But as passengers leave Central Station they find the portico clogged with taxis, and Neville Street is a shabby, traffic dominated mess. Points of entry by road also require attention, especially the approaches from the A1, along Askew Road and across the Tyne Bridge.

Gateshead contains two thirds of the woodland in Tyne and Wear, including large areas of ancient semi-natural woodlands. The borough is characterised by the river valleys of the Tyne, the Derwent and the Team, with a wide variety of habitats, including grasslands and wetlands. The tidal mud flats and salt marshes on the River Tyne in Gateshead form a prominent Estuary. The borough's countryside also contains landscapes of high quality, particularly the wooded river valleys and designed parklands. The eastern half of the borough also forms part of the Great North Forest.

The two closest Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty (AONB) are the North Pennines AONB and Northumberland Coast AONB.

Gateshead and Newcastle form part of the North East Regional Volume for National Character Areas (produced in 2005 by Natural England with support from English Heritage), specifically the Character Areas of; The Tyne gap and Hadrians Wall, South East Northumberland Coastal Plain, Tyne and Wear Lowlands and Durham Coalfield Pennine Fringe. Profile descriptions for these Character Areas are available at:

<http://www.naturalengland.org.uk/ourwork/landscape/englands/character/areas/northeast.aspx>

The Tyne Gorge Study was commissioned for Architecture and the Built Environment, Newcastle City Council and Gateshead Council in order to:

- define the geographical extent of the study area;
- analyse the historical development of the Gorge and its two settlements, Newcastle and Gateshead;
- undertake a visual analysis of the Gorge;
- indicate the importance of different areas of the Gorge;
- identify threats and opportunities within the Gorge; and
- indicate principles for the protection and development of the Gorge in the future.

The study is available at:

<http://www.gateshead.gov.uk/Building%20and%20Development/Regeneration/GatesheadWide/TyneGorgeStudy.aspx> and provides detailed descriptions of 23 landscape character areas throughout the gorge.

ANNEX C

APPRAISAL OF THE CORE STRATEGY AND URBAN CORE PLAN POLICIES

C.1: Introduction

This Annex shows the appraisal tables for the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan Policies as follows:

- C1: The Spatial Strategy and Strategic Policies
- C2: The Urban Core Policies
- C3: The Sub-Area Overarching Policies
- C4: The Sub-Areas and Sites Policies

In each table the potential impact is stated and where appropriate mitigation is included to offset possible negative impacts. Each appraisal is accompanied by a 'comments' column that provides an explanation of the rationale behind the assessment (see Annex E for an explanation of how the appraisal tables work).

The assessments in C4 are set out differently to reflect the spatial locational aspects (see Annex E for an explanation of how these tables work).

C1: Appraisal of The Spatial Strategy and Strategic Policies

Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth

Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative

Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a strong positive effect.		Policy CS1 should have a major positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The main focus of this spatial policy is to direct development and growth to sustainable and accessible locations. This is the key policy that provides the strategic direction for delivering growth and positive change within the council areas of Gateshead and Newcastle and thus sets the tone for the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan. - It starts very positively in Clause 1 with a presumption in favour of sustainable development. The other clauses and in particular Clause 8 provide the definition of sustainable development for the area. - This policy has become socially much stronger as the Plan has been revised and in Clause 8 now has four very strong principles that focus in on the delivery of social inclusion, community cohesion and support for equality and diversity. - The supporting text from Paragraphs 5.8 to 5.11 provides further clarity and emphasises the resonance of the policy with NPPF principles.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a strong positive effect.		Policy CS1 should now have a major positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This policy text has been amended since its last iteration and now states that all new development will be fully inclusive, irrespective of cultural background, ethnicity and age. The supporting text in Paragraph 5.11 highlights that all developments will be in line with the latest equality legislation. - The addition of the Development Principles and the new supporting text at Paragraph 5.11 strengthens the positive effect of the policy ensuring that new development does not inadvertently exclude anyone within the community, particularly in the longer term as the policy starts to deliver results.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Although not addressing educational achievement and skills levels directly the Spatial Strategy should provide appropriate development opportunities that will enhance the range of jobs available, via development of key employment areas, helping to develop a skilled workforce and overcome some of the barriers that prevent people from getting to work (e.g. accessibility, travel choices and childcare).

Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
4. Improve health and wellbeing and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.	In addition to Clause 8 (iii) that promotes wellbeing the simultaneous application of Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health will play a key role ensuring that spatial planning will make a positive contribution to reducing health inequalities.	With the simultaneous application of Policy CS14 the Spatial Strategy Policy should have a strong positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	• The main policy text 8.iii and the supporting text in Paragraphs 5.11 and 5.13 emphasises the desire to ensure that new development contributes towards improved health and wellbeing for all. • The simultaneous application of Policy CS14 will promote public participation and activity in addressing health needs and inequalities through improved access to resources and recreational opportunities. • The addition of Development Principles 8 (i) and (ii) will help to strengthen the positive effect of the policy, particularly on delivering the longer term benefits of socially inclusive design and accessibility for all.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	• The presumption in favour of Sustainable Development expressed in Clause 1 together with Clauses 8 (i) and (iii) now ensure that culture, heritage and diversity will be promoted and enhanced. Delivering on the commitments in Paragraphs 5.11 and 5.13 will ensure that the Spatial Strategy in Policy CS1 will have strong positive effects on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term as the policy starts to deliver. • With the simultaneous application of Policy CS15 and commitments made in Paragraphs 12.1 to 12.20 there will be a strong positive effects, again particularly in the longer term.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a major positive effect, particularly in the longer term as the policy starts to deliver results.	Delivery of Policy CS13 Transport will further strengthen the statement in Policy CS1 8.ii.	With the simultaneous application of Policy CS13 there will be a strong positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	• This Policy specifically states that development will be well connected and accessible by sustainable modes of transport. In this regard, the policy is likely to have a major positive effect on this objective, particularly in the medium to longer term as the policy starts to deliver on these objectives. • Positive contributions will also be made from improving rural accessibility and improving infrastructure/services provision.

Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS16 Climate Change will further strengthen the effect of this Policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.		✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The Policy's emphasis on 'directing development to sustainable locations' and '[designing development] to reduce carbon emissions' demonstrates a positive contribution made to this objective. Sustainable locations are expected to have an emphasis on the promotion of walking, cycling and the use of public transport and a focus on reducing use of the car and congestion. - If delivered, these measures should all contribute to reductions in emissions of CO₂ and hence contributions to the causes of climate change and are likely to contribute more positively in the longer term as the policy delivers results.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS16 Climate Change and CS17 Flood Risk and Water Management will further strengthen the effect of this policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- By ensuring that development is directed to the most sustainable locations this should take into account climate change adaptation and mitigation. Also the implementation of this policy in combination with Policy CS16: Climate Change and Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management will ensure that Policy CS1 makes a stronger positive contribution to this sustainability objective, especially in the longer term. - Mitigation should also be covered through the consideration of the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) as well as through the Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP).

Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS16 Climate Change, CS9 Existing Communities, CS15 Place Making and CS21 Waste will further strengthen the effect of this policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	With its presumption in favour of sustainable development and its emphasis on directing development to sustainable locations the tone of the policy fits well with the aspirations of this SA objective. Also the implementation of this policy in combination with Policy CS16: Climate Change (with its emphasis on carbon reduction and sustainable design), Policy CS9 Existing Communities (with its emphasis on making use of existing housing where possible) and Policy CS15: Place Making (with its emphasis on development demonstrating how it will respond to and incorporate climate change mitigation and adaptation into the design process) and Policy CS21: Waste (with its commitments to following the waste hierarchy of prevention, reuse, recycling, recovery and only then safe disposal) will ensure that Policy CS1 makes a stronger positive contribution to this sustainability objective, especially in the longer term.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will further strengthen the effect of this policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.		✓	✓✓	✓✓	- With the presumption now in favour of sustainable development and with the inclusion of the Development Principle 8 Clause (iii) that states 'Development being...well designed...to reflect and enhance the area's character and natural environment' this policy now supports this sustainability objective. - With the simultaneous application of Policy CS18 which is a strategic policy designed specifically to address the protection of the natural environment and green infrastructure this will further assure the protection of any environmental assets in areas favoured for development.

Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application and delivery of Policies CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) and Policy CS9 Existing Communities should serve to strengthen the effect in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The broad thrust of this policy is to drive forward Gateshead and Newcastle's ambitions and to make provision for potentially substantial development. This should therefore lead to the creation of new and varied employment opportunities and strengthen the economy. - The simultaneous application of Policies CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) and the delivery of the objectives and aspirations set out in Chapter 9: Economic Prosperity will enable the Spatial Strategy to have a stronger positive effect in the longer term.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application and delivery of Policies CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) and Policy CS2 Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core should serve to strengthen the effect in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The broad thrust of this policy is to support sustainable growth. This should lead to the creation of new employment opportunities. - The simultaneous application of Policies CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) and Policy CS2: Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core together with the delivery of the objectives and aspirations set out in Chapter 9: Economic Prosperity will enable the Spatial Strategy to have a stronger positive effect in the longer term on this sustainability objective.

Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓✓ The focus of this policy is to facilitate through effective spatial planning the growth and development of strategic growth areas to deliver a more prosperous and attractive Gateshead and Newcastle. The policy is framed positively to support the more 'socially orientated' by focusing growth and development in the most sustainable and accessible locations in Gateshead and Newcastle. It also has the addition of a new set of 'Development Principles' in Clause 8 and the Sub-Clauses (i) to (iii) have a particularly strong social focus with an emphasis on inclusive development that respects equality and diversity principles and which promotes community cohesion and wellbeing. There are also references to enhancing neighbourhoods, sustaining villages and the rural economy and support for existing employment areas, and an emphasis on new development areas being in locations that must be sustainably connected and designed to high standards. This is all very supportive of the social objectives and with the simultaneous application of other overarching policies, in particular Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health and Policy CS15: Place Making, the positive effects will be further enhanced, with the opportunity for these positive effects to be felt by all residents of the area.							
Environmental: ✓(✓) By placing an emphasis on the presumption in favour of sustainable development and to 'directing development to sustainable locations', with an emphasis on the Urban Core, the policy is likely to make positive contributions towards the sustainability objectives that have an environmental thrust. By focusing development on previously developed land in the targeted regeneration areas there is less likelihood of generating adverse impacts on the natural environment. Along with the simultaneous application of Policies CS16: Climate Change, CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management, CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment this will ensure positive implications for the environmental and cultural heritage assets of the area.							
Economic: ✓✓ With its aim to stimulate the economy through making provision for substantial development in sustainable and accessible locations, this policy is likely to have strong positive effects on the economic objectives. Through the development of the urban core for major development including office, retail, commercial leisure, culture and tourism and supporting expansion and improvement of existing employment areas the policy will have strongly positive implications for providing new jobs and thus boosting the economy of the region. With the simultaneous application of Policies CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth policies), Policy CS2 (Spatial Strategy for Urban Core) and CS9 (Existing Communities) this will enable the Spatial Strategy to have a stronger positive effect in the longer term.							

Policy CS2: Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy will help to strengthen the community through the development of the Urban Core as a strategic priority. The desire to maintain and enhance its vibrancy through the promotion of the area for offices, enhanced retail, housing, cultural diversification and tourism together with promoting sustainable transport and access for all should all contribute positively towards strong and inclusive communities. - The diversification of the range of neighbourhood-specific cultural tourist attractions, facilities and activities during the day into the evening for both tourists and residents has the potential to encourage involvement in communal life and help create a sense of communal identity and place. - The supporting text (6.8) encourages a mix of housing and flats and the promotion of housing as part of mixed use schemes at upper floors. This should contribute to creating mixed and sustainable communities as well as widen the available housing options. - The emphasis on reducing traffic in the Urban Core and increasing sustainable transport modes will provide additional support to this sustainability objective.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Uncertain but could have a range of positive or negative effects depending on how developments in the urban core are delivered.	The implementation of area wide policies such as Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth, Policy CS13: Transport, Policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health, CS11: Providing a range and choice of housing, and Policy CS9 Existing Communities, should ensure equality and better integration of development area-wide.	This policy should have positive effects when combined with other area - wide policies.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core has the potential to contribute to equality and integration through the provision of new sustainably designed urban neighbourhoods - providing new homes and associated facilities and services, and increasing the diversity of retail offer along with leisure, culture and tourism developments that will be accessible to all. - The additional focus on sustainable transport modes should provide further support by improving accessibility. - The simultaneous application of Policies CS1, 9, 14 and 15 should strengthen the way this spatial policy addresses equality issues and ensures that development within the Urban Core is socially inclusive.

Policy CS2: Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy seeks to actively promote the clustering of knowledge-based industries, universities, colleges and hospitals at the Science Central Key Site (C2) as part of Policy CS5(2): Employment and Economic Opportunities. This directly contributes to retaining, attracting and developing a skilled workforce and forming links with relevant industries. - It also focuses on the provision of jobs and developing the Urban Core as an employment centre that will offer a wide range of employment and skill development opportunities. This should be supportive towards developing and retaining a skilled workforce
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.	The positive effects will be strengthened with the simultaneous application of Policies CS14: Wellbeing and Health, CS 15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment.		✓	✓	✓✓	- This Policy is broadly supportive of improving health and well-being within the area through its measures to diversify culture, leisure and tourism facilities and to promote sustainable modes of transport (including cycling and walking) and access for all. - If delivered alongside Policies CS14 and CS18 and if developments are able to create new public spaces, improve the public realm and add new green space then these measures will make significant positive contributions to public well-being and health particularly in the longer term.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS15: Place Making should strengthen the positive contribution to this objective.		✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy includes a clause that promotes 'high quality design that promotes local distinctiveness and sustains and enhances the historic environment' so this is supportive of respecting culture, heritage and diversity. - Combined with the conservation principles embedded within Policy CS15 it should ensure positive implications for culture, heritage and diversity, particularly in the longer term as developments start to take place.

Policy CS2: Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have major positive effects.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS13: Transport should strengthen the positive contribution to this objective.		✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This policy is likely to increase accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services within the Urban Core through the development of the Urban Core's role as a regional centre. Clause 6 that promotes sustainable forms of transport and access for all makes a significant contribution to addressing this sustainability objective. - The impact will be enhanced with the simultaneous application of CS13.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could give rise to a range of both positive and negative effects depending on how developments are delivered.	The application of Policy CS16: Climate Change provides more than adequate mitigation if this is needed.	Likely to be positive	?0	✓	✓	- The strategic growth sites within the Urban Core in general are sustainable locations for development in terms of concentration of services, employment and residential uses and good internal linkages for walking and cycling. They have good transport links via the metro and buses and to the wider region and country by train. - Focusing development in strategic growth areas and to integrate residential and employment land is likely to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by minimising the need for travel and maximising the opportunities for making the best use of the existing transport infrastructure and more sustainable modes such as walking and cycling. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS16 provides an added layer of protection and would ensure that developments at these sites reduce their contribution to the causes of climate change.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could generate negative effects depending on the delivery of the policy and the precise location of new development.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS16: Climate Change, CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment and CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management should provide the necessary	Likely to be positive.	?0	✓	✓	- The policy itself makes no direct reference to adaptation to the effects of climate change but with the simultaneous application of policies CS16 and CS17, the relevant issues would be addressed. - Policy CS18 seeks to maintain the multifunctionality of green infrastructure and so green infrastructure improvements undertaken as part of the Urban Core developments would be likely to include provision for surface water management. - Flood risk can also be managed through appropriate mitigation via the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) (such as improvements to the current drainage system and use of SUDS where appropriate), as well as through the Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP).

Policy CS2: Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		mitigation, to ensure development in the strategic growth areas adapts to the effects of climate change and the risks of flooding are minimised.					
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new developments are designed and delivered in the Urban Core – any large scale office or business developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.	Through the application of Policies CS13: Transport, CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS21: Waste, the impacts of new developments can be minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the increased development in the Urban Core brings more vehicles, energy usage and waste generation (and thus a reliance on fossil fuels and further resource depletion).	?*	?*	?*	- By increasing the number of developments (e.g. office, retail and leisure) with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policies CS13 (Transport), CS15 (Place Making), CS16 (Climate Change) and CS21 (Waste) should serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.

Policy CS2: Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could generate negative effects depending on the delivery of the policy and the precise location of new development.	Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment presents strategic measures to ensure development within the Urban Core considers the protection and enhancement of environmental assets and infrastructure.	Likely to be broadly positive with mitigation and robust planning conditions.	✓	✓	✓✓	- By promoting more retail development together with the further development of knowledge-based industries, tourism and leisure-based facilities and housing there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure depending on location, design and construction. - Using the mitigation measures set out in Policies CS15 and CS18 the residual effects are likely to be neutral or slightly positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made that includes for example green walls and roofs, green spaces and urban gardens and allotments.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have major positive effects.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	The policy makes provision for a number of development opportunities, including residential development to support population growth, retail growth, support for the knowledge-based industries and new culture, leisure and tourism facilities which are all likely to strengthen the economy. The effects of the policy are therefore thought to be very positive particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have major positive effects.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	If the range of office, retail, leisure, culture and tourism developments are delivered then this is likely to make a significant contribution towards job creation in the Urban Core and therefore of improving access to a more stable and sustainable employment market in Gateshead and Newcastle.

Policy CS2: Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓							
The policy is assessed as being likely to generate positive effects on the social objectives, particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered. Improving the strength and vibrancy of the Urban Core will help to improve social conditions within the area. This policy together with other overarching policies seek to tackle social inclusion issues and promote community cohesion. The only risk is that a major focus on the Urban Core could leave little investment available for other areas, in particular those in more remote rural locations. However delivery alongside other area-wide spatial policies (such as CS3: Neighbourhood Areas and CS4: Rural and Villages Area) and economic regeneration policies (Policies CS5 and CS6) should ensure the economic benefits are shared across Gateshead and Newcastle and should therefore deliver wider social benefits.							
Environmental: ? ✖ to ✓							
The effects of encouraging more office, retail, leisure and tourism developments together with residential development and associated facilities and services in in the Urban Core, were considered to be uncertain but possibly negative with regard to impacts on the natural environment with issues like air quality (from e.g. increases in vehicle use associated with industrial/commercial uses), resource use and waste (again from the additional commercial/industrial/retail developments) likely to increase. Impacts on the wider natural environment would be expected to be less significant if development was concentrated in city/town centres within the Urban Core. If the commitment in Policy CS18 - to maintain, protect and enhance the integrity, connectivity, multifunctionality and accessibility of the strategic green infrastructure network is delivered then development within the Urban Core should be broadly positive towards the natural environment.							
Economic: ✓✓							
This policy is likely to have major positive effects on the economic objectives. The provision of retail and expanding office space will make a positive contribution to sustaining the local economy and should therefore also support the creation of new jobs in the future.							

Policy CS3: Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS1 and CS15 should strengthen the positive contribution to this objective.	Likely to have a strong positive effect, particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The Policy sets out to increase housing provision in areas where it is required, developing the economy within Neighbourhoods and promoting social, economic and physical regeneration. It also aims to improve access for local communities to essential facilities and services and to improve the overall environment within the recognised Neighbourhoods. It is therefore likely to have strong positive effects on promoting strong and inclusive communities within Gateshead and Newcastle in the longer term as the goals are delivered. - The simultaneous application of Policies CS1 and CS15 with their Development Principles that focus in on creating safe and inclusive environments will serve to strengthen the delivery of the policy goals.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS1 and CS15 should strengthen the positive contribution to this objective.	Likely to have a positive effect when the other policies are applied together with this one, particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	The policy sets out how sustainable communities will be promoted and maintained in the Neighbourhood Areas. It sets out the key areas for housing and employment. The simultaneous application of Policy CS1 with its Development Principle Clause 8 (i) that focuses on development being inclusive and meeting diverse needs and CS15 that focuses on creating safe and inclusive environments will serve to strengthen the delivery of the policy goals and how the policy supports this sustainability objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- Although this policy is not directly concerned with improving educational achievement in Gateshead and Newcastle it does put an emphasis on social regeneration, accessibility and connectivity, the improved provision of facilities and services within the key Neighbourhoods that could enhance conditions that influence access to education and improved skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle. This should be supportive towards developing and retaining a skilled workforce. - The detailed development Policies for individual areas have a detailed list of what development in the area must deliver – primary and secondary education feature both in regeneration areas (AOC1) and new development (NN1 etc). If developers follow the guidance, this Policy will contribute to improving education facilities across Gateshead and Newcastle.

Policy CS3: Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a neutral effect.	Positive effects will be strengthened with the simultaneous application of Policies CS13: Transport, CS14: Wellbeing and Health and CS18: Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment.	With the simultaneous implication of the other policies likely to have a positive effect, particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	If delivered alongside Policies CS14, 15 and 18 and if developments within the main Neighbourhoods are able to create new public spaces, improve the public realm and add new green space (providing access to an attractive environment providing opportunities for leisure and recreation) then these measures will make contributions to public well-being and health particularly in the longer term.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Uncertain but could have a range of positive or negative effects depending on how developments in the neighbourhoods are delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS15: Place Making Should mitigate any negative effects and strengthen the positive contribution to this objective.	The combination of this policy with Policy CS15 should ensure positive implications to culture, heritage and diversity.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy sets out to increase housing provision in areas where it is required, developing the economy within Neighbourhoods and promoting social, economic and physical regeneration. There is a risk that development of business, retail, housing and other facilities within the Neighbourhoods could negatively impact on elements of the cultural heritage depending on precise location. - However when this policy is combined with the conservation principles embedded within Policy CS15 it should ensure positive implications for culture, heritage and diversity, particularly in the longer term as developments with positive implications for the cultural heritage start to take place.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS13: Transport should strengthen the positive contribution.	The combination of this policy with Policy CS13 should ensure positive implications to accessibility.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The Policy sets out to increase housing provision in areas where it is required, developing the economy within Neighbourhoods and promoting social, economic and physical regeneration in sustainable places. This type of development should improve access for local communities to essential facilities and services and to improve the overall environment within the recognised Neighbourhoods. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS13 with its commitments to a sustainable transport network to improve accessibility should strengthen the support for this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term as the goals are delivered.

Policy CS3: Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could give rise to a range of both positive and negative effects depending on how developments are delivered.	The application of Policy CS16: Climate Change provides more than adequate mitigation if this is needed.	Likely to be positive	✓	✓	✓	- The Policy sets out to increase housing provision in areas where it is required, developing the economy within Neighbourhoods and promoting social, economic and physical regeneration. It also aims to improve access for local communities to essential facilities and services and to improve the overall environment within the recognised Neighbourhoods. - Establishing sustainable communities within the Neighbourhood Area should mean that sustainable transport will be encouraged and sustainable design and construction particularly if overarching policies CS 13, 15 and 16 are simultaneously applied.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could generate negative effects depending on the delivery of the policy and the precise location of new development.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS16: Climate Change, Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management and Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment should provide the necessary mitigation.	Likely to be neutral or slightly positive after mitigation.	?0	?0/ ✓	✓	- The policy itself makes no direct reference to adaptation to the effects of climate change but with the simultaneous application of policies CS16 and CS17, the relevant issues should be addressed. - Flood risk can also be managed through appropriate mitigation via the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) (such as improvements to the current drainage system and use of SUDS where appropriate), as well as through the Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP).
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new developments are designed and delivered in the Neighbourhoods – any large scale	Through the application of Policies CS13: Transport, CS16: Climate Change and CS15 Place Making the impacts of new developments can	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the increased	?*	?*	?*	- By increasing the number of developments (e.g. office, retail, housing and leisure) with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption, consumption of other non-renewable resources and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policies CS13, CS15 and CS16 should serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.

Policy CS3: Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	offices, business developments, housing or industrial premises that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.	be minimised.	development in the Neighbourhoods brings more vehicles, energy usage, resource consumption and waste generation (and thus a reliance on fossil fuels and further resource depletion).				

Policy CS3: Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could generate negative effects depending on the delivery of the policy and the precise location of new development.	Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management requires Sustainable Urban Drainage Systems (SUDS) to help deal with flood risk and surface water problems Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment presents strategic measures to ensure development within the strategic growth areas considers the protection and enhancement of environmental assets and infrastructure.	Likely to be broadly positive with mitigation.				- The development within the Neighbourhood areas associated with this policy has the potential to impact on environmental assets and infrastructure. However when combined with strategic policy CS18 this infrastructure should be protected. - If appropriate mitigation is in place, and development considers the enhancement of environmental assets through for example the development of SUDS systems, developments within the Neighbourhood Area would have the potential to improve biodiversity.

Policy CS3: Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy has identified those areas which have the greatest need for investment and which present the greatest opportunity to support growth in the population and growth in the economy. The areas mentioned in the policy are accessible from the urban core and on the whole are well served by public transport, walking and cycling routes, providing opportunity for sustainable access to employment opportunities via transport links. - The policy seeks to support existing employment areas and residential development within Neighbourhoods, it is therefore supportive of a growing economy both within the central urban core and within smaller communities that lie on the periphery of this. - The policy will focus and protect manufacturing and industrial uses in two Key Employment Areas at Walker Riverside (marine/off shore engineering and renewables) and Team Valley (advanced manufacturing and engineering).
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	As above, regeneration and investment in those areas identified will create the right environment for the economy to improve, while supporting a growing population. The policy is therefore likely to both generate new skilled employment and help provide access to it through well planned redevelopment (Walker Riverside is in a Local Enterprise Zone). It will therefore have a positive impact on the employment market.

Policy CS3: Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓							
The policy is assessed as having a broadly positive impact on social objectives by identifying those areas which have the greatest need for investment and which present the greatest opportunity to support growth in the population and growth in the economy whilst also reducing current inequalities between Neighbourhoods. The areas mentioned in the policy are accessible from the Urban Core and on the whole are well served by public transport, walking and cycling routes. The policy aims to ensure residential development meets the needs of the current and future communities by providing access to a range of facilities and services, improving accessibility and providing a range of housing options.							
Environmental: ? ✗ to ✓							
The main focus of the policy is to improve the sustainability of existing communities primarily through improving access to a range of sustainable transport modes and links to the wider transport network. It places development largely on previously developed land (regeneration and growth areas). The majority of the areas mentioned for regeneration are in good and potentially sustainable locations; however, one of the areas mentioned in the policy requires additional works to make it more viable as sites for development – Dunston Hill (GN1). Dunston had been shown on the borough wide Strategic Flood Risk Assessment to be in Flood Zone 2 – at risk from tidal flooding – on its northern edge, from the River Tyne. Policy CS18 states that green infrastructure will be expected to maximise the potential for flood water storage. The development of Dunston would be likely to include flood storage measures. The development within the Neighbourhood areas associated with this policy has the potential to impact on environmental assets and infrastructure, however when combined with strategic policies 16, 17 and 18 (the latter stating that development will protect and enhance biodiversity and designated sites) this infrastructure should be protected.							
Economic: ✓ to ✓✓							
In terms of economic objectives it was assessed that this policy is likely to have positive effects. The policy has identified those areas which have the greatest need for investment and which present the greatest opportunity to support growth in the population (via residential development) and growth in the economy. The areas mentioned in the policy are accessible from the Urban Core, are in a Local Enterprise Zone and on the whole are well served by public transport, walking and cycling routes, and are supported by a range of facilities and services.							

Policy CS4: Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS1 and CS15 should strengthen the positive contribution to this objective.	Likely to have a strong positive effect, particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy (through its supporting text) sets out to increase housing, both provision and choice, in areas where it is required, developing the economy within rural areas and villages and improving transport services and accessibility. It also aims to improve the overall environment within rural areas and villages. It is therefore likely to have a positive effect on promoting strong and inclusive communities. - The simultaneous application of Policies CS1 and CS15 with their Development Principles that focus in on creating safe and inclusive environments will serve to strengthen the delivery of the policy goals.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS1 and CS15 should strengthen the positive contribution to this objective.	Likely to have a positive effect when the other policies are applied together with this one, particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy has positive implications towards this sustainability objective because it has the potential to improve equality, diversity and integration in rural areas by ensuring access and promoting development that creates conditions to support well-being for rural communities in the face of falling average household sizes. - However, there is the possibility of integration issues with commuters/incomers coming in to rural locations. - The simultaneous application of Policies CS1, 9, 14 and 15 should strengthen the way this spatial policy addresses equality issues and ensures that development within the Rural and Villages Area is socially inclusive.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Although this policy is not directly concerned with improving educational achievement in Gateshead and Newcastle it does put an emphasis on the long-term sustainability of villages and the improved provision of facilities and services within the rural area and improvements to accessibility in general that could lead to improved access to jobs and education and improved skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle. This should be supportive towards developing and retaining a skilled workforce.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a neutral effect.	The positive effects will be strengthened with the simultaneous application of Policies CS14: Wellbeing and		0	✓	✓✓	- This policy does not specifically address the improvement of health and well-being within the area, however if delivered alongside Policies CS14, 15 and 18 and if developments are able to create new public spaces, improve the public realm and add new green space then these measures will make contributions to public well-being and health particularly in the longer term. - The supporting text highlights the focus on providing new housing choices for families and the elderly (potentially vulnerable groups) which is a positive

Policy CS4: Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		Health, CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment.					influence towards improving local well-being.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Uncertain but could have a range of positive or negative effects depending on how developments in the rural area and villages are delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS15: Place Making should mitigate any possible negative effects and strengthen the positive contribution to this objective.	The combination of this policy with Policy CS15 should ensure positive implications to culture, heritage and diversity.	✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy aims to improve the economy within the rural areas and villages through spatial development. There is a risk that development of new employment facilities and housing could negatively impact on elements of the cultural heritage depending on precise location. - However when this policy is combined with the conservation principles embedded within Policy CS15 it should ensure positive implications for culture, heritage and diversity, particularly in the longer term as developments with positive implications for the cultural heritage start to take place. - Given the proximity of Throckley to the Hadrian's Wall World Heritage Site and its buffer zone, impacts upon the setting of the World Heritage Site will have to be a consideration of any development or regeneration in this area.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS13: Transport and CS15 Place Making should strengthen the positive contribution.	The combination of this policy with Policies CS13 and 15 should ensure positive implications to accessibility in rural areas.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The Policy sets out to increase housing provision in areas where it is required, developing the economy within Villages and Rural Areas and promoting social and economic development in sustainable places. This type of development should improve access for local communities to essential facilities and services and to improve the overall environment within allocated Village Growth Areas. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS13 with its commitments to a sustainable transport network to improve accessibility and CS15 with its commitments to ensuring connectivity and accessibility should strengthen the support for this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term as the goals are delivered.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new airport related development and new housing	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making and CS16: Climate Change and the impacts of new	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative	?*	?*	?*	- By increasing the number of new developments including housing with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and carbon emissions that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policies CS15 and CS16 should serve to mitigate these potential effects and considerably reduce carbon emissions but are unlikely to completely remove them.

Policy CS4: Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	developments are designed and delivered – any large scale developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.	developments in the rural areas and villages can be minimised.	effects if the increased development is not fully resourced by renewable energy and ends up with more cars (and thus more carbon emissions).				- The locations dealt with in this policy are, by their rural nature, likely to increase the use of the car. Development locations will require improvements in public transport to make them more sustainable. Application of Policy CS13: Transport puts an emphasis on such improvements and so will help to mitigate against the reliance on the car. - The policy could start to show more positive implications towards reducing contributions to the causes of climate change through encouraging renewable energy schemes in appropriate locations.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of any housing development, and its design and construction.	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change, CS17 Flood Risk and Water Management and CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment the impacts of the future development will be minimised.	The policy could have a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective if the policies providing mitigation are rigorously applied.	✓	✓	✓	- The application of Policy CS17 would ensure that any future development takes on board flood risk and therefore adapts to one of the more significant effects relating to climate change. - The application of Policy CS16 ensures that any future development must address the effects of climate change in the wider sense. - The application of Policy CS18 ensures that green infrastructure is promoted that will provide ecosystem services such as flood attenuation and surface water management. - All of these policy measures if rigorously applied will ensure that new developments will adapt to the effects of climate change and thus Policy CS4 should have a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.

Policy CS4: Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new developments are designed and delivered in the rural areas and villages – any large scale developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS21: Waste, the impacts of new developments can be minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the increased development in rural areas results in the increased use of non-renewable resources and brings more cars (and thus a reliance on fossil fuels and further resource depletion).	?*	?*	?*	- By increasing the number of houses and other developments with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policies CS15, CS16 and CS21 should serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.
9. Protect and enhance environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of new housing and other forms of development in the rural areas, and its design and construction.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment, the negative impacts of this policy on the natural	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be broadly positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By promoting additional housing and other kinds of development in the rural areas and villages, there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments). This would depend on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. - With regard to the natural environment using the mitigation measures set out in Policy CS18 the residual effects are likely to be positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made and housing developments are steered away from vulnerable areas. - Policy CS18 includes a number of measures which aim to protect and enhance environmental assets. Measures such as biodiversity enhancement, protection

Policy CS4: Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		environment should be minimised, and there is the potential for new housing developments to provide additional green infrastructure. Similarly Policy CS15: Place Making should mitigate against any negative effects on the historic environment and cultural heritage. Policy CS19: Green Belt looks to safeguard the countryside from urban encroachment.					of designated sites and wildlife corridors, and the development of green infrastructure to maximise the potential for flood alleviation. All imply that this policy will have positive effects on this sustainability objective. • With regard to the historic environment if Policy CS15: Place Making is rigorously applied then there are measures that encourage the protection and enhancement of the historic environment and heritage assets which would thus leave a residual positive effect. • In some of the locational assessments it was noted that some sites were in reasonably close proximity to areas of conservation interest, however, it is assumed that appropriate mitigation would be picked up at the EIA stage and through the rigorous application of policy CS18. • Policy CS19: Green Belt ensures the Green Belt, as shown on Proposals Maps, will be protected in accordance with national policy to prevent the merging of settlements, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, and checking unrestricted urban sprawl.

Policy CS4: Spatial Strategy for Rural and Villages Area							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy includes measures to develop the economy within the rural area through the sustainable growth of rural businesses and increased employment opportunities at the identified Key Employment Areas of Follingsby (KEA2) and Newcastle Airport (KEA). The policy is therefore assessed to have positive implications towards strengthening the economy.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	This policy will help to develop employment opportunities in rural areas helping to increase workforce diversity, ensuring more equality of opportunity and therefore is assessed to have positive implications on this sustainability objective.
Summary							
Social: ✓							
The policy is assessed as having a broadly positive impact on social objectives by improving conditions in rural areas through increasing accessibility, housing choice and availability, provision of services and facilities.							
Environmental: ? * to ✓							
This policy has a mix of effects ranging from an uncertain but probable negative effect on some sustainability objectives, through to broadly positive implications for others. The negative effects relate to the likelihood that new developments during construction and operation will generate carbon emissions (heating and energy use, etc), will use non-renewable resources (e.g. building materials), will lead to the generation of waste and the possible increase in car emissions, and negatively impact on areas of nature conservation, which are all hard to eradicate completely. They should, however be minimised by the simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making and CS16: Climate Change. The simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment should ensure that new development is built in such a way as to ensure minimal impact on the natural and historic environment and in some cases improve conditions such as creating new green infrastructure and green space. Overall this policy was assessed as having an uncertain but leading towards a positive effect on environmental objectives. In some of the locational assessments it was noted that some sites were in reasonably close proximity to areas of conservation interest, however, it is assumed that appropriate mitigation would be picked up at the EIA stage and through the rigorous application of policy CS18. For example, given the proximity of Throckley to the Hadrian's Wall World Heritage Site and its buffer zone, impacts upon the setting of the World Heritage site will have to be a consideration of any new development or regeneration in this area.							
Economic: ✓							
The policy is likely to have positive effects for the region with regard to the economic objectives because the policy seeks to promote the economy of rural areas through direct measures such as the sustainable growth of rural businesses and increased employment opportunities together with the provision of adequate housing.							

Policies - CS5: Employment and Economic Growth Opportunities CS6: Employment Land							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.		.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The commitment to boost economic prosperity through the provision of a flexible portfolio of employment land in appropriate locations to provide local employment opportunities should be broadly supportive of strong and inclusive communities. - The supporting text in Chapter 9 includes reference to the Councils' aim to make sure that the benefits of a successful and growing economy are shared, to promote sustainable economic growth and to proactively tackle social and economic exclusion through improving access to employment and training opportunities. Inclusion of the final clause within policy CS5 '<i>Attracting and supporting a skilled labour force and improving skills and access for local people to job opportunities including through targeted recruitment and training</i>' indicates that the policies will indeed endeavour to maximise the opportunities for local communities and foster an inclusive approach connected with any development that comes forward.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	The focus on sustaining a diverse, skilled workforce and promoting accessibility and inclusivity in employment opportunities will support the delivery of the Councils' equality/diversity obligations and duties as well as long term sustainability.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- Although policies CS5 and CS6 are not directly concerned with improving educational achievement they do focus on delivering a portfolio of employment land that will be able to offer a wide range of employment opportunities. This should act as a catalyst for further skills training and development across the area. - The second clause in policy CS5 makes reference to "supporting the knowledge based economy", and supporting text refers to planned growth of further/higher educational institutions. - The final clause of policy CS5 reinforces support to improved educational achievement by making reference to targeted training in association with new employment developments to maximise opportunities for local communities. The policies will therefore have some contribution to make to improving skills levels in the area.

Policies - CS5: Employment and Economic Growth Opportunities CS6: Employment Land							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Although policies CS5 and CS6 are not directly concerned with improving health and wellbeing it could be argued that improved economic prosperity and the creation of more jobs and opportunities for local people would make a positive contribution to community wellbeing. There is a correlation between more jobs and associated prosperity and the general health and wellbeing of the community (e.g. helping to motivate people and combat depression and the associated mental and physical health problems).
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Possible negative effects depending on how the policies are implemented.	By applying the measures to protect cultural heritage in the overarching Policy CS15: Place Making it should ensure that any potential negative implications of the policies are removed.	Neutral effect after mitigation.	0	0	0	- There is the potential that new development on designated employment land could generate negative impacts on cultural heritage depending on the nature of the development, its location and the proximity of cultural heritage assets. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS15: Place Making should ensure that any potential negative impacts are prevented. - On this basis policies CS5 and CS6 are regarded as having a broadly neutral effect on this sustainability objective. With the full delivery of Policy CS15 new development should create a positive effect on culture, heritage and diversity.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a strong positive effect.	The policies can be further strengthened with the addition of the recommended wording that emphasises 'accessibility for all'		✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- By ensuring the provision of employment land that offers a range and mix of employment uses and types, retaining Gateshead and Newcastle's primary employment areas and offering targeted recruitment and training Policy CS5 has strongly positive implications towards ensuring good access to jobs for the region. - The effects are strengthened by supporting improvements in accessibility of our employment areas (see policy CS5).
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could have negative effects – any large scale developments that do not include de-	Through the application of policies CS13: Transport and CS16: Climate Change the	The policies will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be	?*	?*	?*	- By increasing employment land provision with the possible knock-on increase in traffic and transport activity there is likely to be an inevitable increase in vehicle emissions that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - With an emphasis also on the encouragement of airport related developments there is a risk that if these increase aircraft activity that CO₂ emissions could also increase rather than decrease.

Policies - CS5: Employment and Economic Growth Opportunities CS6: Employment Land							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	carbonisation measures or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections could prejudice delivery of this objective.	impacts of the development will be minimised.	residual negative effects if the increased employment land related development brings more vehicles and the airport-related development at Newcastle Airport increases aircraft activity.				The application of Policies CS13 and CS16 should serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of development, and its design and construction.	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change, CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management the impacts of the development will be minimised.	The policies could have a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective if the policies providing mitigation are rigorously applied.	✓	✓	✓	- The application of Policy CS17 would ensure that any future employment land development takes on board flood risk and therefore adapts to one of the more significant effects relating to climate change. - The application of Policy CS16 ensures that any future development must address the effects of climate change in the wider sense. - All of these policy measures if rigorously applied will ensure that new employment developments will adapt to the effects of climate change and thus Policies CS5 and CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) should have a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new developments are designed and delivered – any large scale developments that do not include de-	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS21: Waste the impacts of new developments can be minimised.	The policies will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the increased employment	?*	?*	?*	- By increasing employment land provision with the possible knock-on increase in traffic and transport activity, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - With an emphasis also on the encouragement of airport related developments there is a risk that if these increase aircraft activity, that fossil fuel use and waste generation could also increase rather than decrease. - The application of Policies CS15, CS16 and CS21 should serve to mitigate

Policies - CS5: Employment and Economic Growth Opportunities CS6: Employment Land							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.		land related development brings more vehicles and the airport-related development at Newcastle Airport increases aircraft activity (and thus a reliance on fossil fuels and further resource depletion).				these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of development, and its design and construction.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policies CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment the negative impacts of these policies on the natural environment should be minimised, and there is the potential for new economic development to	After mitigation the effect of these policies will be broadly positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By encouraging the development and regeneration of employment land there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments). This would depend on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. - With regard to the natural environment using the mitigation measures set out in Policies CS17 and CS18 the residual effects are likely to be positive particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made and development is steered away from vulnerable areas. - With regard to the historic environment if Policy CS15 is rigorously applied then there are measures that encourage the protection and enhancement of the historic environment and heritage assets which would thus leave a residual positive effect.

Policies - CS5: Employment and Economic Growth Opportunities							
CS6: Employment Land							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		provide additional green infrastructure and steer development away from vulnerable areas. Similarly Policy CS15: Place Making should mitigate against any negative effects on the historic environment and cultural heritage.					
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The focus of the policies is on improving economic prosperity and so the measures suggested within the policies have strongly positive implications for strengthening the economy of Gateshead and Newcastle. - The positive effects should increase with time as the policies are delivered and the new developments come online.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The measures for boosting economic growth suggested in Policies CS5 and CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) have strong positive implications for improving access to a stable and sustainable employment market. - Key employment sectors are targeted and there is a good balance of new development within the different categories (larger employer, SME) at strategic locations within the area. - Policy CS5 seeks to develop “accessible employment” and supports new business start-ups and enterprises. - The positive effects should increase with time as the policies are delivered and the new developments come on line.

Policies - CS5: Employment and Economic Growth Opportunities							
CS6: Employment Land							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: Broadly ✓ The commitment to boost economic prosperity through the provision of a flexible portfolio of employment land in appropriate locations to provide local employment opportunities should be broadly supportive of strong and inclusive communities and therefore the sustainability objectives with a social thrust. The economic 'Vision' in Policy CS5 - <i>'to develop a diverse economy with accessible employment and deliver significant increases in the number of businesses and jobs'</i> – further reinforces the support to the social sustainability objectives.							
Environmental: ?* to ? ✓ By increasing employment land provision (especially at the airport) with the possible knock-on increase in traffic and transport activity, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption, CO ₂ emissions and the further depletion of resources that will all tend to prejudice the delivery of some of these environmental objectives. There is also the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments) depending on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. The application of Policies CS15, CS16, CS17 and CS18 should all serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them in some cases.							
Economic: ✓✓ The broad aim of boosting economic growth to deliver a flourishing economy means that the policies have strongly positive implications towards those sustainability objectives with an economic thrust. By ensuring that the economic prosperity of Gateshead and Newcastle will be achieved by delivering a competitive portfolio of employment land that offers a range and mix of employment uses that are accessible and inclusive means that the policies will encourage economic growth at different scales and levels that should benefit the whole community.							

Policy CS7: Retail and Centres							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	This policy focuses on investment and improvement of retail centres in Newcastle and Gateshead, development of the built environment, including improvements to shopping and employment districts, and improving the provision of facilities and services, to ultimately enhance the viability and vitality of centres. It is therefore likely to have a strong positive impact on promoting strong and inclusive communities within Gateshead and Newcastle, particularly in the longer term as the policy is delivered.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The focus of this policy is to meet local, district and borough wide needs. Development is focused in three levels of hierarchy, the Urban Core, District Centres and Local Centres. While the urban core will be the main focus for retail development and enhancement, the policy commits to ensuring district and local centres and their facilities and services are maintained and where necessary enhanced to maintain the vitality and viability of centres. The policy makes particular reference to ensuring isolated facilities such as small parades and corner shops, which communities are reliant on, will be maintained. - The policy therefore makes a strong positive contribution to this sustainability objective, particularly in the long term as the policy is delivered.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Although this policy is not directly concerned with improving educational achievement in Gateshead and Newcastle it does focus on maintaining and enhancing the Urban Core (Gateshead and Newcastle centres) as regional retail centre, maintaining the range of employment opportunities and therefore skills development opportunities. This would be supporting towards developing and retaining a skilled workforce.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- This policy is not directly concerned with improving wellbeing and health but is broadly supportive through maintained and improved provision of facilities and services, which should include medical centres, facilities for leisure and recreation. - If delivered alongside Policy CS15 which states developments should positively contribute towards providing good access to health, recreation and leisure facilities, this policy should make positive contributions towards public well-being and health, particularly in the longer term.

Policy CS7: Retail and Centres							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS15: Place Making should mitigate any negative effects on this objective.	The combination of this policy with Policy CS15 should ensure positive implications to culture, heritage and diversity.	✓	✓	✓	- There is a risk that development of retail centres could negatively impact on elements of the cultural heritage, however, since the focus is on enhancement and maintaining existing provision there should not be implications with regard to this sustainability objective. - When this policy is combined with the conservation principles embedded within Policy CS15 it should ensure positive implications for culture, heritage and diversity, particularly in the longer term as developments that promote or celebrate the cultural heritage start to take place.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy focuses on sustaining and enhancing retail and related facilities and services in Gateshead and Newcastle's city, district and local centres to meet identified need. The policy is therefore likely to increase accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services, and have a major positive impact on this sustainability objective, particularly in the long term as the policy is delivered. - The impact will be enhanced with the simultaneous application of CS13 – Transport.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Although immediate development is likely to give rise to negative effects in terms of carbon emission associated with development, the policy is in the long term likely to have a broadly positive effect.			?0	0/✓	✓	- The identified retail centres are sustainable locations for investment and enhancement, in terms of their concentration of services, employment and residential uses and good internal linkages for walking and cycling. They have good transport links via the metro and buses and to the wider region and country by train. - Focusing development in these areas is likely to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by minimising the need for additional travel investment and maximising the opportunities for making the best use of the existing transport infrastructure and more sustainable modes such as walking and cycling.

Policy CS7: Retail and Centres							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could generate negative effects depending on how enhancement and development of retail centres are delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS18, CS19, and CS21 should provide the necessary mitigation		?	?0/✓	✓	- The policy itself makes no direct reference to adaptation to the effects of climate change, and with the simultaneous application of policies CS16 (Climate Change), CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) and CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management), issues arising due to the effects of climate change, such as flood risk, should be addressed. - Mitigation should also be delivered through the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) (such as improvements to the current drainage system and use of SUDS where appropriate), as well as through the Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP).
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a broadly positive impact			✓	✓	✓	- The policy focuses on redevelopment and enhancement of existing retail centres, and therefore issues associated with growth and increased development (such as traffic, energy consumption and waste generation) are likely to be minimal. - The enhancement of built up areas, which are already served by good transport links and are already a focus of activity and community life, should have minimal impact on this sustainability objective. - The application of policies CS16 (Climate Change), CS13: (Transport) and CS15 (Place Making) should serve to mitigate any potential negative effects and make a positive contribution towards this sustainability objective as developments (including enhancement to existing buildings) will incorporate design measures that minimise energy needs and reduce impact on the environment.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Potential negative impacts depending on precise location of development.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policy CS19 and CS17 the impacts on the natural environment should be minimised.	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be broadly positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By focusing on redevelopment and enhancement of existing retail centres, the impact on environmental assets and infrastructure is likely to be minimal. - The supporting text in the policy names Metrocentre as an important area for enhancement, and there is a need to improve the external environment of the Metrocentre. This could potentially impact on environmental assets and infrastructure, but with the combined application of Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) and Policy CS15 (Place Making), the residual effects on this strategic objective are likely to be positive.

Policy CS7: Retail and Centres							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a major positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	The investment in retail centres in Gateshead and Newcastle will have a direct positive impact on the economy. Strengthening the economy in both the Urban Core and in centres at a district and local level. The effect of the policy on this strategic objective is therefore thought to be very positive, particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a major positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	If retail centres are enhanced it is likely to make a significant contribution towards job creation in both the Urban Core and in district and local centres, therefore improving access to a more stable and sustainable employment market in Gateshead and Newcastle.
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓							
The policy is assessed as having a generally positive impact on social sustainability objectives by focusing on investment and improvement of retail centres, the focus of activity and community life. The policy aims to invest in and improve the provision of facilities and services to enhance the viability and vitality of retail centres, ensuring centres at a local, district and city level are meeting day-to-day needs of residents and visitors to the area. The policy is likely to increase accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services, and invest further in the good transport links that can be found in the identified retail centres, improving access to retail centres as well as to the wider region and countryside.							
Environmental: 0 to ✓							
The policy is assessed as having a mix of either neutral or slightly positive effects on the environmental objectives. Although the policy makes no direct reference to the mitigation or adaptation to climate change, or the enhancement of environmental assets and infrastructure, there are a number of policies, which if simultaneous applied should mitigate against any negative effects. For example Policy CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) will mitigate against issues arising due to the effects of climate change, such as flood risk. Mitigation against flood risk should also be delivered through the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) as well as through the Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP). Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) should mitigate against any adverse impacts on biodiversity and the natural environment.							
The identified retail centres are sustainable locations for investment and enhancement, in terms of their concentration of services, employment and residential uses and good internal linkages for walking and cycling. They have good transport links via the metro and buses and to the wider region and country by train. Focusing development in these areas is likely to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by minimising the need for additional travel investment and maximising the opportunities for making the best use of the existing infrastructure.							
Economic: ✓✓							
This policy is likely to have positive effects on the economic objectives. The enhancement and investment in retail centres will make a positive contribution to sustaining the economy at a local, district and borough level, and should therefore also support the creation of new jobs in the future.							

Policy CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- This Policy encourages leisure, culture and tourism facilities to be located in the urban core or smaller scale developments in rural and villages areas to support the rural tourism economy. The supporting text in this section particularly at Paragraph 9.42 emphasises the desire to deliver facilities that are socially inclusive and welcoming to communities. - The application of the 'Development Principles' in CS1 will ensure that all such facilities and developments are fully inclusive and well designed to promote community cohesion.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	The policy can be further strengthened with the addition of the recommended wording.	With the additional wording likely to increase the positive effects in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- This Policy encourages tourism and recreation development that will improve the quality and range of facilities in the existing evening economy so that it is more socially-inclusive and welcoming. The Policy will therefore contribute to this SA Objective. - The application of the 'Development Principles' in CS1 will ensure that all such facilities and developments are fully inclusive and well designed to promote community cohesion.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	This Policy encourages tourism, leisure and recreation development that will in turn improve the quality and range of facilities for our communities. Teaching and learning benefits from having access to a broad range of facilities and experiences that are available locally. Therefore there should be positive benefits for skills development (in sports, recreation, cultural and tourism related subjects). The policy will therefore have a broadly positive effect on this SA Objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This Policy aims to encourage both sport and recreation facilities and major leisure and tourism attractions with the intention of improving the quality and range of facilities for communities. This is likely to have a major positive effect on health and wellbeing in the community. - The application of the 'Development Principles' in CS1 will ensure that all such facilities and developments are fully inclusive and well designed to promote community cohesion and wellbeing, thus reinforcing the positive contribution that this policy can make. - The positive effects should increase with time as the policy is delivered and the new developments come on line.

Policy CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral effect. Could potentially be positive depending on how the policy is delivered in line with Policy CS15.	Policy CS15 (Place Making) includes the requirement for new development to reinforce local characteristics, meet the needs of the local community, protect and sustain and enhance heritage assets and promote use, understanding and enjoyment of the historic environment.	After mitigation, this policy is likely to have a positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	With the simultaneous application of Policy CS15 there will be sufficient safeguards to ensure that new developments delivering tourism and recreation facilities under Policy CS8 do so in a way that respects local culture and heritage.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- This Policy encourages leisure, culture and tourism development that improve the quality and range of facilities for communities. - The application of the 'Development Principles' in CS1 will ensure that all such facilities and developments are fully inclusive and well designed to promote community cohesion and wellbeing, thus reinforcing the positive contribution that this policy can make.

Policy CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could have negative effects – any large scale sports, leisure or tourism developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections could prejudice delivery of this objective.	Through the application of policy CS16 (Climate Change) the impacts of the development will be minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the increased sports, leisure and tourism related development brings more vehicle activity.	✖?	✖?	✖?	- By increasing leisure, culture and tourism related provision with the possible knock-on increase in traffic and transport activity there is likely to be an inevitable increase in vehicle emissions that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policy CS16 should serve to mitigate these potential effects but is unlikely to completely remove them.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of development, and its design and construction.	Through the application of policies CS16 (Climate Change) and CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) the impacts of the development will be minimised.	The policy could have a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective if the policies providing mitigation are rigorously applied.	✓	✓	✓	- The application of Policy CS17 would ensure that any future leisure, culture or tourism development takes on board flood risk and therefore adapts to one of the more significant effects relating to climate change. - The application of Policy CS16 ensures that any future development must address the effects of climate change in the wider sense. - All of these policy measures if rigorously applied will ensure that new leisure and tourism developments will adapt to the effects of climate change and thus Policy CS8 should have a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new developments are designed and delivered – any large scale leisure or tourism	Through the application of policy CS16 (Climate Change) the impacts of new developments can be minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the leisure or	✖?	✖?	✖?	- By increasing the provision of leisure, culture and tourism developments with the possible knock-on increase in traffic and transport activity, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policy CS16 should serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.

Policy CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.		tourism related development brings more vehicles.				
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of development, and its design and construction.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment the negative impacts of this policy on the natural environment should be minimised, and there is the potential for new economic development to provide additional green infrastructure and	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be broadly positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By encouraging additional leisure, culture and tourism developments there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments). This would depend on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. - With regard to the natural environment using the mitigation measures set out in Policy CS18 the residual effects are likely to be positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made and development is steered away from vulnerable areas. - With regard to the historic environment if Policy CS15 is rigorously applied then there are measures that encourage the protection and enhancement of the historic environment and heritage assets which would thus leave a residual positive effect.

Policy CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		steer development away from vulnerable areas. Similarly Policy CS15 (Place Making) should mitigate against any negative effects on the historic environment and cultural heritage.					
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a strongly positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This Policy has a direct bearing on this SA objective and is likely to have a strong positive effect by facilitating the growth of the tourism sector, one of the important business sectors for the Gateshead and Newcastle economy. - Arguably the provision of an improved range and quality of leisure, culture and tourism facilities should also boost economic opportunities and make the area attractive for people to live.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a strongly positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	Through the potential boost in the tourism sector and in the provision of more leisure, culture and tourism facilities there should be a positive impact on employment opportunities. This is likely to become more positive in the longer term as developments take place and the tourism sector expands.

Policy CS8: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓ This Policy encourages leisure, culture and tourism development that will improve the quality and range of facilities for communities. The Policy will therefore contribute positively to the SA Objectives with more of a social thrust. With the simultaneous application of CS1 with its 'Development Principles' together with the wording in Paragraph 5.11 this will ensure that Policy CS8 more effectively addresses the Councils' equality and diversity obligations which are particularly important in the context of sport, leisure, culture and tourism. Environmental: ?✖ to ? ✓ By increasing the number of leisure, culture and tourism facilities across Gateshead and Newcastle, with the possible knock-on increase in traffic and transport activity, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption, CO₂ emissions and the further depletion of resources that will all tend to prejudice the delivery of some of the environmental objectives. There is also the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments) depending on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. The application of Policies CS15, CS16 and CS17 should all serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them in some cases. Economic: ✓✓ The promotion of the growth of the tourism sector in Gateshead and Newcastle has strongly positive implications for the economy of the region and the potential to increase the employment market for the region. Arguably the provision of an improved range and quality of leisure, culture and tourism facilities should also boost economic opportunities and make the area attractive for people to live and work.							

Policy CS9: Existing Communities							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This Policy seeks to continue to support existing communities, ensuring that there is adequate investment to sustain quality and desirability and to prevent the loss of family housing while maintaining a range and choice of housing throughout the area. There is also a desire to prevent over concentrations of shared accommodation that will have a detrimental effect on the environment, social cohesion and services. - All these measures should act to promote strong and cohesive communities, particularly in the longer term as the policy delivers its ambitions and goals.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- This is an overarching policy, applying to all existing neighbourhoods, regardless of background and so will help to improve communities across the board. - The supporting text emphasises that the focus for investment will be on those areas which are characterised by an over dominance of particular housing types and a lack of tenure choice where residents have poor access to essential services and facilities. Within these areas there are many strengths including a strong sense of community and existing infrastructure. New development must complement strengths, retain existing residents and attract new ones.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	- This policy does not deal directly with issues addressing the improvement of educational achievements and skills levels across Gateshead and Newcastle. There are, however no negative effects on this objective anticipated from the application of this policy so the effect is likely to be broadly neutral. - Furthermore, both the policy and its supporting text explicitly state that existing services, including schools, can always be improved when ensuring long term sustainability of a community as part of the regeneration process. Thus there is scope for maintaining and providing.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly neutral to positive effect, particularly in the longer term.			0/✓	0/✓	✓	- Although this policy does not focus on health and well-being directly, indirect benefits of better housing security and ongoing support for existing communities should be generally supportive of health and wellbeing in the community and could lead to general improvements in mental and physical health in the longer term. - Measures such as preventing loss of family housing and investing in existing homes and the surrounding local environment should promote development

Policy CS9: Existing Communities							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
							that creates conditions for supporting well-being and happiness in all communities. The general principle of support for Neighbourhoods
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a positive effect.	With the simultaneous application of Policy CS15: Place Making that includes the requirement for new development to reinforce local characteristics, meet the needs of the local community, protect sustain and enhance heritage assets and promote use, understanding and enjoyment of the historic environment, there could be a stronger positive effect in the longer term.		✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy aims to support existing communities and ensure the continuing use of existing buildings where possible and the investment in the surrounding environment, it will therefore be broadly supportive of this SA Objective. - The supporting text of policy CS15 states that progress has already been made in regeneration areas, making improvements to existing environment and public services. - When combined with the application of Policy CS15 there is the potential for Policy CS9 to have a strongly positive effect over the longer term, making sure that local distinctiveness is enhanced, heritage assets are protected whilst meeting the needs of the community.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	This policy states that investment will be focused on those areas with poor access to essential services and facilities. This should provide positive support to this sustainability objective.

Policy CS9: Existing Communities							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could have positive or negative effects depending on how improvement, renewal and regeneration of existing communities and housing stock are carried out.	Simultaneous application of policies CS15: Place Making and CS16: Climate Change would ensure that regenerated housing stock addressed climate change issues and was energy efficient.	Likely to be positive.	?✓	✓	✓	- Bringing empty properties back into use or replacing them could generate positive or negative effects on the environment depending on how this was carried out and the extent to which sustainability principles in design, construction and energy supply were incorporated. The Policy clearly promotes the reuse of existing housing and the improvement of existing neighbourhoods environmentally. By supporting existing neighbourhoods, the policy is ensuring that there is likely to be less need for new buildings and infrastructure, which would have embodied carbon and would add to the overall carbon footprint rather than reducing it. - Application of Policies CS15 and CS16 would help to reduce the carbon load from any new development or regeneration initiative.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to be broadly supportive.			✓	✓	✓	By supporting existing neighbourhoods, the policy is ensuring that there is less need for new buildings, and therefore less pressure to find suitable sites on which to build and perhaps run the risk of building in the flood plain or on sites at risk from flooding.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have positive or negative effects depending on how improvement, renewal and regeneration of existing communities and housing stock are carried out.	Simultaneous application of policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS21: Waste would ensure that use of non-renewable resources, energy efficiency and environmental protection were all considered in regeneration programmes.	Likely to be positive.	?✓	✓	✓	- Bringing empty properties back into use or replacing them could generate positive or negative effects on the environment depending on how this was carried out and the extent to which sustainability principles in design, construction and energy supply were incorporated. The Policy clearly promotes the reuse of existing housing and the improvement of existing neighbourhoods environmentally. By supporting existing neighbourhoods, the policy is ensuring that there is likely to be less need for new buildings and infrastructure, which would have embodied carbon and would add to the overall carbon footprint rather than reducing it. - Application of Policies CS15, CS16 and CS21 would help to reduce the carbon load from any new development or regeneration initiative.

Policy CS9: Existing Communities							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of the proposed housing improvements, any new regeneration initiatives and the design and construction of any new build.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment the negative impacts of this policy on the natural environment should be minimised, and there is the potential for new housing development and regeneration schemes to provide additional green infrastructure. Similarly Policy CS15: Place Making should mitigate against any negative effects on the historic environment and cultural heritage.	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be broadly positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By encouraging housing restoration and new regeneration initiatives there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments). This would depend on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. - With regard to the natural environment using the mitigation measures set out in Policy CS18 the residual effects are likely to be positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made within any new development. - With regard to the historic environment if Policy CS15 is rigorously applied then there are measures that encourage the protection and enhancement of the historic environment and heritage assets which would thus leave a residual positive effect.

Policy CS9: Existing Communities							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Although this policy does not target specifically on economic growth and strengthening the economy, it is nevertheless likely that reviving existing communities and investing in regeneration initiatives should increase the availability of housing and support sustainable thriving communities, including local facilities and services, which in turn supports the strengthening of the local economy.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	By striving for quality neighbourhoods and contributing towards sustainable thriving communities this policy is likely to encourage more people to remain or move to Gateshead and Newcastle thus helping to ensure a stable and sustainable employment market.
Summary							
Social: ✓							
This is an overarching policy, applying to all existing neighbourhoods so will help to improve communities across the board. The supporting text in Chapter 10 underpins the desire to create sustainable thriving communities. Delivery of this policy and its various measures should act to promote strong and cohesive communities, particularly in the longer term as the policy delivers its ambitions and goals. Although not focusing on health and well-being directly, indirect benefits from this policy of better housing security and ongoing support for existing communities should be generally supportive of health and wellbeing in the community. The supporting text of the policy states making improvements to education, employment, transport, the environment and public services is an integral part of regeneration. Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect.							
Environmental: ✓							
Regeneration activities could lead to increased energy consumption, waste generation, fossil fuel consumption, CO₂ emissions and the further depletion of resources that will all tend to prejudice the delivery of some of these environmental objectives. There is also the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments) depending on the precise location of any housing stock renewal and regeneration programmes and how any restoration work was designed and constructed. The application of Policies CS15, CS16, CS17 and CS18 should all serve to mitigate these potential effects. The emphasis of this policy on bringing back empty properties into use and investing in the surrounding local environment should generate positive effects on the environment. Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect.							
Economic: ✓							
Although economic drive is not the emphasis of this policy it is likely to contribute to a sustainable employment market in the region by encouraging people to stay or move to the area because the neighbourhoods are places of quality and choice and their facilities and services should be improved over time, especially through regeneration. Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect.							

Policy CS10: Delivering New Homes							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The Policy seeks to deliver new housing based on the findings of the Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment (SHLAA) and therefore should help to strengthen the community by providing housing where it is needed.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- This Policy is likely to have a positive effect on equality, diversity and integration through the provision of housing in areas where it is needed. The simultaneous application of Policy CS11: Providing a range and choice of housing should ensure that the appropriate types of housing are built to meet the needs of specific groups within the community. - The simultaneous application of CS13: Transport should ensure that new housing developments are accessible to all.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not deal directly with issues addressing the improvement of educational achievements and skills levels across Gateshead and Newcastle. There are, however no negative effects on this objective anticipated from the application of this policy so the effect is likely to be broadly neutral.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly neutral to slightly positive effect.			0	0	✓	Although this policy does not deal directly with issues around health and well-being, indirect benefits of better housing availability and in areas where it is needed should lead to general improvements in wellbeing and health in the longer term.

Policy CS10: Delivering New Homes							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.	Policy CS15: Place Making includes the requirement for new development to reinforce local characteristics, meet the needs of the local community, protect and enhance heritage assets and promote use, understanding and enjoyment of the historic environment.		0	✓	✓	Combined with the application of Policy CS15 the policy has the potential to have a positive effect over the long term, ensuring that new housing developments promote, enhance and respect culture heritage and diversity.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	When applied together with Policy CS13: Transport, DEL1: Infrastructure and Developer Contributions and individual site specific plans this policy will ensure that housing is built together with an emphasis on accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services therefore having positive implications for this sustainability objective.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new housing developments are designed and delivered – any large scale housing developments that do not include de-carbonisation	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making and CS16: Climate Change the impacts of new housing developments can be minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the increased housing development is not fully	?*	?*	?*	- By increasing the number of houses with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and carbon emissions that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policies CS15 and CS16 should serve to mitigate these potential effects and considerably reduce carbon emissions but are unlikely to completely remove them.

Policy CS10: Delivering New Homes							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.		resourced by renewable energy and brings more cars (and thus more carbon emissions).				
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of any housing development, and its design and construction.	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management the impacts of the housing development will be minimised.	The policy could have a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective if the policies providing mitigation are rigorously applied.	✓	✓	✓	- The application of Policy CS17 would ensure that any future housing development takes on board flood risk and therefore adapts to one of the more significant effects relating to climate change. - The application of Policy CS16 ensures that any future development must address the effects of climate change in the wider sense. It emphasises that all development '<i>will be sustainable and able to function effectively in a changing climate</i>' - If all of the relevant policy measures in CS16 are rigorously applied this will ensure that new housing developments will adapt to the effects of climate change and thus Policy CS10 should have a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new housing developments are designed and delivered – any large scale housing developments that do not include de-	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS21: Waste the impacts of new housing developments can be minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the increased housing development	?*	?*	?*	- By increasing the number of houses with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policies CS2, CS3, CS4, CS15, CS16 and CS21 should serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.

Policy CS10: Delivering New Homes							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.		brings more cars (and thus a reliance on fossil fuels and further resource depletion).				
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of new housing development, and its design and construction.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policies CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management, CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment the negative impacts of this policy on the natural environment should be minimised, and there is the potential for new housing developments to provide additional green infrastructure.	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be broadly positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By promoting additional housing developments there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments). This would depend on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. - With regard to the natural environment using the mitigation measures set out in Policies CS17 and CS18 the residual effects are likely to be positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made and housing developments are steered away from vulnerable areas. - With regard to the historic environment if Policy CS15 is rigorously applied then there are measures that encourage the protection and enhancement of the historic environment and heritage assets which would thus leave a residual positive effect.

Policy CS10: Delivering New Homes							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		Similarly Policy CS15: Place Making should mitigate any negative effects on the historic environment and cultural heritage.					
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a neutral to slightly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The provision of housing in the way indicated in Policy CS10 is likely to provide some form of support to the economy through making more housing available, attracting people into the area, increasing workforce diversity and encouraging communities to be more stable, thriving and sustainable. In addition there will be a boost to the construction industry as a direct result of house building. - Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral to slightly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	There is likely to be positive implications when combined with Policy CS11 by providing affordable housing where it is required because this will encourage more people to move to the area and thus increase the employment market.

Policy CS10: Delivering New Homes							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓							
The Policy seeks to deliver new housing based on the findings of the Strategic Housing Land Availability Assessment (SHLAA) and therefore should help to strengthen the community by providing housing where it is needed, this in turn is likely to have a positive effect on equality, diversity and integration. Although the policy does not deal directly with issues around health and well-being, indirect benefits of better housing availability and a mix of housing offer could lead to general improvements in mental and physical health within the community in the longer term. Overall the policy is assessed as being broadly supportive of the social SA Objectives.							
Environmental: ?✖ to ✓							
There is the possibility for the development of new housing stock to impact negatively on the environment, in terms of generating carbon emissions, use of non-renewable resources, generation of waste and the possible increase in car emissions but this should be minimised by the simultaneous application of Policies CS15 and CS16. The simultaneous application of Policies CS15 and CS18 should ensure that new housing development is built in such a way as to ensure minimal impact on the natural and historic environment and in some cases improve conditions such as creating new green infrastructure and green space. Overall this policy was assessed as having an uncertain but leading towards a positive effect on environmental objectives.							
Economic: ✓							
The provision of housing in the way indicated in Policy CS10 is likely to provide some form of support to the economy through direct benefits to the construction industry, and making more housing available, attracting people into the area, increasing workforce diversity and encouraging communities to be more stable, thriving and sustainable. Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect on the economic objectives.							

Policy CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	The Policy seeks to promote 'Lifetime Neighbourhoods' and thus to ensure an appropriate range of housing to meet varied and changing needs. This mix will help to ensure strong and sustainable communities because housing will be available to all members of society and a mix of house sizes and prices will help to ensure that a fair and equitable range of housing is available in support of social inclusion.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	This Policy will help to create communities that are mixed in terms of housing tenures, thus encouraging a greater proportion of citizens to benefit from living in shared neighbourhoods. This is likely to have a positive effect on equality, diversity and integration.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not deal directly with issues addressing the improvement of educational achievements and skills levels across Gateshead and Newcastle. There are, however no negative effects on this objective anticipated from the application of this policy so the effect is likely to be broadly neutral.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			0	✓	✓	- Although this policy does not focus on health and well-being directly, indirect benefits of better housing availability, appropriate housing densities and a mix of housing offer should be generally supportive of health and wellbeing in the community and could lead to general improvements in mental and physical health in the longer term. - The development of 'Lifetime Neighbourhoods' will help to create a healthy environment through the support this concept gives to 'walkable' environments and the provision of green spaces both of which will be designed to cater for all.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.	Policy CS15: Place Making includes the requirement for new development to protect, sustain and enhance heritage assets.		0	✓	✓	Combined with the application of Policy CS15 the policy has the potential to have a positive effect over the long term, protecting and sustaining historical buildings and heritage assets and supporting the cultural life and diversity of the residents as part of Lifetime Neighbourhood design.

Policy CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy will be supportive of this objective through the promotion of Lifetime Neighbourhoods that are likely to have mixed use developments with a focus on good accessibility to services, facilities and employment opportunities. - Also when applied together with CS13: Transport, DEL1: Infrastructure and Developer Contributions and individual site specific plans this policy will ensure that housing is built together with an emphasis on accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services thus reinforcing the positive implications for this sustainability objective.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new housing developments are designed and delivered – any large scale housing developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS21: Waste the impacts of new housing developments can be minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the increased housing development is not fully resourced by renewable energy and brings more cars (and thus more carbon emissions).	✖✖	✖✖	✖✖	- By increasing the number of houses that will be constructed together with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and carbon emissions that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policies CS15 and CS16 should serve to mitigate these potential effects and considerably reduce carbon emissions but are unlikely to completely remove them.

Policy CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of any housing development, and its design and construction.	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management the impacts of the housing development will be minimised.	The policy could have a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective if the policies providing mitigation are rigorously applied.	✓	✓	✓	- The application of Policy CS17 would ensure that any future housing development takes on board flood risk and therefore adapts to one of the more significant effects relating to climate change. - The application of Policy CS16 ensures that any future development must address the effects of climate change in the wider sense and incorporate climate change mitigation and adaptation in the design process. - All of these policy measures if rigorously applied will ensure that new housing developments will adapt to the effects of climate change and thus Policy CS11 should have a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new housing developments are designed and delivered – any large scale housing developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS21: Waste the impacts of new housing developments can be minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the increased housing development brings more cars (and thus a reliance on fossil fuels and further resource depletion).	✖✖	✖✖	✖✖	- By increasing the number of houses with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policies CS15, CS16 and CS21 should serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.

Policy CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of new housing development, and its design and construction.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policies CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment the negative impacts of this policy on the natural environment should be minimised, and there is the potential for new housing developments to provide additional green infrastructure. Similarly Policy CS15: Place Making should mitigate against any negative effects on the historic environment and cultural heritage.	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be broadly positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By promoting additional housing developments there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments). This would depend on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. - With regard to the natural environment using the mitigation measures set out in Policies CS17 and CS18 the residual effects are likely to be positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made and housing developments are steered away from vulnerable areas. - With regard to the historic environment if Policy CS15 is rigorously applied then there are measures that encourage the protection and enhancement of the historic environment and heritage assets which would thus leave a residual positive effect.

Policy CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a neutral to slightly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The provision of housing in the way indicated in Policy CS11 is likely to provide some form of support to the economy through making a greater range of housing available, attracting people into the area, increasing workforce diversity and encouraging communities to be more stable, thriving and sustainable. - Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral to slightly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	There are likely to be positive implications through the provision of a range of housing types to meet a wide range of needs including affordable housing and to locate it where it is required. This is likely to encourage more people to move to the area and thus increase the employment market.
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓							
The policy is likely to have positive effects on the social sustainability objectives since it seeks to ensure an appropriate mix of housing and a sustainable supply of affordable housing. This mix will help to ensure strong and sustainable communities. Housing will be based on demand and the indirect benefits of better housing availability, appropriate housing densities and a mix of housing offer should be generally supportive of health and wellbeing in the community. In terms of delivering the Councils' equality and diversity obligations a mix of house sizes and prices will help to ensure that a fair and equitable range of housing is available in support of social inclusion. This policy should ensure the social requirements of affordable housing stock is met, and by ensuring buildings are recovered and reused this should ensure long term benefits and sustainability of neighbourhoods. There is also positive supporting text that provides a focus on the Lifetime Neighbourhoods initiative – creating and retrofitting neighbourhoods to provide health and wellbeing to residents of all ages, backgrounds, abilities.							
Environmental: ?* to ✓							
There is the possibility for the development of new housing stock to impact negatively on the environment, in terms of generating carbon emissions, use of non-renewable resources, generation of waste and the possible increase in car emissions but this should be minimised by the simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making and CS16: Climate Change. The simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment should ensure that new housing development is built in such a way as to ensure minimal impact on the natural and historic environment and in some cases improve conditions such as creating new green infrastructure and green space. Overall this policy was assessed as having an uncertain but leading towards a positive effect on environmental objectives.							
Economic: ✓							
The provision of housing in the way indicated in Policy CS11 is likely to provide some form of support to the economy through making more housing available, attracting people into appropriate areas for accessing work and thus potentially increasing workforce diversity. Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect on the economic objectives.							

Policy CS12: Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Showpeople							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a strong positive impact.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy focuses on ensuring provision is made for travelling groups in appropriate locations that meet a variety of criteria (including accessibility to jobs, schools, utilities and public transport, and local facilities and services) therefore promoting a sense of place and 'strong' communities that are capable of accommodating travelling groups. - The policy aims to meet identified need whilst minimising any environmental impacts on neighbouring communities (e.g. size, noise and visual impact). - The policy is therefore assessed to have a positive impact on this sustainability objective, particularly in the longer term as the goals of this policy are delivered.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a strong positive impact.			✓	✓	✓✓	- By accommodating travelling groups in sustainable locations, this promotes equality in terms of access and opportunities. - The policy states preference will be given firstly to locations within and then adjacent to existing settlements, encouraging integration of this minority group into local communities. - The policy is therefore assessed to have a major positive impact on this sustainability objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive impact.			✓	✓	✓	- Although this policy does not directly contribute to improved educational achievement and skills level across Gateshead and Newcastle, it does commit to ensuring potential sites for travelling groups are assessed for suitability on accessibility to local schools and jobs. - The policy is assessed as having a broadly positive impact on this sustainability objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive impact.			✓	✓	✓	This policy commits to ensuring potential sites for travelling groups are assessed on providing a safe and healthy environment for residents, and on access to local facilities and services (which will include access to medical centres).
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.	Policy CS15: Place Making includes the requirement to protect and sustain cultural diversity.		0	✓	✓	Combined with the application of Policy CS15 the policy has the potential to have a positive effect over the long term, protecting and sustaining the cultural life and diversity of the residents, particularly those of travelling groups.

Policy CS12: Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Showpeople							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a strong positive impact.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy makes a direct contribution to improving accessibility for travelling groups, including ensuring potential sites are considered in accordance with a range of criteria: accessibility to jobs, schools, shops and local facilities; access to the highway network; and access to utilities and refuse storage). - The policy is assessed as having a strong positive impact on this sustainability objective.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could be negative depending on precise location of sites whether the provision of sustainable energy and waste solutions is incorporated.	Mitigation measures offered by Policy CS16: Climate Change should ensure impacts are minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if the increased housing development is not fully resourced by renewable energy	✖	✖	✖	- By promoting the use of areas adjacent to settlements and brownfield sites there could be a possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and carbon emissions that would prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The policy states that during assessment of potential sites for travelling groups, sites will be assessed for not having any unacceptable impact on the wider environment, and if delivered in combination with Policy CS16: Climate Change there should be minimal residual impact on this sustainability objective.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could be negative depending on mitigation measures, and how sites are assessed as suitable.	The application of policies CS16 and CS17 should ensure the impacts of this policy are minimised.	The policy could have a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective if the policies providing mitigation are rigorously applied.	✓	✓	✓	- This policy could potentially have a negative impact on this sustainability objective depending on the precise location of sites and the supporting infrastructure provided to travelling groups. The policy states that sites should be “safe, secure” environment for residents and avoid areas at risk of flooding. - Policy CS16 and CS17 would ensure that any sites designated for travelling groups addresses the effects of climate change and takes on board flood risk, therefore adapting to one of the more significant effects relating to climate change. - With the combined application of these policies, there should be a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.

Policy CS12: Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Showpeople							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects depending on the allocation of suitable sites.	Through the application of policies CS15: Place Making and CS16: Climate Change the impacts should be minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation, but impact depends on the precise location of allocated sites.	✖	✖	✖	- By promoting the use of areas adjacent to settlements and brownfield sites, there could be a possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation in urban areas. As a result of this there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The strategic allocation of potential sites next to existing settlements and the application of Policies CS15 and CS16 should serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of allocated land.	Through the mitigation measures offered by policies CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment and CS21: Waste the negative impacts of this policy on the natural environment should be minimised.	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be broadly positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By promoting the use of available land for accommodating traveling groups there is potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments). This would depend on the precise location of the allocated sites and the development of supporting infrastructure provided to travelling groups. - Implementation of policies CS18 and CS21 should ensure the residual effects are likely to be positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made, and if previously brownfield or urban environments are reused or developed.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a neutral to slightly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- This policy is likely to provide some form of support to the economy by ensuring travelling groups have access to jobs and education, increasing workforce diversity and encouraging integration of communities. - Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- This policy will help to develop employment opportunities for travelling groups. - By encouraging the integration of travelling groups into the community, ensuring accessibility to jobs and education, this policy is likely increase the local employment market and diversity of workforce, therefore providing a broadly positive impact on this sustainability objective.

Policy CS12: Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Showpeople

Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative

Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	

Summary

Social: ✓ to ✓✓

This policy is assessed as having a positive impact on social objectives, by ensuring appropriate criteria are used to assess site allocation for travelling groups. The policy ensures that allocated sites have good access to jobs, schools, utilities, refuse storage, public transport, local facilities and services, ensuring that the needs of travelling groups are met and they are provided with a safe and healthy environment. The policy gives preference to site allocation within or adjacent to existing settlements, promoting integration of travelling groups into communities. All of this contributes positively towards social sustainability objectives.

Environmental: ? ✗ to ✓

There is the possibility for the allocation of sites for travelling groups to impact negatively on the environment, in terms of generating carbon emissions, use of non-renewable resources, generation of waste, and increased traffic but this should be minimised by the simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. There is potential to make a positive contribution towards environmental assets, particularly if site allocation means the redevelopment of brownfield or reuse of sites within urban environments and if the development of green infrastructure is incorporated into the regeneration. Overall this policy was assessed as having an uncertain but leading towards a positive effect on environmental objectives.

Economic: ✓

This policy is likely to provide a broadly positive impact on the economy by encouraging the integration of travelling groups into the community, ensuring accessibility to jobs and education, this policy is likely increase the local employment market, diversity of workforce, and ultimately strengthen the economy.

Policy CS13: Transport							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This Policy seeks to improve transport infrastructure and connectivity within the Gateshead and Newcastle area and to increase sustainable travel choices as well as improve on accessibility within communities. - The supporting text in Section11 sets out the key principles and aspirations and underlines how accessibility and sustainable transport support social inclusion and improved quality of life for all in Gateshead and Newcastle. - As such the policy is likely to generate significant positive effects on this objective, particularly in the longer term.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	Clause 1 (i) emphasises that sustainable travel choices for all will be promoted through 'improving equality of access to transport for everyone'. This ensures that equality principles are embedded in this transport policy and therefore that the policy is likely to generate significant positive effects on this objective, particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Although this policy does not address issues that specifically relate to educational achievement and skills development it does aim to provide a sustainable transport network that supports economic prosperity and improved access to employment centres, facilities and services. This should therefore provide a supporting framework for improving skills (e.g. access to educational facilities and services) and retaining the skilled workforce (e.g. improved access to employment).
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The policy sets out to promote a reduction in the dominance of the car and access to more sustainable travel choices (including walking and cycling) both of which support improved health and wellbeing by promoting increased personal exercise and increased interaction with the physical environment and other people. - Improved sustainable travel choices are likely to enable more walking and cycling which will help to improve physical and mental health. - Improved connectivity throughout the region and within neighbourhoods will assist in people accessing health services, either planned or emergencies. And also provides opportunities to improve access to healthy food outlets and green space. - All of these are likely to generate more significant positive effects in the longer term as the policies deliver their objectives.

Policy CS13: Transport							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Uncertain but could have positive or negative effects depending on how the improvements in the transport network are delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS15 will make sure that the effect is positive on this objective.	With the application of Policy CS15 the effect can be strengthened to a broadly positive effect.	✓	✓	✓	- The policies do not make any particular reference to cultural heritage and diversity so the delivery of transport interventions (particularly major construction activities) could generate either positive or negative effects on this sustainability objective depending on how they were delivered. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS15 (Place Making), however, with its provisions for protecting heritage assets and safeguarding local characteristics and distinctiveness will make sure that culture and heritage issues are considered appropriately.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The whole thrust of this policy is about delivering improvements to transport infrastructure and improving accessibility across the area through an integrated sustainable transport network, so it will directly and positively impact on this SA objective. - There are measures proposed to improve public transport and a range of other transport modes that will ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities and services.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Through the promotion of the use of public transport, walking and cycling over the private car and also seeking to invest further in the sustainable travel networks throughout Gateshead and Newcastle, this policy contributes very positively to this sustainability objective. - Clause 3 in particular promotes the use of measures within development that will provide more sustainable forms of motor transport via the provision, for example of charging points for electric vehicles and infrastructure and parking for cycles. It will therefore be instrumental in reducing the output of greenhouse gasses in the Gateshead and Newcastle area and therefore promoting a significant positive effect on this sustainability objective. - The expansion of travel and freight movement at Newcastle Airport has the potential to offset some of the positive impacts of the policy and should be implemented towards the shift in decarbonisation where possible.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The Policy will not have a direct positive effect on either reducing vulnerability or adapting to climate change but, as transport related development will be governed by Policy CS1 and will so be subject to sequential and exception tests it will not have a negative effect on reducing vulnerability to climate change.

Policy CS13: Transport							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a strongly positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	The Policy promotes the use of public transport, walking and cycling over the private car and also seeks to invest further in the sustainable travel networks throughout Gateshead and Newcastle. It will therefore be instrumental in reducing the reliance on and consumption of fossil fuels in the overall area.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a neutral to broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The aim of reducing the dominance of the private car across the area and enhancing opportunities for more sustainable forms of travelling such as walking and cycling should mean that green infrastructure that will include green spaces and linking corridors will be protected and enhanced which in turn will make a contribution towards safeguarding environmental assets and infrastructure within the area.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a neutral to slightly positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	- This policy is not directed at strengthening the economy of the area but there are no negative effects anticipated. - In the supporting text in Section 11, there is a commitment to ensure local transport networks as well as connections at a national and international level are fit for purpose and are able to support ambitions set out within the Plan. This should generate positive benefits for the local economy.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral to slightly positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	This policy is not directed strictly towards improving access to stable and sustainable employment markets, but it does aim to promote more sustainable travel choices and ensure that new development proposals provide robust accessibility assessments. No negative effects are anticipated and the residual effect is considered to be either neutral or slightly positive.

Policy CS13: Transport							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓✓ Policy CS13 seeks to improve transport infrastructure and connectivity within Gateshead and Newcastle area and to increase sustainable travel choices as well as improve on accessibility within communities. There are also strongly positive health implications of promoting sustainable transport modes such as walking and cycling. It is therefore assessed overall to have strong positive implications on the social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ✓✓ The policy promotes the use of public transport, walking and cycling over the private car and seeks to invest further in sustainable travel networks. It promotes the use of more sustainable forms of motor transport via the provision of charging points for electric vehicles as well as improving on the infrastructure and facilities for cycling. Therefore the major direction of the policy is on improving environmental conditions through promoting sustainable transport (commitments to tackle climate change, improve air quality and reduce carbon emissions) and therefore it is assessed as likely to generate strong positive effects on the environmental objectives. Economic: ✓ The major focus of the policy is to improve travel connectivity and promote the sustainable transport network. It focuses on improving accessibility throughout the area and the provision of an integrated sustainable network for travel both of which should support improved access to jobs, facilities and services, thus broadly supporting access to employment and therefore indirectly economic prosperity. It is therefore assessed as having a positive effect on the economic objectives.							

Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a strongly positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The Policy seeks to improve the health and wellbeing of all residents within the Gateshead and Newcastle area and to provide good access to health and social care facilities within communities. - Helping to reduce inequalities in health and access to health facilities should make a very positive contribution towards building stronger and more inclusive communities. As such it is likely to generate significant positive effects on this objective, particularly in the longer term. - Supporting text in Chapter 12.8 states “<i>The Councils will continue to work with partners, including health providers, to deliver and protect an integrated network of appropriate health facilities in sustainable, accessible locations, responsive to the diverse needs of residents.</i>” This commitment ensures the changing needs of diverse communities will be responded to, ensuring positive effects particularly in the longer term.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a strongly positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This policy focuses on good access for all to health and social care facilities and is therefore directed towards equality of health and wellbeing across the entire community. - Much of the supporting text in Chapter 12 stresses the need to ensure equitable distribution of development and lifestyle opportunities and how the Plan can help reduce health inequalities.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- This policy does not address issues that specifically relate to improving educational achievement. - However, studies have found positive health and wellbeing is shown to improve educational attainment and skills development.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a major positive effect			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	This Policy specifically addresses well-being and health issues and therefore has a major positive effect on this SA objective.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral to positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	✓	Although this Policy does not address issues that relate specifically to enhancing and respecting the culture, heritage and diversity of communities there are references to the importance of these issues in the supporting text of Chapter 12. The policy also articulates the need for development to contribute

Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
							positively and equitably to health for all.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- Although this Policy does not address issues that specifically relate to ensuring good accessibility to jobs and goods, it does intend to ensure that communities are supported by accessible health and leisure facilities and services for all. - The effect is therefore anticipated to be positive on this SA objective.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could have positive or negative effects depending on how developments arising from the policy are delivered and how buildings and facilities are designed and constructed.	The application of Policies CS14: Wellbeing and Health and CS16: Climate Change should make sure that new developments (e.g. health and sports facilities) that arise out of this policy do not generate negative effects on this SA Objective.	After mitigation, this policy is likely to have a neutral or broadly positive effect.	0?	0/✓	✓	- With the application of Policy CS16 there will be sufficient safeguards to ensure that new developments (e.g. health, education, recreation and sports facilities) supporting improved health and wellbeing under Policy CS14 do not contribute towards the causes of climate change but rather reduce their contribution. - This will be tied in with an effective decarbonisation strategy that ensures more rapid uptake of renewable energy within new buildings and shifts to access by more sustainable transport.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could have positive or negative effects depending on how the policy is delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth and CS16: Climate Change should make sure that new developments (e.g. health and sports facilities) that arise out of Policy CS14 do not generate negative effects on this SA Objective.	After mitigation, this policy is likely to have a broadly neutral effect.	0	0	0	With the simultaneous application of Policies CS1 and CS16 there will be sufficient safeguards to ensure that new developments (such as health education and sports facilities) supporting improved health and wellbeing under Policy CS14 contribute towards climate change adaptation.

Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have positive or negative effects depending on how the policy is delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth, CS16: Climate Change and CS21: Waste should make sure that new developments (e.g. new health and sports facilities) that arise out of Policy CS14 do not generate negative effects on this SA Objective.	After mitigation, this policy is likely to have a positive effect.	✓	✓	✓	- With the simultaneous application of Policies CS1, CS16 and CS21 there will be sufficient safeguards to ensure that new developments such as health, education or sports facilities supporting improved health and wellbeing under Policy CS14, contribute towards 'living within environmental limits'. So for example Policy CS1 should ensure the reuse of previously developed land is favoured over developing on Greenfield sites. - Policy CS16 encourages the uptake of renewable energy and low carbon technology and so should ensure that new build operates within environmental limits. - The focus on improving access to healthy, affordable locally produced food should be supportive towards reducing the transport carbon footprint associated with foods travelling very long distances.
9. Protect and enhance environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could have positive or negative effects depending on how the policy is delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment should make sure that new developments that arise out of Policy CS14 do not generate negative effects on this SA Objective.	After mitigation, this policy is likely to have a neutral effect.	0	0	0	With the simultaneous application of Policies CS17 and CS18 there will be sufficient safeguards to ensure that new developments (such as new health, education or sports facilities) supporting improved health and wellbeing under Policy CS14 do not generate negative effects and where appropriate contribute towards the protection and enhancement of environmental assets and infrastructure.

Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✕ overall impact likely to be negative, ✕✕ major negative, ✓✕ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✕ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	✓	✓	- This policy is not focused on strengthening the economy of the area directly and there are no negative effects anticipated. - Improved health and wellbeing will enable more people to be available for work, providing opportunities to strengthen the economy in the medium and longer term.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy is not directed towards improving access to stable and sustainable employment markets. No negative effects are anticipated and the residual effect is considered to be neutral.

Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓✓							
The key focus of this policy is on improving health and wellbeing of the residents of Gateshead and Newcastle irrespective of their cultural background, ethnicity or age, thereby reducing health inequalities. Ensuring that development contributes positively to health, wellbeing and safety of communities, along with the enhanced provision of social, health, education, leisure and sports facilities and services (provided by supporting policies) mean that this policy will make strong positive contributions towards social sustainability objectives. Improving access to healthy, affordable locally-produced food and controlling the location and access to unhealthy eating outlets, alongside the requirement of Health Impact Assessments for major development, further builds upon these positive contributions. Supporting text in Chapter 12 (and alongside the Development Principles in Policy CS1: Paragraphs 5.8 to 5.13) strengthens the policy aim to promote healthy communities and reduce health inequalities, stating the Councils' commitment to equality and fairness the promotion of community cohesion, ensuring health facilities are in sustainable accessible locations that are responsive to the diverse needs of residents. This commitment to demand responsive facilities and services that promote health and wellbeing of Gateshead and Newcastle citizens will ensure positive effects particularly in the long term.							
Environmental: 0/✓							
The policy has the potential to cause negative impacts on environmental objectives through the enhanced provision of infrastructure (new building developments) to support health and wellbeing (e.g. new social, health, education, leisure and sports facilities). These potential impacts can be offset and mitigated by the measures within some of the supporting strategic policies that ensure environmental protection (e.g. Policy CS15: Place Making, CS16: Climate Change, and Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment). There will also be positive contributions made by the encouragement of locally produced food that can help to reduce the carbon footprint generated by the transport of food from overseas or north to south across the country. Overall this policy is assessed as having a neutral to slightly positive effect.							
Economic: 0 to 0/✓							
The policy is focused on improving health and wellbeing rather than economic prosperity and therefore is assessed to be generally neutral in its impact on economic objectives. It could be argued that promoting healthy urban planning, healthy lifestyles and active living should all support a healthier workforce which in turn should make an indirect contribution towards strengthening the economy particularly in the longer term. There also are some potential economic opportunities from increased health and wellbeing infrastructure provision but, as the focus is on equality of access and affordability to all of these facilities, it is unlikely they will have a strong economic impact on the region.							

Policy CS15: Place Making							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a major positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The policy, which is designed to reinforce local distinctiveness and character, promote social interaction, and create a strong sense of place that is safe, inclusive and accessible to all, should therefore help to promote a strong inclusive community. - By definition good place making is socially inclusive and so the delivery of this policy should make a positive contribution towards community cohesion and participation. Overall the policy should have a strong positive effect on this sustainability objective.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Through the implementation of this policy, development should be designed to create a strong locally-distinctive sense of place that promotes inclusivity, and is accessible to all. The main thrust of equality, diversity and integration objectives should be met through the delivery of this policy.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral or slightly positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	Although this policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development it does however seek to promote public art (as a way of enhancing legibility, character and local distinctiveness) along with promoting an understanding of the historic environment and protecting heritage assets. Implementation of the policy could be seen as therefore making a contribution towards education and skills development in the region.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The creation of attractive public realm together with a strong locally distinctive sense of place is likely to make a strong positive contribution towards social interaction, a healthy and active lifestyle and the overall feeling of community well-being. Good place making will involve the provision of green infrastructure and green spaces that will provide areas for recreation and exercise both of which will lead to improved quality of life and health in the area. - The above will be achieved with the help of Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a major positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	A major thrust of this policy is to create a strong locally distinctive sense of place, protect, sustain and enhance heritage assets and promote the use, understanding and enjoyment of the historic environment all of which will make a major contribution towards the delivery of this sustainability objective.

Policy CS15: Place Making							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services. There are, however no negative effects on this objective anticipated from the application of this policy so the effect is likely to be broadly neutral.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a neutral effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS16: Climate Change will ensure a contribution to causes of climate change will be minimised.	Clauses in the policy itself and in combination Policy CS16 should ensure a positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓	The policy aims to ensure the design of future development is sustainable and with the simultaneous application of Policy CS16: Climate Change should serve to mitigate potential effects, and ensure a positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The policy aims to ensure the design of future development is sustainable and that development creates safe and inclusive environments. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS16: Climate Change should serve to ensure that future development is able to function in a changing climate and so will have a positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy aims to ensure the design of future development is sustainable. - However, it is Policy CS16: Climate Change and its supporting text which clearly outline strong commitments to ensuring developments include a range of climate change adaptation and mitigation measures including signing up to a decentralised energy scheme in the future. - Overall, the policy will therefore have positive implications for the wise use of resources and hence living within environmental limits, particularly in the longer term as the policy delivers its goal.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The integration of sustainable design principles into development and the promotion of good place making should mean that the policy will have positive implications for environmental assets and infrastructure. - The policy is likely to have strong positive effects on the historic environment and cultural assets particularly in the longer term as the main objectives are delivered.

Policy CS15: Place Making							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to broadly have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Through the delivery of the main objectives of good place making it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across Gateshead and Newcastle. The creation of an attractive sustainable environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. The policy was therefore assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			✓	✓	✓	The central focus of this policy is not to provide a sustainable employment market but it is anticipated that improved public realm and the working environment will attract people to the area, creating a more diverse and vibrant workforce.
Summary							
Social: ✓✓ The policy is designed to reinforce local distinctiveness and cultural heritage, encourage a sustainable approach towards design and create a sense of place that is safe, inclusive and accessible to all, and therefore should help to promote a strong and inclusive community. Good place making will involve the provision of well-designed public realm, green infrastructure and green spaces that all will provide areas for recreation and exercise both of which will promote social interaction and lead to improved quality of life and health in the area. Overall the policy should have strong positive effects on the social sustainability objectives.							
Environmental: ✓ The policy is focused on improving environmental conditions of the area (both mitigating and adapting to the effects of climate change, and protecting and enhancing the natural and historic environment) by ensuring that sustainable design and good place making is implemented through all developments. It therefore has a positive contribution to make towards the delivery of the environmental sustainability objectives. The simultaneous application of Policies CS16, 17 and 18 should serve to mitigate any potential effects, and ensure a positive effect on these sustainability objectives particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered.							
Economic: ✓ The policy is not focussed on improving economic conditions in the area but is unlikely to generate negative effects. In fact there may be job creation and a possible boost for the tourism market through promoting the use, understanding and enjoyment of the public realm, and creating locally distinct, high quality and interactive places across Gateshead and Newcastle. This policy is therefore assessed as having a positive effect on the economic sustainability objectives.							

Policy CS16: Climate Change							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not deal directly with issues addressing community cohesion and the promotion of strong, inclusive communities. There are, however no negative effects on this objective anticipated so the effect is likely to be broadly neutral.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not deal directly with issues addressing equality, diversity and integration. There are, however no negative effects on this objective anticipated from the application of this policy so the effect is likely to be broadly neutral.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy is directed towards climate change impact mitigation and adaptation and so is unlikely to have impacts on educational achievement in the region. There may be some increase in skills related to sustainable design (e.g. renewable energy) but these are less direct.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a neutral to broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- Mitigating and adapting to the effects of climate change will have direct benefits on health in terms of reducing the risks related to extreme weather conditions (e.g. flood risk, overheating) which may result from climate change. - Embedding carbon reduction principles in development will positively support a number of areas that contribute to the overall health, wellbeing and quality of life of communities. The contribution made to improve the overall environmental conditions of the area (reducing reliance on fossil fuels, cutting CO₂ emissions, etc) will in turn contribute to improving long-term health. - Therefore the policy was assessed to have a broadly positive effect on this objective, particularly in the longer term.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral to broadly positive effect.			0	0/✓	✓	- This policy does not deal directly with issues that address the cultural heritage and diversity of the area. The application of this policy will not jeopardise historical assets in the area, which will be even more strongly protected by the simultaneous application of Policy CS15: Place Making. There may even be positive implications for cultural heritage through the mitigation of adverse climatic effect from climate change on these interests. - The effect is considered to be broadly positive in the longer term as any beneficial effects from climate change mitigation take effect.

Policy CS16: Climate Change							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.			0	0	0	The key focus of this policy is not directed towards accessibility but the policy is unlikely to have adverse effects and so is given a neutral assessment.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This Policy has a direct relationship with this SA objective, stating that all development proposals must reduce the potential contribution they make to the causes of climate change. - The policy commits to reduction in CO₂ emissions, ensuring sustainable energy and the use of carbon reduction principles are embedded within development. - There will therefore be a very strong and major positive effect on this sustainability objective. Particularly in the longer term.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This Policy has a direct and very positive effect on this SA objective, building into the spatial strategy a means of ensuring that climate change mitigation and adaptation are addressed through development. - This policy is concerned directly with energy efficiency, carbon reduction and the sustainable use of resources, as well as mitigating the effects of climate change in future development through renewable or low carbon energy, which will contribute to reducing contributions to climate change - There will therefore be a very strong and major positive effect on this sustainability objective, particularly in the longer term.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The details of the policy focuses on energy efficiency, carbon reduction, sustainable use of resources and the first clause states that development must demonstrate how it will reduce the potential contribution that it makes to climate change. The policy will therefore have strong positive effects on this sustainability objective. - The emphasis on climate change adaptation and mitigation measures brings a truly 'global' dimension to the policy.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- By committing to ensure development proposals address the impacts of climate change, and reduce the potential contribution they make to its cause, as well as function effectively in a changing climate this policy will offer protection to environmental assets from the negative impacts of climate change (e.g. flooding, high temperatures, water loss etc.). - The policy states development proposals must make use of building fabric and

Policy CS16: Climate Change							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
							passive design measures that minimise energy demand requirements and the supporting text (Paragraph 12.25) states development will promote more efficient use of resources and land through a Sustainability Statement. All of these would be expected to have broadly positive effects on the environmental assets and infrastructure in the area. There will therefore be a very strong and major positive effect on this sustainability objective, particularly in the longer term.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a neutral to broadly positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	✓	- The policy aims to ensure that developments will be able to withstand the long- term impacts of climate change which will make contributions to the longer term sustainability of future developments. - Whilst the policy might have a slight constraint on new development with the requirement to develop renewable or low carbon energy sources and commitment to reduced CO₂ emissions it will be balanced by the opportunities that this brings particularly in the longer term. - Through the development of renewable energy sources there should be benefits to the economy in the long term because of the sustainable long-term nature of these technologies and the potential new jobs that it can bring.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			✓	✓	✓	The development of renewable energy and low carbon technology may present new high quality jobs related to this sector. If successful these jobs are likely to be more sustainable and longer term by nature.

Policy CS16: Climate Change							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: 0 to ✓ In general the policy does not have any clear relationship or influence on most of the social sustainability objectives and is therefore considered to have a broadly neutral effect. The policy focuses on the use of sustainable energy resources and in cutting carbon emissions and although of benefit to the community does not have a direct bearing on many of the social objectives. There is, however, expected to be a positive effect on health and wellbeing since many of the activities or actions taken to cut carbon also have positive impacts on health (e.g. reducing car use and cutting congestion thus reducing vehicle emissions, adopting more sustainable forms of transport such as walking and cycling that are good for health, creating more green infrastructure etc.). The policy also sets out to ensure that in all development proposals appropriate mitigation and adaptation measures for the predicted impacts of climate change (e.g. risks of flooding, etc) are included, thus addressing the potentially adverse health impacts of climate change. The policy is therefore considered to have a broadly positive effect on the long-term health and wellbeing of local communities and therefore on Sustainability Objective 4.							
Environmental: ✓✓ The policy focuses on climate change adaptation and mitigation through development proposals and ensuring that development can demonstrate a reduction in the potential contribution it makes to the cause of climate change. This combination of both mitigation and adaptation means that the policy has strong positive implications for all of the environmental sustainability objectives. By emphasising carbon reduction, reducing CO ₂ emissions, improving energy efficiency, decentralised low carbon networks and increased renewable energy generation these all have strongly positive implications for most of the environmental objectives.							
Economic: ✓ By ensuring development can withstand the long-term impacts of climate change means that the long-term economic viability of the area is more likely to be assured. Sustainable economic growth will be inextricably linked with locating new development in sustainable locations that not only are not at risk from the effects of climate change (such as increased flood risk) but that also have built in adaptation design features for, for example, combating extreme temperatures, water loss and loss of biodiversity (e.g. green roofs). The promotion of sustainable energy (renewable and low carbon energy sources) may present a slight constraint on development through its specific requirements, however, the potential to provide associated jobs to the area, and a more sustainable energy source for the region in the long term, the impact on sustainability objectives for the economy should overall be positive.							

Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water management							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not focus on elements that directly relate to strong and inclusive communities, but no adverse effects are anticipated from its implementation.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	Equality, diversity and integration are not key aspects of this policy but there are no negative impacts anticipated from its implementation.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	Educational achievement is unlikely to be impacted on by the implementation of this policy.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			0	✓	✓	This policy will help to ensure that there are reduced health impacts from flood risk especially in the long term. Flooding can have catastrophic impacts on health when uncontrolled and so this policy is assessed to be of positive impact, particularly in the longer term.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral or slightly positive effect.			0	0/?✓	0/?✓	By reducing flood risk in Gateshead and Newcastle there is the possibility that it will reduce the risks of flooding impacts on the historic environment and cultural heritage assets, particularly in the longer term as the policy starts to have an impact. The policy was therefore assessed as having a neutral to slightly positive impact on this sustainability objective.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a neutral or slightly positive effect.			0	✓	✓	Although not targeted directly at addressing issues of accessibility to, for example jobs, facilities and services, the policy should help to ensure that accessibility is not compromised by flooding impacts especially in the longer term.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a neutral or slightly positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	The policy is not specifically focussed on reducing the contribution to climate change but is likely to raise the profile and awareness of this agenda because flood risk is one of the major anticipated impacts of climate change, therefore the policy was assessed to be of neutral or slightly positive effect.

Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water management							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	One of the key anticipated negative impacts of climate change is increased flood risk. The policy is focused on managing flood risk, reducing flood risk, mitigating the effects of flooding and managing surface water effectively. Therefore the application of this policy will have strong positive implications for mitigating against the impacts of climate change in the short, medium and longer term.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	- The policy relates to mitigating and reducing the negative impacts of flooding rather than addressing lifestyles to ensure that these can fit within the recognition of environmental limits and use of sustainable resources. - The policy is therefore assessed to be of broadly a neutral impact on this sustainability objective.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The policy centres on managing and mitigating flood risk through development and so will help to ensure the protection of environmental infrastructure from flooding impacts. - It also promotes the use of SUDS where appropriate for surface water management and in the supporting text in Section 12.37 it recognises the role of SUDS to fulfil on their potential to provide new wildlife habitats and amenity spaces. It is assessed as being broadly supportive of protecting and enhancing environmental assets and infrastructure and therefore of this sustainability objective.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	- Whilst the policy might have a slight constrain on where new development is located and imposes requirements for a flood risk assessment in some circumstances it will be balanced by the security it brings particularly in the longer term. - Protection against serious flooding should benefit the economy particularly in the longer term because of the long-term security benefits. - However, the policy was given an overall neutral assessment with regard to this sustainability objective.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy is unlikely to contribute to improving access to a stable and sustainable employment market but no adverse impacts are anticipated.

Policy CS17: Flood Risk and Water management							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: 0 to ✓ The policy does not specifically focus on issues relating to inclusive communities, equality and educational achievement but there are no adverse impacts anticipated. There are positive effects anticipated from mitigating against the potential health impacts from flood risks and the impacts to accessibility. Therefore the policy was assessed as having a broadly neutral to positive effect on the social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ✓ This policy has positive implications for environmental objectives as the policy will help to minimise the environmental impacts of flooding and most importantly help to adapt and mitigate against the potential impacts from climate change. Flooding is likely to be one of the major adverse effects of climate change. The promotion of SUDS where appropriate for surface water management has the potential to provide new habitats and amenity space, potentially enhancing environmental assets and infrastructure. This policy therefore has strong implications for meeting environmental sustainability objectives. The consideration of the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) as well as the Surface Water Management Plan (SWMP) should also strengthen the positive effects. Economic: 0 In terms of economic objectives the policy was assessed to be of broadly neutral effect, there are unlikely to be negative impacts on the economy from the implementation of this policy. If anything the avoidance of flood risk and the corresponding negative economic effects that flooding can bring should serve to contribute positively to the economic objectives.							

Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The protection and enhancement of green infrastructure and the natural environment of the area will make a positive contribution towards building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community well-being. All of these features serve to strengthen the community. - Green infrastructure provides a number of essential ecosystem services (such as flood attenuation, water management and biodiversity protection and enhancement) many of which are also measures to mitigate against the effects of climate change and all of which will help to promote stronger communities. - Overall the policy is regarded as having a positive effect on this sustainability objective with the effect likely to be stronger in the longer term as key measures are delivered.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy is focused on protecting, maintaining and enhancing the integrity and connectivity of the green infrastructure network. In terms of delivering the Councils' equality and diversity obligations, the policy alone does not make clear connections between its objectives and the benefits, in terms of social inclusion, that these can bring to the whole community. - However making reference to the Development Principles set out in Clause 8 of Policy CS1 and in particular 8(i) and 8(iii) would demonstrate how the whole community could benefit from the implementation of this policy both in terms of access to green spaces and in the design of new ones. The positive effects of implementing this policy are likely to increase with time.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	Educational achievement and skills are not the focus of this policy but it is not anticipated that there will be any negative impact on this sustainability objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a major positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	The improvement of green infrastructure in the area is likely to benefit health and well-being through the enhancement of the residential landscape, the provision of more areas for exercise and the improvement of air quality and general environmental conditions.

Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
							It is well documented that public physical and mental health improves in proximity to natural green areas and countryside, so the promotion of green spaces and the natural environment can only serve to improve health and wellbeing. The positive effects are likely to build with time.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	- The policy is directed toward natural heritage rather than cultural heritage, but there are no anticipated negative impacts on culture, heritage and diversity associated with the implementation of this policy. - The riverside environment (banks of the Tyne) is an integral part of the city's historical and therefore cultural heritage. Improving and maintaining access to this part of the city's "distinctive landscape character" will help maintain the sense of place and local distinctiveness and add to this sustainability objective.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a neutral or slightly positive effect, especially in the long-term.			0/✓	0/✓	✓	- This policy does not have a focus towards addressing accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services but there are no anticipated negative effects associated with this policy. - Policy Text 6 commits to "Improving access to, along and onto the River Tyne and tributaries", which in turn presents an open space and may well link to "designated sites for biodiversity and standards for open space, sport and recreation" in future (Supporting text Paragraph 12.42). Consequently increasing accessibility to open space and/or recreation facilities.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have major positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	The policy focuses on the enhancement of the natural environment which will help to reduce contributions to the causes of climate change, especially where the protection or creation of carbon sinks and other climate change mitigation measures are emphasised.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have major positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This policy will have major positive effects toward this sustainability objective because the emphasis is on enhancing and creating green infrastructure that will provide very strong climate change adaptation benefits. - These are based on the ecosystem services provided by green infrastructure that include flood attenuation, water management, heat absorption and acting as a carbon sink.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy ensures the protection of the natural environment associated with development, making an important contribution to mitigating and adapting to the effects of climate change. The policy will therefore help to ensure that new developments seek to remain within environmental limits.

Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a major positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	The major thrust of this policy is the protection and enhancement of environmental assets and infrastructure, including the protection and enhancement of biodiversity and geodiversity therefore the policy makes a major positive contribution towards the delivery of this sustainability objective.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- By ensuring a high quality environment with plenty of green spaces and green infrastructure this is likely to encourage businesses to locate into the area. This will be particularly relevant to the science and technological based industries that Gateshead and Newcastle is targeting on for future economic growth. - The improvement of the overall local natural environment will complement the historic environment and cultural attractions and should serve to attract more visitors and tourists into the area. This in turn should also have knock-on benefits to the local economy.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy is not directly concerned with the employment market of the region but there are no negative impacts anticipated from its implementation.

Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ By protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure and natural environment of the region in an inclusive way the policy is likely to have positive effects on those social objectives that relate to strengthening the community, improving health and wellbeing, particularly in the longer term as the measures within the policy start to deliver results.							
Environmental: ✓✓ The main focus of the policy is on retaining, protecting enhancing the natural environment of the area, increasing the amount of green space and green infrastructure, and protecting and enhancing biodiversity and geodiversity in the area. All of these will make strong positive contributions to most of the environmental objectives. Green infrastructure has a clear role to play in providing ecosystem services that contribute towards climate change mitigation and adaptation.							
Economic: 0 to ✓ The broad emphasis of this policy is not economic, but by enhancing the environmental conditions of the region and making the natural environment more attractive for residents, workers and visitors there are likely to be indirect positive effects on the local economy in terms of encouraging businesses to locate and people to visit the region.							

Policy CS19: Green Belt							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a neutral effect	This policy commits to preventing the merging of settlements and ensuring no land will be removed from the Green Belt beyond what is necessary for growth.	Neutral effect as long as mitigation in place.	0	0	0	- This policy commits to preventing growth beyond that which is necessary and preventing the merging of settlements, both of which are likely to contribute towards retaining strong local-distinctiveness and community sense of place. - If merging of settlements is prevented, and the green belt area is not encroached on, beyond what is necessary for growth, then this policy is likely to have an overall neutral effect on this sustainability objective. - The policy states it will assist in urban regeneration through the recycling of derelict and other urban land, possibly creating a safer urban environment and improving the sense of local community.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy is not seen to deal directly with equality and diversity issues and is unlikely to have any negative impact on this sustainability objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	- This policy is not concerned with factors relating to educational attainment and skills levels across the area. Although, revision of the Green Belt boundary to allow residential development of Callerton, and other, strategic growth areas will include the investment in additional educational provision to meet local community needs (so as not to put pressure on existing education facilities). - Overall the policy is likely to have a neutral effect on this sustainability objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The policy focuses on safeguarding the revised Green Belt boundary and includes clauses intended to prevent the merging of settlements, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, checking unrestricted urban sprawl and encouraging the 'recycling' of derelict land. - Safeguarding green areas around the fringes of the main neighbourhoods, urban conurbations and villages should provide a healthier environment conducive for walking and general amenity. This will be supportive for general wellbeing and health.

Policy CS19: Green Belt							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	- The policy focuses on safeguarding the revised Green Belt boundary and includes clauses intended to prevent the merging of settlements, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, checking unrestricted urban sprawl and encouraging the 'recycling' of derelict land. - This policy is not seen to deal directly with culture, heritage and diversity issues but is unlikely to have any negative impact on this sustainability objective.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	- The policy focuses on safeguarding the revised Green Belt boundary and includes clauses intended to prevent the merging of settlements, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, checking unrestricted urban sprawl and encouraging the 'recycling' of derelict land. - This policy is not seen to deal directly with accessibility issues but is unlikely to have any negative impact on this sustainability objective.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	- The policy focuses on safeguarding the revised Green Belt boundary and includes clauses intended to prevent the merging of settlements, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, checking unrestricted urban sprawl and encouraging the 'recycling' of derelict land. - Safeguarding green areas around the fringes of the main neighbourhoods, urban conurbations and villages and preventing further urban sprawl whilst not leading to significant reductions in greenhouse gas emissions should not encourage an increase either. The policy is therefore seen as broadly neutral in effect on this sustainability objective.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The policy focuses on safeguarding the revised Green Belt boundary and includes clauses intended to prevent the merging of settlements, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, checking unrestricted urban sprawl and encouraging the 'recycling' of derelict land. - Safeguarding green belt around the fringes of the main neighbourhoods, urban conurbations and villages and preventing further urban sprawl should mean that there will be some green spaces and open countryside providing 'ecosystem services' such as surface water management, flood attenuation and the provision of local biodiversity. All of these will help in some way to mitigate against the effects of climate change.

Policy CS19: Green Belt							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	- The policy focuses on safeguarding the revised Green Belt boundary and includes clauses intended to prevent the merging of settlements, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, checking unrestricted urban sprawl and encouraging the 'recycling' of derelict land. - This policy is not seen to deal directly with issues connected with 'environmental limits' and depletion of resources but is unlikely to have any negative impact on this sustainability objective. It could be argued that encouraging the 'recycling' of derelict land is a more resource efficient way of developing land since it can often lead to the re-use of civil waste and former construction materials.
9. Protect and enhance environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The policy focuses on safeguarding the revised Green Belt boundary and includes clauses intended to prevent the merging of settlements, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, checking unrestricted urban sprawl and encouraging the 'recycling' of derelict land. - Safeguarding green areas and countryside around the fringes of the main neighbourhoods, urban conurbations and villages should help to protect environmental assets and safeguard green corridors and green infrastructure. The policy is therefore broadly supportive of this sustainability objective.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	- The policy focuses on safeguarding the revised Green Belt boundary and includes clauses intended to prevent the merging of settlements, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, checking unrestricted urban sprawl and encouraging the 'recycling' of derelict land. - This policy is not seen to deal directly with the economy of the area and measures to strengthen it, but is unlikely to have any negative impact on this sustainability objective.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	- The policy focuses on safeguarding the revised Green Belt boundary and includes clauses intended to prevent the merging of settlements, safeguarding the countryside from encroachment, checking unrestricted urban sprawl and encouraging the 'recycling' of derelict land. - This policy is not seen to deal directly with employment issues but is unlikely to have any negative impact on this sustainability objective.

Policy CS19: Green Belt							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: 0 to ✓							
The policy commits to preventing the merging of settlements (which should retain local distinctiveness and a sense of place) and unrestricted sprawl together with safeguarding the countryside from encroachment. It also commits to encourage the recycling of derelict and other urban land during development. All of which should ensure an overall neutral to broadly positive impact (in the case of wellbeing and health) on social sustainability objectives. The revision of the Green Belt boundary to allow for residential development at Callerton will include investment in associated facilities and services including additional education provision and improved transport links, promoting accessibility and inclusivity.							
Environmental: 0 to ✓							
Because the policy commits to preventing the merging of settlements and checking unrestricted sprawl together with safeguarding the countryside from encroachment it is therefore assessed as being either neutral or broadly supportive towards the environmental objectives. It also commits to encouraging the recycling of derelict and other urban land during development which is a more environmentally positive solution.							
Economic: 0							
The policy is likely to have a neutral effect on the economic objectives. The policy itself puts a curb on any further encroachment into the countryside but is supportive of urban regeneration in the city region. So whilst it places a partial restriction on development outwith of the centres it fully encourages development within the Urban Core.							

Policy CS20: Minerals							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not have any strong social dimensions to it since it focuses on safeguarding mineral resources and is not concerned with issues connected with social inclusion and community cohesion. It is anticipated that it will have a neutral effect on this sustainability objective.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	As above the policy is not seen to deal directly with equality and diversity issues and is unlikely to have any negative impacts on this sustainability objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy is also not concerned with factors relating to educational attainment and skills levels across the area and is unlikely to have any negative impacts on this sustainability objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.			0	0	0	The Minerals Policy is unlikely to have any negative impact on this sustainability objective and is assessed as generating a broadly neutral effect.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy is not seen as having a strong bearing on cultural heritage in the area and is unlikely to have any negative effects on this sustainability objective.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	Again as above the policy is not concerned with accessibility within the region but is unlikely to have negative impact on this objective, therefore the policy is assessed as being of neutral effect on this sustainability objective.

Policy CS20: Minerals							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a negative effect.			✖	✖	✖	- Although ensuring that as far as possible mineral provision will come from local sources, therefore cutting transport impacts, by continuing the mineral extraction practices in the region (that include mineral processing and transportation) there will inevitably be fossil fuels consumed in energy and transport that will lead to further carbon emissions with a resultant negative impact on this sustainability objective. Fossil fuels including coal are likely to continue to be extracted which in turn will encourage the continuation of coal use related carbon emissions and consequential environmental impacts that contribute to climate change. - The supporting text to the policy also makes mention of the potential extraction and burning of shale gas in the longer term. This would only contribute to and exacerbate the causes of climate change.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy is not concerned with measures to adapt and mitigate against the effects of climate change. It is considered that there will be no discernible effect on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have a negative effect.			✖	✖	✖	- Since the policy is supporting the use of non-renewable resources, in particular the potential extraction and use of coal (and shale gas) then it is likely to have a negative effect on this sustainability objective. - Mineral extraction will inevitably lead to processing and transportation that rely on the consumption of resources (including fossil fuels) and are likely to result in emissions of pollutants into the environment. Even with pollution control and mitigation there is likely to remain some residual adverse environmental impact.

Policy CS20: Minerals							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✕ overall impact likely to be negative, ✕✕ major negative, ✓✕ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✕ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could have negative impacts depending on the location of mineral sites and the extraction processes.	When combined with Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment any potential negative impacts should be avoided.	When combined with Policy CS18 there are no anticipated residual negative effects.	? ✕/0	? ✕/0	? ✕/0	- Through the continuation of mineral extraction processes there is the possibility for negative impact on environmental assets and infrastructure. The simultaneous application of Policy CS18 (that protects the natural environment) and the clause within the Policy CS20 that states that minerals will be exploited in a way "that supports the Council's social, environmental and economic objectives" the policy should remove the risks of negative effects on environmental assets. - Additionally, the policy commits to high standards of restoration and aftercare on worked land while considering airport safety, biodiversity, woodland and recreational enhancement. This should complement and further safeguard the restoration of worked sites. - The addition of fracking to the list of possible activities may have negative consequences on local water quality if the 'fracking mix' contaminates the regional aquifer.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy has broadly positive implications for the economy since its focus is on safeguarding the economic benefits of the mineral assets for the region.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	By safeguarding mineral extraction and mineral resources the policy will also tend to protect the jobs associated with these practices and potentially contribute to providing further jobs in this sector and therefore has been assessed to have positive implications towards this sustainability objective.

Policy CS20: Minerals							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: 0							
The policy is deemed to have a broadly neutral effect on the social sustainability objectives since this policy is not concerned with social inclusion, equality, education, health, cultural heritage or accessibility.							
Environmental: ✖							
The nature of mineral extraction means that it is likely to have negative impacts on environmental sustainability objectives because the nature of the process contributes to the causes of climate change and does not support the concept of living within environmental limits. There are some benefits of ensuring that mineral extraction is localised to the region and thus reducing transportation impacts but despite this the combined effect of extraction, processing and transportation will have residual negative impacts. Gateshead and Newcastle should seek to promote a greater proportion of more sustainable energy sources and fuels alongside mineral extraction for coal so that gradually more sustainable sources can be phased in. The policy does however commit to a high level of restoration and aftercare on worked land while considering airport safety, biodiversity, woodland and recreational enhancement. This should complement and further safeguard the restoration of worked sites.							
The addition of fracking, however to the potential list of activities in the region has negative long-term implications for sustainability objectives. Not only is there a focus on extracting and burning a non-renewable fuel source, but the extraction process itself has the potential to contaminate local groundwater.							
Economic: ✓							
In terms of economic objectives it was assessed that this policy is likely to have positive effects for the region because safeguarding mineral wealth will contribute to the economy and mineral extraction and processing is likely to safeguard and perhaps increase associated jobs within the area.							

Policy CS21: Waste							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not have any strong social dimensions to it since it focuses on managing waste and is not concerned with issues connected with social inclusion and community cohesion. It is anticipated that it will have a neutral effect on this sustainability objective.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	As above the policy is not seen to deal directly with equality and diversity issues and is unlikely to have any negative impacts on this sustainability objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy is also not concerned with factors relating to educational attainment and skills levels across the area and is unlikely to have any negative impacts on this sustainability objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a neural to positive effect.			0	0	✓	Proposals for new waste management capacity will be assessed on any adverse impact on human health. Health and well-being is not the primary focus of this objective but it is possible that through sustainable management of waste it will improve the overall environment of Gateshead and Newcastle leading to positive effects in the longer term.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy is not seen as having a strong bearing on cultural heritage in the area and is unlikely to have any negative effects on this sustainability objective.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.			0	0	0	Again as above the policy is not concerned with accessibility within the region but is unlikely to have negative impact on this objective, therefore the policy is assessed as being of neutral effect on this sustainability objective.

Policy CS21: Waste							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	The major focus of this policy is ensuring sustainable waste management which is a key component of cutting carbon emissions and reducing the contribution towards the causes of climate change. The policy stresses the need to adopt a waste hierarchy of prevention, preparing for re-use, recycling, other recovery and safe disposal. The policy therefore has a strong positive role in reducing contributions to climate change.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have uncertain possible positive effect.			0	0	0	This policy is concerned directly with sustainable waste management which will contribute to reducing contributions to climate change. It does not directly offer means to adapt to the effects of climate change so the effect is considered to be neutral on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The major focus of this policy is ensuring sustainable waste management which is a key component of cutting carbon emissions and so should also contribute towards better resource management. - The policy stresses the need to adopt a waste hierarchy of prevention, preparing for re-use, recycling, other recovery and safe disposal which promotes the concept of sustainable production and consumption and the better management of resources.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- With its focus on sustainable waste management there are likely to be indirect benefits to the wider environment and therefore the environmental assets through improved environmental protection. - The effect is considered to therefore be broadly positive.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			0	✓	✓	The policy is likely to have positive effects on the economy especially in the longer term since sustainable waste management should present more efficient and cost effective ways of dealing with waste.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have possible positive effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address issues of employment markets but is assessed to not have any negative impacts on this sustainability objective.

Policy CS21: Waste							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: 0							
The policy is determined to have mostly neutral effects on the social sustainability objectives although in some areas such as health and social wellbeing there is likely to be a positive effect.							
Environmental: ✓✓							
This policy has strong positive implications for environmental sustainability objectives because improving sustainable waste management is one component of improving and enhancing environmental conditions within Gateshead and Newcastle. It has positive implications for issues relating to climate change, living within environmental limits and general environmental conditions of the region. The policy stresses the need to adopt a waste hierarchy of prevention, preparing for re-use, recycling, other recovery and safe disposal which promotes the concept of sustainable production and consumption and the better management of resources.							
Economic: ✓							
The policy is likely to have positive effects on the economy especially in the longer term since sustainable waste management should present more efficient and cost effective ways of dealing with waste. There may also be further market and employment opportunities in the recovery, re-use and recycling of waste materials.							

Policy DEL1: Infrastructure and Developer Contributions							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy does not directly commit to promoting strong and inclusive communities. However, it does supports the provision of services to meet needs associated with growth. Effective provision of facilities and services where it is needed – such as transport infrastructure, recreational and community facilities, schools, open space and access to the countryside - will support the development of sustainable communities, and ultimately contributing to strong and inclusive neighbourhoods.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			0	✓	✓	If developers are required to fund new and consequential facilities and services associated with proposed residential and economic growth, while addressing off site and cumulative impacts, the policy should ensure equality and integration (particularly in terms of access to services) are embedded in all future development.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	Education and skill levels are not a primary focus within this policy but it is not expected to have a negative effect on this objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- Due to the requirement for developers to contribute towards new and improved facilities and services during proposed residential and economic growth, the provision of supporting social, environmental and physical infrastructure should be integrated into the community. Due to this there is the opportunity to improve access to health care, promote healthy urban planning, promote open spaces and encourage healthy lifestyles (e.g. walking). - Therefore the policy is likely to have positive implications for health and well-being.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral to positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	The supporting text of the policy (Paragraphs 18.3-18.5) seeks to ensure development mitigates against unacceptable impact of growth on existing communities. There is no direct commitment to promote or enhance culture, heritage and diversity, however, when applied in conjunction with Policy CS15 (Place Making) then additional safeguards for heritage assets will be put in place.

Policy DEL1: Infrastructure and Developer Contributions							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a major positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	In the long term this policy should ensure that access to jobs, facilities, goods and services continually improves. The policy can also make positive contributions towards sustainable transport solutions and effective use of technology which can be encouraged through developer contributions.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive effect.			0	✓	✓	- Since the policy recognises that infrastructure development should mitigate against unacceptable impacts of growth, this means that there is the scope to decrease contributions (e.g. carbon emissions) to climate change through the incorporation of sustainable design principles outlined in Policy CS16 (Climate Change). - Planning obligations and developer contributions can be set to minimise contributions to climate change and so this policy could have positive implications for this sustainability objective especially in the longer term.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			0	✓	✓✓	- Planning obligations and developer contributions can be set to make sure that developments adapt to the effects of climate change and so this policy could have positive implications for this sustainability objective especially in the longer term. - Drainage and green infrastructure are two key components to which developers are required to contribute. If coupled with the delivery of Policies CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment), it will have a positive effect on this SA.
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new developments and associated infrastructure are designed and delivered – any large scale developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to	Through the application of CSUCP Policies CS15 (Place Making) and CS16 (Climate Change) the impacts of new developments and associated infrastructure can be minimised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation but there are still likely to be residual negative effects if new developments and the associated infrastructure result in more	✖	✖	✖	- By encouraging more development of any kind, including the provision of infrastructure with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The application of Policies CS15 and CS16 together with certain clauses in Policy DEL1 itself (e.g. point 1.iv.) should serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.

Policy DEL1: Infrastructure and Developer Contributions							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.		cars (and thus a reliance on fossil fuels), further resource depletion (fuels, energy etc.) and waste generation.				
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy seeks to mitigate against any negative effects of infrastructure development. Also developer contributions will be encouraged to protect and enhance both the natural environment and built environment, therefore this policy has positive implications for the environmental assets and infrastructure of Gateshead and Newcastle.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			0	✓	✓	The policy will improve the connectivity within the area by ensuring the timely provision of infrastructure required to meet needs associated with growth. With this in place it is anticipated that the policy would have an overall positive effect on the local economy particularly in the longer term.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			0	✓	✓	It is likely that the policy will help to increase the accessibility of employment opportunities in the area particularly where these have been identified as requiring improvements in infrastructure. The policy therefore is assessed as having positive implications for this sustainability objective.

Policy DEL1: Infrastructure and Developer Contributions							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ Overall the policy is likely to improve the provision of and access to essential services and facilities and promote infrastructure development that creates conditions for supporting health, well-being, and community cohesion. The focus on developer contributions which will provide social, environmental and physical infrastructure means that infrastructure development will focus on providing for the needs of the community, ultimately reducing inequalities and promoting strong and inclusive communities. The policy is therefore considered to have a broadly positive effect on the social objectives.							
Environmental: 0-✓ The policy seeks to mitigate adverse impacts from infrastructure developments along with ensuring that developer contributions are sought to secure provision of the necessary social, environmental and physical infrastructure. Overall the policy was judged to have a broadly positive effect on the environmental objectives, especially when assessed in light of other supporting policies.							
Economic: ✓ The timely provision of infrastructure required to meet needs associated with growth will aid in contributing to meeting the economic sustainability objectives, and thus support economic growth and access to employment.							

C2: Appraisal of The Urban Core Policies

Policy UC1: Offices and Business Development

Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative

Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy UC12 (Urban Design) should mitigate any negative impacts.	The combination of this policy with Policy UC12 should have positive implications on this sustainability objective.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy seeks to focus new office developments key strategic sites within the Urban Core. The supporting text emphasises that future office development will be critical for meeting the Councils' aspirations for growth, and that growth is planned to occur in areas which are highly accessible and where there are supporting facilities and services. - The location itself, proposed for planned development is likely to further promote strong inclusive communities as they are already hubs of business activity. - The combined application of this policy with supporting text to Policy UC12 Urban Design should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to deliver at Paragraph 14.92 "Buildings and spaces in the Urban Core [which] must contribute to social inclusion and sustainable environments and [are expected] to be designed and managed to take into account all users and their accessibility needs."
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have an uncertain effect that could have positive or negative effects on this objective depending on how the new office development was designed and delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policy UC12 (Urban Design) and the supporting text at Paragraph 14.93 together with Policy CS1 and its 'Development Principles' should mitigate any negative impacts.	The combination of this policy with Policy UC12 (and the supporting text at Paragraph 14.93) should have positive implications on this sustainability objective.	✓	✓	✓	- The policy seeks to focus new office developments in some key strategic sites within the Urban Core and commits to providing a range of employment sites and premises (supporting text specifies development of entrepreneurship and start-ups). - Supporting text (Paragraphs 14.92 and 14.93) and Policy UC12 pushes for high-levels of mixed usage in the developments and emphasises the "[provision of] strong urban-frontages" with "shared access, shared spaces and provide communal benefits" which "[reinforce] continuity and enclosure at a walkable urban block scale". - The combined application of this policy with Policy UC12 (Urban Design) and supporting Paragraphs 14.92 and 14.93, together with the development principles in Policy CS1 and supporting text at Paragraph 5.11, should further promote strong and inclusive communities and meet equality needs. This would result in the policy having positive effects on this SA objective.

Policy UC1: Offices and Business Development							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a positive impact.			✓	✓	✓✓	Although this policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development it does however seek to promote substantial office development within the Urban Core, including the “Science Central” area which will be prioritised for science and research led uses, including higher education. The encouragement of diverse office-based businesses and education and research centres should drive a demand for varied skills levels across Gateshead and Newcastle therefore making a contribution towards this SA objective, particularly in the longer term as this policy is delivered.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not deal directly with issues addressing the improvement of health and well-being and reducing inequalities in health. There are, however no negative effects on this objective anticipated from the application of this policy so the effect is likely to be broadly neutral.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Uncertain but could have a range of positive or negative effects depending on how new office developments in the urban core are delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS15 Place Making and Policy UC12 (Urban Design) should mitigate any negative effects and strengthen the positive contribution to this objective.	The combination of this policy with Policy CS15 Place Making and Policy UC12 Urban Design should ensure positive implications to culture, heritage and diversity.	✓	✓	✓✓	- There is a risk that new office development in the desired locations within the Urban Core could negatively impact on elements of the cultural heritage depending on precise location and how office developments were delivered. - However when this policy is combined with the conservation principles embedded within Policy CS15, and the principles of good place making together with the architectural and design excellence of Policy UC12 (Urban Design) this should ensure positive implications for culture, heritage and diversity particularly in the longer term.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.	With the simultaneous application of CS13 Transport and UC11 Gateways and Arrival Points, the effect will be enhanced.	The combination of this policy with CS13 Transport and UC11 should ensure positive implications to good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services.	✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy is likely to increase accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services within the Urban Core through the development of prestige office developments. - The impact will be enhanced with the simultaneous application of CS13 Transport particularly in the longer term. - Policy UC12 Urban Design commits to delivering “strong urban frontages [which reinforce] continuity and enclosure at a walkable urban block scale” which should reduce car dependency and ensure access for all to the range of services available.

Policy UC1: Offices and Business Development							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could give rise to a range of both positive and negative effects depending on how new office developments are delivered at the various locations within the Urban Core.	The combination of this policy with Policy CS13 (Transport) and CS16: (Climate Change) should be able to provide mitigation.	Likely to be neutral or slightly positive	?0/✓	✓	✓	- The urban core in general is a sustainable location for new office development with a concentration of services, employment and residential uses and good internal linkages for walking and cycling. It has good transport links to the rest of the area via the metro and buses and to the wider region and country by train. - The move to focus major new office development in the Urban Core and make it the priority location for offices, is likely to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by maximising the opportunities for making the best use of the existing transport infrastructure and more sustainable modes such as walking and cycling. - CS16 obligates new developments to follow hierarchy for adoption of alternative energy schemes.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could generate negative effects depending on the delivery of the policy and the precise location of new office development.	Through the application of CS16 (Climate Change), CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management), CS15 (Place Making) and CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment the impacts of the development will be minimised.	Likely to be broadly positive.	?0/✓	✓	✓	- The application of Policy CS17 would ensure that any future office development takes on board flood risk and therefore adapts to one of the more significant effects relating to climate change. - The application of Policy CS16 ensures that any future development must address the effects of climate change in the wider sense. - Policy CS17 should also ensure that new development should control and minimise surface water run-off and consider alternative sustainable drainage solutions. - Further Water Management requirements for Developers written into the site specific plans state that Sustainable Urban Drainage Systems (SUDS) are to be given priority by developers (Paragraph 16.92). - All of these policy measures if rigorously applied will ensure that new office developments adapt to the effects of climate change and thus this Policy should have a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new office developments are designed and	Through the application of Policies CS13 Transport, CS16 (Climate Change) and the application of UC5 (Primary	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation, potentially neutralising the effects of	? ✓	✓	✓✓	- By increasing office developments at all, there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and carbon emissions that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - However, by developing new offices within the Urban Core, the policy will help to reduce the need for commuting and maximise opportunities for sustainable travel.

Policy UC1: Offices and Business Development							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	delivered – any large scale office developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.	and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling), UC7 (Public Transport), UC12 (Urban Design) and UC15 (Urban Green Infrastructure) the impacts of the development will be mitigated.	development as compared to that development taking place elsewhere in the Newcastle/ Gateshead area, in potentially less sustainable locations.				- The application of Policies UC5, UC6, UC7 and CS13 should serve to mitigate these potential effects potentially removing them. - The application of Policy CS16 could lead to the integration of decentralised energy networks as part of new development and this could lead to greater energy efficiency savings and a reduction in contribution to greenhouse gas emissions. - The application of Policy UC12 Urban Design obligates the use of “high quality, durable and sustainable materials appropriate to the character of the area and the use envisaged for the site” thereby fulfilling sustainable design and construction practices and encouraging the use of sustainable materials.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on the design and construction of the new office development.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policy CS18 (Urban Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) and UC15 (Urban Green Infrastructure) the negative impacts of this policy on the natural environment should be minimised, and there is the potential for new	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By promoting additional office developments, and SME development, there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments). This would depend on how new development was designed and constructed. - With regard to the natural environment using the mitigation measures set out in Policies CS18 and UC15 the residual effects are likely to be positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made (including green and brown roofs on new offices). - The application of Policy UC15 Urban Green Infrastructure could further contribute to sustainable design and construction by encouraging improvements to local biodiversity, increasing green connectivity to existing networks, the creation of new green areas and the use of living roofs and walls where appropriate. - With regard to the historic environment if Policy CS15 is rigorously applied then there are measures that encourage the protection and enhancement of the historic environment and heritage assets which would thus leave a residual positive effect.

Policy UC1: Offices and Business Development							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		office development to provide additional green infrastructure (such as green roofs) and steer development away from vulnerable areas. Similarly Policy CS15 (Place Making) should mitigate against any negative effects on the historic environment and cultural heritage.					
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have major positive effects.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	The policy makes provision for office-based development opportunities that are likely to strengthen the economy within the Urban Core. The effects of the policy are therefore thought to be very positive particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have major positive effects.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	Growth of office-based businesses is likely to make a significant contribution towards job creation in the Urban Core and therefore of improving access to a more stable and sustainable employment market in Gateshead and Newcastle.

Policy UC1: Offices and Business Development							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ The policy seeks to support new office development within the Urban Core which, if successful, will be able to offer a wide range of employment and skill development opportunities. This should be strongly supportive towards developing and retaining a skilled workforce and in turn to encourage stronger communities. It may also help to improve educational aspirations for young people throughout the Gateshead and Newcastle area. The combined application of this policy with Policy UC12 (Urban Design) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to deliver a public realm which is inclusive and accessible to all. The policy is assessed overall to have positive implications on social sustainability objectives. Environmental: 0 to ?✓ The effects of supporting more office-based and SME developments in the Urban Core were considered to be uncertain but possibly negative with regard to impacts on the natural environment with issues like resource use, fossil fuel consumption, carbon emissions and likely increases in waste. The application of a number of associated policies provide effective mitigation and if these policies are rigorously applied in combination with Policy UC1, together with robust planning conditions or obligations, then there is the potential for the residual effects to be improved to become either neutral or even positive. Economic: ✓✓ Growth of office-based and SME businesses is likely to make a significant contribution towards job creation in the Urban Core and therefore of improving access to a more stable and sustainable employment market in Gateshead and Newcastle.							

Policy UC2: New Retail (A1) in Newcastle and Gateshead							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Strengthening the retail offer in a way that improves the quality and quantity of comparison and convenience shops that will cater better for the needs of workers, visitors and residents should help to boost community confidence and thus promote a stronger more vibrant community. The policy is therefore considered to have a broadly positive effect on this SA objective.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- Strengthening the retail offer in a way that improves the quality and quantity of comparison shops but that caters better for the needs of workers, visitors and residents should make sure that the needs of every group within the community are met. - The policy is therefore considered to have a broadly positive effect on this SA objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- This policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development but is not anticipated to generate any negative effects on this SA objective. - Development of new shops and improved retail offer will promote increased employment and possible skill development opportunities. This should be supportive towards developing and retaining a skilled workforce and in turn supporting economic prosperity and stronger communities. - The overall effect is considered to be broadly positive.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect to positive with slightly positive influences in the long-term.			0	0/✓	0/✓	- This policy does not deal directly with issues addressing the improvement of health and well-being and reducing inequalities in health. - However, when coupled with Policy UC12 Urban Design, it contributes to creating “a safer and more attractive walkable Urban Core” which in turn results in promoting healthy urban planning and encourages walking. - There is scope to incorporate Urban Green Infrastructure (Policies CS18 and UC15) and public spaces within developments. - This focus should encourage user friendly, inclusively designed retail hubs, which will help promote improved visitors’ experience and overall wellbeing. There are no negative effects on this objective anticipated from the application of this policy so the effect is likely to be broadly neutral.

Policy UC2: New Retail (A1) in Newcastle and Gateshead							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Uncertain but could have a range of positive or negative effects on for example the historic environment and cultural heritage depending on how the shopping areas are developed and the precise location of any new shops.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS15: Place Making and UC12 (Urban Design) should mitigate any negative effects and strengthen the positive contribution to this objective.	The combination of this policy with Policies CS15 and UC12 should ensure positive implications to culture, heritage and diversity.	✓	✓	✓	- There is a risk that development of new shops within the two key shopping centres of the Urban Core could negatively impact on elements of the cultural heritage depending on precise location and how developments were delivered (design and construction). - However when this policy is combined with the conservation principles embedded within Policy CS15 and the architectural and design excellence of UC12 with the principles of good place making this should ensure positive implications for culture, heritage and diversity particularly in the longer term.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.	With the simultaneous application of Policy CS13 (Transport) the effect will be enhanced.		✓	✓	✓	- This policy is likely to increase accessibility, especially for pedestrians, to shopping and retail facilities, goods and services within the Urban Core through the improvement in quality and quantity of shops and retail outlets. - The impact will be enhanced with the simultaneous application of Policy CS13 Transport particularly in the longer term.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could give rise to a range of both positive and negative effects depending on how new shops and associated developments are delivered at the two prime locations within the Urban Core.	The application of Policy CS16 (Climate Change) should be able to provide mitigation.	Likely to be neutral or slightly positive	?0/✓	✓	✓	- The Urban Core in general and the main shopping centres are sustainable locations for new shops with a concentration of other services, employment and residential uses and good internal linkages for public transport, walking and cycling. They have good transport links to the rest of the area via the metro and buses and to the wider region and country by train. - The move to focus new shops in the primary shopping areas within the Urban Core is likely to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by maximising the opportunities for making the best use of the existing transport infrastructure and more sustainable modes such as public transport options as well as walking and cycling. - By increasing the number of shops with the possible knock-on increase in energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further emissions of carbon that will

Policy UC2: New Retail (A1) in Newcastle and Gateshead							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
							prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. The application of Policy CS16 (Climate Change) should be able to provide the necessary mitigation and ensure that any new developments include a carbon reduction strategy as well as maximising the use of local renewable or low carbon energy.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could generate negative effects depending on the precise location of any new shops.	Through the application of Policies CS15 (Place Making), CS16 (Climate Change) and CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) the potential impacts will be minimised.	Likely to be neutral or slightly positive.	?0/✓	✓	✓	- The city centre shopping locations are not in areas at risk from flooding and with the application of Policy CS17 this would ensure that any future shop and retail developments take on board flood risk and therefore adapt to one of the more significant effects relating to climate change. - The application of Policy CS16 ensures that any future development must address the effects of climate change in the wider sense. - Policy CS17 should also ensure that new development should control and minimise surface water run-off and consider alternative sustainable drainage solutions. - All of these policy measures if rigorously applied will ensure that new shopping developments adapt to the effects of climate change and thus this policy should have a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new shops and associated retail developments are designed and delivered – any large scale shopping development that does not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or	Through the application of Policies CS16 (Climate Change), UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling), and UC7 (Public Transport) the impacts of the shopping development will be minimised and potentially neutralised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation and with rigorous application could even become broadly positive.	? ✓	✓	✓	- By increasing the number of shops at all, there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and carbon emissions (construction and operation) that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - However, by developing new shops in the city centres within the Urban Core, the policy will help to reduce the need for car traffic and maximise opportunities for more sustainable travel (public transport, walking and cycling). - The application of Policies UC5, UC6 and UC7 should serve to mitigate the potential negative effects relating to resource use. - The application of Policy CS16 should lead to the integration of decentralised energy networks as part of new development and this could lead to greater energy efficiency savings and a reduction in contribution to greenhouse gas emissions.

Policy UC2: New Retail (A1) in Newcastle and Gateshead							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.						
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on the precise location of new shops and retail development.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policies CS15 (Place Making), CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment), and UC15 (Urban Green Infrastructure) possible negative impacts on environmental assets should be minimised.	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be neutral or slightly positive.	0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	- By promoting more shops and retail development there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure depending on location, design and construction. - Using the mitigation measures set out in Policy CS15, CS18, and UC15 the residual effects are likely to be neutral or slightly positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made (including green and brown roofs on new shops and retail outlets).
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have major positive effects.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	The policy makes provision for a number of shopping development opportunities in the city centres that are likely to strengthen the economy within the Urban Core. The effects of the policy are therefore thought to be very positive particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have major positive effects.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	Growth in the number of shops and related retail outlets is likely to make a significant contribution towards job creation in the Urban Core and therefore of improving access to a more stable and sustainable employment market in Gateshead and Newcastle.

Policy UC2: New Retail (A1) in Newcastle and Gateshead							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ The policy seeks to support the case for new shops and retail development to be located in the main shopping centres within the Urban Core. More buoyant shopping and retail provision, that improves the quality and quantity of retail offer, and caters better for the needs of workers, visitors and residents, will help to boost community confidence and increase community vibrancy. Focusing development on specific areas which possess poor quality built design and a lack of green space should promote user friendly, inclusively designed retail hubs, improving the visitors' experience. Furthermore, development of new shops and an improved retail offer area should promote increased employment and possible skill development opportunities. This should be supportive towards developing and retaining a skilled workforce and in turn supporting economic prosperity and stronger communities. The policy is assessed overall to have broadly neutral to positive implications for the social sustainability objectives.							
Environmental: ? ✖ to ✓ The effects of supporting more shop and retail developments in the Urban Core were considered to be uncertain but possibly negative with regard to impacts on the natural environment with issues like resource use, carbon emissions and waste likely to increase. The application of a number of associated policies provide effective mitigation and if these policies are rigorously applied in combination with Policy UC2, together with robust planning conditions or obligations, then there is the potential for the residual effects to be improved to become either neutral or even positive.							
Economic: ✓✓ Growth of shops and retailing is likely to make a contribution towards job creation in the Urban Core and therefore of improving access to a more stable and sustainable employment market in Gateshead and Newcastle. There should also be an overall contribution to the economic prosperity of the area.							

Policy UC3: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Uncertain but with supporting overarching policies should become positive.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS1 will ensure positive effects	Likely to be positive.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The Policy seeks to broaden and improve the offer of leisure and tourism facilities in the Urban Core in order to encourage a more diverse range of people to spend their leisure time in the Urban Core. By improving the appeal of the Urban Core, including increased usage of the River Tyne as a recreational resource to people from surrounding communities, as well as those people who currently visit the Urban Core, the policy will help to improve community life within the Urban Core, making it more sociable and welcoming. - The combined application of this policy with CS1 (the overarching Spatial Strategy) should ensure that developments are fully inclusive and cater for diverse needs.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Uncertain but with supporting overarching policies should become positive.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS1 and its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11 should ensure positive effects	Likely to be positive.	✓	✓	✓	- This policy encourages tourism and recreational development that will improve the quality and range of facilities, which will in turn promote an Urban Core that is family friendly and welcoming. - The combined application of this policy with CS1 (the overarching Spatial Strategy) and in particular Paragraph 5.11 in the supporting text should ensure that developments meet their equality and diversity obligations.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	This Policy encourages tourism, leisure and recreation development that will in turn improve the quality and range of facilities available. Teaching and learning benefits from having access to a broad range of facilities and experiences that are available locally and there should be positive benefits for skills development (in sports, recreation and tourism related subjects). The policy will therefore have a broadly positive effect on this SA Objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	The Policy seeks improve the culture, leisure and tourism offer of the Urban Core, building on its success as a leading destination, in order to encourage more people, and a more diverse range of people to spend their leisure time in the Urban Core. The Policy seeks to achieve this by improving the public realm and creating spaces that encourage visitors to stay in the area. Promoting the River Tyne and its surrounding environment as a recreational resource will clearly have a positive impact on general well-being and also may encourage more physical activity such as walking, cycling or jogging in and around the Urban Core, thereby helping to improve physical health.

Policy UC3: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Uncertain but with supporting overarching policies should become positive..	The simultaneous application of Policy CS15 Place Making and UC14 Heritage should mitigate any negative impacts		✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy seeks to improve access to cultural facilities by encouraging cultural uses within mixed-use developments. The Policy will therefore contribute to this SA Objective. - Developing the iconic riverfront area is the main focus of this policy and will inevitably include reusing warehouse and industrial buildings along the river. Heritage and cultural led regeneration projects will continue and Policies CS15 and UC14 should ensure that this SA is met.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- This Policy encourages tourism and recreation development that improves the quality and range of facilities available. The supporting text emphasises the desire to encourage complementary uses to group together, such as hubs for evening entertainment (i.e. theatres, venues, bars and restaurants). By grouping complementary facilities this will in turn provide improved accessibility to facilities and services. - Furthermore, the supporting text (14.36) details improvements to pedestrian access along the river and increasing connectivity between riverside sites.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could have negative effects – any leisure or tourism developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections could prejudice delivery of this objective.	Through the application of Policy CS16 (Climate Change) and the application of Policy UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), Policy UC6 (Cycling), and Policy UC7 (Buses and Coaches) the impacts of the development will be minimised and potentially neutralised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation, potentially neutralising the effects of development.	? *	? *	? *✓	- By increasing culture, leisure and tourism related provision there is likely to be an increase in energy use, potentially contributing to greenhouse gas emissions both directly (increased energy, public transport or car usage to get to the areas) and indirectly (tourists flying into the location). - The application of Policies CS16, UC5, UC6 and UC7 should serve to mitigate these potential effects, particularly in the longer term but may not necessarily remove them entirely.

Policy UC3: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of development, and its design and construction.	Through the application of Policies CS15 (Place Making), CS16 (Climate Change) and CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management), the impacts of the development will be minimised.	The policy could have a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective if the policies providing mitigation are rigorously applied.	✓	✓	✓	• The application of Policy CS17 would ensure that any future recreation/leisure or tourism development takes on board flood risk and therefore adapts to one of the more significant effects relating to climate change. • The application of Core Strategy Policy CS16 ensures that any future development must address the effects of climate change in the wider sense. • Policy CS16 should also ensure that new development should control and minimise surface water run-off and consider alternative sustainable drainage solutions. • All of these policy measures if rigorously applied will ensure that new leisure and tourism developments will adapt to the effects of climate change and thus this policy should have a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new developments are designed and delivered – any leisure or tourism developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.	Through the application of Policy CS16 (Climate Change), CS21 (Waste), UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling), and UC7 (Public Transport) the impacts of the development will be minimised and potentially neutralised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation, potentially neutralising the effects of development.	✖ ✖	✖ ✖	? ✖	• By increasing the provision of sports, leisure, culture and tourism developments with the possible knock-on increase in traffic and transport activity, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. • However, riverside developments are likely to occur on currently derelict or reclaimed industrial land (Brownfield sites) and bring them back into use. • The application of Policies CS16, CS21, UC5, UC6 and UC7 should serve to mitigate these potential effects but are unlikely to completely remove them.

Policy UC3: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of development, and its design and construction.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policies CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment and UC15 (Urban Green Infrastructure) the negative impacts of this policy on the natural environment should be minimised, and there is the potential for new economic development to provide additional green infrastructure and steer development away from vulnerable areas. Similarly Policy CS15 (Place Making) should mitigate against any negative effects on the historic environment and cultural heritage.	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By encouraging additional sports, leisure and tourism development there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments). This would depend on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. - With regard to the natural environment using the mitigation measures set out in Policies CS18 and UC15 the residual effects are likely to be positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made and development is steered away from vulnerable areas. - With regard to the historic environment if Policy CS15 is rigorously applied then there are measures that encourage the protection and enhancement of the historic environment and heritage assets which would thus leave a residual positive effect.

Policy UC3: Leisure, Culture and Tourism							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a strongly positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This Policy has a direct bearing on this SA objective and is likely to have a strong positive effect by facilitating the growth of the tourism sector, one of the important business sectors for the Gateshead and Newcastle economy. - Arguably the provision of an improved range and quality of leisure and recreational facilities should also boost economic opportunities and make the area attractive for people to live.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a strongly positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	Through the potential boost in the tourism sector and in the provision of more leisure, sports and tourism facilities there should be a positive impact on employment opportunities. This is likely to become more positive in the longer term as developments take place and the tourism sector expands.
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓ This policy encourages tourism, culture and recreation development that will improve the quality and range of facilities available. The policy will therefore contribute to the SA Objectives with more of a social thrust, promoting an Urban Core that is socially inclusive and welcoming. The policy makes no direct reference to accessibility for all, or catering for a diverse range of users. However, the combined application of this policy with Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) should promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to deliver fully inclusive developments that meet diverse needs, and with CS14 which has a focus on equality of access to amenity facilities. The supporting text is also positive about inclusive design of facilities by encouraging complementary uses to group together, for example hubs for evening entertainment, which will improve accessibility and overall positive experience of visitors to the Urban Core.							
Environmental: ? By increasing the number of leisure and tourism facilities in the Urban Core, with the possible increases in energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption, CO ₂ emissions and the further depletion of resources that will all tend to prejudice the delivery of some of the environmental objectives. There is also the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments) depending on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. Through the application of Policies CS16 (Climate Change), CS21 (Waste), UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling), and UC7 (Public Transport) the impacts of the development will be considerably minimised.							
Economic: ✓✓ The promotion of the growth of the tourism sector in Gateshead and Newcastle has strongly positive implications for the economy of the region. Arguably the provision of an improved range and quality of sports, leisure and recreational facilities should make the area attractive for people to live and work, further strengthening the economy of the region by increasing the employment market and boosting economic opportunities.							

Policy UC4: Homes							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new housing developments are designed and delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy) CS15 (Place Making) and UC12 (Urban Design) should ensure residential developments meet the highest standards of access and inclusion.	Likely to be positive if applied simultaneously with other policies.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The Policy seeks to deliver new housing based on the targets and policies and therefore should help to strengthen the community by providing housing where it is needed. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing should ensure that a fair and equitable range of housing is available in support of social inclusion. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS15 (Place Making) and UC12 (Urban Design) should ensure that inclusive design principles are picked up by this policy and therefore embedded in any future housing developments. - The supporting text (14.43) highlights the importance of the student population to the local economy and vibrancy of the Urban Core and looks to support purpose built student accommodation, making reference to Policies CS9 (Existing Communities) and CS11.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new housing developments are designed and delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS15 (Place Making) and UC12 (Urban Design) should ensure residential developments meet the highest standards of access and inclusion. The application of CS1 and supporting text at 5.11 should ensure that equality and diversity needs are met	Likely to be positive if applied simultaneously with other policies.	✓	✓	✓	- This Policy is likely to have a positive effect on equality, diversity and integration through the provision of housing in areas where it is needed – providing a range of housing to meet market demand - and provision of a mix of tenures including a requisite amount of affordable housing as appropriate. - The simultaneous application of Policies CS15 (Place Making) and UC12 (Urban Design) should ensure residential developments meet the highest standards of access and inclusion. The application of CS1 and supporting text at 5.11 should ensure that equality and diversity needs are met. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS11: Providing a Range and Choice of Housing should ensure that the appropriate types of housing are built to meet the needs of specific groups within the community, ensuring a fair and equitable range of housing is available in support of social inclusion. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS13 (Transport) should ensure that new housing developments are accessible.

Policy UC4: Homes							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not deal directly with issues addressing the improvement of educational achievements and skills levels across Gateshead and Newcastle. There are, however no negative effects on this objective anticipated from the application of this policy so the effect is likely to be broadly neutral.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly neutral to slightly positive effect.			0	✓	✓	Although this policy does not deal directly with issues around health and well-being, indirect benefits of better housing availability and a mix of housing offer could lead to general improvements in mental and physical health in the longer term.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a broadly neutral effect.	Policy CS15 (Place Making) includes the requirement for new development to reinforce local characteristics, meet the needs of the local community, protect sustain and enhance heritage assets and promote use, understanding and enjoyment of the historic environment.		0	✓	✓	Combined with the application of Policy CS15 the policy has the potential to have a positive effect over the long term, ensuring that new housing developments promote, enhance and respect culture heritage and diversity.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Uncertain but could have positive or negative effects depending on where new housing developments are finally located and how they are	Accessibility improvements will be achieved through the application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy), CS15 (Place Making) and CS13		✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Provision of a range of housing within the Urban Core, where a good range and quantity of jobs are likely to be located, will allow more people to live within close proximity to their places of employment and make this lifestyle affordable and accessible to more people. The Policy should therefore contribute positively to this Sustainability Objective. - When applied together with Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy), CS15 (Place Making) and CS13 (Transport) this policy will ensure that all housing is built together with an emphasis on accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services therefore having positive implications for this sustainability objective, particularly

Policy UC4: Homes							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	designed and delivered.	(Transport).					in the longer term as policy goals are delivered.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new housing developments are designed and delivered – any large scale housing developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.	Through the application of Policies CS16 (Climate Change), UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling), and UC7 (Public Transport) the impacts of the development will be minimised and potentially neutralised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation, potentially neutralising the effects of development as compared to that development taking place elsewhere in the Newcastle/ Gateshead area, in potentially less sustainable locations.	? ✓	? ✓	? ✓	- By increasing the absolute number of houses with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and carbon emissions that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - However, by improving housing provision closest to the Urban Core, close to where a large number of employment opportunities are likely to be located, the policy will help to reduce the need for commuting and maximise opportunities for sustainable travel. - The application of Policies CS13, UC5, UC6 and UC7 should serve to mitigate these potential effects potentially removing them. - The application of Policy CS16 should lead to the integration of decentralised energy networks as part of new housing development and this could lead to great energy efficiency savings and a reduction in contribution to greenhouse gas emissions.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of development, and its design and construction.	Through the application of Policies CS15 (Place Making), CS16 (Climate Change) and CS17 (Flood Risk and Water	The policy could have a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective if the policies providing	✓	✓	✓	- The application of Policy CS16 ensures that any future development must address the effects of climate change in the wider sense. - Policy CS16 should also ensure that new development should control and minimise surface water run-off and consider alternative sustainable drainage solutions. - The application of Policy CS17 would ensure that any future housing development takes on board flood risk and therefore adapts to one of the more

Policy UC4: Homes							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		Management) the impacts of the development will be minimised.	mitigation are rigorously applied.				significant effects relating to climate change. All of these policy measures if rigorously applied will ensure that new housing developments will adapt to the effects of climate change and thus this Policy should have a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Uncertain but could have negative effects and will depend on how new housing developments are designed and delivered – any large scale housing developments that do not include de-carbonisation measures (to address fossil fuel use and resource depletion) or sustainable energy and sustainable transport connections, as well as waste minimisation could prejudice delivery of this objective.	Through the application of Policies CS16 (Climate Change), CS13 (Transport), UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling) and UC7 (Public Transport) the impacts of the development will be minimised and potentially neutralised.	The policy will have a less negative effect after mitigation, potentially neutralising the effects of development.	?0	?0/✓	? ✓	- By increasing the number of houses with the possible knock-on increase in traffic, energy consumption and waste generation there is likely to be an inevitable increase in fossil fuel consumption and further depletion of resources that will prejudice the delivery of this sustainability objective. - The Policy supports redevelopment and conversions of upper floors and mixed-use schemes, this in turn will minimise the use of additional resources during construction and delivery of housing objectives. - The application of Policies CS16, UC5, UC6 and UC7 should serve to mitigate these potential effects and if applied rigorously could generate broadly positive support for this SA objective in the longer term.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of new housing development, and	Through the mitigation measures offered by Policies CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be positive.	✓	✓	✓	- By promoting additional housing developments there is the potential for negative or positive impacts on environmental infrastructure (both the natural and historic environments). This would depend on the precise location of any new development and how it was designed and constructed. - With regard to the natural environment using the mitigation measures set out in Policies CS18 and UC15 the residual effects are likely to be positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made.

Policy UC4: Homes							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
	its design and construction.	Environment and UC15 (Urban Green Infrastructure) the negative impacts of this policy on the natural environment should be minimised, and there is the potential for new economic development to provide additional green infrastructure and steer development away from vulnerable areas. Similarly Policy CS15 (Place Making) should mitigate against any negative effects on the historic environment and cultural heritage.					With regard to the historic environment if Policy CS15 is rigorously applied then there are measures that encourage the protection and enhancement of the historic environment and heritage assets which would thus leave a residual positive effect.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The provision of housing in the way indicated in this Policy (mixed-use) is likely to provide some form of support to the economy through making more housing available, attracting people into the area, increasing workforce diversity and encouraging communities to be more stable, thriving and sustainable. In addition there will be a boost to the construction industry as a direct result of house building.

Policy UC4: Homes							
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Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
							Overall the policy is regarded as having a broadly positive effect.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- Provision of a range of housing within the Urban Core, where a good range and quantity of jobs are likely to be located, will allow more people to live within close proximity to their places of employment and provide employers with a ready source of workers. The Policy will therefore contribute strongly to this Sustainability Objective, particularly in the longer term. - There is likely to be positive implications when combined with Policy CS11 by providing affordable housing and student accommodation where it is required because this will encourage more people to move to the area and thus increase the employment market.
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓ The Policy seeks to deliver new housing based on the Core Strategy targets and Policies and therefore should help to strengthen the community by providing housing where it is needed. This in turn is likely to have a positive effect on equality, diversity and integration. The supporting text is positive about meeting diverse housing needs of communities, and if applied simultaneously with Policies CS15 and UC12 (Urban Design) this should ensure that inclusive design principles are picked up by this policy and therefore embedded in any future housing developments. The policy does not deal directly with issues around health and well-being, however indirect benefits of better housing availability and a mix of housing offer could lead to general improvements in mental and physical health within the community in the longer term. Overall the policy is assessed as being broadly supportive of the social SA Objectives.							
Environmental: ? to ✓ There is the possibility for the development of new housing stock to impact negatively on the environment, in terms of generating carbon emissions, use of non-renewable resources and generation of waste materials but this should be minimised by the simultaneous application of Policies CS16, UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling), and UC7 (Public Transport). The simultaneous application of Policies CS15 and CS18 should ensure that new housing development is built in such a way as to ensure minimal impact on the natural and historic environment and in some cases improve conditions such as creating new green infrastructure and green space. By improving housing provision close to the Urban Core, where a large number of employment opportunities are likely to be located, the policy will help to reduce the need for commuting and maximise opportunities for sustainable travel. Overall this policy was assessed as having an uncertain but leading towards a positive effect on environmental objectives.							
Economic: ✓ The provision of housing in the way indicated in this Policy is likely to provide support to the economy through direct benefits to the construction industry, and making more housing available, attracting people (including students) into the area, increasing workforce diversity and encouraging communities to be more stable, thriving and sustainable. Overall the policy is regarded as having a positive effect on the economic objectives.							

Policy UC5: Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes							
Policy UC6: Cycling							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy) and UC12 (Urban Design) should strengthen the positive contribution.	Likely to be positive with the combined application of Policies CS1 and UC12.	✓	✓	✓✓	- By making the Urban Core more inviting to pedestrians and cyclists, the policies will make a positive contribution towards building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community wellbeing. All of these features serve to strengthen the community. - The combined application of these policies with CS1 (Spatial Strategy) and UC12 (Urban Design) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to design a public realm which is inclusive and accessible to all. - Overall the policies are regarded as having a positive effect on this sustainability objective with the effect likely to be stronger in the longer term as key measures are delivered.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on how well pedestrian and cycling routes accommodate the needs of all.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy) with its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11 and CS13 (Transport) should ensure that positive contributions are made.	Likely to be positive with the combined application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy) with its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11 and CS13 (Transport).	✓	✓	✓	The simultaneous application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy) with its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11 and CS13 (Transport) should ensure that equality, diversity and integration are all embedded into the development of the pedestrian routes and cycleways.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	Policies UC5 and UC6 do not directly address educational achievement and skills development but are not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.

Policy UC5: Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes							
Policy UC6: Cycling							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of CS 14 (Wellbeing and Health), CS13 (Transport) and UC12 (Urban Design) should strengthen the positive contribution.	Likely to be strongly positive with the combined application of the other policies.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The creation of a safe environment for walking and cycling within the Urban Core will help to encourage more people to choose active transport rather than sedentary modes of transport, thereby increasing physical activity and improving health. - The simultaneous application of CS14 (Wellbeing and Health), CS13 (Transport) and UC12 (Urban Design) should strengthen the positive contributions particularly in the longer term.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral or slightly positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	Policies UC5 and UC6 do not directly address culture, heritage and diversity but are not assessed as having any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective. It is possible that these policies may help to improve appreciation of the heritage within the Urban Core by encouraging people to experience the urban environment on foot, thereby bringing them into close contact with the architecture, sounds and sights of the vibrant urban centre.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of UC12 (Urban Design) should strengthen the positive contribution.	Likely to be positive with the combined application of Policy UC12.	✓	✓	✓✓	- Policy UC5 commits to ensuring a safer and better linked Urban Core, providing improved access to all potential users. - The combined application of these policies with UC12 (Urban Design) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to design a public realm which is inclusive and accessible to all.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	Policies UC5 and UC6 promote the use of walking and cycling over the private car and also seek to invest in the cardinal walking and cycling routes within the Urban Core. It will therefore be instrumental in reducing the output of greenhouse gasses in the Urban Core.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a neutral or slightly positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	These policies will not have a direct positive effect on either reducing vulnerability or adapting to climate change but, as walking and cycling are highly adaptable, they are likely to be modes of transport that are the most resilient against the effects of climate change.

Policy UC5: Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes Policy UC6: Cycling							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	These policies promote the use of walking and cycling over the private car and also seek to invest in the primary and secondary walking routes within the Urban Core. It will therefore be instrumental in reducing the reliance on fossil fuels, reducing carbon emissions associated with traffic and promoting better use of non-renewable resources in the Urban Core.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The aim of reducing the dominance of the private car across the area and enhancing opportunities for more sustainable forms of travelling will make a contribution towards safeguarding environmental assets and infrastructure within the area.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	These policies are not directed at strengthening the economy of the area but there are likely to be positive effects on the economy as overall connectivity within the Urban Core is improved, allowing greater access to goods, services and employment opportunities and linking businesses with consumers.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- These policies are not directed strictly towards improving access to stable and sustainable employment markets, but it does aim to promote more sustainable travel choices. No negative effects are anticipated and the residual effect is considered to be broadly positive. - Increased uptake of walking/cycling through the provision of safer/more appealing infrastructure may have broad long-term health and well-being benefits, reducing sick days.

Policy UC5: Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes

Policy UC6: Cycling

Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative

Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	

Summary

Social: ✓ to ✓✓

These policies seek to improve transport infrastructure and connectivity within the Urban Core and to increase sustainable travel choices as well as improve on accessibility within communities. All of which will make a positive contribution towards promoting social inclusion, community cohesion, quality of life and community wellbeing. The combined application of these policies with CS15 (Place Making) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to create safe and inclusive environments. The policies are therefore likely to generate strong positive support for the social objectives.

Environmental: ✓✓

These policies promote walking and cycling over the use of the private car and seek to invest further in the sustainable travel networks. They support commitments to tackle climate change and also to improve air quality. The major directions of these policies is on improving environmental conditions through promoting sustainable transport and therefore are assessed as generating positive effects.

Economic: ✓

The major focus of the Policies UC5 and UC6 are to improve travel connectivity and promote more sustainable modes of transport therefore the key direction is not centred on economic prosperity but there are likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall connectivity within the Urban Core is improved, allowing greater access to goods and services and linking businesses with consumers. Therefore the policies are assessed to be of a broadly positive effect.

Policy UC7: Public Transport							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.	The combined application of Policy CS13 (Transport) which encompasses accessibility and inclusiveness, will strengthen the positive effects.	Likely to be positive with the simultaneous application of CS13.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	• The Policy seeks to improve the public transport infrastructure and connectivity within the Urban Core, focusing on improving accessibility to buses and the Metro thereby encouraging sustainable travel choices and reducing car traffic. • There is no direct commitment to equality of access, however, if combined with Policy CS13 (Transport), which encompasses inclusivity and equality of access this will strengthen the 'thrust' of this policy towards inclusiveness. • Accessibility and sustainable transport support social inclusion and are likely to improve quality of life for all in Gateshead and Newcastle, allowing them greater ease of access to the Urban Core. • As such the policy is likely to generate significant positive effects on this objective, particularly in the longer term.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.	The combined application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy), Paragraph 5.11 (on equalities) and CS13 (Transport) which encompasses accessibility and inclusiveness, will strengthen the positive effects	Likely to be positive with the simultaneous application of Core Strategy policies.	✓	✓	✓✓	• The Policy seeks to improve transport infrastructure and connectivity within the Urban Core, focusing on improving accessibility to buses and the Metro thereby encouraging sustainable travel choices and reducing car traffic. • Improvement of the public transport network in this way will help in furthering this objective by focusing on the more affordable and therefore inclusive forms of transport such as buses. • If combined with the Transport Policy (CS13) – which encompasses inclusivity and equality of access – this will strengthen the 'thrust' of the policies towards equality and integration. • As such the policy is likely to generate significant positive effects on this objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	• Although the policy does not address issues that specifically relate to educational achievement and skills development it does aim to provide a sustainable transport network that supports economic prosperity and improved access to jobs, facilities and services. This should therefore provide a supporting framework for improving skills (e.g. access to educational facilities and services) and retaining the skilled workforce (e.g. improved access to employment).

Policy UC7: Public Transport							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- Although the policy does not specifically address health and well-being issues, it does nevertheless promote a reduction in the dominance of the car and access to more sustainable travel choices (the public transport network) both of which support improved health and wellbeing. - Improved sustainable travel choices and ease of use is likely to promote good mental health and to enable more walking and cycling which will help to improve physical and mental health. - All of these are likely to generate more significant positive effects in the longer term as the policy delivers its objectives.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Uncertain but could have positive or negative effects depending on how the improvements in the transport network are delivered.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS15 and UC12 (Urban Design) will make sure that the effect is positive on this objective.	With the application of Policy CS15 UC12 (Urban Design) the effect can be strengthened to a broadly positive effect.	✓	✓	✓	- The policy itself does not make any particular reference to cultural heritage and diversity so the delivery of transport interventions (particularly major construction activities) could generate either positive or negative effects on this sustainability objective depending on how they were delivered. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS15 and UC12 (Urban Design) however, provide for protection of heritage assets, and safeguarding local characteristics and distinctiveness will make sure that culture and heritage issues are considered appropriately.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The whole thrust of this policy is about delivering improvements to transport infrastructure and improving accessibility across the area through an integrated sustainable transport network, so it will directly and positively impact on this SA objective. - Policy CS13 in particular has a clause which supports public transport services out with the operation hours of the Metro and bus service, promoting access to evening services. - There are measures proposed to improve public transport and a range of other transport modes that will ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities and services.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	The policy promotes the use of public transport over the private car and also seeks to invest further in the sustainable travel networks throughout the Urban Core. It will therefore be instrumental in reducing the output of greenhouse gases in the Urban Core.

Policy UC7: Public Transport							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy will not have a direct positive effect on either reducing vulnerability or adapting to climate change but, as transport related development will be governed by Policy CS17 and will also be subject to sequential and exception tests it will not have a negative effect on reducing vulnerability to climate change.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have a strongly positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	This policy promotes the use of public transport over the private car and also seeks to invest further in the sustainable travel networks throughout the Urban Core. It will therefore be instrumental in reducing the reliance on and consumption of fossil fuels.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a neutral to broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The aim of reducing the dominance of the private car across the area and enhancing opportunities for more sustainable forms of travelling will make a contribution towards safeguarding environmental assets and infrastructure within the area.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- These policies are not directed at strengthening the economy of the area but there are likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall connectivity within the Urban Core is improved, allowing greater access to goods and services and linking businesses with consumers. - Policy CS13 (Transport) ensures the support of public transport provision outside of Metro and bus operation hours, therefore enabling the Urban Core to function as a location for activity at all hours, promoting the '8 until late' economy.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	These policies are not directed strictly towards improving access to stable and sustainable employment markets, but it does aim to promote more sustainable travel choices. No negative effects are anticipated and the residual effect is considered to be positive.

Policy UC7: Public Transport							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓ Policy UC7 seeks to improve transport infrastructure and connectivity within the Urban Core, enhancing the service around, and to the edge of the city centre. This policy focuses on increasing sustainable travel choices and the more inclusive forms of transport (i.e. buses) as well as improvement in accessibility within communities. All of which contribute positively towards quality of life and promoting strong inclusive communities. If combined with the Transport Policy (CS13) – which encompasses equality and safe and inclusive access – this will strengthen the ‘thrust’ of the policy towards equality and integration. It is therefore assessed overall to have positive implications on social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ✓✓ These policies promote the use of public transport over the private car and seek to invest further in the sustainable travel networks. Therefore reducing the output of greenhouse gases in the Urban Core, improving air quality, and reducing our contribution to the causes of climate change. Since these policies are focused on improving environmental conditions through promoting sustainable transport, it is assessed as having strong positive implications on environmental sustainability objectives. Economic: ✓ The major focus of this policy is to improve travel connectivity and promote the sustainable transport network. The key direction is therefore not centred on economic prosperity of the region, however, there are likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall connectivity within the Urban Core is improved, allowing greater access to goods and services and linking businesses with consumers. Overarching Policy CS13 (Transport) ensures the support of public transport provision outside of Metro and bus operation hours, therefore enabling the Urban Core to function as a location for activity at all hours, promoting the ‘8 until late’ economy. Therefore the policies are assessed to generate positive effects.							

Policy UC8: Freight and Servicing							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a broadly positive impact.			✓	✓	✓	- The Policy seeks to manage servicing traffic in a way that strikes a balance between accommodating servicing requirements and seeking to minimise their impact. By ensuring freight and servicing does not negatively impact on public transport service, pedestrian and cycle routes, this will have a broadly positive impact on supporting the public realm in a way that is inclusive and accessible (each new development within the revised Freight Management Area will be required to create a Delivery Service Plan). - The policy will have a broadly positive impact on this sustainability objective.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a broadly positive impact			✓	✓	✓	- As above, by ensuring freight and servicing does not negatively impact on public transport service, pedestrian and cycle routes, this will have a broadly positive impact on supporting the public realm in a way that is inclusive and accessible. - The policy will have a broadly positive impact on this sustainability objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral impact			0	0	0	The policy does not address issues that specifically relate to educational achievement and skills development. It is assessed as having a neutral impact on this sustainability objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Although the Policy does not specifically address health and well-being issues, the supporting text does promote the use of low emission vehicles and electric vehicles as well as combining journeys (through its freight consolidation measures). This will have a positive impact on air quality, having a broadly positive impact on health.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral impact			0	0	0	The management of the freight and servicing sector is unlikely to have any negative impact on this sustainability objective. It is therefore assessed as having a neutral impact on this sustainability objective.

Policy UC8: Freight and Servicing							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect			✓	✓	✓	- The whole thrust of policy UC8, and its supporting text is about delivering improvements to freight and servicing by maintaining a balance between accommodating these services whilst reducing their impact on other forms of transport. - The policy is therefore likely to have a positive impact on accessibility, by ensuring freight and servicing does not negatively impact on buses, pedestrian/cyclists and promoting the smooth flow of other traffic in the city centre. - The policy is therefore assessed as having a positive impact on this sustainability objective.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The policy and its supporting text aims to mitigate against the impact of freight and servicing through freight consolidation measures, as well as the use of low emission vehicles and electric vehicles. - Therefore reducing the output of greenhouse gases in the urban core, improving air quality, and reducing our contribution to the causes of climate change. - These measures will all have a positive impact on this sustainability objective.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The Policy will not have a direct effect on adapting to climate change but, as transport related development will be governed by Policy CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) and will also be subject to sequential and exception tests, it will not have a negative effect on reducing vulnerability to climate change.
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- This Policy and its supporting text promotes the use of low emission vehicles (including electric vehicles), as well as freight consolidation measures (combining journeys). - The policy will therefore reduce the reliance on and consumption of fossil fuels.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a neutral to broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The aim of the Policy, to consolidate freight journeys and encourage adoption of low emission vehicles promotes a more sustainable freight and servicing sector. - The policy is therefore assessed as having a neutral impact on this sustainability objective.

Policy UC8: Freight and Servicing							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	By promoting a more sustainable environmentally friendly freight and servicing sector, and promoting freight consolidation measures, this will have positive implications for cost of running and overall overheads of the freight and servicing sector. Thus strengthening the local economy.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	✓	This policy is not directed strictly towards improving access to stable and sustainable employment markets, but it does have the potential to enhance markets in low carbon emission technologies (including electric vehicles) in the automotive industry.
Summary							
Social: ✓ The Policy and its supporting text seek to manage servicing traffic in a way that strikes a balance between accommodating servicing requirements and seeking to minimise their impact. By ensuring freight and servicing does not negatively impact on the public transport service, pedestrian and cycle routes, this will support an inclusive and accessible public realm. The policy promotes the use of low emission vehicles (and electric vehicles) as well as freight consolidation measures, which will have a positive impact on air quality, and therefore health and wellbeing. By ensuring freight does not negatively impact on other forms of transport this should have positive implications for accessibility to goods, facilities and services. The policy is therefore assessed as having a positive impact on social sustainability objective.							
Environmental: ✓ The policy and its supporting text aims to mitigate against the impact of freight and servicing through freight consolidation measures (the use of smaller vehicles and combining journeys), as well as the use of low emission vehicles (including electric vehicles). The policy will therefore have positive implications on reducing the output of greenhouse gases in the urban core, reducing our reliance on and the consumption of fossil fuels and reducing our contribution to the causes of climate change The policy is assessed as having a broadly positive contribution to environmental sustainability objectives, particularly in the longer term as the policy is delivered.							
Economic: ✓ By promoting a more sustainable environmentally friendly freight and servicing sector and freight consolidation measures, the policy will have positive implications for running costs and overall overheads of the freight and servicing sector. Thus strengthening the local economy. Therefore the policy is assessed to generate broadly positive effects.							

Policy UC9: General Traffic							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS13 (Transport) should strengthen the positive effects.	Likely to be positive with the combined application of Policy CS13 (Transport)	✓	✓	✓✓	- By managing traffic more proactively in the Urban Core, reducing traffic, and in combination with Policy CS13 (Transport) giving greater priority to more sustainable travel options, and improving the overall pedestrian experience, the policy will make a positive contribution towards building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community wellbeing. All of these features serve to strengthen the community. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS13 (Transport) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to '[improve] equality of access to transport for everyone' and its' other community-friendly measures.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a broadly positive impact.			✓	✓	✓	- As above, by ensuring the movement of through traffic does not negatively impact on public transport service, pedestrian and cycle routes, this will have a broadly positive impact on supporting the public realm in a way that is inclusive and accessible. - The policy will have a broadly positive impact on this sustainability objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to be positive.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The thrust of general traffic management is towards reducing car traffic and together with Policy CS13, giving greater priority to more sustainable modes of travel (likely to be public transport, walking and cycling). This is supportive of improved health and well-being (helping to cut vehicle emissions and encouraging more physical exercise) and therefore gives some support to this SA Objective. - Overall this policy is assessed as having a positive impact on this sustainability objective, particularly in the longer term as the policies' goals are delivered.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address issues associated with culture, heritage and diversity but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.

Policy UC9: General Traffic							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policy CS13 (Transport) should further strengthen the effect on this SA Objective.	Likely to be a stronger positive effect with the application of Core Strategy Policy CS13 particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The thrust of the policy is towards more efficient management of traffic within the Urban Core. This should be supportive towards improved accessibility around the Urban Core to places of work, shops and other facilities. - The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policies CS13 will strengthen the effect with significant positive effects likely in the longer term as the policies deliver their objectives.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	The policy sets out to reduce car traffic where possible in the Urban Core and to promote more sustainable forms of travel such as public transport, walking and cycling. If all of the measures work then it will make a contribution towards reducing the output of greenhouse gasses in the Urban Core. The positive effects should increase with time.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address issues associated with adapting the effects of climate change but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy intends to give priority to reducing car traffic in the Urban Core and with Policy CS13 promoting sustainable transport over the use of the car and so should support a reduction in the reliance on fossil fuels and a reduction in carbon emissions associated with traffic in the Urban Core.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address issues associated with protecting and enhancing environmental assets but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy is not directed at strengthening the economy of the area but there are likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall pedestrian movement around the Urban Core is improved improving the access of shoppers and retail staff to goods, services and employment opportunities and linking businesses with consumers.

Policy UC9: General Traffic							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy is not directed strictly towards improving access to stable and sustainable employment markets, but it does aim to promote better accessibility by pedestrians thus using more sustainable travel choices and easier access and movement around the Urban Core. No negative effects are anticipated and the residual effect is considered to be broadly positive.
Summary							
Social: ✓ This policy seeks to minimise through traffic and improve connectivity within the Urban Core, reducing car traffic and congestion and improving the overall pedestrian experience. All of this will make a positive contribution towards building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community wellbeing. The simultaneous application of Policy CS13 (Transport) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to '[improve] equality of access to transport for everyone' and its' other community-friendly measures. It is therefore assessed overall to have positive implications on social sustainability objectives, particularly in the longer term as the policy goal of minimising through traffic and improving the local environment is delivered.							
Environmental: ✓ The policy endeavours to manage traffic access in and around the Urban Core. Together with the application of CS13 it will help to support commitments to tackle climate change by reducing through traffic and a reliance on the car and therefore consumption of fossil fuels, reducing greenhouse gas emissions and improving air quality. It is assessed as broadly supportive of the environmental objectives.							
Economic: ✓ The major focus of the policies is to improve car traffic management and improve ease of getting into and around the Urban Core. Therefore the key direction is not centred on economic prosperity of the region but there are nevertheless likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall connectivity within the Urban Core by more sustainable forms of travel is improved, allowing greater access to goods and services and linking businesses with consumers. Therefore the policy is assessed to generate broadly positive effects.							

Policy UC10: Car Parking							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS13 (Transport) should strengthen the positive effects.	Likely to be positive with the combined application of Policy CS13	✓	✓	✓	The combined application of this policy with Policy CS13 (Transport) should make a positive contribution towards reducing the reliance on the car and building quality places which in turn will support quality of life community wellbeing.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not directly address equality, diversity and integration issues but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not directly address health and wellbeing issues but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Uncertain but could have positive or negative effects depending on where new car parks and improved parking are located.	The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policies CS15 (Place Making) and UC12 (Urban Design) will make sure that the effect is positive on this objective.	With the application of overarching or supporting policies the effect can be strengthened to a broadly positive effect.	✓	✓	✓	- The policy does not make any particular reference to cultural heritage and diversity so the construction of new car parks and additional parking areas could generate either positive or negative effects on this sustainability objective depending on how they were designed, constructed and where they were located. - The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policy CS15 (Place Making) and Policy UC12 (Urban Design) however, provide for protection of heritage assets, and safeguarding local characteristics and distinctiveness. The application of these umbrella policies simultaneously will make sure that culture and heritage issues are considered appropriately.

Policy UC10: Car Parking							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS13 (Transport) should further strengthen the effect on this SA Objective.	Likely to be a stronger positive effect with the application of Policy CS13 particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓	- The thrust of the policy is towards the provision of adequate parking and Park and Ride facilities. This should be supportive towards improved accessibility around the Urban Core to places of work, shops and other facilities. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS13 will strengthen the effect.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- Although making provisions for the car by providing car parking, this policy nevertheless aims to discourage the use of the car by minimising car parking (in preference to other forms of sustainable transport) and managing the use through pricing to encourage short stays. - If this is successful in discouraging the use of the car then together with Policy CS13 it should be broadly supportive of the sustainability objective.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on precise location of new car parks and associated development together with its design and construction.	Through the application of Core Strategy policies CS16 (Climate Change), CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) and CS15 (Place Making) the impacts of any new car park developments will be minimised.	The policy could have a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective if the policies providing mitigation are rigorously applied.	✓	✓	✓	- The application of Core Strategy Policy CS17 would ensure that any future car parking development takes on board flood risk and therefore adapts to one of the more significant effects relating to climate change. - The application of Core Strategy Policy CS16 ensures that any future development must address the effects of climate change in the wider sense. This is also reinforced in Core Strategy Policy CS17. - Policy CS17 should also ensure that new development should control and minimise surface water run-off and consider alternative sustainable drainage solutions. - All of these policy measures if rigorously applied will ensure that new car parking developments will adapt to the effects of climate change and thus these policies should have a broadly positive residual effect on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on how any future car parking development was constructed.	Through the application of Core Strategy policy CS16 (Climate Change) the likelihood of possible positive effects would be increased.		✓?	✓?	✓?	- The degree with which contributions can be made to this SA objective would depend on the extent to which sustainable design and construction methods were applied to new car park developments and the energy sources for lighting and other requirements. - Application of Policy CS16 (Climate Change) would ensure that sustainable design criteria were used in any car park design.

Policy UC10: Car Parking							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Uncertain but could be positive or negative depending on particular location of any future car parking development.	Through the mitigation measures offered by Core Strategy Policy CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) and Policy CS16 (Climate Change) the negative impacts of this policy on the natural environment should be minimised.	After mitigation the effect of the policy will be positive.	✓?	✓?	✓?	The application of Core Strategy Policy CS18 would ensure that any future car parking development considers its effects on environmental assets and green infrastructure. If a provision for additional green infrastructure is made within developments then a positive contribution would be made to this objective.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy is not directed at strengthening the economy of the area but there are likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall movement around the Urban Core is improved by the enhancement and improvement of car parking allowing greater access to goods, services and employment opportunities and linking businesses with consumers.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy is not directed strictly towards improving access to stable and sustainable employment markets, but it does aim to support easier access and movement around the Urban Core. No negative effects are anticipated and the residual effect is considered to be broadly positive.

Policy UC10: Car Parking							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ This policy endeavours to ensure the provision of safe and secure car parking whilst simultaneously minimising the amount available because of the highly accessible nature of the Urban Core. All of this will make a positive contribution towards reducing the reliance on the car and building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community wellbeing. It is therefore assessed overall to have broadly positive implications for some of the social sustainability objectives. Environmental: 0 to✓ With the emphasis on minimising the amount of car parking available because of the highly accessible nature of the Urban Core, this will effectively encourage the more sustainable forms of transport such as walking, cycling and public transport. All of this will make a positive contribution towards reducing the reliance on the car and hence harmful emissions to the environment. The policy is regarded as being broadly supportive of the environmental objectives. Economic: ✓ The key direction of the policy is not focused on economic prosperity but there are no negative effects anticipated so the effect is regarded as neutral.							

Policy UC11: Gateways and Arrival Points							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- By improving the definition of arrival points into the city centre, and improving the overall pedestrian experience, the policy will make a positive contribution towards building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community wellbeing. All of these features serve to strengthen the community. - The combined application of the policy with CS15 (Place Making) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to creating 'safe and inclusive environments'.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not directly address equality, diversity and integration issues but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to be positive.			✓	✓	✓	- The policy aims to ensure improvements are made to the Urban Core to ensure it is a safe and pleasant place for pedestrians, as well as an easy place to find your way around. - Overall the policy is assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to be positive.			✓	✓	✓	The policy aims to ensure improvements are made in and around defined gateways to the Urban Core. This would be expected therefore to have a positive effect on this sustainability objective.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policy CS13 (Transport) should further strengthen the	Likely to be a stronger positive effect with the application of Core Strategy Policy CS13	✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy focuses on ensuring the Urban Core is an easy place to find your way in, and a safe enjoyable place to walk. This should be supportive towards improved accessibility around the Urban Core to places of work, shops and other facilities. - The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policy CS13 will strengthen the effect with significant positive effects likely in the longer term as the policies

Policy UC11: Gateways and Arrival Points							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		effect on this SA Objective.	particularly in the longer term.				deliver their objectives.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not directly address climate change issues but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not directly address climate change issues but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not directly address environmental limits and resource issues but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Depends on how policy will be delivered but likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment and CS15 (Place Making) should further strengthen the effect on this SA Objective.	Likely to be a stronger positive effect with the application of Core Strategy Policies CS15 and CS18.	✓	✓	✓✓	The policy focuses on ensuring the Urban Core is an easy place to find your way into, and a safe enjoyable place to walk. It aspires to improving and enhancing the areas around major gateways and arrival points. With the combined application of Policy CS18 and Policy UC15 during the development and enhancement of gateways, the residual effects are likely to be positive, particularly if a provision for additional green infrastructure is made.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy is not directed at strengthening the economy of the area but there are likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall movement around the Urban Core is improved, including enhanced definition of gateways and arrival points, allowing greater access to goods, services and employment opportunities and linking businesses with consumers.

Policy UC11: Gateways and Arrival Points							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy is not directed strictly towards improving access to stable and sustainable employment markets, but it does aim to promote more sustainable travel choices and easier access and movement around the Urban Core. No negative effects are anticipated and the residual effect is considered to be broadly positive.
Summary							
Social: ✓ The policy seeks to improve the definition of arrival points and gateways into the city centre, and improve the overall pedestrian experience in the Urban Core. All of this will make a positive contribution towards building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community wellbeing. The simultaneous application of Policy CS15 (Place Making) should further promote strong and inclusive communities through its commitment to design 'to create safe and inclusive environments' and 'ensure connectivity, accessibility and legibility'. It is therefore assessed overall to have positive implications on social sustainability objectives, particularly in the longer term as the policy begins to deliver its objectives. Environmental: ✓ This policy endeavours to promote the use of more sustainable forms of transport over the private car through improving the transition between sustainable travel modes such as public transport to pedestrian access in and around defined arrival points. In making use of sustainable travel more easy and enjoyable it will promote more use of these modes and so will be supportive of commitments to tackle climate change by reducing reliance on and consumption of fossil fuels, reduce greenhouse gas emissions and improving air quality. Economic: ✓ The major focus of this policy is to enhance the definition of gateways and arrival points and improve ease of getting into and around the Urban Core. Therefore the key direction is not centred on economic prosperity of the region but there are nevertheless likely to be positive effects on the economy if overall connectivity within the Urban Core is improved, allowing greater access to goods and services and linking businesses with consumers. Therefore the policy is assessed to generate broadly positive effects.							

Policy UC12: Urban Design							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy requires development to respect the positive elements of its context, working with the unique topography and landscape, architecture and public realm to create quality locally distinctive places. - By definition good urban design and quality place making is socially inclusive and so the delivery of this policy should make a positive contribution towards this sustainability objective.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- Through the implementation of this policy, development will respond to and enhance local distinctiveness and reinforce local characteristics. This policy aims to support a vibrant social centre through sustainable urban design. - This policy should provide strong contributions towards this SA Objective, particularly in the longer term as the policy is delivered.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	The creation of attractive public realm together with a strong locally distinctive sense of place is likely to make a strong positive contribution towards the feeling of community wellbeing. Good urban design and place making will involve the provision of green infrastructure and green spaces that will provide areas for recreation and exercise both of which will lead to improved quality of life and health in the area.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	A major thrust of this policy is to deliver a high level of design quality, and provide a holistic approach to development that is locally relevant. This should ensure culture and heritage is respected and where possible enhanced, creating a strong locally distinctive sense of place which will make a positive contribution towards the delivery of this sustainability objective, particularly in the longer term as the policy is delivered.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	By providing a holistic approach to development that reinforces the urban core, and promotes a public realm that is inclusive and assessable to all, there will be positive implications towards this sustainability objective.

Policy UC12: Urban Design							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policies and CS15 (Place Making) and CS16 (Climate Change) should further strengthen the effect on this SA Objective.	Likely to be a stronger positive effect with the application of Strategic Policies CS15 andCS16.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy requires that development incorporates high quality, durable and sustainable materials appropriate to the character of the area and the use envisaged for the site. Sustainable materials should mean that they have a lower carbon footprint than more conventional materials. - The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policies and CS15 (Place Making) and CS16 (Climate Change) should further strengthen the effect on this SA Objective.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- This policy does not directly address adaptation to climate change except that it could be argued that architectural and design excellence should ensure positive implications on this sustainability objective. This in turn would be expected to address issues such as flood risk or the incorporation of green roofs and sustainable urban drainage systems into the design – all of which help with adaptation and mitigation of the effects of climate change. - There are no negative effects on this objective anticipated from the application of this policy and the commitment to promote sustainable design should provide an overall positive impact on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policies and CS15 (Place Making) and CS16 (Climate Change) should further strengthen the effect on this SA Objective.	Likely to be a stronger positive effect with the application of Strategic Policies CS15 andCS16.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy requires that development incorporates high quality, durable and sustainable materials appropriate to the character of the area and the use envisaged for the site. Sustainable materials should mean that they have a lower carbon footprint than more conventional materials and are likely to be sustainably sourced. - The simultaneous application of Core Strategy Policies and CS15 (Place Making) and CS16 (Climate Change) should further strengthen the effect on this SA Objective.

Policy UC12: Urban Design							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The Policy doesn't specifically address the protection of environmental assets, however it does require development to be designed to respect and enhance the positive characteristics and context, which means that if green infrastructure and the natural environment are involved then these too will be protected and enhanced. The commitment to sustainable urban design would also be expected to protect and enhance environmental assets and infrastructure thus reinforcing the positive support for this SA objective. - The combined application of Policies CS15 (Place Making) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) should strengthen the positive effects on this sustainability objective.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to broadly have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Through the delivery of this policy it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across the Urban Core. The creation of an attractive environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. The policy was therefore assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not focus centrally on providing a sustainable employment market but it is anticipated that there will be positive effects stemming from the support this Policy will give improving the public realm, improving attractiveness of the area, and therefore encouraging tourism and visitors and shoppers to the Urban Core.

Policy UC12: Urban Design							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓✓ This policy and its supporting text is focused on enhancing the positive, distinctive qualities of the Urban Core, respecting the positive elements of its context, working with the unique topography and landscape, architecture and public realm to create distinctive quality buildings befitting their setting, which should therefore help to promote a strong and inclusive community. Supporting Strategic Policies (such as CS1 and CS15) make commitments to ensure buildings and spaces make a contribution to promoting socially inclusive and sustainable communities, ensuring accessibility is an integral part of urban design, and ensuring urban design delivers a safer and attractive Urban Core. In terms of contribution to health and wellbeing, good place making will involve the provision of well-designed public realm and public spaces, which will include areas for recreation and exercise, which will lead to improved quality of life and health in the area. Overall the policy should have strong positive effects on the social sustainability objectives. Environmental: ✓ The policy is focused on improving environmental conditions of the area by ensuring that excellent design and good place making is implemented throughout the Urban Core. It therefore has a positive contribution to make towards protecting and enhancing environmental assets. This policy is expected to have an overall positive impact. Economic: ✓ Through the delivery of this policy it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across the Urban Core. The creation of an attractive environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. Tourism and shopping will be supported by improvements to the 'gateways' and so business should benefit from this. The policy was therefore assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective.							

Policy UC13: Respecting and Managing Views Within, From and Into Urban Core							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- By maintaining the positive visual experience of the Urban Core, this will help create an enabling environment for the building of lively and cohesive communities. - This policy is likely to have a positive impact on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term by maintaining the positive visual experience of the urban core, and therefore a sense of place and locally distinctiveness, is enhanced.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not focus on issues connected with addressing equality and diversity but it is anticipated that there will be positive effects stemming from the support this policy will give to improving the public realm, improving attractiveness of the area, and therefore encouraging sense of place and a more cohesive community.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect			0	0	0	Although this policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development it does however it is expected to have a neutral impact on this sustainability objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	Community health and wellbeing can be promoted by the retention and enhancement of outdoor space and visual assets. The creation of attractive public realm by respecting and maintaining views is therefore likely to make a positive contribution towards the feeling of community wellbeing, particularly in the longer term as the positive visual experience of the urban core is enhanced.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	A major thrust of this policy is to ensure development does not negative impact on views of heritage assets and other distinctive landmark buildings and structures. This policy will make a positive contribution towards the delivery of this sustainability objective.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy makes no direct contribution to this sustainability objective, however, there is expected to be no negative implications.

Policy UC13: Respecting and Managing Views Within, From and Into Urban Core							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive impact.			✓	✓	✓	This policy does not directly address the Urban Core's contribution to climate change; however, by respecting and protecting views, this is likely to include the protection of green infrastructure and environmental assets. This policy is likely to have a broadly positive impact on this sustainability objective.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address adaptation to climate change and is therefore expected to have a neutral impact on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address living within environmental limits; the impact is expected to be neutral.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy does not specifically address the protection of environmental assets, except that it could be argued that retention of the visual experience (which is likely to include green space) will mitigate against any unnecessary encroachment on environmental assets, and therefore have a broadly positive implication on this sustainability objective.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to broadly have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Through the delivery of this policy – the protection of views - it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be protected across the Urban Core. The creation of an attractive environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. The policy was therefore assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not focus centrally on providing a sustainable employment market but it is anticipated that there will be positive effects stemming from the support this policy will give to improving the public realm, improving attractiveness of the area, and therefore encouraging tourism and visitors and shoppers to the Urban Core.

Policy UC13: Respecting and Managing Views Within, From and Into Urban Core							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ This policy and its supporting text focuses on protecting views within, from and into the Urban Core, maintaining the positive visual experience for residents and visitors to the area. This will help create an enabling environment for the building of lively and cohesive communities and promote a feeling of community wellbeing. The protection of views should promote local distinctiveness and reinforce local characteristics and therefore a sense of place. This policy is expected to have a positive impact on social sustainability objectives. Environmental: 0 to ✓ This policy is assessed as having no negative impacts on living within environmental limits, or adapting to the effects of climate change. It is assessed as having a broadly positive impact on mitigating against climate change, and protecting environmental assets through its commitment to retain the visual environment and its distinct views and vistas – which should include green space, trees, parks and recreational areas. Economic: ✓ Through the delivery of this policy it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across the Urban Core. The creation of an attractive environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. The policy was therefore assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective.							

Policy UC14: Heritage							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy is designed to sustain and enhance the positive, distinctive qualities of the Urban Core, by ensuring that the cultural and visual vibrancy of the Urban Core is maintained and enhanced. Retention and enhancement of cultural and heritage assets, promotes welcoming, locally distinct and attractive areas which in turn promotes quality of life and strong, inclusive communities. - The delivery of this policy should make a positive contribution to this sustainability objective, particularly in the long term as the attractiveness and vibrancy of the urban core is improved.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Through the implementation of this policy – the protection and enhancement of heritage assets - development is likely to enhance local distinctiveness and reinforce local characteristics, and therefore a sense of place. All of these contribute towards promoting diversity and integration of local communities. The policy is therefore likely to have a positive contribution towards this sustainability objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral or slightly positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	Although this policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development it does however seek to promote high quality design and architecture. Implementation of the policy could be seen as therefore making a contribution towards education and skills development in the architectural sector in the region.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The creation of attractive public realm (by sustaining and enhancing heritage assets) and a strong locally distinctive sense of place are likely to make a strong positive contribution towards the feeling of community wellbeing.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	The main focus of this policy is to ensure development within the urban core is sensitive to heritage assets. The policy states that development will ensure heritage assets are sustained and where possible, the restoration and re-use of heritage assets will be integral part of the development scheme. Development will demonstrate an understanding of the importance of heritage assets, ensuring development is sensitive to their context. This policy will therefore have a strong positive impact on this sustainability objective.

Policy UC14: Heritage							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	This policy should have a broadly positive impact on accessibility due to the enhancement of heritage assets as visitor, retail and leisure attractions.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive effect.			?✓	?✓	?✓	The policy does not directly address climate change issues, however it could be argued that promoting the re-use of historic buildings and using high quality design of new buildings should have positive impacts on this sustainability objective.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not focus on issues connected with adapting to the effects of climate change but it is not assessed to have any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address living within environmental limits but it is not assessed as having any likely negative impacts on this SA Objective.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The Policy doesn't specifically address the protection of environmental assets, however it does commit to sustain and enhance the significance of heritage assets and their setting. This could involve promoting the provision of new green infrastructure as well as the retention of existing infrastructure. The policy is likely to have an overall positive impact on this sustainability objective.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- The economic, cultural and visual vibrancy of the Urban Core is underpinned and driven by the historic environment. Heritage assets are vital to the character of the area as visitor attractions, retail and leisure destinations as well as office and business locations. - Through the delivery of this policy it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across the Urban Core. The creation of an attractive environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. The policy was therefore assessed as having a positive effect on this sustainability objective.

Policy UC14: Heritage							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	This policy does not have a primary focus on providing a sustainable employment market, however, since heritage assets are vital to the character of an area, and the historic environment underpins the economic and cultural vibrancy of the Urban Core it is anticipated that there will be positive effects stemming from the support this Policy gives through improvements to the public realm and therefore attractiveness of the area.
Summary							
Social: ✓ The historic environment underpins the visual vibrancy of an area, and is therefore key to promoting welcoming and attractive areas. The creation of an attractive urban environment will promote local distinctiveness, a sense of place and consequently overall community wellbeing. All of these contribute towards promoting strong and inclusive communities. Therefore the policy should have positive effects on the social sustainability objectives.							
Environmental: ✓ This policy and its supporting text commits to the re-use and restoration of historic building, and together with the application of Policies CS15 and CS16 will require developers to have fully considered sustainable design and construction during development. The creation and retention of environmental assets, mitigation measures to ensure developments are able to adapt to the effects of climate change all underpin sustainable design. This policy should therefore ensure positive implications on the environmental objectives.							
Economic: ✓ Through the delivery of this policy it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across the Urban Core. The historic environment is considered to underpin the economic vibrancy of an area, and therefore the creation of an attractive, vibrant environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. The policy is assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective.							

Policy UC15: Urban Green Infrastructure							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The protection and enhancement of green infrastructure and the natural environment of the area will make a positive contribution towards building quality places which in turn will support quality of life and community wellbeing. All of these features serve to strengthen the community. - Urban green infrastructure provides a number of essential ecosystem services (such as flood attenuation, water management and biodiversity protection and enhancement) will help to promote wellbeing and stronger communities. - Overall the policy is regarded as having a positive effect on this sustainability objective with the effect likely to be stronger in the longer term as key measures are delivered.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	This policy is focused on protecting, maintaining and enhancing the integrity and connectivity of the urban green infrastructure network. Although this policy does not directly contribute towards this strategic objective, by addressing gaps in the urban green infrastructure network this will ultimately improve equality of access to green space across Gateshead and Newcastle.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	Educational achievement and skills are not the focus of this policy but it is not anticipated that there will be any negative impact on this sustainability objective.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a major positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The improvement of urban green infrastructure in the area is likely to benefit health and well-being through the enhancement of the urban landscape, the provision of more areas for exercise and the improvement of air quality and general environmental conditions. - It is well documented that public physical and mental health improves in proximity to natural green areas, so the promotion of green spaces and the natural environment can only serve to improve health and wellbeing. The positive effects are likely to build with time.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy is directed toward natural heritage rather than cultural heritage, but there are no anticipated negative impacts on culture, heritage and diversity associated with the implementation of this policy.

Policy UC15: Urban Green Infrastructure							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a neutral to positive effect.			0-✓	0-✓	0-✓	This policy does not have a focus towards addressing accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services but it does commit to creating or improving connections between green spaces and to the wider Strategic Green Infrastructure Network therefore could improve accessibility for walkers and cyclists. There are no anticipated negative effects associated with this policy and there is potential for positive impacts.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have major positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	The policy focuses on the enhancement of the natural environment which will help to reduce contributions to the causes of climate change, especially where the protection or creation of carbon sinks and other climate change mitigation measures are emphasised.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have major positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This policy will have major positive effects toward this sustainability objective because the emphasis is on enhancing and creating green infrastructure that will provide very strong climate change adaptation benefits. - These are based on the ecosystem services provided by green infrastructure that include flood attenuation, water management, heat absorption and acting as a carbon sink.
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	The policy ensures the protection of the natural environment associated with development and therefore will help to ensure that new developments seek to remain within environmental limits.
9. Protect and enhance environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a major positive effect.			✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	The major thrust of this policy is the protection and enhancement of environmental assets and infrastructure therefore the policy makes a major positive contribution towards the delivery of this sustainability objective.

Policy UC15: Urban Green Infrastructure							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- By ensuring a high quality environment with plenty of green spaces and urban green infrastructure this is likely to encourage businesses to locate into the area. This will be particularly relevant to the science and technological based industries that Gateshead and Newcastle is targeting on for future economic growth. - The improvement of the overall local natural environment will complement the historic environment and cultural attractions and should serve to attract more visitors and tourists into the area. This in turn should also have knock-on benefits to the local economy.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0-✓	0-✓	0-✓	The policy is not directly concerned with the employment market of the region but it does commit to creating or improving connections between green spaces, and to the wider Strategic Green Infrastructure Network therefore could improve accessibility for walkers and cyclists to employment areas. There are no negative impacts anticipated from its implementation and potentially positive impacts.
Summary							
Social: ✓ By protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure and natural environment of the region, his is likely to have positive effects on those social objectives. By enhancing the natural environment, addressing gaps and improving linkages, this will improve access to green space, access to space for recreation and leisure, improvements in air quality, all of which will contribute positively towards health and wellbeing, and ultimately strengthen the community. This policy is expected to have positive impact on social sustainability objectives, particularly in the longer term as the measures within the policy start to deliver results. Environmental: ✓✓ The main focus of the policy is on enhancing the natural environment of the area and where possible increasing the amount of green space and green infrastructure. Green infrastructure provides a number of essential ecosystem services (such as flood attenuation, water management and biodiversity protection and enhancement) which will contribute positively towards mitigating our impact on climate change and adapting to its effects. Protection and enhancement of the green infrastructure has strong positive contributions towards environmental sustainability objectives. Economic: 0 to ✓ The broad emphasis of this policy is not economic, but by enhancing the environmental conditions of the region and making the natural environment more attractive for residents, workers and visitors there are likely to be indirect positive effects on the local economy in terms of encouraging businesses to locate and people to visit the Urban Core.							

Policy UC16: Public Realm							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a major positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The policy, which is designed to improve the network of linked open spaces and the routes that connect them, should by definition make a positive contribution towards community cohesion and participation. Improved networks of open space should encourage increased outdoor activity and interaction between people and therefore promote strong inclusive communities. - This policy should have strong positive implications on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- Improvement of the open space network should improve accessibility and therefore equality of opportunity across Gateshead and Newcastle. - The main thrust of equality, diversity and integration objectives should be supported through the delivery of this policy.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a neutral or slightly positive effect.			0/✓	0/✓	0/✓	Although this policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development it does however seek to promote the use of open space (as a way of enhancing local distinctiveness, promoting the use of open space for temporary events, and promoting the increased use of the public realm). Increased activity and use of open space for day-to-day activities, and possibly learning and cultural events should encourage opportunities for interaction and learning.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	The creation of attractive public realm should make a strong positive contribution towards social interaction, a healthy and active lifestyle and the overall feeling of community wellbeing. Improvements to the public realm should involve the provision of green infrastructure and green spaces that will provide areas for recreation and exercise (walking and cycling) both of which will lead to improved quality of life and health in the area.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	A major thrust of this policy is to create a strong locally distinctive sense of place, via the protection and enhancement of open space and the creation of an enhanced public realm. This policy is likely to make a positive contribution towards the delivery of this sustainability objective.

Policy UC16: Public Realm							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a major positive impact.			✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy does not directly address accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services. However, improved network of open space and routes that connect them should improve accessibility and movement within Gateshead and Newcastle. The enhancement of open space should promote an environment which is both safe and enjoyable for walking and cycling the Urban Core. - The policy is likely to have a positive impact on accessibility, particularly in the longer term as the network of open space and routes are improved.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	The policy states the materials and streetscape products proposed for public open spaces and routes should be sustainably sourced, durable and be easily maintained. All of which contribute to sustainable design and positive impact on reducing our contribution to the causes of climate change.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Future maintenance is an essential consideration to the enhancement and development of the public realm. Sustainability in long term maintenance should include mitigation measures against effects of climate change (for example, risk of flooding). - The enhancement of the public realm will also include the retention of green space and provide opportunity to enhance green infrastructure network. Ecosystem services provided by green infrastructure include flood attenuation, water management, heat absorption and acting as a carbon sink. All contributing positively towards mitigating and adapting to the effects of climate change.
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The policy states the materials and streetscape products proposed for public open spaces and routes should be sustainably sourced, durable and be easily maintained. - The policy will therefore have positive implication for the wise use of resources and hence living within environmental limits, particularly in the longer term as the policy delivers its goal.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- The enhancement of the public realm will also include the retention of green space and provide opportunity to enhance the green infrastructure network. - This policy will therefore have a major positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term.

Policy UC16: Public Realm							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to broadly have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Through the development and enhancement of the public realm locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across Gateshead and Newcastle. The creation of an attractive sustainable environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy. The policy was therefore assessed as having a broadly positive effect on this sustainability objective.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The central focus of this policy is not to provide a sustainable employment market but it is anticipated that there will not be any negative implications on this sustainability objective.
Summary							
Social: ✓✓ The policy is designed to improve he network of linked open spaces and routes that connect them, which should in turn encourage increased outdoor activity and therefore social interaction. The improvement of the open space network and public realm should improve accessibility, enjoyment of the outdoors, opportunity for interaction, learning, recreation and exercise, which all contributes positively towards improved quality of life and community cohesion. This policy has strong positive implications on the social sustainability objectives.							
Environmental: ✓✓ The policy is focused on improving the public realm "using materials and streetscape products that are sustainably sourced, durable and easily maintained". By enhancing the public realm, and promoting longevity of routes and spaces, and the sustainable maintenance and sourcing of materials, this policy will have strong positive implications on the environmental sustainability objectives.							
Economic: 0 to ✓ Through the development and enhancement of the public realm locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across Gateshead and Newcastle. The creation of an attractive sustainable environment is likely to encourage more people to come and work, live in or visit the area thus helping to boost the local economy.							

Policy UC17: Public Art							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Public art is considered to contribute to a strong sense of place, adding value and bringing distinctiveness to an area, boosting a place's identity, civic pride and inward investment. Therefore contributing positively towards sense of community. - If public art is used to promote collaboration of individuals and organisations and help to engage stakeholders in consultation exercise, this policy will have strong positive impact on this sustainability objective, particularly in the long term as goals are delivered.
2. Ensure that equality , diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- This policy makes no direct contribution to the Councils equality and diversity obligations. However, where the supporting text comments on the use of public art as a tool for community engagement and collaboration projects, there is increased opportunity for integration and participation and therefore equality of opportunity. - The policy is likely to have a broadly positive impact on this sustainability objective.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Although this policy does not directly address educational achievement and skills development it does however have the potential to improve the learning experience of the public realm, promoting the engagement of the public in culture and art. This policy is likely to have a broadly positive impact.
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	The main focus of this policy is using art to promote a sense of place and local distinctiveness within a community. Encouraging the use of the outdoor public realm for art is likely to increase opportunity for social engagement and increased public activity. All of which is likely to promote a healthy and active lifestyle, a sense of community and feeling of overall wellbeing.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	Likely to have a strong positive effect.			✓	✓✓	✓✓	A major thrust of this policy is to promote the use of art to enhance a sense of place and local distinctiveness within communities. This will enhance the engagement of the public in the cultural and historic environment, therefore having a positive impact on this sustainability objective.

Policy UC17: Public Art							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a broadly positive impact			✓	✓	✓	- The policy makes no direct contribution to this sustainability objective, however, the use of public art to promote collaboration of organisations (i.e. those providing facilities and services) and to help engage stakeholders in consultation exercises through the use of creative consultation exercises is likely to increase the likelihood that the needs of communities and target groups are realised and met. - Using art to meet needs and increase public participation is likely to, in the longer term, increase accessibility to public facilities and services. - There is expected to be a broadly positive impact on this sustainability objective.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a neutral impact.	Likely to be positive if the development of public art utilises sustainably sources materials and energy sources.	Likely to be positive if sustainability of resources is taken into account.	0	0	0	This policy does not directly address the Urban Core's contribution to climate change and is therefore expected to have a neutral impact on climate change, however, if the promotion of public art utilises sustainably sources materials and energy sources, there is likely to be a positive impact on this sustainability objective.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address adaptation to climate change and is therefore expected to have a neutral impact on this sustainability objective.
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	This policy does not directly address living within environmental limits; the impact is expected to be neutral.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Likely to have a neutral effect.			0	0	0	The policy does not specifically address the protection of environmental assets and is therefore expected to have a neutral impact on this sustainability objective.

Policy UC17: Public Art							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	- Through the delivery of this policy public art should add value and bringing distinctiveness to an area, boosting a place's identity, civic pride and inward investment. Investment in and enhancement of art and the creative sector is likely to boost the local economy. - The use of art to enhance the public realm is likely to promote an attractive environment for investment and business tourism.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a neutral effect.			✓	✓	✓	This policy does not focus centrally on providing a sustainable employment market but it is anticipated that there will be positive effects stemming from the support this Policy will give to improving the public realm, improving attractiveness of the area, and therefore encouraging tourism and visitors and shoppers to the Urban Core.
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓ Public art is considered to contribute to a strong sense of place, adding value and bringing distinctiveness to an area, boosting a place's identity, civic pride and inward investment. The use of public art as a tool for community engagement and collaboration projects, promotes opportunity for integration and participation. Encouraging the use of the outdoor public realm for art is likely to increase opportunity for social engagement and increased public activity. All of which is likely to promote a healthy and active lifestyle, a sense of community and feeling of overall wellbeing. This policy is expected to have a positive impact on social sustainability objectives.							
Environmental: 0 to ✓ This policy is assessed as having no negative impacts on living within environmental limits, or adapting to the effects of climate change. It is assessed as having a broadly positive impact on mitigating against climate change if the development of public art utilises sustainably sources materials and energy sources. The policy is assessed as having a neutral to broadly positive impact on environmental SA Objectives.							
Economic: ✓ Through the delivery of this policy it is likely that locally distinct, high quality and interactive places will be created across the Urban Core. The use of public art should add value and bring distinctiveness to an area, boosting a place's identity, and civic pride. The use of art to enhance the public realm is likely to promote an attractive environment for investment and business tourism. Investment in and enhancement of art and the creative sector is likely to boost the local economy.							

C3: Appraisal of the Sub-Area Overarching Policies

Policy NC1: Newcastle Central Sub-Area

Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative

Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a positive effect.	This effect will be strengthened by the simultaneous application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth), CS15 (Place Making) and UC12 (Urban Design)	With the application of CS1, CS15 and UC12 a strong positive effect.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The Policy's focus on significant regeneration and refurbishment of older historic parts of the city together with substantial improvements to the public realm should result in a more attractive and safer urban environment, instil pride in people's surroundings and create a better sense of community identity for residents. This will all support the promotion of strong inclusive communities particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered. - The effects of the above should be strengthened when coupled with Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) and its clauses on inclusive design, CS7 (Retail and Centres), CS9 (Existing Communities), CS15 (Place Making) and UC12 (Urban Design).
2. Ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a neutral or broadly positive effect.	This effect will be strengthened by the simultaneous application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) and its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11, CS15 (Place Making) and UC12 (Urban Design)	With the application of CS1, CS15 and UC12 a strong positive effect.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	This policy builds on the success of previous heritage-led regeneration schemes which have had a positive impact on communities. Clause 2 sets out broad measures for improving the environment and accessibility particularly with regard to the public realm and pedestrian space and Clause 4 the refurbishment of the Central Gateway through high quality urban design. With the simultaneous application of Strategic Policy CS1 and its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11, and other relevant Strategic Policies this will ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in future development taking place in the Newcastle Central Sub-Area, particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓	Although not addressing educational achievement and skills levels directly the Sub-Area Strategy should provide appropriate development opportunities that will enhance the range of jobs available, via development of key employment areas, encouraging the development of a skilled workforce and overcome some of the barriers that prevent people from getting to work (e.g. accessibility and travel choices).
4. Improve health and wellbeing and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.	This effect will be strengthened by the simultaneous application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth), CS15	With the application of the suggested Strategic Policies the Spatial Strategy Policy should have a strong	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Improving the environment and accessibility, upgrading the public realm and extensive refurbishments of key zones in this Sub-Area will improve and encourage active lifestyles (walking and cycling) and contribute to this sustainability objective. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS14 and CS18 will promote more public participation in addressing health needs and inequalities, and access to open space and recreation facilities through spatial planning.

Policy NC1: Newcastle Central Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		(Place Making) and CS1 (Wellbeing and Health). This will make sure that development in the Central Area will make a positive contribution to improving wellbeing and reducing health inequalities.	positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term.				
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	In isolation this policy could be seen as uncertain to generate positive or negative effects on culture, diversity and heritage depending on the way new development is delivered.	Delivery of the commitments in Chapter 12: People and Place, and the policies therein will ensure that Policy NC1 is able to support this sustainability objective and the principles of promoting, enhancing and respecting culture, heritage and diversity.	With the simultaneous application of Policy CS15 and commitments made in Chapter 12 there will be a strong positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This policy makes dedicated commitments to build on previous successful heritage-led urban regeneration work and, when combined with supporting policies CS1 and CS15 and details in Chapter 12, should result in improvements to cultural assets in the area. - Examples of specific initiatives within the policy itself include: - o heritage-led education and interpretation centre at Black Gate and Castle Keep; - o improving signage and interpretation of cultural assets in the area; and - o regeneration at Grainger Town that will respect the historic buildings. - Overall, therefore the policy should have positive effects on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term as the measures are delivered.
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a major positive effect, particularly in the longer term as the policy starts to deliver results.	Delivery of Policy CS13 Transport will further strengthen the accessibility statements in Policy NC1.	With the simultaneous application of Policy CS13 there will be a strong positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The main focus of this policy is to ensure improved connectivity to services, facilities, open space and recreation facilities. Car dependency should be reduced by improving cycle routes, bus routes and creating a more pedestrian friendly environment. - Consequently this policy directly addresses this sustainability objective.

Policy NC1: Newcastle Central Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✗ overall impact likely to be negative, ✗✗ major negative, ✓✗ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✗ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS16 Climate Change will further strengthen the effect of this Policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.	With the simultaneous application of Policies CS7, CS13 and UC12 there will be a strong positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- This policy does not directly address energy efficiency, renewable energy or emissions reductions. - However, it does focus on reducing car dependency and encouraging cycling and walking (via improvements to public transport, cycle routes and the walking environment). Indirectly this would all contribute to reducing emissions from traffic. - While the improvements to retail frontages may bring increased energy use, Policies CS7: Retail and Centres, CS16: Climate Change and UC12: Urban Design should mitigate any negative effects and ensure the policy is implemented in a sustainable way.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS16 Climate Change, CS17 Flood Risk and Water Management and CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will further strengthen the effect of this policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- Measures within this policy directly contribute to enhancing the Urban Green Infrastructure in the area by focusing on undertaking improvements of public open spaces at the Bigg Market. - Flooding has not been identified as an issue in this area, however the use of green roofs should be considered in regeneration efforts at Grainger Town and Primary and Secondary Retail areas. - The simultaneous application of Policies CS16 Climate Change, CS17 Flood Risk and Water Management and CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will further strengthen the effect of this policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS9 Existing Communities, CS13 Transport, CS15 Place Making, CS16 Climate Change	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- If the supporting policies CS9, CS13, CS15, CS16 and CS21, and guidance on UC15: Urban Design, are adhered to policy NC1 should make a positive contribution to fulfilling all aspects of this sustainability objective. - An increase in population would occur as areas like Grainger Town are regenerated; however, supporting policies should mitigate most negative environmental impacts of such a change. Albeit increased energy usage and goods consumption is inevitable.

Policy NC1: Newcastle Central Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		and CS21 Waste will further strengthen the effect of this policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.					
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Should be positive overall.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will ensure that there is no risk of any negative effects on environmental assets and green infrastructure.	With the mitigation the Policy is likely to be supportive of this objective.	✓	✓	✓	- Upgrades to the public realm and enhancement of the Urban Green Infrastructure Network at Bigg Market directly contribute to this sustainability objective. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will ensure that there is no risk of any negative effects on environmental assets and green infrastructure.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application and delivery of Policies CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) and Policy CS9 Existing Communities should serve to strengthen the effect in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Targeted protection and improvements to the retail frontages, public realm and residential assets in this area will help consolidate and develop the local economy. - Enhancements to the leisure and tourism markets, especially the development of the cultural centre at Black Gate and Castle Keep, also contribute to this objective. - Ultimately, these changes to the Central Sub-Area should help raise its national and international profile.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application and delivery of Policies CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Enhancing Gateways and arrival points around Central Station should help improve access to job opportunities – both within the sub-area, due to improvements to its retail frontages, and further afield. - Improvements to cultural and heritage venues will also add to the pool of potential (temporary) tourism jobs. - The continuing regeneration of Grainger Town should lead to a greater need for

Policy NC1: Newcastle Central Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		policies) and Policy CS2 Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core should serve to strengthen the effect in the longer term.					services and facilities as the population increases, potentially increasing more permanent job opportunities in the sub-area.
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓ The focus of this policy is to improve accessibility to shopping areas and enhancing the public realm in order to create more vibrant integrated communities and ensure continued success of the Central Sub-Area. The Policy's focus on significant improvements to the public realm should result in a safer urban environment, instil pride in people's surroundings and create a better sense of community identity for residents (notably a new heritage centre at Black Gate). This in turn should result in reducing crime and maintain and improve the area's cultural and diverse assets.							
Environmental: ✓ to ✓✓ By focusing development on previously developed land in the targeted regeneration areas there is less likelihood of generating adverse impacts on the natural environment. Furthermore, enhancing the Urban Green Infrastructure Network and improving accessibility throughout the sub-area also safeguards the environment. Along with the simultaneous application of Policies CS16: Climate Change, CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management, CS15: Place Making, CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment and UC15: Urban Design this will ensure broadly positive implications for the environmental and cultural heritage assets of the area.							
Economic: ✓✓ With its aim to stimulate the economy through making provision for substantial development in increasingly sustainable and accessible locations, this policy is likely to have strong positive effects on the economic objectives. Through the development of the urban core for major development including office, retail, commercial leisure, culture and tourism and supporting expansion and improvement of existing employment areas the policy will have strongly positive implications for providing new jobs and thus boosting the economy of the region.							

Policy C1: Civic Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	This effect can be strengthened by highlighting the link to Clause 8 of policy CS1: that new development will be designed to be fully inclusive and promote a strong sense of community cohesion and wellbeing.	With the addition of the clause in Policy CS1:8, and with the application of Policy CS15, the Sub-Area Policy should have a major positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The Policy's focus on substantial improvements to the public realm and improved pedestrian and cycling accessibility should result in a safer urban environment, instil pride in people's surroundings and create a better sense of community identity for residents. This in turn should result in reducing crime. - Improving gateways and entry points will help create a clear sense of place and neighbourhood. - The effects of the above should be strengthened when coupled with Policies CS7: Retail and Centres, CS9: Existing Communities, CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment.
2. Ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	This effect will be strengthened by the simultaneous application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) and its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11, CS15 (Place Making) and UC12 (Urban Design)	With the simultaneous application of the recommended policies the effect is likely to be strengthened and made more positive.	✓	✓	✓✓	Although there is little mention of equality of opportunity, community diversity, elimination of discrimination and good community relations in both the main and supporting text to this policy the application of clause 8 of Policy CS1 together with the principles outline in Paragraph 5.11 should ensure that this sustainability objective is met.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy (C1:1) supports the expansion of the Universities and RVI Hospital and their ancillary developments (e.g. improved accommodation). - Space will be provided for facilities operating on stem cell research, ageing sciences, energy and environment and engineering technology. - Newcastle was named one of six Science Cities in 2005 – regional development projects, based upon university, industry and government collaborations that creatively bring together local and natural resources to achieve science based economic growth. - Overall the above proposals directly contribute to this sustainability objective.
4. Improve health and wellbeing and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a positive effect.	This effect can be strengthened by highlighting Clause 8 of Policy CS1:	With the application of Paragraph 5.11, and with the	✓	✓	✓✓	Extensive refurbishments of key infrastructure zones in this Sub-Area (C1:2 and C1:3) will improve and encourage active lifestyles (walking and cycling) and contribute to this sustainability objective.

Policy C1: Civic Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		that new development will be designed to be socially inclusive and focus on equality and accessibility through the application of Paragraph 5.11 (Equality and Diversity agenda). In addition to this the simultaneous application of Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will play a key role here ensuring that spatial planning will make a positive contribution to reducing health inequalities.	application of Polices CS14 and CS18, this Sub-Area Policy should have a strong positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term.				- The simultaneous application of Policy CS14 and CS18 will promote more public participation in addressing health needs and inequalities, and access to open space and recreation facilities through spatial planning. - Application of Policy CS1:8 will help to strengthen the positive effect of the policy, particularly on delivering the longer term benefits of socially inclusive design.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	In isolation this policy could be seen as uncertain to generate positive or negative effects on culture, diversity and heritage depending on the way new development is delivered.	Delivery of the commitments in Chapter 12: People and Place, and the policies therein, in particular CS15 (Place Making) will ensure that Policy C1 is able to support this sustainability	With the simultaneous application of commitments made in Chapter 12 and in particular Policy CS15 there will be a strong positive effect particularly in the	✓	✓	✓✓	Reference to heritage and cultural assets does not feature specifically in this policy , however when combined with supporting Strategic Policies CS1 and CS15 and details in Chapter 12, this should result in retention of and improvements to heritage and cultural resources in the area, particularly in the longer term as the policy goals are delivered.

Policy C1: Civic Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		objective and the principles of promoting, enhancing and respecting culture, heritage and diversity.	longer term.				
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a major positive effect, particularly in the longer term as the policy starts to deliver results.	Delivery of Policy CS13 Transport will further strengthen the accessibility statements in Policy C1.	With the simultaneous application of Policy CS13 there will be a strong positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The main focus of this policy is to ensure improved connectivity to adjoining neighbourhoods and enhancing gateways to the area, services, facilities, open space and recreation facilities. Car dependency should be reduced by improving cycle routes, bus routes and creating a more pedestrian friendly environment. - Consequently this policy should have positive effects on this sustainability objective.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS16 Climate Change will further strengthen the effect of this Policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.	With the simultaneous application of Policies CS7, CS13, CS16 and UC12 there will be a strong positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy does not directly address energy efficiency, renewable energy or emissions reductions. - However, it does focus on reducing car dependency and encouraging cycling and walking (via managing traffic and making improvements to public transport, cycle routes and the walking environment). Indirectly this would all contribute to reducing emissions from traffic. - While the provision of additional accommodation, research and office facilities will inevitably bring increased energy use, Policies CS7: Retail and Centres, CS16: Climate Change and UC12: Urban Design should mitigate most negative effects and ensure the policy is implemented in a sustainable way.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS16 Climate Change, CS17 Flood Risk and Water Management and CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will further strengthen	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy directly contributes to enhancing the Urban Green Infrastructure in the area by focusing on undertaking improvements of public open spaces at: - o Strawberry Place; - o St James Metro; - o Percy Street West; and - o Kings Manor Business Park. - Flooding is not an issue in this area. However, through supporting policies (CS16 and 17), the use of green roofs and facilitating local energy production (a district heating scheme) (C2:1iii)) is considered in the regeneration efforts for this Sub-Area. - Overall there should be positive support to this sustainability objective.

Policy C1: Civic Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		the effect of this policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.					
8. Live within environmental limits , both locally and globally	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS9 Existing Communities, CS13 Transport, CS15 Place Making, CS16 Climate Change and CS21 Waste will further strengthen the effect of this policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- If the supporting policies CS9, CS13, CS15, CS16 and CS21, and guidance on UC15: Urban Design, are adhered to Policy C1 should make a significant contribution to fulfilling all aspects of this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term. - An increase in population would occur as the area is regenerated and improved accommodation is built; however, supporting policies should mitigate most negative environmental impacts of such a change. Albeit increased energy and goods consumption is inevitable.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Should be positive overall.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will ensure that there is no risk of any negative effects on environmental assets and green infrastructure.	With the mitigation the Policy is likely to be supportive of this objective.	✓	✓	✓	- Upgrades to the public realm and network of public open spaces and enhancement of the Urban Green Infrastructure Network at: - o Strawberry Place; - o St James Metro; - o Percy Street West; and - o Kings Manor Business Park. - These measures would make a positive contribution to this sustainability objective.
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application and delivery of Policies	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	Targeted protection and improvements to the science-based, public realm, transport and residential assets in this area will help consolidate and develop the local economy.

Policy C1: Civic Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) and Policy CS9 Existing Communities should serve to strengthen the effect in the longer term.					- Enhancements to the science and education sectors in this sub-area, especially supported by C2 Science Central's Accelerated Development Zone status, should result in improving opportunities for new and existing businesses. - Ultimately, these changes to the Civic Sub-Area should help raise its national and international profile.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application and delivery of Policies CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) and Policy CS2 Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core should serve to strengthen the effect in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Enhancing gateways and arrival points at Barras Bridge and Percy Street should help improve access to job opportunities – both within the sub-area and further afield. - The promotion of research and development industries in the sub-area will provide a major commercial opportunity and help achieve science based economic growth. - The continuing regeneration of the sub-area should lead to a greater need for services and facilities as the population increases, potentially increasing permanent job opportunities in the sub-area.

Policy C1: Civic Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓ The focus of this policy is to improve connectivity through this sub-area, which enables better access to shopping areas, while enhancing the public realm in order to create more vibrant integrated communities and ensure continued success of the Civic Sub-Area and its adjoining neighbourhoods. The Policy's focus on vast improvements of the public realm should result in a safer urban environment, instil pride in people's surroundings and create a better sense of community identity for residents (notably the improved accommodation and expansion of the Universities and RVI Hospital). This in turn should result in reducing crime and maintain and improve the area's cultural assets. Environmental: ✓ to ✓✓ By focusing development on previously developed land in the targeted regeneration areas there is less likelihood of generating adverse impacts on the natural environment. Furthermore, enhancing the Urban Green Infrastructure Network (with the prospect of creating more public open spaces) and improving accessibility throughout the sub-area also safeguards the environment. Planned local energy production with a district heating scheme at Science Central (Policy C2:1iii) further contributes to mitigating the effects of climate change. Along with the simultaneous application of Policies CS16: Climate Change, CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management, CS15: Place Making, CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment and UC15: Urban Design this will ensure broadly positive implications for the environmental and cultural heritage assets of the area. Economic: ✓✓ With its aim to stimulate the economy through science based growth in increasingly sustainable and accessible locations, this policy is likely to have strong positive effects on the economic objectives. Through the expansion of the Universities' and RVI Hospital, including offices and research laboratories, and the support of Science Central through the Accelerated Development Zone initiative, the policy will have strongly positive implications for providing new jobs and thus boosting the economy of the region.							

Policy D1: Discovery Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Social							
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	This effect can be strengthened by highlighting the link to Clause 8 of policy CS1: that new development will be designed to be fully inclusive and promote a strong sense of community cohesion and wellbeing.	With the addition of the clause in Policy CS1:8, and with the application of Policy CS15, the Sub-Area Policy should have a major positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- The Policy's focus on improvements to the public realm (D1:2 and D1:3) should result in a more accessible urban environment, instil pride in people's surroundings and create a better sense of community identity for residents. - The policy encourages mixed tenure in this area including offices, leisure and residential supported by a range of other activities. - The positive effects of the policy can be strengthened when coupled with Policies CS7: Retail and Centres, CS9: Existing Communities, CS15: Place Making and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment.
2. Ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future development	Likely to have broadly positive effect.	This effect will be strengthened by the simultaneous application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) and its supporting text at Paragraph 5.11, CS15 (Place Making) and UC12 (Urban Design)	With the application of the recommended policies the effect is likely to be strengthened and made more positive.	✓	✓	✓✓	Although there is little mention of equality of opportunity, community diversity, elimination of discrimination and good community relations in both the main and supporting text to this policy the application of clause 8 of Policy CS1 together with the principles outline in Paragraph 5.11 should ensure that this sustainability objective is met.
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.			✓	✓	✓✓	- This Sub-Area policy supports the expansion and continued redevelopment of Newcastle College Campus to meet their needs for new and improved accommodation (D1:1) and improved links to the surrounding area (Supporting Text 16.50). - Overall the above proposals directly contribute to this sustainability objective.
4. Improve health and wellbeing and reduce inequalities in health	Likely to have a broadly positive effect.	This effect can be strengthened by highlighting Clause 8 of Policy CS1: that new development will be designed to be	With the application of Polices CS1, CS14 and CS18, the Sub-Area Policy should have a strong	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Extensive refurbishments of key infrastructure zones in this Sub-Area (D1:2 and D1:3) will improve and encourage active lifestyles (walking and cycling) and contribute to this sustainability objective. - Application of Policy CS1:8 will help to strengthen the positive effect of the policy, particularly on delivering the longer term benefits of socially inclusive design. - The simultaneous application of Policy CS14 and CS18 will promote more

Policy D1: Discovery Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
		socially inclusive and well designed to promote community cohesion and wellbeing. In addition to this the simultaneous application of Policy CS14: Wellbeing and Health and CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will play a key role here ensuring that spatial planning will make a positive contribution to reducing health inequalities.	positive effect on this sustainability objective particularly in the longer term.				public participation (through walking and cycling activity, etc) that will help to address health needs, and also promote access to open space and recreation facilities.
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity	In isolation this policy could be seen as uncertain as to whether it will generate positive or negative effects on culture, diversity and heritage since this will depend on the way new development is delivered.	Delivery of the commitments in Chapter 12: People and Place, and the policies therein (especially CS15) will ensure that Policy D1 is able to support this sustainability objective and the principles of promoting, enhancing and respecting culture, heritage and diversity.	With the simultaneous application of Policy CS15 and commitments made in Chapter 12 there will be a strong positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	The policy outlines the heritage and cultural assets in the area, when combined with supporting policies CS1 and CS15 and details in Chapter 12, should result in retention of and improvements to the resources in the area.

Policy D1: Discovery Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services	Likely to have a major positive effect, particularly in the longer term as the policy starts to deliver results.	Delivery of Policy CS13 Transport will further strengthen the accessibility statements in Policy D1.	With the simultaneous application of Policy CS13 there will be a strong positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓✓	✓✓	✓✓	- The main focus of this policy is to ensure improved connectivity and accessibility to services, facilities, open space and recreation facilities. Car dependency should be reduced by improving cycle routes, transport access and creating a more pedestrian friendly environment. - Consequently this policy directly addresses this sustainability objective.
Environmental							
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS16 Climate Change will further strengthen the effect of this Policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.	With the simultaneous application of Policies CS13 and UC12 there will be a strong positive effect particularly in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy does not directly address energy efficiency, renewable energy or emissions reductions. However, it does focus on reducing car dependency and encouraging cycling and walking (via improvements to public transport, cycle routes and the walking environment). Indirectly this would all contribute to reducing emissions from traffic. - While the improvements to retail frontages may bring increased energy use CS16: Climate Change and UC12: Urban Design should mitigate any negative effects and ensure the policy is implemented in a sustainable way.
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS16 Climate Change, CS17 Flood Risk and Water Management and CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will further strengthen the effect of this policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- This policy directly contributes to enhancing the Urban Green Infrastructure in the area by focusing on undertaking improvements of public open spaces at Blandford Square and George Street Triangle. - Flooding has not been identified as an issue in this area, however good practice on surface water control and flood mitigation plans is outlined in the supporting policies.

Policy D1: Discovery Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application of Policies CS9 Existing Communities, CS13 Transport, CS15 Place Making, CS16 Climate Change and CS21 Waste will further strengthen the effect of this policy and ensure that a stronger positive contribution is made in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓	✓✓	- If the supporting policies CS9, CS13, CS15, CS16 and CS21, and guidance on UC15: Urban Design, are adhered to policy D1 should make a significant contribution to fulfilling all aspects of this sustainability objective. - An increase in population would occur as sites are regenerated; however, supporting policies should mitigate most negative environmental impacts of such a change. Albeit increased energy usage and goods consumption is inevitable.
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure	Should be positive overall.	The simultaneous application of Policy CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment will ensure that there is no risk of any negative effects on environmental assets and green infrastructure.	With the mitigation the Policy is likely to be supportive of this objective.	✓	✓	✓	Upgrades to the public realm and enhancement of the Urban Green Infrastructure Network at Blandford Square and George Street Triangle directly contribute to this sustainability objective.

Policy D1: Discovery Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, ✖ overall impact likely to be negative, ✖✖ major negative, ✓✖ range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? ✖ uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Economic							
10. Strengthen our economy	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application and delivery of Policies CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) and Policy CS9 Existing Communities should serve to strengthen the effect in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Enhancements to the science and education sectors in this sub-area, especially supported by D2 Stephenson Quarter's Accelerated Development Zone status, should result in improving opportunities for new and existing businesses. - Ultimately, these changes to the Discovery Sub-Area should help raise its national and international profile. - Targeted protection and improvements to transport access and public realm assets in D1 and adjoining areas will help consolidate and develop the local economy.
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	Likely to have a positive effect.	The simultaneous application and delivery of Policies CS5 to CS6 (employment and economic growth policies) and Policy CS2 Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core should serve to strengthen the effect in the longer term.	Major positive in the longer term.	✓	✓✓	✓✓	- Regenerating the areas as a major gateway and arrival point should help improve access to job opportunities – both within the sub-area, due to improvements to riverside office capacity, and further afield. - The continuing regeneration of the sub-area should lead to a greater need for services and facilities as the population increases, potentially increasing permanent job opportunities in the sub-area.

Policy D1: Discovery Sub-Area							
Scale: ✓ overall impact likely to be positive, ✓✓ major positive, 0 neutral or no discernible effect, * overall impact likely to be negative, ** major negative, ✓* range of positive and negative effects, ? uncertain effect, ? ✓ uncertain possible positive, ? * uncertain possible negative							
Sustainability Objective	Potential Impacts	Mitigation	Nature of Residual Effect	Assessment of Residual Effect			Comments
				Short term	Med term	Long term	
Summary							
Social: ✓ to ✓✓ The focus of this policy is to improve accessibility through the area and enhancing the public realm in order to create more vibrant integrated communities and ensure continued success of the Discovery Sub-Area. The Policy's focus on improvements of the public realm should result in a more accessible urban environment, instil pride in people's surroundings and create a better sense of community identity for residents (notably a new heritage centre at Black Gate). This in turn should result in reducing crime and maintain & improve the area's cultural assets. Environmental: ✓ to ✓✓ By focusing development on previously developed land in the targeted regeneration areas there is less likelihood of generating adverse impacts on the natural environment. Furthermore, enhancing the Urban Green Infrastructure Network and improving accessibility throughout the sub-area also safeguards the environment. Along with the simultaneous application of Policies CS16: Climate Change, CS17: Flood Risk and Water Management, CS15: Place Making, CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment and UC15: Urban Design this will ensure broadly positive implications for the environmental and cultural heritage assets of the area. Economic: ✓✓ With its aim to stimulate the economy by providing riverside office development in increasingly sustainable and accessible locations, this policy is likely to have strong positive effects on the economic objectives. Through the expansion of Newcastle College, including accommodation, and the support of Stephenson Quarter through the Accelerated Development Zone initiative, the policy will have strongly positive implications for providing new jobs and thus boosting the economy of the region.							

C4A: Appraisal of The Sub-Areas and Sites Policies: Neighbourhood Growth Areas

Housing Site	SA Objectives ¹ Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NN1a Lower Callerton	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses NN1:4 and 7 and CS13 Transport. The site does appear to have good walking and cycle routes including a link to the Tyneside Cycling network. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas (good road access, buses every 10 minutes). There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile and the area is well serviced by schools, furthermore clauses NN1:2 and 3 commit to further provision of schools and improved access to local services including healthcare. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health.													
Environmental: ✓ The development of this agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Additionally, clauses NN1:15 and 16 overarching Policy CS17 Flood Risk and Water Management addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Policy NN1:9 commits to protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. The site lies in close proximity to Hadrian's Wall UNESCO World Heritage Site; however, any cultural and heritage features should be enhanced as per Policy CS15 Place Making and clause NN1:10 commits to carrying out any necessary archaeological assessments.													
Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a well-connected position, but away from the Urban Core's main centres of commerce and employment. However, Newcastle International Airport is nearby and due to be expanded as per Policy KEA1. Although the site has road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead as well as the Key Employment Areas at the Airport and Dunston via the A69, there is no access to a rail or metro link. Nonetheless, the site does appear to have good walking and cycle routes including a link to the Tyneside Cycling network as well as bus services. Additionally, Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local transport services.													
Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially Newcastle International Airport which is due to be expanded						NN1:2, 3, 4 and 7; CS13, CS14, KEA1						
Environmental	No outstanding environmental concerns out with Policy coverage						NN1:9, 10, 15 and 16; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Improved access (public transport provision) to additional employment areas may make this site more appealing						CS13, KEA1						

¹Some elements of the SA objective questions may be influenced by overarching Strategic or Urban Core Policies set out in "Planning for the Future: CSUCP for Newcastle and Gateshead Submission Document", this will be indicated in the assessment summary below.

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NN1b Middle Callerton	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses NN1A:4 and 7 and CS13. The site does appear to have good walking and cycle routes including a link to the Tyneside Cycling network. There is variable public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas (good road access, bus service between every 15mins to 2 hours). There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile and good school provision. Policy clauses NN1A:2 and 3 commit to further provision of schools and improved access to local services including healthcare. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The development of this Greenfield site could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19. The northwestern extreme of the site immediately adjacent to the Ouseburn is identified to be within Flood Zone 3b of the SFRA; however clauses NN1:15 and 16 and Policy CS17 outline SUDS and flood protection measures. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which covers these issues. Policy NN1:9 commits to protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a relatively isolated position, away from the Urban Core's main centres of commerce and employment, although it does have road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead as well as the Key Employment Areas at the Airport and Dunston via the B6324 leading to the A1 or the A69, there is no access to a rail or metro link. However, the site does appear to have good walking and cycle routes including a link to national cycle network Tyneside Cycling Network as well as bus services. Policy CS13 should also contribute to improving local transport services. Additionally, Policy CS13 Transport should contribute to improving local transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is relatively isolated from jobs and facilities in the immediate area – bus service improvements to come as per Policy CS13						NN1:2, 3, 4 and 7; CS13, CS14, KEA1						
Environmental	North western end of the site identified to be at risk of flooding, however policies sufficiently cover mitigation measures						NN1:9, 15 and 16; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Bus service of variable reliability depending on route – to be improved as per Policy CS13						CS13, KEA1						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NN1c Upper Callerton	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses NN1A:4 and 7 and CS13. The site does appear to have good walking and cycle routes including a link to the Tyneside Cycling network. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas (good road access, buses every 15-30 minutes, 15-20 minutes from Bank Foot Metro station). There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile and good school provision. Policy clauses NN1A:2 and 3 commit to further provision of schools and improved access to local services including healthcare. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The development of this agricultural land (Greenfield site) following reclamation from open-cast mining could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site through hedgerow and tree belt removal, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; however clauses NN1:15 and 16 and Policy CS17 outline SUDS and flood protection measures. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. Policy NN1:9 commits to protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a relatively isolated position, away from the Urban Core's main centres of commerce and employment. However, it does have excellent transport options including road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead as well as the Key Employment Areas at the Airport via the A696 and it is within walking distance from Bank Foot Metro station providing further access to the Urban Core, although, there is no access to a rail link. The site does appear to have good walking and cycle routes including a link to the Tyneside Cycling network as well as bus services. Additionally, Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment									Potential Mitigation			
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities both in the immediate and wider area									NN1:2, 3, 4 and 7; CS13, CS14			
Environmental	No outstanding environmental concerns out with Policy coverage									NN1:9, 15 and 16; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19			
Economic	Very good public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment									CS13, KEA1			

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NN2 Kingston Park/Kenton Bank Foot	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and likely to be improved over the course of development especially with regards to metro access as per policy clauses NN2:3, 4, 7 and CS13. The site does appear to have good walking and reasonable access to cycle routes including a link to the Tyneside Cycling network. There is good public transport access (range of routes in the area, hourly buses to Urban Core, also Bank Foot and Kingston Park Metro station) to proposed Key Employment Areas. There are 3 GP clinics within 1 mile and good school provision. Policy clauses NN2:2 and 3 commit to further provision of schools and improved access to local services. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The development of these land patches (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site through hedgerow and tree belt removal, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability especially as clause NN2:9 states that it will enhance areas of ecological and landscape importance. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; however there are extensive drainage, water supply and flood risk management commitments within clauses NN2:15 and 16, and overarching policy CS17. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. Clause NN2:9 and 12 commit to enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18 on Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. Clause NN2:10 commits to delivery of any necessary archaeological assessments. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a well-connected position, close to main centres of commerce and employment; furthermore it has road links to the Key Employment Areas at the Airport via the A696 and B6918, as well as two metro stations – Bank Foot and Kingston Park – in close vicinity linking it to the Urban Core. However, there is no access to a rail link. The site does appear to have good walking and reasonable access to cycle routes including a link to national cycle network Tyneside Cycling Network as well as bus services. Additionally, Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a neutral-positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities both in the immediate and wider area						NN2:3, 4, 7 and 10; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	No outstanding environmental concerns out with Policy coverage						NN2:9, 10, 12, 15 and 16; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Very good public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment						CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NN3 Newbiggin Hall	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and likely to be improved over the course of development especially with regards to highways access as per policy clause NN3:4 and CS13. The site appears to have good walking and reasonable access to cycle routes including a link to the Tyneside Cycling network which crosses the site. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas as well as the Urban Core via the metro (Bank Foot and Kingston Park stations). There are 3 GP clinics within 1 mile and good school provision. Policy clauses NN3:2 and 3 commit to further provision of schools and improved access to local services. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: 0-✓ The development of mostly agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site through hedgerow and tree belt removal, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability especially as clause NN3:9 of the policy states that it will enhance areas of ecological and landscape importance including Newbiggin Dene. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; however there are extensive drainage, water supply and flood risk management commitments within NN3:15 and 16 and the overarching policy CS17. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. Clause NN3:9 commits to enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a well-connected position, close to main centres of commerce and employment; furthermore it has road links to the Key Employment Areas at the Airport via the A696 and the Urban Core via the A167, as well as two metro stations – Bank Foot and Kingston Park – in close vicinity also linking it to the Urban Core. However, there is no access to a rail link. The site does appear to have good walking and reasonable access to cycle routes including a link to national cycle network Tyneside Cycling Network as well as bus services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs, facilities and services both in the immediate and wider area						NN3:2,3 and 4; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Environmental concerns are largely mitigated through overarching CS policies and NN3 policy commitments - Good potential to improve ecological connectivity to Newbiggin Dene						NN3:9, 15 and 16; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Very good public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment						CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NN4a Newcastle Great Park Cell A	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be reliant on a regular bus service or road usage, but is likely to be improved over the course of development especially with regards to highways access and transport as per policy clauses NN4:4 and 7 and CS13. The site does appear to have good walking and limited access to cycle routes including a link to National Cycle Network. There is mixed public transport access to Newcastle International Airport (hourly service) as well as the Urban Core (2 routes providing service ~30mins, hourly bus to a metro interchange). There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile and schools nearby at Hazlerigg, Middle Brunton and Fawdon. Policy clauses NN4:2 and 3 commit to further provision of schools and improved access to local services. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The development of agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability especially as clause NN4:9 states that it will enhance areas of ecological and landscape importance. The area is in Flood Zone 2 of the SFRA, however there are extensive drainage, water supply and flood risk management commitments within NN4:15 and 16 and the overarching policy CS17. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. Clause NN4:9 and 12 commit to enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Natural England's MagicMap service identified the site is adjacent to Havannah/Three Hills Nature Reserve and a locally designated Site of Nature Conservation Interest – see Index below for further details. Economic: 0 The site is located in a reasonably well-connected position, relatively close to main centres of commerce and employment; furthermore it has road links to the Key Employment Areas at the Airport and the Urban Core via the A1. However, there is no access to a rail link. The site does appear to have good walking and reasonable access to cycle routes including a link to National Cycle Network as well as bus services, including one which links to the Metro system. The development's proximity to the airport may detract from its appeal due to flight paths and associated noise. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a broadly positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location has average connections to jobs, facilities and services, public transport and shop provision in the local area would benefit from improvements						NN4:2, 3, 4 and 7; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Adjacent to Havannah/Three Hills Nature Reserve and Site of Nature Conservation Interest (recorded populations of great crested newt, dingy skipper butterfly and a red squirrel colony) and has Deciduous Woodland BAP Priority Habitat and ponds on site – extreme care must be taken to ensure development does not impact on the reserve - Remaining environmental concerns are largely mitigated through overarching CS policies and NN3 policy commitments						NN4:9, 12, 15 and 16; CS16, CS17, CS18						
Economic	- Good connections to main centres of commerce and employment, especially in context of CS13 - Proximity to the airport may detract from the development's appeal						NN4:4; CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NN4b Newcastle Great Park Expansion Site	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be reliant on a regular bus service or road usage, but is likely to be improved over the course of development especially with regards to transport as per policy clauses NN4:4, 7 and CS13. The site does appear to have good walking routes, but no immediate access to the National Cycle Network, which will be addressed by policy clause NN4:6 and CS13. There is mixed public transport access to Newcastle International Airport (regular service) as well as the Urban Core (2 routes providing service ~30mins, metro access within 1 mile). There is GP clinic within 1 mile (2 more within 1.06 miles) and schools nearby at Kenton Bank Foot, Middle Brunton and Fawdon. Policy clauses NN4:2 and 3 commit to further provision of schools and improved access to local services. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The development of agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability as clause NN4:9 states that it will enhance areas of ecological and landscape importance. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19. The site is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; however clauses NN4:15 and 16 and Policy CS17 outline SUDS and flood protection measures. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. Clause NN4:9 and 12 commit to enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Natural England's MagicMap service identified the development has a Deciduous Woodland BAP habitat immediately to the north and Woosington Park (designated parkland, Woodland Inventory, and further BAP Priority Habitats) and Hall within 300m to the west – this poses a good opportunity to enhance ecological connectivity between these sites. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a reasonably well-connected position, relatively close to main centres of commerce and employment; furthermore it has road links to the Key Employment Areas at the Airport and the Urban Core via the A1. While there is no access to a rail link, there is a metro station within a mile. Bus services are also quite regular. The site does appear to have good walking routes, but no immediate access to the National Cycle Network. The development's proximity to the airport may detract from its appeal due to flight paths and associated noise. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a broadly positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location has average connections to jobs, facilities and services, public transport and shop provision in the local area would benefit from improvements						NN4:2, 3, 4 and 7; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Opportunities to improve ecological connectivity between Deciduous Woodland BAP Priority Habitat to the north, Woosington Park and associated designations to the west - Remaining environmental concerns are largely mitigated through overarching CS policies and NN4 policy commitments						NN4:9, 12, 15 and 16; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	- Good connections to main centres of commerce and employment, especially in context of CS13 - Proximity to the airport may detract from the development's appeal						NN4:4; CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NN4c Newcastle Great Park Brunton Quarry Site	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average-good, and is likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses NN4:4 and 7 and CS13. The site does appear to have good walking, but no immediate access to the National Cycle Network. There is good public transport access to Newcastle International Airport (hourly bus service and metro link) as well as the Urban Core (3 routes providing service ~30mins, metro access ~1.5 miles). There are 3 GP clinics within 1 mile and schools nearby at Hazlerigg and Middle Brunton. Policy clauses NN4:2 and 3 commit to further provision of schools and improved access to local services. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The development of agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability as clause NN4:9 states that it will enhance areas of ecological and landscape importance. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; however clauses NN4:15 and 16 and Policy CS17 outline SUDS and flood protection measures. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. Clause NN4:7 and 9 commit to enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Natural England's MagicMap tool identified the development has a Deciduous Woodland BAP habitat immediately to the east and within 250m to the west at Dark Plantation which is also on the National Woodland Inventory – this poses the opportunity to improve ecological connectivity between these two sites. It is also very close to two Scheduled Ancient Monuments – enclosed settlements (one is adjacent to the western site boundary), however, clause NN4:10 and overarching policy CS15 cover the need to carry out necessary archaeological assessments. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a reasonably well-connected position, relatively close to main centres of commerce and employment; furthermore it has road links to the Key Employment Areas at the Airport and the Urban Core via the A1. While there is no access to a rail link, there is a metro station within 1.5 miles. Bus services are also quite regular. The site does appear to have limited access to walking routes, and the National Cycle Network – these would benefit from improvements. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a broadly positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location has above-average connections to jobs, facilities and services						NN4:2, 3, 4 and 7; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Opportunities to improve ecological connectivity between Deciduous Woodland BAP Priority Habitat to the east and another BAP to the 225m west - Close proximity to two SAM sites, archaeological assessments recommended - Remaining environmental concerns are largely mitigated through overarching CS policies and NN4 policy commitments						NN4:9, 12, 15 and 16; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18						
Economic	- Average-good connections to main centres of commerce and employment, especially in context of CS13 - Walking and cycling access would benefit from access improvements, as one currently has to cross the A1 to get to public transport						NN4:4 and 10; CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GN1 Dunston Hill	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and likely to be improved over the course of development especially with regards to transport as per policy clause GN1:1i-v and CS13. The site does appear to have good walking and reasonable access to cycle routes including a link the Tyneside Cycling network and the Tanfield Railway Path; these will be further improved through clause GN1:1iv, 1v and 3. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas such as the Metrocentre and Team Valley Trading Estate as well as the Urban Core (bus service and Dunston rail station). There are 3 GP clinics within 1 mile and Lobley Hill Primary School is located not far from the proposed development site. Policy clauses GN1:2 commits to further provision of primary schools. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The development of mostly agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability especially as clause GN1:4 states that it will enhance areas of ecological and landscape importance including 30ha of land for habitat creation, Tanfield Railway Path, and Watergate Forest Park. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per clause GN1:3 and Policy CS19 Green Belt. Protection will be given to the setting of the adjacent Locally Listed Dunston Hill Estate and the Whickham Conservation Area as well as the Whickham Grand Lease Waggonway of 1621 which runs through the site as per clause GN1:3 and 5. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; however a Flood Risk Assessment will still need to be undertaken as per clause GN1:6 while clauses GN1:7, 8 and Policy CS17 outline the use of SUDS and flood protection measures. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. Clauses GN1:3 and 4 commit to enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a well-connected position, close to main centres of commerce and employment; furthermore it has road links to the Key Employment Areas at the Metrocentre, Team Valley Trading Estate and the Urban Core via the A1. Dunston rail station is within 1 mile. The site does appear to have good walking and reasonable access to cycle routes including a link to national cycle network Tyneside Cycling Network and the Tanfield Railway Path as well as local bus services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs, facilities and services						GN1:1i-v and 3; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Policy makes good provisions for protection and enhancement of habitats and cultural heritage features - Remaining environmental concerns are largely mitigated through overarching CS policies and GN1 policy commitments						GN1:3, 4, 5, 7 and 8; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Location is well-connected to main centres of commerce and employment, especially in context of CS13						GN1; CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
AOC1 Newburn	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The development is 7 miles west of Newcastle City Centre and existing transport infrastructure mean that residential development in the area will be reasonably well placed for people to access jobs within the Urban Core. Access will likely to be improved over the course of development especially with regards to highways access as per policy clause AOC1:4. The site will be of mixed tenure, allowing opportunities for more social integration, AOC1:1. The site has good access to road links, walking and local cycling routes (National Route 72) and reasonable bus services (every 10 minutes) to employment areas and the city centre, these will be improved as per policy clause AOC1:7 and CS13. There is 1 GP clinics and four schools within 1 mile, however policy clauses AOC1:2 and 3 commit to the development providing primary and secondary education facilities as well as facilitating improved access to other local services including healthcare. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The development is Brownfield, so will not damage any designated wildlife sites or remove any areas of green space. At least two public open spaces are planned. This former industrial site has undergone a clean-up programme, so the risk of contaminated land is very low. The SFRA states that the site – overall in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA – is at risk of flooding on the banks of the River Tyne, but is restricted to a very small section of the site. Consequently, the Environment Agency would therefore have no issue with this site coming forward for development. However, development should demonstrate there is an adequate foul and Surface Water Drainage Strategy in place, AOC1:12; further precautionary measures are outlined in overarching policy CS17. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. It does however commit to safeguarding areas of ecological and landscape importance and provide the opportunity to integrate green infrastructure with creation of public spaces to improve ecological connectivity, as per policy clause AOC1:8 and CS18. The site is adjacent to the Historic Battlefield of The Battle of Newburn Ford – policy clause AOC1:9 commits to providing necessary archaeological assessments of the site. Economic: ✓ The site is relatively close to the Urban Core and the existing and planned accessibility measures mean the site is adequately well placed to connect residents with employment and commercial developments. There are road links into the wider area via the A1 and a number of other A-roads. It is situated next to local walking and cycling routes (National Route 72) and close to buses (every 10 minutes). Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is relatively well-connected to jobs, facilities and services						AOC1:1, 2, 3, 4 and 7; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Potential to improve local green infrastructure and ecological connectivity - Environmental concerns are largely mitigated through overarching CS and AOC1 commitments						AOC1:8 and 12; CS16, CS17, CS18						
Economic	- Road infrastructure in the area will be improved - Location is well-connected to main centres of commerce and employment by public transport, especially in context of CS13						AOC1:7; CS13						

C4A: Summary Table of Neighbourhood Growth Area Housing Land Allocations

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NN1a Lower Callerton	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
NN1b Middle Callerton	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
NN1c Upper Callerton	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
NN2 Kingston Park/Kenton Bank Foot	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
NN3 Newbiggin Hall	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
NN4a Newcastle Great Park Cell A	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	0	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
NN4b Newcastle Great Park Expansion Site	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
NN4c Newcastle Great Park Brunton Quarry	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GN1 Dunston Hill	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
AOC1 Newburn	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

C4B: Appraisal of Sub-Areas and Sites Policies: Village Growth Areas

Housing Site	SA Objectives ¹ Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NV1 Dinnington	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses NV1:3, NV1:5 and overarching policy CS13. The site appears to have good walking and cycle routes including a link to the Route 10 of the National Cycle Network. There is good public transport access to the proposed Key Employment Area at Newcastle Airport and Urban Core in Newcastle (buses every 20-30 minutes). There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile of the development. There is a primary school located in Dinnington and, while there is no secondary school, policy clause NV1:2 commits to provision of education for primary and secondary age school children. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of this Greenfield site could have potential impacts for its landscape and amenity value, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Additionally, policy clause NV1:13 commits to managing surface water runoff rates while overarching policy CS17 Flood Risk and Water Management addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is an area of Coastal and Floodplain Grazing Marsh 500m west of the proposed development site. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. The development commits to enhancing the green infrastructure of the area including development and protection of rights of way, walking and cycle routes, green spaces, communities and local facilities (NV1:5), and areas of ecological and landscape importance (NV1:7) in addition to the effects of Policy CS18 on Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. Any cultural and heritage features should be safeguarded or enhanced as per clause NV1:8 for necessary archaeological assessments and overarching Policy CS15 Place Making. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a relatively well-connected position, albeit away from the Urban Core's main centres of commerce and employment. However, Newcastle International Airport is nearby and due to be expanded as per Policy KEA1. Although the site has road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead via the A1 and A969, as well as the Key Employment Area at the Airport via the A969, there is no access to a rail or metro link. Nonetheless, the site does appear to have good walking and cycle routes, including a link to Route 10 of the National Cycle Network, as well as bus services. Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	- Local facilities will be enhanced - Location is relatively well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Newcastle International Airport						NV1:2, NV1:3, NV1:5; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Potential to enhance local areas of ecological and landscape importance - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage						NV1:5, NV1:7, NV1:8, NV1:13; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Good public transport provision to Key Employment Areas						CS13, KEA1						

¹Some elements of the SA objective questions may be influenced by overarching Strategic or Urban Core Policies set out in "Planning for the Future: CSUCP for Newcastle and Gateshead Submission Document", this will be indicated in the assessment summary below.

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NV2a Hazlerigg and NV2b Wideopen	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The locations' access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and is likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses NV2:3, NV2:7 and overarching policy CS13. The sites appear to have good walking and cycle routes including a link to the Tyneside Cycling Network and Route 10 of the National Cycle Network. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas via bus (every 20 minutes) and subway as well as good road links to the Urban Core. A designated recreation ground is adjacent to the site. There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile of the development. There is a primary school located midway between Hazlerigg and Wideopen; while there is no secondary school, policy clause NV2:2 commits to provision of education for primary and secondary age school children. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of these Greenfield sites could have potential impacts for their landscape and amenity value; however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate their sustainability. The sites are on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. Both areas are in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Additionally, policy clauses NV2:13 and 15 commit to producing a Surface Water Drainage Strategy and managing surface water runoff rates while overarching policy CS17 addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clause NV2:7 and 9 commit to protection and enhancement of green infrastructure and areas of ecological importance in the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Natural England's MagicMap service identified the southern boundary of the Hazlerigg Site (NV2a) is adjacent to Havannah/Three Hills Nature Reserve and a locally designated Site of Nature Conservation Interest – see index below for further details. Clause NV2:10 commits to implementing any necessary archaeological assessments while overarching policy CS15 ensures the safeguarding and enhancement of cultural and heritage features. Economic: 0-✓ The sites are located in a relatively good position for access to main centres of commerce and employment, and the northern boundary of NV2a is adjacent to Brunswick Industrial Estate and Newcastle International Airport is due to be expanded as per policy KEA1. There are good road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead via the A1 and the A1056/B1318 at Wideopen, to which the policy states access will be improved (NV2:4), as well as the Key Employment Area at the Airport. While there is no access to a rail link, there are regular bus services close to the proposed development sites which link to Kingston Park metro station. The sites do appear to have good access to walking and cycle routes. Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Newcastle International Airport						NV2:3, NV2:7; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- NV2a is adjacent to Havannah/Three Hills Nature Reserve and Site of Nature Conservation Interest (recorded populations of great crested newt, dingy skipper butterfly and a red squirrel colony) and has Deciduous Woodland BAP Priority Habitat and ponds on site – extreme care must be taken to ensure development does not impact on the reserve - Remaining environmental concerns are largely mitigated through overarching CS policies and NV2 policy commitments						NV2:7, NV2:9, NV2:10, NV2:13, NV2:15; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Good public transport access to Key Employment Areas						NV2:4; CS13, KEA1						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NV3a Throckley North	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and is likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses NV3:3, NV3:7 and overarching policy CS13. There do appear to be good walking and cycle routes in the area; however traffic-free cycling options are roughly 1km away from the site. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas and Urban Cores. 2 GP clinics are located within 1 mile of the development. There is a school and recreation ground located in Throckley and policy clause NV3:2 commits to provision of education for primary and secondary age school children. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of this agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The south eastern boundary of the site is adjacent to a Deciduous Woodland Biodiversity Action Plan Priority Habitat. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Additionally, policy clause NV3:13 and 15 commit to producing a Foul and Surface Water Drainage Strategy and managing surface water runoff rates while overarching policy CS17 addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clause NV3:9 commits to the protection and enhancement of green infrastructure and areas of ecological importance in the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. The site is located within the Hadrian's Wall World Heritage Site buffer zone. Clause NV3:10 commits to implementing any necessary archaeological assessments while overarching policy CS15 ensures the safeguarding and enhancement of cultural and heritage features. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a relatively well-connected position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, but with good road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead as well as the Key Employment Areas at the Airport via the A1 and A69, to which the policy states access will be improved (NV3:4 and 5). However, there is no access to a rail or metro link nearby. Nevertheless, the southern site does appear to have good walking and cycle routes. The site has good access to bus services (every 20-30 minutes), which should be improved as part of overarching policy CS13. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment									Potential Mitigation			
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Newcastle International Airport									NV3:2, NV3:3, NV3:3; CS13, CS14			
Environmental	- Site located within Hadrian's Wall World Heritage Site and Woodland Priority Habitat - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage									NV3:9, NV3:10, NV3:13, NV3:15; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19			
Economic	Good public transport access to Key Employment Areas									NV3:4, NV3:5; CS13			

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NV3b Throckley South	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and is likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses NV3:3, NV3:7 and overarching policy CS13. There do appear to be good walking and cycle routes in the area including traffic-free cycle routes. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas and Urban Cores. 2 GP clinics are located within 1 mile of the development. There is a school and recreation ground located in Throckley and policy clause NV3:2 commits to provision of education for primary and secondary age school children. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of this agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The southern boundary of the site is adjacent to a Deciduous Woodland Biodiversity Action Plan Priority Habitat. The area does not appear to be at risk of flooding. Additionally, policy clause NV3:13 and 15 commit to producing a Foul and Surface Water Drainage Strategy and managing surface water runoff rates while overarching policy CS17 addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clause NV3:9 commits to the protection and enhancement of green infrastructure and areas of ecological importance in the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. The site of The Battle of Newburn Ford is located immediately south of the development. Clause NV3:10 commits to implementing any necessary archaeological assessments while overarching policy CS15 ensures the safeguarding and enhancement of cultural and heritage features. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a relatively well-connected position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, but with good road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead as well as the Key Employment Areas at the Airport via the A1 and A69, to which the policy states access will be improved (NV3:4 and 5). However, there is no access to a rail or metro link nearby. Nevertheless, the southern site does appear to have good walking and cycle routes. The site has good access to bus services (every 15 minutes), which should be improved as part of overarching policy CS13. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Newcastle International Airport						NV3:2, NV3:3, NV3:7; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Adjacent to site of The Battle of Newburn Ford and Woodland Priority Habitat - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage						NV3:9, NV3:10, NV3:13, NV3:15; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Good public transport access to Key Employment Areas						NV3:4, NV3:5; CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV1a Chopwell North	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but is likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses GV1:2, GV1:3 and overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have very good walking through Chopwell Wood and reasonable access to cycle routes, including access to Route 14 of the National Cycle Network in the wider area, the only potential deterrent for cyclists and walkers could be the fact that Chopwell sits on top of a hill. A continuous surface path between North and Middle Chopwell will be provided (GV1:3). There is reasonable public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas such as the Metrocentre and Team Valley Trading Estate as well as the Urban Core. There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile and Chopwell Primary School is located not far from the proposed development site, the policy commits contributing to primary school provision (GV1:4). However there is no secondary school located within Chopwell. Chopwell Park is located not far from the development site and there are also several playing fields nearby. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of mostly agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability especially as clause GV1:8i of the policy states that the development will have a landscape buffer. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. An area of Broadleaved National Inventory of Woodland and Trees lies immediately south of the site, which could be affected by the development as it will be isolated from the wider landscape by the rest of Chopwell. The site is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Additionally, a flood risk assessment will be carried out, SUDS potential will be explored (GV1:6 and GV1:8iii) and surface water runoff managed (GV1:7), while overarching clause and Policy CS17 which addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Policy clause GV1:5 commits to enhancing the biodiversity and green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a relatively isolated position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, although it does have road links into Gateshead and the Metrocentre via the A694 as well as the Key Employment Area at Team Valley Trading Estate, there is no access to a rail or metro link. The site does appear to have reasonable walking and cycle routes including access to Route 14 of the National Cycle Network in the wider area. There are reasonable bus services (every 15 minutes, but takes 1 hour to arrive at Gateshead) close to the proposed development site, which should be improved as part of clause GV1:2 and overarching policy CS13. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the local area – especially the Metrocentre and Team Valley Trading Estate						GV1:2, GV1:3, GV1:4; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Area of National Inventory of Woodland and Trees adjacent to site - Habitat enhancements and landscape buffers around the development - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage						GV1:5, GV1:6, GV1:7, GV1:8i and 8iii; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Adequate public transport provision to Key Employment Areas, to be improved as per clause GV1:2 and overarching Policy CS13						GV1:2; CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV1b Middle Chopwell	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but is likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses GV1:2, GV1:3 and overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have very good walking through Chopwell Wood and reasonable access to cycle routes, including access to Route 14 of the National Cycle Network in the wider area, the only potential deterrent for cyclists and walkers could be the fact that Chopwell sits on top of a hill. A continuous surface path between North and Middle Chopwell will be provided (GV1:3). There is reasonable public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas such as the Metrocentre and Team Valley Trading Estate as well as the Urban Core. There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile and Chopwell Primary School is located not far from the proposed development site, the policy commits contributing to primary school provision (GV1:4). However there is no secondary school located within Chopwell. Chopwell Park is located not far from the development site and there are also several playing fields nearby. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of mostly agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability especially as clause GV1:9i of the policy states that the development will have a landscape buffer. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. An area of Broadleaved National Inventory of Woodland and Trees lies immediately north of the site, which could be affected by the development as it will be isolated from the wider landscape by the rest of Chopwell. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Additionally, a flood risk assessment will be carried out, SUDS potential will be explored (GV1:6) and surface water runoff managed (GV1:7), while overarching Policy CS17 which addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Policy clause GV1:5 commits to enhancing the biodiversity and green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a relatively isolated position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, although it does have road links into Gateshead and the Metrocentre via the A694 as well as the Key Employment Area at Team Valley Trading Estate, there is no access to a rail or metro link. The site does appear to have reasonable walking and cycle routes including access to Route 14 of the National Cycle Network in the wider area. There are reasonable bus services (every 15 minutes, but takes 1 hour to arrive at Gateshead) close to the proposed development site, which should be improved as part of clause GV1:2 and overarching policy CS13. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the local area – especially the Metrocentre and Team Valley Trading Estate						GV1:2, GV1:3, GV1:4; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Area of National Inventory of Woodland and Trees adjacent to site - Habitat enhancements and landscape buffers around the development - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage						GV1:5, GV1:6, GV1:7, GV1:9i; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Adequate public transport provision to Key Employment Areas, to be improved as per clause GV1:2 and overarching Policy CS13						GV1:2; CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV1c Chopwell South	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but is likely to be improved over the course of development as per policy clauses GV1:2, GV1:3 and overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have very good walking through Chopwell Wood and reasonable access to cycle routes, including access to Route 14 of the National Cycle Network in the wider area, the only potential deterrent for cyclists and walkers could be the fact that Chopwell sits on top of a hill. A continuous surface path between North and Middle Chopwell will be provided (GV1:3). There is reasonable public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas such as the Metrocentre and Team Valley Trading Estate as well as the Urban Core. There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile and Chopwell Primary School is located not far from the proposed development site, the policy commits contributing to primary school provision (GV1:4). However there is no secondary school located within Chopwell. Chopwell Park is located not far from the development site and there are also several playing fields nearby. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of mostly agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability especially as clause GV1:10i-ii of the policy states that hedgerows around the boundaries of the site will be protected and enhanced. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The site is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Additionally, a flood risk assessment will be carried out, SUDS potential will be explored (GV1:6) and surface water runoff managed (GV1:7), while overarching Policy CS17 which addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Policy clause GV1:5 commits to enhancing the biodiversity and green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a relatively isolated position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, although it does have road links into Gateshead and the Metrocentre via the A694 as well as the Key Employment Area at Team Valley Trading Estate, there is no access to a rail or metro link. The site does appear to have reasonable walking and cycle routes including access to Route 14 of the National Cycle Network in the wider area. There are reasonable bus services (every 15 minutes, but takes 1 hour to arrive at Gateshead) close to the proposed development site, which should be improved as part of clause GV1:2 and overarching policy CS13. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment									Potential Mitigation			
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the local area – especially the Metrocentre and Team Valley Trading Estate									GV1:2, GV1:3, GV1:4; CS13, CS14			
Environmental	- Hedgerow enhancements as part of landscape buffers around the development - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage									GV1:5, GV1:6, GV1:7, GV1:10i-ii; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19			
Economic	Adequate public transport provision to Key Employment Areas, to be improved as per clause GV1:2 and overarching Policy CS13									GV1:2; CS13			

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV2a Crawcrook North	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but is likely to be improved over the course of development as per overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have good walking, but only access to Route 141 of the National Cycle Network within 1 mile along roads with traffic. There is reasonable public transport access to the Metrocentre and Team Valley Trading Estate as well as the Urban Cores in Gateshead and Newcastle by regular bus services which link to Wylam rail station. There are 3 GP clinics within 1 mile and 2 primary schools located not far from the proposed development site as well as a secondary school in Ryton, furthermore clause GV2:3 commits to local primary school provision. There are several recreational facilities within the area. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of mostly agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Moreover, policy clause GV2:5 commits to managing surface water runoff rates while overarching policy CS17 and clause GV2:6iii address SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clause GV2:4 commits to the protection and enhancement of green infrastructure and areas of ecological importance in the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a relatively isolated position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, although it does have road links into Gateshead, the Metrocentre, and Team Valley Trading Estate via the A695 as well as the Urban Cores, there is access to a rail link at Wylam Station. The development commits to nearby road improvements to the junction at the A695 and Crawcrook Lane (GV2:2 and GV2:6i-ii). There are reasonable bus services (every 10 minutes) close to the proposed development site. The site does appear to have good walking access, but only access to Route 141 of the National Cycle Network within 1 mile along roads with traffic. Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is reasonably well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Key Employment Areas						GV2:3; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Potential to enhance local habitats via landscape buffers around the development - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage						GV2:4, GV2:5, GV2:6iii; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	- The location is less suited for cycling access than other sites - Good public transport provision to Key Employment Areas						GV2:2, GV2:6i-ii; CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV2b Crawcrook South	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but is likely to be improved over the course of development as per overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have good walking, but only access to Route 141 of the National Cycle Network within 1 mile along roads with traffic. There is reasonable public transport access to the Metrocentre and Team Valley Trading Estate as well as the Urban Cores in Gateshead and Newcastle by regular bus services which link to Wylam rail station. There are 3 GP clinics within 1 mile and 2 primary schools located not far from the proposed development site as well as a secondary school in Ryton, furthermore clause GV2:3 commits to local primary school provision. There are several recreational facilities within the area. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of mostly agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt; however, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The area is not at risk of flooding. Moreover, policy clause GV2:5 commits to managing surface water runoff rates while overarching policy CS17 and clause GV2:7iv address SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clause GV2:4 and GV2:7ii commit to the protection and enhancement of green infrastructure and areas of ecological importance in the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a relatively isolated position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, although it does have road links into Gateshead, the Metrocentre, and Team Valley Trading Estate via the A695 as well as the Urban Cores, there is access to a rail link at Wylam Station. The development commits to nearby road improvements (new junction) at the A695 (GV2:2 and GV2:7i). There are reasonable bus services (every 10 minutes) close to the proposed development site. The site does appear to have good walking access, but only access to Route 141 of the National Cycle Network within 1 mile along roads with traffic. Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment									Potential Mitigation			
Social	Location is reasonably well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Key Employment Areas									GV2:3; CS13, CS14			
Environmental	- Potential to enhance local habitats via landscape buffers around the development - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage									GV2:4, GV2:5, GV2:7ii, GV2:7iv; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19			
Economic	- The location is less suited for cycling access than other sites - Good public transport provision to Key Employment Areas									GV2:2, GV2:7i; CS13			

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV3 Highfield	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but is likely to be improved over the course of development as per overarching policy CS13. The site appears to have good walking access through Chopwell Wood as well as a local wildlife park and access to Route 14 of the National Cycle Network. There is reasonable public transport access by bus to the Urban Cores in Gateshead and Newcastle via Metrocentre rail station. There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile and there are 3 primary schools located not far from the proposed development site, however there are no secondary schools in the area. Furthermore, clause GV3:3 outlines contribution to local primary school provision. There are several recreational facilities within the area. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of rough grazing land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt and a footpath runs through the site; however the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The Strother Hill SSSI (designated for its wet alder and dry acidic woodland uncommon to the region) and Site of Nature Conservation Interest (SINC) is adjacent to the development which could be affected by the development; however clause GV3:1 of the policy commits to maintaining and enhancing the ecological value of the SSSI and adjacent Local Wildlife Sites. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Moreover, policy clause GV3:6 commits to managing surface water runoff rates while overarching policy CS17 and clause GV3:5 address SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clause GV3:1 and GV3:2 commit to the protection and enhancement of green infrastructure and areas of ecological importance in the area, including an appropriate landscape buffer along the new site boundary, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a relatively well-connected position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, but situated right on the A695 which links into Gateshead, Newcastle, and the Metrocentre. There are regular bus services (every 20 minutes) to Metrocentre rail station close to the proposed development site. The site does appear to have good access to walking and the National Cycle Network (Route 14). Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment									Potential Mitigation			
Social	Location is relatively well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Metrocentre									GV3:3; CS13, CS14			
Environmental	- Potential to enhance local woodland habitats including SSSI and Local Wildlife Sites - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage									GV3:1, GV3:2, GV3:5, GV3:6; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19			
Economic	Good public transport provision to Key Employment Areas									CS13			

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV4a High Spen West	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but is likely to be improved over the course of development as per overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have good walking routes, and access to local cycle routes in addition to linking with Route 14 of the National Cycle Network within 2 miles. There appears to be reasonable public transport access to the Urban Cores in Gateshead and Newcastle as well as the Metrocentre. There is 1 GP clinic within 1 mile and 1 primary school located close to the proposed development site; however there are no secondary schools in the area. Clause GV4:3 outlines contribution to local primary school provision. There are recreational facilities within the area as well as a golf course adjacent to the site boundary. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of rough grazing land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt and a footpath runs through the site; however the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The development will mitigate the impact on biodiversity and enhance the ecological value of the disused quarry to the south of the site (GV4:5ii). The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; clause GV4:3 outlines a surface water management plan, clause GV4:5iv states a flood risk assessment will be carried out to demonstrate that there is no increased risk of flooding; while Policy CS17 addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clause GV4:5ii commit to the protection and enhancement of green infrastructure and areas of ecological importance in the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a relatively well-connected position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, but with access to the A964 within 1.5 miles which links into Gateshead, Newcastle, and the Metrocentre. There are reasonable bus services (every 20-30 minutes) close to the proposed development site. The site does appear to have good walking, local and National cycling routes. Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment									Potential Mitigation			
Social	Location is reasonably well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Key Employment Areas									GV4:3; CS13, CS14			
Environmental	- Potential to enhance local habitats – the nearby disused quarry - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage									GV4:5ii, GV4:5iv; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19			
Economic	Good public transport provision to key employment areas									CS13			

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV4b High Spen East	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but is likely to be improved over the course of development as per overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have good walking routes, and access to local cycle routes in addition to linking with Route 14 of the National Cycle Network within 2 miles. There appears to be reasonable public transport access to the Urban Cores in Gateshead and Newcastle as well as the Metrocentre. There is 1 GP clinic within 1 mile and 1 primary school located close to the proposed development site; however there are no secondary schools in the area. Clause GV4:2 outlines contribution to local primary school provision. There are recreational facilities within the area. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of rough grazing land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt and a footpath runs through the site; however the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The development will mitigate the impact on biodiversity and enhance the hedgerow along the eastern and southern boundaries of the site (GV4:6ii). It will also protect and enhance the existing wetland area in the northwestern corner of the site (GV4:6iii). The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; clause GV4:3 outlines a surface water management plan, clause GV4:6vi states a flood risk assessment will be carried out to demonstrate that there is no increased risk of flooding; while clause GV4:6v and policy CS17 address SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clause GV4:6i-ii commit to the protection and enhancement of green infrastructure (hedgerows through a landscape buffer) and areas of ecological importance in the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a relatively well-connected position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, but with access to the A964 within 1.5 miles which links into Gateshead, Newcastle, and the Metrocentre. There are reasonable bus services (every 20-30 minutes) close to the proposed development site. The site does appear to have good walking, local and National cycling routes. Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is reasonably well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Key Employment Areas						GV4:2; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Potential to enhance: - Local wetland at the north-west corner of the site - Hedgerow along eastern and southern boundaries - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage						GV4:6i-iii, GV4:6v-vi; CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Good public transport provision to key employment areas						CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV5 Kibblesworth	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average, but is likely to be enhanced over the course of development; a local junction will be improved as per GV5:1 (having regard to the Lamesley Conservation Area) and overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have good walking, and good access to Route 11 of the National Cycle Network. There appears to be irregular public transport access (buses every 40 minutes which take 30-40 minutes) to the Urban Core. There are no GP clinics within 1 mile, but there is 1 primary school is located close to the proposed development site, but there are no secondary schools. However, clause GV5:5 outlines contribution to local primary school provision. There is a recreational ground within the area. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of mostly agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability buffer. The site is on existing Green Belt; however the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. Policy GV5:7 states that a clear green belt boundary will be created on the northeast and southwest of the site and enhancement to hedgerows to provide a boundary and improve ecological connectivity. The site is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; furthermore a flood risk assessment will be carried out to ensure the risk is not exacerbated downstream (GV5:9). Clause GV5:10 and policy CS17 address SUDS and flood protection issues including a surface water management plan (GV5:11). There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clauses GV5:2-4 commit to the protection and enhancement of green infrastructure and areas of ecological importance in the area (ecological buffers to woodland and wetland to the north of the site and enhancement of recreational value of Bowes Railway Path), in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. There will be an archaeological report to confirm the presence or absence of an early colliery waggonway within the site (GV5:6) while overarching policy CS15 ensures the safeguarding and enhancement of cultural and heritage features. Economic: 0-✓ The site is located in a relatively well-connected position, away from the main centres of commerce and employment, but with road links into Gateshead, the Metrocentre, and Newcastle via the A1. The development ensures improvements to a nearby junction as per clause GV5:1 and overarching policy CS13 Transport. There are relatively irregular bus services (every 40 minutes) near the proposed development site. The site does appear to have reasonable walking and access to Route 11 of the National Cycle Network. Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a broadly positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment									Potential Mitigation			
Social	- GP clinics only within 2 miles of the development – would benefit from a closer surgery as per CS14 - Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area by road – especially the Urban Core and Key Employment Areas (Team Valley Trading Estate)									GV5:1, GV5:5; CS13, CS14			
Environmental	- Potential to enhance local habitats through landscape buffers around development - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage									GV5:2-4, GV5:6-7, GV5:9, GV5:11; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19			
Economic	Irregular public transport provision to Key Employment Areas will benefit from improvements as per CS13									GV5:1; CS13			

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV6 Ryton	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and is likely to be enhanced over the course of development; local junctions and road links will be improved as per clauses GV6:2-5 and overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have good walking and the development will include improvement to local footways (GV6:4). There appears to be good access to Routes 72 and 141 of the National Cycle Network. There is good public transport access (buses every 10-20 minutes) to the Urban Cores in Gateshead and Newcastle. There are 2 GP clinics within 1 mile and there are 6 primary schools located not far from the proposed development site, and 1 secondary school. Clause GV6:6 outlines contribution to local primary school provision. There are recreational facilities within the area. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of mostly agricultural land and small areas of woodland (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt; however the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. Clause GV6:1, 5 and 7 state that there will be landscape and ecological buffers and retention of the waggonway which runs through the site. A flood risk assessment will be carried out (GV6:11), however the site is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; clause GV6:12 proposes a surface water management plan while clause GV6:10 and overarching policy CS17 address SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clauses GV6:1 and GV6:7 commit to enhancing the green infrastructure of the area in, addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Overarching policy CS15 ensures the safeguarding and enhancement of cultural and heritage features. Economic: ✓ The site is located relatively close to the main centres of commerce and employment, and has road links into Gateshead, the Metrocentre, and Newcastle via the A695 and A1. The development ensures improvements to a nearby junction and road link as clauses GV6:2-5 and overarching policy CS13 Transport. There are reasonable bus services (every 10-20 minutes) close to the proposed development site. The site does appear to have reasonable walking routes, which will be further improved as per clause GV6:4, and access to Routes 72 and 141 of the National Cycle Network. Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Key Employment Areas						GV6:2-6; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Potential to enhance local habitats and ecology through landscape buffers - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage						GV6:1, GV6:5, GV6:7, GV6:11-12; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Good public transport provision to Key Employment Areas						GV6:2-5; CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV7a Sunnyside North East	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and is likely to be enhanced over the course of development, local junctions will be improved as per GV7:2 and overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have good walking including local walking routes and good access to the Tyneside Cycle Network. Furthermore, GV7:7i commits to improve the cycle and pedestrian links to the Tanfield Railway Path. There appears to be good public transport access (buses every 10-30 minutes) to the Urban Cores in Gateshead and Newcastle. There 1 GP clinic within 1, and only 1 primary school within the vicinity and no secondary schools. Clause GV7:3 outlines contributions to local primary school provision. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of a group of adjoining small holdings in garden, paddock and commercial nursery use, with an associated scatter of buildings on the northern edge of Streetgate, adjoining behind Gateshead Road could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site especially the areas of woodland adjacent to the western boundary, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt; however the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. Clause GV7:7ii states that there will be an ecological buffer to protect and enhance the integrity and value to wildlife of the adjacent Lottie's Wood Local Wildlife Site. A flood risk assessment will be carried out as per GV7:5; however, the site is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Policy CS17 addresses SUDS and flood protection issues while clause GV7:6 outlines managing surface water runoff rates in the context of anticipated climate change. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. The development commits to enhancing the green infrastructure of the area in clause GV7:7iii, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Overarching policy CS15 ensures the safeguarding and enhancement of cultural and heritage features. Economic: ✓ The site is located relatively close to the main centres of commerce and employment, and has road links into Gateshead, the Metrocentre, and Newcastle via the A692. The development ensures improvement to a nearby junction and improvements to junctions on the A692 as per clause GV7:2 and Policy CS13 Transport. There are reasonable bus services (every 10-30 minutes) close to the proposed development site on the A692. The site does appear to have reasonable access to walking routes and the Tyneside Cycle Network, pending improvements to cycle and pedestrian linkages (GV7:7i). Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Key Employment Areas						GV7:2, GV7:3, GV7:7i; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Large area of woodland adjacent to the western site boundary - Potential to enhance local habitats and ecology via landscape buffers - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage						GV7:5, GV7:6, GV7:7ii-iii; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Good public transport provision to Key Employment Areas						GV7:2, GV7:7i; CS13						

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV7b Sunniside South East	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and is likely to be enhanced over the course of development, local junctions will be improved as per GV7:2 and overarching policy CS13. The site does appear to have good walking including local walking routes and good access to the Tyneside Cycle Network. There appears to be good public transport access (buses every 10-30 minutes) to the Urban Cores in Gateshead and Newcastle. There 1 GP clinic within 1, and only 1 primary school within the vicinity and no secondary schools. Clause GV7:3 outlines contributions to local primary school provision. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14 Wellbeing and Health. Environmental: ✓ The development of 3 adjoining sites on the west side of Pennyfine Road leading uphill out of the village, opposite an existing housing area, including a garden centre, and some small fields could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site, however comprehensive planning should be able to demonstrate its sustainability. The site is on existing Green Belt; however the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. Policy GV7:8i states that there will be a landscape buffer and enhancement of existing hedgerows and trees to encourage biodiversity and create a clear defensible Green Belt; while GV7:8ii maintains an adequate buffer between the site and Tanfield Railway path to the north. A flood risk assessment will be carried out as per clause GV7:5 to determine whether the development will exacerbate flood risk downstream. However, the site is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; clause GV7:8iii and policy CS17 address SUDS and flood protection issues while clause GV7:6 outlines managing surface water runoff rates in the context of anticipated climate change. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. The development commits to enhancing the green infrastructure of the area including retention and enhancement of existing hedgerows and trees near and within the site boundary (GV7:8i), in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Economic: ✓ The site is located relatively close to the main centres of commerce and employment, and has road links into Gateshead, the Metrocentre, and Newcastle via the A692. The development ensures improvement to a nearby junction and improvements to junctions on the A692 as per clause GV7:2 and Policy CS13 Transport. There are reasonable bus services (every 10-30 minutes) close to the proposed development site on the A692. The site does appear to have reasonable access to walking routes and the Tyneside Cycle Network, pending improvements to cycle and pedestrian linkages (GV7:7ii). Additionally Policy CS13 should contribute to improving local public transport services. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the wider area – especially the Urban Core and Key Employment Areas						GV7:2, GV7:3, GV7:; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Potential to enhance local habitats and ecology via landscape buffers - No outstanding environmental concerns outwith Policy coverage						GV7:5, GV7:6, GV7:8i-iii; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Good public transport provision to Key Employment Areas						GV7:2; CS13						

C4B: Summary Table of Village Growth Area Housing Land Allocations

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NV1 Dinnington	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
NV2a Hazlerigg and NV2b Wideopen	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
NV3a Throckley North	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
NV3b Throckley South	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV1a Chopwell North	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV1b Middle Chopwell	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV1c Chopwell South	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV2a Crawcrook North	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV2b Crawcrook South	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV3 Highfield	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV4a High Spen West	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓

Housing Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GV4b High Spen East	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV5 Kibblesworth	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV6 Ryton	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV7a Sunnyside North East	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	
GV7b Sunnyside South East	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

C4C: Appraisal of The Sub-Areas and Sites Policies: Mixed-Use Land

Site	SA Objectives ¹ Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
KEA1a Newcastle International Airport	✓	✓	0?	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and likely to be improved over the course of development (especially with regards to highway access as per clause KEA1:3i, 3ii and 3iv). The site does appear to have reasonable walking and cycle route access including a link to Route 10 of the National Cycle Network, and there are commitments in policy clauses KEA1:3iii and CS13 to improve them. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The continued development of this commercial land (Brownfield site) should not impact the landscape and the amenity value of this site. The site is not on existing Green Belt; and, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Additionally, overarching Policy CS17 addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Policy KEA1:3v commits to protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18 on Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a well-connected position, within easy reach of main centres of commerce and employment as well as acting one itself once development is completed. The road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead via the A696, there is a good bus service (around every 10 minutes) as well as metro access; and access to a rail link, public transport services are subject to improvements as per policy CS13. However, the site does appear to have reasonable access to walking routes including a link to Route 10 of the National Cycling Network, however clauses KEA1:3iii, 3iv commit to improving both pedestrian and cycling access. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	- Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the immediate area, will also provide them once completed - Potential to promote synergies between education/training and the airline industry						KEA1:3i-3iv, CS13, CS14						
Environmental	Commitments and wider CS policies should ensure the meeting of environmental objectives						KEA1:3v, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	- Development will improve airport facilities and associated services - Very good public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as one once completed - Should encourage more business and tourism to the region						KEA1:3iii-3iv, CS13						

¹Some elements of the SA objective questions may be influenced by overarching Strategic or Urban Core Policies set out in "Planning for the Future: CSUCP for Newcastle and Gateshead Submission Document", this will be indicated in the assessment summary below.

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
KEA1b Newcastle Airport South of Freight	✓	✓	0?	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Assessment Summary												
	Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be good, and likely to be improved over the course of development (especially with regards to highway access as per clause KEA1:3i, 3ii and 3iv). The site appears to have reasonable walking, but poor traffic free cycle route access; however, there are commitments in policy clause KEA1:3iii and CS13 for improvements. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14.												
	Environmental: ✓ The continued development of this Greenfield site could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site. The site is not on existing Green Belt; and, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. Additionally, overarching Policy CS17 addresses SUDS and flood protection issues. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Policy KEA1:3v commits to protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18 on Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment.												
	Economic: ✓ The site is located in a well-connected position, within easy reach of main centres of commerce and employment as well as acting as a minor one itself once development is completed. The road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead via the A696, there is a good bus service (every 20-30 minutes) as well as metro access; and access to a rail link within 1.5 miles. Public transport services are subject to improvements as per policy CS13. The site does appear to have reasonable access to walking, but only limited traffic-free access to cycle routes, including a link to Route 10 of the National Cycling Network in the wider area, however clauses KEA1:3iii, 3iv commit to improving both pedestrian and cycling access.												
Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment								Potential Mitigation				
Social	• Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the immediate area, will also provide them once complete								• KEA1:3i-3iv, CS13, CS14				
Environmental	• Commitments and wider CS policies should ensure the meeting of environmental objectives								• KEA1:3v, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19				
Economic	• Very good public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as one (small business and/or industrial units) once completed • Should encourage more business and tourism to the region								• KEA1:3iii-3iv, CS13				

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
KEA1c Newcastle Airport Southside	✓	✓	0	✓	0?	✓	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be relatively good, and likely to be improved over the course of development, especially with regards to highway access as per policy clauses KEA1:3i, 3ii and 3iv. The site appears to have reasonable walking and poor traffic-free cycle route access; however, there are commitments in policy clause KEA1:3iii and CS13 for improvements. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The continued development of this agricultural and plantation land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site. The site is not on existing Green Belt; and, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. Most of the site is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA, but smaller parts of the site are in greater risk zones (up to 3b); however, Policy CS17 addresses SUDS and flood protection issues and should mitigate the risk. Nevertheless, a clause for surface water runoff and integration with the wider flood protection measures based on the Ouse Burn could be added to KEA1. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Policy KEA1:3v commits to protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18 on Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a reasonably well-connected position, within relatively easy reach of main centres of commerce and employment as well as acting as a minor one itself once development is completed. The road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead via the A696, there is a good bus service (every 20-40 minutes), as well as metro access and access to a rail link within 1.5 miles. Furthermore, public transport services are subject to improvements as per policy CS13. The site does appear to have reasonable access to walking routes, but only limited traffic-free access to cycle routes, including a link to Route 10 of the National Cycling Network in the wider area, however clauses KEA1:3iii, 3iv commit to improving both pedestrian and cycling access. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a broadly-positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs and facilities in the immediate area, will also provide them once complete						KEA1:3i-3iv, CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Flood mitigation plans should be developed and presented by the developer - Commitments and wider CS policies should ensure the meeting of environmental objectives						KEA1:3v, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Good public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as a minor one (warehousing units) once completed						KEA1:3iii-3iv, CS13						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
KEA1d Newcastle Airport Southside Expansion Site	✓	✓	0	✓	0	✓	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The location's access to facilities, jobs and services currently appears to be average (between 1-1.5 miles to nearest services), but likely to be improved over the course of development, especially with regards to highway access as per policy clauses KEA1:3i, 3ii and 3iv. The site does appear to have reasonable walking and traffic-free cycle route access; however, there are commitments in policy clause KEA1:3iii to improve them. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The continued development of this agricultural land (Greenfield site) could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site. The site is on existing Green Belt; and, the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19 Green Belt. The area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. However, Policy CS17 addresses SUDS and flood protection issues and should mitigate any risk. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Policy KEA1:3v commits to protecting and enhancing the green infrastructure of the area, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18 on Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. Economic: ✓ The site is located in a reasonably well-connected position, with relatively easy access to main centres of commerce and employment, and acting as a minor one itself once development is completed. The road links into Central Newcastle and Gateshead via the A1 or the A696. There is comparably average public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas (good road access, bus stations within 15-20 minute walk, and run every 20-40 minutes, a metro station within 1.5 miles and a train station within 2.5 miles). The site does appear to have reasonable access to walking and cycle routes along Brunton Lane. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a broadly-positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location has average connections to jobs and facilities in the immediate area, will also provide them once complete						KEA1:3i-3iv, CS13, CS14						
Environmental	Commitments and wider CS policies should ensure the meeting of environmental objectives						KEA1:3v, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19						
Economic	Comparably average public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as one (site for single large user) once completed						KEA1:3iii-3iv, CS13						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
KEA2 South of Follingsby Lane	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The site will aim to provide developable employment land, some of which will be used for warehouse premises. The policy states the walking and cycling routes in the area will be improved including new routes linking to Green Infrastructure (KEA2:3ii), however public transport access to the site is poor at present but is due to be improved as well (KEA2:3i; CS13). The Urban Green Infrastructure Network and open spaces will be enhanced to help to encourage use of the space for outdoor recreation and thereby promote healthy, active lifestyles. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The site is on existing Green Belt, but the Green Belt boundary has been revised as per Policy CS19. Natural England's Magic Map Tool shows the site be in an area of community forest with areas of National Inventory of Woodland and Trees and Deciduous Woodland BAP Priority Habitat along its southern boundary. The area immediately along the River Don is in Flood Zone 3b of SFRA; however SUDS will be applied to the development site where appropriate as per clause KEA2:3v and Policy CS17, a flood risk assessment will be carried out (clause KEA2:3v) and clause KEA2:3x commits to closely managing surface water runoff rates. Furthermore, the policy makes strong commitments to mitigating the impacts on biodiversity from the development by applying buffers along the southern, eastern and western boundaries (KEA2:3iv) as well as enhancing the River Don Wildlife Corridor including the incorporation of SUDS measures (KEA2:3v). There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. The development commits to enhancing the on-site Green Infrastructure network (KEA2:3vi) in addition to improvements outlined in overarching Policy CS18 on Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. A desk based archaeological study will be carried out to assess the site for any potential issues (KEA2:3viii). Economic: ✓ The site is south east of the Urban Core and consequently not ideally located for access to areas of retail, business and leisure. The road links into Central Gateshead and Newcastle via the A194 (M) and A194. There is currently fairly poor public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas, however good road access. Policy clause KEA2:3i commits to provision of sustainable transport links to the site supported by overarching Policy CS13. KEA2:3iii also outlines potential to utilise Leamside Line rail link in the future. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	- Encourages outdoor recreation and walking by improving green space along the Tyne - Has good access to jobs, facilities and services in the immediate area						KEA2:3i-3ii; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Potential to improve the environment by enhancement of River Don Wildlife Corridor - Detailed flood mitigation protocol written into the policy						KEA2:3iv-3vi, KEA2:3viii, KEA2:3x; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, CS19 Supporting Text						
Economic	- Job creation potential - Good road access - Fairly poor public transport access links to main centres of commerce and employment which will be improved as part of development						KEA2:3i; KEA2:3iii; CS13						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
GC1 & GC2 Gateshead Central Sub- Area and Gateshead Central Development Opportunity Sites	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Assessment Summary												
	Social: ✓ To be successful as a retail centre the area needs to improve the overall quality and range of its retail provisions, this is an important step in revitalising Gateshead Centre. Development will incorporate retail, offices, hotels, leisure and residential facilities and will be important for the local economy and community. The policy states the walking and cycling routes in the area will be improved to enhance connectivity for cyclists and pedestrians by widening current spaces, upgrading pedestrian crossings, traffic removal and relocation, and completion of the Great North Cycle Route, as well as improvement of routes between residential, commercial, and leisure areas (GC1:3i-3x; GC2:3iv; CS13). The Urban Green Infrastructure Network and open spaces will be enhanced to help to encourage use of the space for outdoor recreation and thereby promote healthy, active lifestyles (GC1:4i-iii; GC2:1iii-iv; CS18). Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14.												
	Environmental: ✓ The continued development of these Brownfield sites could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site. The areas do not appear to be at risk of flooding; SUDS will be used on the development site where appropriate as per Policy CS17. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. The development commits to Policy CS18 on Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment by improving pedestrian and cycle routes (GC1:3i-xi), enhancing public open spaces (GC1: 4ii-4iii; GC2:1iii-iv), Conservation Area Management (GC1:6; GC2:1vi; CS15), and the development of living roofs (GC1:4i).												
	Economic: ✓ The site is in the heart of the Urban Core and consequently in close proximity to areas of retail and business, itself acting as one when developed. The road links into Central Newcastle via the A167, the Gateshead Highway, and the A184. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas, good road access (with further car parking planned), and a bus station adjacent to the southwest boundary, as well as 2 metro stops within 1 mile west of the development site (GC1:3ii and 3iv, GC2:1iv; CS13).												
Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	• Location has good connections to jobs and facilities in the immediate area, and will also provide them once completed						• GC1:3i-3x, GC2:3iv; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	• Encourages outdoor recreation by improving green space • Potential to improve environment by adding green space • Commitments and wider CS policies should ensure the meeting of environmental objectives						• GC1:4i-4iii, GC2:1iii-iv; GC1:6; GC2:vi; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18						
Economic	• Further encourages tourism and visitors from the wider region, country and globe • Excellent public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as one once completed						• GC1:3ii and GC1:3iv, GC2:1iv; CS13						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
SG1 & SG3 Southern Gateway Sub-Area, Southern Gateway Development Opportunity Sites	✓	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Assessment Summary												
	Social: ✓ Development will incorporate retail, offices, hotels, leisure and residential facilities and will be important for the local economy and community. The policy states the walking and cycling routes in the area will be improved to enhance connectivity for cyclists and pedestrians by providing new pedestrian and cycle links and new routes completing the Great North Cycle Route, as well as upgrading pedestrian crossings (SG1:1ii-1x; SG3:2iii; CS13). The Urban Green Infrastructure Network and open spaces will be enhanced to help to encourage use of the space for outdoor recreation and thereby promote healthy, active lifestyles. The former Windmill Hills nursing home will be brought back into use (SG1:3i-3ii). Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14.												
	Environmental: ✓ The continued development of these Brownfield sites could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site. The areas are in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; SUDS will be used on the development site where appropriate as per Policy CS17. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. The development commits to Policy CS18 on Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment if delivered by improving pedestrian and cycle routes (SG1:1ii-1x; SG3:2iii), contributing towards the establishment of the Riverside Park to Windmill Hills Park Urban Green Infrastructure Corridor, improving existing public green spaces, and the development of living roofs where technically feasible. The development will also retain, repair and restore the Grade II listed building at Windmill Hills where appropriate (SG1:3ii; CS15) and be sensitive to the setting of the Bridges Conservation Area (SG3:1iii). Economic: ✓ The site is in the heart of the Urban Core and consequently in close proximity to areas of retail and business, itself acting as one when developed. The road links into Central Newcastle via the A189, and the A184. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas as well as planned improvements (SG1:1vii; CS13), good road access (with further car parking planned), and a bus station across from the eastern boundary (SG1:1i), as well as two metro stops within 1 mile of the development site. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:												
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location has good connections to jobs and facilities in the immediate area, and will also provide them once completed						SG1:1ii-1x, SG1:3i-3ii, SG3:2iii; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Enhances cultural assets in the vicinity - Encourages outdoor recreation by improving green space - Potential to improve environment by adding green space - Commitments and wider CS policies should ensure the meeting of environmental objectives						SG1:1ii-1x, SG1:3ii, SG3:1iii, SG3:2iii; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18						
Economic	- Further encourages tourism and visitors from the wider region, country and globe - Excellent public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as one once completed						SG1:1i, SG1:1vii; CS13						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
SG2 The Exemplar Neighbourhood Key Site	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Assessment Summary												
	Social: ✓ The development is close to Gateshead City Centre and existing transport infrastructure mean that residential development in the area will be well placed for people to access jobs within the Urban Core. Accessibility improvements are likely to come from clauses SG2:2vi, 2vii and CS13. The site will be of mixed tenure, allowing opportunities for more social integration. Developments will be subject to the Building for Life 12 scheme (or equivalent) which looks to increase the amount of local community participation in local decision making. Also, The site has good access to road links, walking and local cycling routes and public transport (buses, Gateshead Stadium and Gateshead metro stations). There are 10 GP clinics and two schools within 1 mile. Policy clause SG2:2i commits to further provision of small-scale ancillary development to support resident's needs. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The development is Brownfield, so will not damage any designated wildlife sites or remove any areas of green space. It does however provide the opportunity to integrate green infrastructure with creation of public spaces to improve ecological connectivity, as per policy clauses SG2:2v and 2vii and CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. However, some of the site was formerly used as a freight depot and a glassworks so there is potential that the land is contaminated. This area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; furthermore Policy CS17 outlines the use of SUDS and flood protection measures in developments. The policy clauses SG2:3i-iii make commitments to incorporating sustainable design and recycled/energy efficient materials accredited to appropriate schemes e.g. Code for Sustainable Homes. Consequently, design should be suitably sustainable, not to mention all-new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which further addresses these issues. Economic: ✓ The site is close to the Urban Core and the existing and planned accessibility measures mean the site is ideally placed to connect residents with employment and commercial developments. There are road links into the wider area via the A167 and A184. It is situated next to local cycle routes and close to public transport links including buses (every 4-5 minutes), Gateshead Stadium and Gateshead metro stations (within 1 mile). Clause SG2:2viii also emphasises provision of communal parking spaces for car clubs and electric car hook-up points to promote sustainable transport. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:												
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Location is well-connected to jobs, facilities and services						SG2:2i, SG:2vi-vii; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	Environmental concerns are largely mitigated through overarching CS and SG2 commitments – although, some potential for contaminated land						SG2:3i-iii; CS16, CS17, CS18						
Economic	Location is well-connected to main centres of commerce and employment by public transport, especially in context of CS13						SG2:2viii; CS13						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
QB1 Quays and Baltic Sub-Area and QB2 Gateshead Quays Key Site	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ Continuing development of this site for culture and recreation will further build on the cultural distinctiveness of Newcastle, Gateshead and the wider region, making best use of the assets of the Baltic and Sage as cultural beacons. Policy clauses QB1:1i-v and QB2:2iv state the walking and cycling routes in the area will be improved to enhance connectivity for cyclists and pedestrians including links to National Routes 14 and 72 the completion of the Great North Cycle Route (overarching policy CS13 also supports this). Further green space and 'pocket parks' will address the gaps in green infrastructure, and help to encourage use of the space for outdoor recreation and thereby promote healthy, active lifestyles (clause QB2:2ii). The provision of a defined public realm network using streets, squares, lanes, and stairs, with a legible and permeable urban structure, which clearly defines public and private spaces (clause QB2:2iii). Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The continued regeneration of this Brownfield site should not have significant impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site. The area has been shown on the SFRA to be in Flood Zone 2 on its northern edge from the River Tyne with smaller parts in Zone 3a and the remaining area in Zone 1. This clearly has implications for development located in this area. The flood risk should be managed through appropriate mitigation such as improvements to the current drainage system and use of SUDS where appropriate as per commitments in QB1:3, QB2:2viii-x and Policy CS17. QB1:2ii makes reference to sustainable design (living roofs) but not specifically energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clause QB2:2ii commits to creating pocket parks which should improve connectivity with habitats to the east and west of the development, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. The development will also enhance cultural sites and be sensitive to listed buildings in the area as per policy clause QB2:2vi and 2vii and overarching policy CS15. Natural England's Magic Map Tool records nesting Black-legged Kittiwake - <i>Rissa tridactyla</i> – around Newcastle to Seaton Sluice – the most inland breeding Kittiwake population in the world with sites at the Tyne Bridge and Baltic Centre. They are afforded protection as part of the River Tyne Local Wildlife Site which is currently being designated on both sides of the river. Economic: ✓ The site is in the heart of the Urban Core and consequently in close proximity to areas of retail and business, itself acting as one when developed. There are road links into Central Newcastle via the A167. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas (good road access with further car parking planned in QB2:2v) via bus stations throughout the area (every 10-15 minutes); Gateshead Metro and Manors Railway Station are also within 1 mile. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	- Encourages outdoor recreation by improving green space along the Tyne - Has good access to jobs, facilities and services in the immediate area						QB1:1i-v, QB2:2ii-iv; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Enhances cultural assets in the vicinity - Potential to improve the environment by adding green space - Detailed flood mitigation protocol written into the policy						QB1:2ii, QB1:3, QB2:2ii, QB2:2vi-2x; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18						
Economic	- Further encourages tourism and visitors from the wider region, country and globe - Regeneration of the Quays site will further stimulate the economy and build on the economic success of the riverfront - Excellent public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as one when completed						QB2:2v; CS13						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
QB3 Quays and Baltic Development Opportunity Sites	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ Mixed development across the Opportunity Sites will build on service and facilities provision in the Urban Core and commits to providing active urban frontages (QB3:1iii, 3ii and 5ii). Overall this should contribute to creating cohesive local communities with a distinct sense of neighbourhood. The Opportunity sites have good access to walking and cycling routes including links to the Tyneside Cycling Network. The area has good public transport access to buses, metro links and rail access within 1 mile for riverfront sites. Policy clauses QB3:1ii, 2v, 5iv and 5viii (in the context of overarching policies CS14 and CS18) commit to improving pedestrian accessibility with the help of a green corridor which improves north-south connections and links the sites to the wider Urban Core as well as providing green space and encouraging walking. The sites are well serviced by GP clinics, schools and colleges, clause QB3:5i makes further provision for education uses in the Baltic Business Quarter which should further improve educational achievement. Environmental: ✓ The continued development of Brownfield sites should not have significant impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site. Pipewellgate has been shown on the SFRA to be mainly in Flood Zone 2 – at risk from tidal flooding on its northern edge from the River Tyne – with smaller areas in Zone 3a; the other sites are in Flood Zone 1. This clearly has implications for development located in this area. However, the flood risk should be managed through appropriate mitigation such as improvements to the current drainage system and use of SUDS where appropriate as per commitments in QB3:1iv-v, 2vi-vii, 5iv-vi and Policy CS17. QB3 Supporting Text 17.82 makes reference to sustainable design (living roofs, permeable paving) but not specifically energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Clauses QB3:1ii, 2v, 5iv have comprehensive commitments to improving the urban green infrastructure throughout the development sites, potentially improving connectivity between habitats to the east and west of the opportunity sites, in addition to the effects of Policy CS18. Policy clauses QB3:2ii, 2iv, 4ii and overarching Policy CS15 commit to enhancing cultural sites and ensuring sensitivity to Listed Buildings in the area. Economic: ✓ The site is in the heart of the Urban Core and consequently in close proximity to areas of retail and business, itself acting as one when developed providing over 80,000ha of office space (QB3 Supporting Text 17.86) as well as tourism and leisure facilities. There are road links into Central Newcastle via the A167 and A184. The area has excellent public transport access to Proposed Key Employment Areas and the Urban Core via buses, metro links within 1 mile (Gateshead Stadium station for Baltic Business Quarter and Gateshead station for Pipewell and the Quays) and rail access within 1 mile for riverfront sites (Newcastle and Manors stations). There is provision at Baltic Business Quarter for a high quality bus waiting/interchange facility (QB3:5vii) and overall public transport improvements as per overarching policy CS13. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	- Encourages outdoor recreation and walking by improving green space and pedestrian access to the Urban Core - Makes provision for educational facilities at Baltic Business Quarter - Has good access to jobs, facilities and services in the immediate area						QB3:1ii-iii, QB3:2v, QB3:3ii, QB3:5i-ii, QB3:5iv, QB3:5viii; CS14, CS18						
Environmental	- Enhances cultural assets in the vicinity - Potential to improve the environment by adding green space - Detailed flood mitigation protocol written into the policy						QB3:1ii, QB3:1iv-v, QB3:2ii, QB3:2iv-vii, QB3:4ii, QB3:5iv-vi; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, QB3 Supporting Text 17.82						
Economic	- Regeneration of these areas will further stimulate the economy and build on the economic success of the riverfront - Excellent public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as one when completed						QB3:5vii; CS13, QB3 Supporting Text 17.86						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
AOC2 Metrogreen	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ A mixed-use sustainable community will be delivered through a coordinated phased approach. The development will incorporate commercial, leisure and residential facilities and will be important for the local economy and community. The policy states the walking and cycling routes in the area will be improved for cyclists and pedestrians including a continuous recreational riverside route on the Tyne riverbank, and a route connecting the river with the transport interchange (AOC2:2i; CS13). The Urban Green Infrastructure Network and open spaces will be enhanced to help to encourage use of the space for outdoor recreation and thereby promote healthy, active lifestyles. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The continued development of this Brownfield site could have potential impacts for the landscape and the amenity value of this site. The area is at risk of tidal flooding from the River Tyne, fluvial flooding from the River Derwent and is prone to surface water flooding from extreme rainfall events. Over 80% of the site falls under Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA, with the remaining areas split between Zones 2 (~10%), 3a (~7%) and 3b (<1%). SUDS will be applied to the development site where appropriate as per Policy CS17 and comprehensive Surface Water and Flood Management plans will mitigate the flood risk (AOC2:2iii; AOC2 Supporting Text 17.94). There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. The development commits to improving pedestrian and cycle routes, and a new public green space (AOC2:2iv) in addition to the application of Policy CS18 on Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. Development will be appropriate to the local character of the area through implementation of overarching policy CS15. Economic: ✓ The site is just to the west of the Urban Core and consequently in close proximity to areas of retail and business, itself acting as one when developed. The road links into Central Newcastle via the A1. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas, good road access (with further car parking planned), and a bus station, as well as metro stops within 1 mile. There are also policy commitments for further improvements (AOC2:2ii; CS13). Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	- Encourages outdoor recreation and walking by improving green space along the Tyne - Has good access to jobs, facilities and services in the immediate area						AOC2:2i; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Potential to improve the environment by adding green space - Flood mitigation protocol written into the policy						AOC2:2iii; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18, AOC2 Supporting Text 17.94						
Economic	- Further encourages tourism and visitors from the wider region, country and globe - Excellent public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as one when completed						AOC2:2ii; CS13						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NC1 Newcastle Central Sub-Area and NC2 East Pilgrim Street Key Site	✓	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Assessment Summary												
	Social: ✓ Regeneration of these areas for mixed-use development would bring a strong benefit to the local economy and communities. Bringing properties back into use (as outlined in NC1:3i) should improve community cohesion and help improve the quality of life in the area. East Pilgrim Key Site is on the east-west cardinal route, the highest level of the pedestrian hierarchy connecting key attractions. Because of this the policy for the key sites includes public realm interventions which will help improve the connectivity of this pedestrian corridor and link it with local communities and the city centre. Both areas are situated next to Local Cycling Route access and are close to public transport links (buses, Monument and Manor Metro and Manors railway station for NC2 and also Haymarket Metro for NC1). Pedestrian and cycling infrastructure will be further improved throughout the proposed sites as part of development, as per clauses NC1:2i-v; NC1:4i-iii; NC2:2; CS13:1ii. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14.												
	Environmental: ✓ The developments are Brownfield so should improve both landscape and amenity value of the site. These areas are on Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. The developments will not damage any designated wildlife sites or remove any areas of green space. They will, however, create public spaces and these have the potential to incorporate greener infrastructure elements, as per policy clauses NC1:6 and CS18. There are many important historic buildings and streets within the sites and both areas contain Scheduled Ancient Monuments, many Listed buildings and some of the area is of potential archaeological importance – Hadrian’s Wall UNESCO World Heritage Site bisects site NC1. Appropriate archaeological assessments should be carried out during development as per clause NC2:7. The key element of regeneration in these policies is the commitment to integrating, conserving and enhancing historical and cultural assets as part of the design of the new development as outlined in clauses NC1:3ii, 5i-ii (reusing the Black Gate as a heritage led education centre and improving access to and interpretation of Castle Keep); NC2:5 and 6; and CS15.												
	Economic: ✓ The developments are based in Newcastle City Centre and are well linked with existing retail and business activities – providing clear benefit to the local economy. There are road links into the wider area via the A167 and A186. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas (good road access, bus, metro and rail stations) throughout the area. This will be further developed and optimised as per overarching policy commitments CS13 including a new bus facility on the eastern edge of NC2 (NC2:3), appropriate levels of car parking on the edge of the site (NC2:4) and road improvements throughout NC1 (NC1:2i-v, 4iii-iv).												
Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Regeneration will improve retail and commercial opportunities in the city centre and link in with existing employment areas						NC1:2i-v, NC1:3i, NC1:4i-iii, NC2:2; CS13:1ii, CS14						
Environmental	- Potential to improve the environment by creating green space - Commitments and wider CS policies should ensure the meeting of environmental objectives						NC1:3ii, NC1:5i-ii, NC1:6; NC2:5-6; CS15, CS16, CS18						
Economic	- Good public transport and cycling links to main centres of commerce and employment - Continued regeneration, especially of Grainger Town, will improve business opportunities in the city centre						NC1:2i-v, NC1:4iii-iv, NC2:3 and 4; CS13						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
C2 Science Central Key Site	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ The site is located close to the residential areas and a main area of commerce and employment, so any regeneration of this site, and use for employment land would bring a strong benefit to the local economy and local communities. This should promote community cohesion and any regeneration should help to improve the quality of life in the area. The site has connections to the Tyneside Cycling Network and is close to public transport links including St James and Newcastle Central metro stations and Newcastle rail station (within 1 mile) and buses along the A186 and 189. Access (both road and pedestrian) and connectivity will be further improved as per policy clause C2:1i, C2 Supporting text 16.43, 16.44 and overarching policy CS13. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14. Environmental: ✓ The development is Brownfield (mostly former brewery site) so should improve both landscape and amenity value of the site. It does however provide the opportunity to incorporate green infrastructure into a network of public spaces (C2:1ii) to improve ecological connectivity, as per policy CS18. This area is in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA; however precautionary mitigation and prevention methods are covered in policy CS17. Policy clause C2:1iii makes specific reference to buildings in the development meeting latest sustainable design and energy solutions which support delivery of a district heating network, greatly boosting the sustainability of the development, furthermore all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. Natural England's Magic Map tool shows one listed building within the development, three Conservation Areas border the site and it is close to the Hadrian's Wall UNESCO World Heritage Site corridor to the south. The development site itself is unconstrained and redevelopment offers opportunities to complement the nearby conservation areas through good design as per overarching policy CS15. Economic: ✓ The site is close to Newcastle City Centre and the business and residential communities of Westgate and Ryehill, so any regeneration of this site, and use for employment, education and residential land would bring a strong benefit to the local economy. There are road links into the wider area via the A186 and A189. The site has connections to the Tyneside Cycling Network and is close to public transport links including St James and Newcastle Central metro stations and Newcastle rail station (within 1 mile) and buses along the A186 and 189. Public transport improvements are outlined in overarching policy CS13. The specific location of this site in relation to the Universities, the College, and International Centre for Life and General Hospital will aid the growth of knowledge sector employment. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment							Potential Mitigation					
Social	- Has good access to jobs, facilities and services in the immediate area - Good public transport, walking and cycling links - Development of former brewery land should help revitalise the community - Makes provision for mixed-use development including knowledge based industry							C2:1i; C2 Supporting Text 16.43 and 16.44; CS13, CS14					
Environmental	- Potential to improve the environment by adding green space and adjacent cultural heritage areas through sensitive development - Plans to incorporate district heating scheme as part of the development - Commitments and wider CS policies should ensure the meeting of remaining environmental objectives							C2:1ii-iii; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18					
Economic	Excellent public transport access provides links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as one when completed							CS13					

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
D2 Stephenson Quarter Key Site and D3 Forth Yards Development Opportunity Site	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Assessment Summary												
	Social: ✓ Both sites are located close to Newcastle City Centre and will link this area with the existing retail and commercial activities. Mixed-use development will ensure the developments are used throughout the day – clearly benefiting the local economy and creating a sense of place and community. Stephenson Quarter and Forth Yard are next to National Route 72 of the national Cycling Network and Hadrian's Wall Path which follow the River Tyne. Comprehensive public transport links including buses (every 4-5 minutes), Central metro and Newcastle rail stations (within 1 mile) are also present. Both policies commit to further improving accessibility and permeability through and between the sites, D2:1i and D3:1i-ii, promotion of sustainable modes of transport and improvements to public transport accessibility are outlined in overarching policy CS13. Other social objectives including inclusivity and wellbeing are covered by overarching policy CS14.												
	Environmental: ✓ The development is Brownfield (former industrial land), so should improve both landscape and amenity value of the proposed sites. The developments will not damage any designated wildlife sites or remove any areas of green space. They will, however, provide the opportunity to integrate green infrastructure with creation of public spaces (D2:1ii and D3:1v) to improve ecological connectivity, as per policy CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment. CS18 supporting text 12.53 outlines the importance of sensitive infrastructure improvements in areas close to mud flats, such as the mud flat BAPs along the southern banks of the Tyne. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. Both sites are in Flood Zone 1 of the SFRA and overarching policy CS17 covers precautionary flood mitigation and prevention methods. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 which addresses these issues. The Stephenson Quarter is of significant historical and archaeological importance with the Town Wall nearby and many historic buildings, including Scheduled Ancient Monuments, dating from its industrial past and is within the Central Conservation Area. Hadrian's Wall UNESCO World Heritage site is adjacent to the Quarter's northeast edge. Appropriate archaeological assessments should be carried out during development as per clause D2:1v. Policy D2:1iii commits to regenerating historic assets and using them as focal points in the development scheme therefore, when coupled with CS15 Place Making, conservation potential is high. Both sites emphasise the protection of the overall regional setting and incorporation of visual links to the wider River Tyne area (D2:1iv, D3:1iii-iv).												
	Economic: ✓ The sites are close to Newcastle City Centre and will link this area in the existing retail and commercial activities. Both sites have south-facing views over the River making them an attractive location. There are road links into the wider area via the A186 and A189, policy D3:1ii commits to improving access roads to and through the Forth Yard. There is good public transport access to proposed Key Employment Areas (good road access, bus, metro and rail stations) throughout the area from both sites. Improvements to accessibility of public transport are outlined in overarching policy CS13.												
Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment						Potential Mitigation						
Social	Very good access to existing jobs, services and facilities benefits local communities and the region as a whole						D2:1i, D2:1iv, D3:1i-iv; CS13, CS14						
Environmental	- Creates opportunities to conserve and enhance the many historical features of the area - Potential to improve environment by adding green space - No significant environmental risks anticipated overall						D2:1ii, D2:1iii, D2:1v, D3:1iii-v; CS15, CS16, CS17, CS18 and CS18 Supporting Text 12.53						
Economic	Excellent public transport, walking and cycling links to main centres of commerce and employment, itself acting as one when completed						D3:1ii, CS13						

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
QO1 Quayside and Ouseburn Sub-Area	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Assessment Summary													
Social: ✓ Regeneration of these sites for mixed-use development would bring a strong benefit to the local economy and communities. The sub-area is located directly east of Newcastle City Centre and is therefore close to existing retail and commercial activities. Mixed-use and mixed-tenure development (QO1:1 and QO1:3) should help increase community cohesion. Furthermore, the area is situated next to Route 72 of the national Cycling Network, is well serviced by walking routes and close to public transport links including buses (every 2-4 minutes), Byker metro station (within 1 mile) and a new station at Stepney Bank is being considered (QO1:4, 1:5 and QO1 Supporting Text 16.81) so accessibility is good. Policy clause QO1:3 commits to promoting leisure, cultural and tourism assets. The overall effect of regeneration sensitive to the local character of the area, as well as increased economic and residential opportunities should fulfil most social SA objectives. Environmental: ✓ The development is largely Brownfield, so should not damage any designated wildlife sites or remove any areas of green space. It does however commit to integrating green infrastructure with creation of public spaces to improve ecological connectivity, as per policy clause QO1:8 and CS18 Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment, while the supporting text (QO1:16.86) outlines improving the biodiversity value of existing features. Generally, sites near the River Tyne are in Flood Zone 1 and sites near the Ouse Burn are in Flood Zone 2 (e.g. Malmo East Quayside) according to the SFRA; however the overall risk to potential development sites is low. The policy states that new development should control surface water runoff to the Ouse Burn (QO1:9); the supporting text 16.91 suggests the use of SUDS and consulting the Environment Agency's Tyne and Wear Catchment Flood Management Plan for flood management/mitigation measures as per overarching policy CS17. There is little detailed reference to sustainable design, energy efficiency and clean technologies, however all new developments are subject to Policy CS16 Climate Change which addresses these issues. The sub-area is of rich historical importance with many historic buildings dating from its industrial past and is within the Lower Ouseburn Valley Conservation Area as well as Hadrian's Wall World Heritage Site which bisects the area east to west. Policy QO1:6 commits to sustaining and enhancing historic assets and using them as focal points in the development scheme therefore, when coupled with CS15, conservation potential is high. Economic: ✓ The sub-area is close to Newcastle City Centre and will link this area in the existing retail and commercial activities. There are road links into the wider area via the A186, A187 and A193. It is situated next to Route 72 of the national Cycling Network, well serviced by walking routes and close to public transport links including buses (every 2-4 minutes), Byker metro station (within 1 mile), but no nearby rail link. There will be further sustainable transport improvements focusing on a new cycle route, improving crossings. Support for the promotion and enhancement of existing public transport (QO1:4 and 5 alongside CS13) and continued development of creative business Small Medium Enterprises at the Ouseburn (QO1:2) will help stimulate the economy. Overall Sustainability Index From this initial screening the indications are that this site allocation should be given a positive score in the general sustainability index for the following reasons:													
Category	This Assessment									Potential Mitigation			
Social	Strong public transport, walking and cycling links									QO1:1, QO1:3-5; QO1 Supporting Text 16.81			
Environmental	- Surface water and flooding mitigation to be outlined as part of new developments - Creates opportunities to conserve and enhance the many historical features of the area - Potential to improve environment/ecology by adding and enhancing green space									QO1:6, QO1:8, QO1:9; QO1 Supporting Text 16.86, 16.91; CS15, CS16, CS17			
Economic	- An accessible location benefits local communities and the region as a whole - Specifically promotes creative business Small Medium Enterprises									QO1:2, QO1:4-5; CS13			

C4C: Summary Table of Mixed-Use Land Allocations

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
KEA1a Newcastle International Airport	✓	✓	0?	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
KEA1b Newcastle International Airport (South of Freight)	✓	✓	0?	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
KEA1c Newcastle International Airport Southside	✓	✓	0	✓	0?	✓	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
KEA1d Newcastle International Airport Southside Expansion Site	✓	✓	0	✓	0	✓	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
KEA2 South of Follingsby Lane	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
GC1 & GC2 Gateshead Central Sub-Area and Gateshead Central Development Opportunity Sites	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
SG1 & SG3 Southern Gateway Sub-Area, Southern Gateway Development Opportunity Sites	✓	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
SG2 The Exemplar Neighbourhood Key Site	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
QB1 Quays and Baltic Sub-Area and QB2 Gateshead Quays Key Site	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
QB3 Quays and Baltic Development Opportunity Sites	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
AOC2 Metrogreen	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
NC1 Newcastle Central Sub-Area and NC2 East Pilgrim Street Key Site	✓	✓	0?	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
C2 Science Central Key Site	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Site	SA Objectives Social						Environmental				Economic		Summary
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
D2 Stephenson Quarter Key Site and D3 Forth Yards Development Opportunity Site	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7A	7B	8	9	10	11	
QO1 Quayside and Ouseburn Sub-Area	✓	✓	0	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

ANNEX D

SUMMARY OF THE CUMULATIVE IMPACTS ASSESSMENT

D.1 INTRODUCTION

This Annex summarises the cumulative impacts of the policies within the Plan under the main sustainability issues of:

- Human health
- Equality and Diversity
- Water resources
- Loss of Biodiversity
- Traffic levels and congestion
- Waste Management
- Emissions of Greenhouse Gases and Energy Consumption
- Inappropriate Use of Land (e.g. development on floodplains, encroaching into greenbelt or open countryside, development on agricultural land etc)
- Historic and cultural heritage

The table outlines the reasons behind the issue, the cumulative and synergistic impacts, and the likely receptors, how the Plan influences the issue and gives examples of mitigation to ameliorate the impact.

Table D1: Summary of Cumulative Effects

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
Human Health	Economic growth and associated development at the level anticipated can clearly lead to increased traffic, industrial emissions, potential loss of countryside and green space and increased risks of environmental pollution. Poor spatial planning could lead to fewer opportunities for people to walk and get involved in sports and recreation. It could also lead to inappropriate location of housing putting properties at risk from flooding, and thus posing a risk to human health. Similarly if new development is not designed to either mitigate or adapt to the effects of climate change there could be potential health effects in the future.	Increases in road traffic (cars, lorries, public transport) could lead to increases in emissions and associated atmospheric pollution. There are clearly public health implications from increased emissions (e.g. respiratory problems, heart disease etc) which will only be exacerbated by congestion at peak traffic flow times. Increased traffic will also create noise, vibration and other nuisances that together with emissions will affect the health of local residents. There will also be safety issues associated with increased traffic. Poor spatial planning could create or exacerbate problems associated with safe housing and issues such as crime and vandalism. This in turn can affect health and quality of life. Increases in industrial emissions could also pose a risk to air and water quality.	• Air quality • Local residents and communities • Water quality	The spatial distribution of housing, commercial development, community infrastructure and leisure facilities will have a determining effect on road space, use of the car, the demand for public transport and the use of alternatives such as cycling and walking. The Plan has the opportunity through good spatial planning to promote safe and vibrant communities, good health and wellbeing and to ensure that the environment of Gateshead and Newcastle is the most conducive to good health that it can be. Policies within the Plan can make sure that new development contributes to improved health, safety and wellbeing in its design and location. Enhanced accessibility to essential services and community facilities together with access to affordable locally produced healthy foods will help to address health inequalities. Avoiding areas at risk from	Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) in its Clause 8 seeks to: - o locate development such that it maximises accessibility and encourages public transport and other alternatives to the car, such as walking and cycling; - o ensure development is well designed to promote community cohesion and wellbeing; - o make sure development is designed to reduce carbon emissions and be adapted to the effects of climate change Policy CS13 (Transport) promotes sustainable travel choices and a transport system that will support better health in the

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
		Loss of land and green spaces to development would also pose a threat to health and wellbeing possibly reducing opportunities for walking, cycling and other recreational activities that are good for health. Loss of green infrastructure and permitting the location of development in areas at risk from flooding would clearly pose a health and safety risk to the affected communities. Similarly if new developments do not adapt to the potential future effects of climate change then people will be put at risk from the effects of extreme climatic events, increased temperatures and flooding that all affect human health.		flooding and making sure that new developments adapt to the future effects of climate change will all contribute towards a better quality of life in the future and less health risks.	community. Policy CS14 (Health and Wellbeing) addresses many of the potential health issues and seeks to make sure that spatial planning makes a significant contribution towards improved health and wellbeing. Policy CS15 (Place Making) seeks to promote quality in building design and the retention of local distinctiveness in order to meet community needs and promote quality of life and wellbeing. Policies CS16 (Climate Change) and CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management) seek to protect new development from the negative effects of climate change and to make sure that

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
					adaptation is built into new designs.
Equality and Diversity	Poor spatial planning could create or exacerbate problems associated with the exclusion of certain groups within the community from leading normal and equitable lives. Policies within the Plan could inadvertently discriminate against certain groups and lead to serious adverse impacts on quality of life and wellbeing.	Inadvertent discrimination across a number of policies could easily affect minority groups and so for example, if access for the disabled or elderly was not given due consideration then these groups could be deprived of certain travel choices and not gain ready access to a range of recreational and community facilities. If due care and attention was not paid to access to employment opportunities then certain groups could become excluded thus seriously affecting quality of life. Spatial planning can play an important role in maintaining diversity and enabling different community groups to express themselves and take part in normal day to day life. The location of facilities and ready access to these together with the design and location of housing all have a role to play.	All citizens and community groups	The 'tone' of the Plan in promoting social inclusion and ensuring that equal opportunities are encouraged clearly has a key role to play. The spatial distribution of housing, commercial development, community infrastructure and leisure facilities will all have a determining effect on access for all. The way that transport infrastructure and accessibility is designed will influence the extent to which an integrated sustainable travel network is achieved that in turn will help to support economic prosperity, health and wellbeing and quality of place for all. The quality of design in place making will have a significant effect on fostering diversity, enhancing local distinctiveness and creating a sense of place for everyone. Similarly the location	This version of the Plan has now placed the promotion of an inclusive approach to future spatial planning right at the core of the document. The new overarching Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) has a Clause 8 (i) that requires all development to be <i>'Fully inclusive, irrespective of cultural background, ethnicity and age, to meet the diverse needs of all residents and communities'</i>. It is also supported in the main text with Paragraph 5.11 that states that: <i>'Both Councils are committed to the promotion of diversity, equality and fairness'</i>

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
				and accessibility of green infrastructure will affect the quality of life for all groups within the community. The way that healthcare and the promotion of healthy lifestyles is maintained and improved, for example through access to facilities and opportunities for physical activity, has a key role to play in addressing social inclusion issues and health inequalities.	<i>and expect all development to contribute to this in accordance with the latest equalities legislation'</i> This sets the scene for an approach that emphasises the need for development to cater for the needs of all across the suite of policies. Policy CS13 (Transport) has a major focus on equality of access for all to transport (Clause 1 (i)), catering for the needs of everyone and in doing this creating a better quality of place. Policy CS11 (Providing a Range and Choice of Housing) seeks to cater for the needs of specific groups ensuring that housing provision is equitable and does not exclude anyone.

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
					Policy CS15 (Place Making) seeks to make sure that new development creates a strong locally distinctive sense of place through high quality, innovative and sustainable design. Policy CS14 (Wellbeing and Health) in Clause 1 requires that development contributes to <i>'creating an age-friendly, healthy and equitable living environment'</i>. It also contains other clauses that require development to provide <i>'good access for all to health and social care facilities'</i> and also <i>'promote access for all to green spaces, play and recreation opportunities'</i>. The rigorous application of these policies together with others that recognise the need to cater for all should

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
					ensure that equality and diversity are adequately addressed. The previous recommendations for an overarching policy that included social inclusion, equality and diversity or for supporting text that set out development principles have now been met. This has considerably strengthened the policies in the Plan.
Water Resources (water use and water quality impacts)	Development that leads to increases in the number of houses and commercial premises, on the scale anticipated in the Plan is likely to lead to an increased demand for water and wastewater treatment. There will be a requirement to make sure that wastewater is treated to acceptable levels in order to	Increases in the pollution load to sewage treatment works could put pressure on operations and the water quality of receiving waters. There may be additional risks for surface and groundwater. If more infrastructure is needed this could put costs up for the water company and in turn for the consumer. More urban development with roads, paving and infrastructure could lead to more run-off,	- Controlled waters (rivers, groundwaters and coastal waters) - Habitats and biodiversity - Water companies - Consumers	Housing and business growth (e.g. offices, retail, leisure, cultural and tourism) will lead to increased water consumption and the amount of wastewater generated that could put pressure on current capacity. Policies CS2 (Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core) and CS3 (Spatial Strategy for Neighbourhood Area), that deal with the regeneration of the Urban Core and Neighbourhoods, will direct	Application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth), CS15 (Place Making), CS16 (Climate Change) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment), should in the first instance prevent these effects and should also mitigate against the possible negative impacts.

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
	safeguard the quality of controlled waters (surface and groundwater) and to make sure that there is no deterioration in amenity value of Gateshead and Newcastle's rivers and watercourses. There may also be issues with regard to surface water management around developments during construction and thereafter. The need to adapt to the effects of climate change will also have knock-on effects on water management.	some of this can pick up pollutants from road use and maintenance that could affect the quality of receiving waters.		certain developments towards the riverside (the River Tyne) and within other river catchments (e.g. the Team and Ouseburn) and these developments could have a cumulative impact on water quality. The Plan does, however, place an emphasis on protecting the natural environment of Gateshead and Newcastle (Policy CS18: Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) and there are policies that incorporate the principles of sustainable design and specifically the protection of the River Tyne (Policy CS15:Place Making).	Existing water pollution control legislation implemented under the Water Framework Directive should also provide for adequate protection.

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
Threats to Designated Areas for Nature Conservation and possible loss of biodiversity and geodiversity	Development of sites for housing, retail, business premises, new leisure, recreational and tourism facilities, transport infrastructure and utilities. Development near to the River Tyne and also the Tyne estuary, plus any development that threatens feeding and roosting sites of migratory birds could put pressure on areas of international (SPA), national (SSSIs) and local nature conservation importance. Threats to biodiversity may not just be restricted to conservation areas but also the wider Gateshead and Newcastle area including areas of greenbelt, green infrastructure and open space areas of amenity value to local communities.	There will be the potential to disturb, remove and replace habitats and associated flora and fauna (possibly including protected species) at the sites of development and then depending on their location there could be indirect negative impacts on nearby sites of conservation importance (disturbance, downstream contamination etc). There may also be risks of possible fragmentation of habitats and destruction or interruption of wildlife corridors. Development on the River Tyne and in and around the Tyne Estuary could put pressure on the Northumbria Coast Ramsar site and SPA. An indirect effect of further development in and around these areas, particularly tourism developments could be associated increases in traffic and the disturbing impacts that this could have on biodiversity. A cumulative effect of further	• Land take • Biodiversity (flora and fauna) • Public amenity • Local residents and communities	Additional housing and growth of businesses and commercial operations, including retail and recreational facilities with associated transport infrastructure could lead to a reduction in biodiversity (particularly for large developments along the River Tyne or in more rural locations). The influence of the Plan could be beneficial if policies are used vigorously not only to protect biodiversity but also to enhance it.	Application of Policies CS15 (Place Making) and CS18 (Green Infrastructure and Natural Environment) together with Urban Core Policies UC12 (Urban Design) and UC15 (Urban Green Infrastructure) with specific measures to promote sustainable design and protect green infrastructure and the natural environment, should help to mitigate against any potentially negative effects that other more specific development policies within the Plan might have.

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
		housing development would be the additional construction of road and other infrastructure that would arise as a consequence of the development. There is the potential for positive impacts if habitats and biodiversity are restored and/or recreated. This could become part of good design and within targeted areas for development there could be set requirements to create wildlife corridors and new habitats.			
Traffic levels and congestion	Increases in the number of houses and commercial business premises could lead to an increase in the number of cars on the road in Gateshead and Newcastle (related to more people and more commuting). There could also be increases in HGV, van and other delivery traffic (bringing supplies and raw materials in and taking products out).	Increases in road traffic (cars, lorries, public transport) will inevitably lead to increases in emissions and associated atmospheric pollution. Knock-on increases in congestion or travel time whilst commuting, particularly in the Urban Core, the towns and the key Neighbourhoods will lead to further emissions that will only exacerbate the problem. Increased traffic creates noise, vibration and other nuisances that together with emissions will	• Air quality • Local residents and communities • Biodiversity • Historic and built environment • Local amenity and image	The spatial distribution of housing and commercial development in Gateshead and Newcastle will have a determining effect on road space, the demand for public transport and the use of alternatives such as cycling and walking. Policy CS13 (Transport) (supported by Urban Core Policies UC5 (Primary and Secondary Pedestrian Routes), UC6 (Cycling) and UC7 (Public Transport)) seeks to promote	Policy CS13 (Transport) sets out policy on planning for sustainable travel that has a clear focus on encouraging the minimum use of the car and adopting strategies for using other more sustainable modes of transport including walking, cycling and use of public transport. Policy CS16 (Climate Change) sets out policy

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
		affect local residents close to roads and general amenity in the near vicinity. Increases in emissions, noise and vibration are likely to have a negative impact on human health, biodiversity, the historic and built environment, and the general image and amenity value of the areas affected. Increased vehicle exhaust emissions will also increase the amount of CO₂ emitted, thus adding to the contribution that NewcastleGateshead makes of greenhouse gas emissions to the global atmosphere and to climate change.		alternative travel choices to encourage a modal shift from sole occupancy car use to more sustainable alternatives, to improve pedestrian routes, to promote cycling and to encourage more public transport. There is recognition that NewcastleGateshead already has an extensive public transport network that provides high levels of accessibility to services and opportunities across most of the area. There are still areas where accessibility is more limited so the Plan will be able to address any inequalities and improve the operation of existing road and rail networks to ensure that these meet local needs.	on the need to mitigate against and adapt to the effects of climate change. The rigorous application of these policies, whilst not completely removing the threats posed by the possible increase in traffic could substantially reduce them.
Waste management	Growth in population and commercial businesses will inevitably lead to increases in waste generation. Legislation will continue to put pressure on land filling and the search for	Increases in waste will put pressure on the search for more sustainable solutions. In the short term there may be more pressure on local land fill sites or those further a field adding to the burden of possible contaminated land,	• Land take • Habitats and biodiversity • Air quality (methane, global warming, human health)	The encouragement of further development in the form of housing and commercial businesses together with increased tourism is likely to increase the volumes of waste generated which in turn will exacerbate the problems of waste minimisation and	The application of Policy CS21 (Waste) and CS16 (Climate Change) will provide mitigation against the main areas of concern, while Policy CS15 (Place Making) should ensure that waste

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
	alternative disposal routes. Legislation also requires that waste minimisation and management plans be put in place to prevent, minimise and recycle waste, and to follow the waste hierarchy, rather than to resort to landfill.	groundwater (from leachate) and atmospheric pollution (from methane generation). There may also be knock-on effects on local biodiversity. The focus will continue to move away from land fill and put pressure on composting and recycling facilities. There may be a rise in vehicle use associated with increases in the collection and transportation of waste, and increased car use by residents to reach recycling centres and depots.	• Roads • Local people and communities	management. Where stand-alone facilities are required, the provision and siting of any new waste management sites, recovery and recycling centres or transfer stations is likely to generate concern with local communities. The issue of waste management and minimisation has been highlighted within the Plan. Policy CS21 (Waste) now includes a requirement for new developments to reflect the principles of the hierarchy of waste management (i.e. prevention, recovery, reuse and recycling). Policy CS16 (Climate Change) now requires that development should reduce its whole-life CO2 equivalent emissions impact and deliver a good level of sustainability. This will require attention to waste minimisation and more sustainable solutions for dealing with waste.	management is included within sustainable design principles.

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
Emissions of Greenhouse Gases and Energy Consumption	Increases in housing, offices, commercial and retail premises and community facilities will lead to increases in electricity, gas and fuel oil use (for heating, lighting etc). Additional travel and journeys will also result in more fossil fuel use. These will lead to either the direct or indirect emissions of CO ₂ and other combustion gases.	Increases in CO₂ and other combustion gases will add to the atmospheric burden and further contribute to climate change, acid rain and other air quality impacts. Increased energy consumption and consequential use of fossil fuels (oil, gas and coal) will contribute to the depletion of finite resources. Through continued demand, encouraging more exploration, extraction, transportation, refining and processing with the consequential impacts on the environment that these will bring (e.g. air, land, water, habitats and biodiversity impacts)	• Global and local air quality • Habitats and biodiversity • Local people and communities	The encouragement of further housing, commercial business and retail development together with associated traffic and transport issues are likely to contribute to these problems. Large scale housing and retail developments will clearly have the potential to consume large amounts of energy. Energy will not only be associated with the operation of such facilities but also in the manufacturing of building materials. With regards to fossil fuel use the Plan attempts through its spatial policies (Policy CS1: Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth, Policy CS2: Spatial Strategy for the Urban Core, Policy CS3: Spatial Strategy for the Neighbourhood Area and Policy CS4: Spatial strategy for the Rural and Villages Area to focus development in a way that will reduce the reliance on the car and shift to other modes such as public transport, walking and cycling. Policy CS13 (Transport) attempts to bring this altogether through the provision of an integrated sustainable transport network.	The rigorous application of Policies CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth, CS15 (Place Making) and CS16 (Climate Change) should provide a strong degree of mitigation and steer Gateshead and Newcastle in the direction of considerably less reliance on fossil fuels as an energy source.

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
				There is the recognition in the main spatial policy (CS1) of the need for development to reduce carbon emissions. There is also the recognition that house building needs to incorporate more sustainable design and energy efficiency measures (see Policies CS15 (Place Making) and CS16 (Climate Change)). Energy efficiency will be particularly important to reduce the consumption of electricity and natural gas use. In policy CS16 (Climate Change) there is also a requirement for developments to include a carbon reduction strategy and the promotion of renewable energy. It is unclear at this stage the extent to which these policies will impact on energy consumption. Although Gateshead and Newcastle have clearly established measures to reduce its contribution to greenhouse gas emissions it is still likely that it will continue to rely on energy generated from fossil fuels for some time to come.	

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
<i>Inappropriate Use of Land (e.g. development on floodplains, encroaching into greenbelt or open countryside, development on agricultural land etc)</i>	Increases in the demand for housing, retail, commercial properties, new leisure and tourism facilities, road and other infrastructure can, in the absence of suitable previously developed land, place pressure on development taking place in or near to floodplains and encroaching or threatening the greenbelt, open countryside and prime agricultural land.	Increasing hard cover on floodplains can clearly prevent natural adsorption and can exacerbate the rate, speed and volume of runoff. This can have effects on water levels and volumes, water quality, fluvial geomorphology, adjacent habitats and biodiversity. It can also have pronounced effects on communities, homes, business premises etc that may be located adjacent to watercourses or downstream. The encroachment into greenbelt or open countryside could have significant impacts on habitat and biodiversity interests (see above) in turn threatening sites designated for their nature conservation (including protected species) or geological heritage interests. There could also be significant visual impacts resulting in damage to the intrinsic landscape character particularly with simultaneous or phased housing, industrial and road or other infrastructure	• Water courses • Habitats and biodiversity • Local communities • Infrastructure • Local businesses • Historic and built environment • Agricultural land • Local countryside	The Environment Agency Flood risk maps for Gateshead and Newcastle indicate that a number of potential development areas along the River Tyne are at risk from flood. In addition, the recently completed Strategic Flood Risk Assessment and Surface Water Management Plan for the Gateshead and Newcastle area further define areas liable to flooding. Whilst the potential threat of flooding may be small it is increasing year on year due to climate change. The Plan recognises the importance and significance of the threat and this is reflected in the development of Policy CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management). The Plan takes a very proactive stance in preventing development that will impact negatively on open green infrastructure, countryside, greenbelt, open space and areas of nature conservation interest. (see Policy CS18). The application of the relevant	The application of Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) with its Clause 1 that indicates 'a <i>presumption in favour of sustainable development</i>' should mean that land would not be inappropriately used in unsustainable ways. The application of Policy CS17 (Flood Risk and Water Management), should provide the mitigation needed to prevent inappropriate development in areas liable to flooding. Policies CS18 (Green Infrastructure and the Natural Environment) and CS19 (Greenbelt) should afford the necessary protection to the greenbelt and countryside. The rigorous application of these policies should

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
		developments. These could all have impacts on the recreational and amenity interests of local communities. Several developments together could also put either direct or indirect pressure on prime agricultural land.		policies together with appropriate mitigation measures (where these are needed) should provide all the necessary mitigation.	provide all the mitigation that is needed.
Historic and cultural heritage	Increases in the demand for housing, retail sites, commercial properties, recreational and tourism facilities, road and other infrastructure can, in the absence of suitable previously developed land and buildings, place pressure on development taking place that could prejudice historic buildings, monuments and archaeological sites.	Developments or conversions of buildings due to housing, commercial properties, roads, other infrastructure could cause the removal or irreversible damage to valuable buildings, monuments, and the historic environment or heritage assets. The quality of development is usually improved when it is informed by local characteristics, including the historic environment. Pressures for development or lack of investment could result in additional heritage assets being put at risk. More and more development could not only impact directly on historic buildings and monuments (i.e. physical	• Buildings • Historic sites • Public amenity • Local residents and communities	In promoting further development in the Urban Core there is the potential to impact on the historic environment in this area and also on specific monuments and buildings. Strategic Policy CS15 (Place Making) aims to make sure that new development enhances local distinctiveness and protects, sustains and enhances heritage assets. The policy also requires that wherever possible new development will promote the use, understanding and enjoyment of the historic environment.	The application of Policy CS1 (Spatial Strategy for Sustainable Growth) with its Clause 1 that indicates 'a <i>presumption in favour of sustainable development</i>' should mean that land and existing buildings would not be inappropriately used in unsustainable ways that would generate adverse impacts on the historic environment. Application of Policy CS17 should also mitigate against any potential negative effects of development on historic sites.

Key Sustainability Issue	Causes	Cumulative and/or Synergistic Effects	Affected Receptor	Influence of the Plan	Potential Mitigation
		destruction or alteration) but also indirectly through impacts on the setting.			

ANNEX E

SUSTAINABILITY APPRAISAL FRAMEWORK AND GLOSSARY

E. SUSTAINABILITY APPRAISAL FRAMEWORK

E.1 INTRODUCTION

A developing plan can be checked for compliance with sustainable development objectives in a number of ways and Government guidance is not prescriptive on this. However it suggests that an SA framework is a useful tool to complete the task and this is the method used for the Core Strategy and Urban Core Plan for Gateshead and Newcastle.

The SA framework consists of objectives¹ with supporting criteria and an accompanying set of indicators that will be used to check whether the objectives have been achieved. The sustainability objectives are based on the Newcastle and Gateshead Sustainability Charter with slight adjustments to accommodate the needs of the HIA, EINA and SFRA. Reference has also been made to relevant plans and programmes that were identified as part of the baseline PPS review (see Annex A). This task has also included examination of the sustainability objectives established in:

- the North East of England Integrated Regional Framework (2004 and 2008);
- the North East of England Regional Spatial Strategy (2005 and 2008);
- Newcastle and Gateshead Council's previous SA/SEA work on their respective core strategies;
- "Vision 2030" the Sustainable Community Strategy for Gateshead;
- "Newcastle 2021: taking the city forward" the Sustainable Community Strategy for Newcastle; and
- the SCS Bridging Document.

The sustainability objectives have been used as the basis of the SA Framework on which the contents of the Plan has been appraised. These objectives provide the "sustainability yardstick" against which the social, environmental and economic effects of the Plan can be tested. They are distinct from the Plan's objectives themselves, but there should be a degree of overlap and a strong synergy between the two sets of objectives.

E.2 PROPOSED SUSTAINABILITY APPRAISAL FRAMEWORKS

E.2.1 Framework for Strategic and Urban Core Policies

The SA framework has been used to assess the sustainability effects of the Strategic and Urban Core Policies. It is made up of the sustainability objectives together with supporting criteria and question sets. As indicated in Section 2.2.5 of the main report they are based on the Newcastle and Gateshead Sustainability Charter and refined to take into account the needs of health, equalities and strategic flood risk assessments. These objectives provide the "sustainability yardstick" against which the social, environmental and economic effects of the Plan can be tested.

They have been carefully established (see Table E.1) to reflect national themes as well, such as sustainable communities, education for all, equality, access to jobs, climate change, health and well-being, whilst also reflecting the local situation.

¹ An objective can be defined as a statement of what is intended including the desired direction of change

E.2.2 Framework for Sub-Areas and Sites – Newcastle and Gateshead

The SA framework has been modified in order to assess the sustainability effects of the policies for the Sub-Areas and Sites. The framework composed of sustainability objectives is the same but the supporting question sets have been modified to ask specific questions that relate to the proposed locations of possible developments in these areas (see Table E.2 for Housing Land Allocations and Table E3 for Mixed-Use Land Allocations). Each sustainability objective has been addressed using appropriate question sets that have been tailored for whether the site is to be developed for housing or for employment land.

For each proposed site an indication of whether the use of the site would result in a positive, neutral, or negative impact on each of the sustainability objectives is given. The question sets are 'spatially' orientated in order to look at the merits of the location in 'sustainable development terms'. In order to make the assessment more user friendly, a potential positive impact has been highlighted in green, a neutral impact in yellow and a negative impact in red. The screening results have been assessed through a combination of:

- 'Averaging' the ticks, zeros and crosses
- Where a negative relates to a significant impact and potential legal breach (e.g. as with impacts on a designated site for nature conservation, or scheduled ancient monument and breach of a legal duty) this is judged to take precedence and have an 'overriding' influence
- Professional judgement

Screening/sifting is of course not an exact science and needs to be treated with a degree of caution. Where a "Sustainability ranking" raises questions does not necessarily mean that a site cannot be considered for development but does mean that there are likely to be issues to resolve.

Table E.1 Sustainability Objectives for The Plan Sustainability Appraisal

Sustainability objectives with a social thrust:
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities
• Work with local communities to promote existing and develop future opportunities • Listen and respond to communities, encouraging participation in local decision making • Decrease opportunities for crime and fear of crime • Tackle the causes of deprivation and narrow the inequality gap • Ensure everyone has the opportunity of living in a decent and affordable home
2. Ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future development
• Listen to and meet the needs of all in the community • Ensure equal access to essential services and facilities • Accommodate and integrate our diverse communities • Promote development that creates conditions for supporting well-being and happiness in all communities
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle
• Improve educational achievement and create opportunities for education, training and lifelong learning • Develop and retain a skilled workforce • Address barriers that prevent people from getting work
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health
• Improve access to essential healthcare and social services provision • Promote healthy urban planning (healthy settings, reducing stress) • Provide access to safe and stimulating open spaces and the natural environment • Promote healthy lifestyles and active living (walking, cycling, sport, exercise, active recreation, equitable access to healthy foods)
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity
• Protect and enhance historic and cultural assets and promote a quality and stimulating urban environment • Encourage engagement with and access to culture and heritage • Protect and enhance, where appropriate, the historical integrity, quality and diversity of Gateshead and Newcastle's townscape

6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services

- Ensure good access to jobs, facilities, goods and services
- Deliver sustainable transport solutions that encourage walking, cycling and the use of public transport and reduce dependency on the private car
- Encourage effective use of technology (communications) especially as an alternative to travel

Sustainability objectives with an environmental thrust:

7. Adapt to and mitigate against the impacts of climate change

A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change

- Promote energy efficiency
- Promote sustainable design and construction and the use of clean technologies
- Promote use of locally produced energy from low carbon and renewable resources

B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development

- Limit risks and impacts of changing weather patterns, including flooding
- Make more use of sustainable urban drainage schemes
- Allow the natural environment to adapt to the consequences of climate change
- Protect and enhance wildlife networks

8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally

- Minimise the use of non-renewable natural resources, including greenfield sites
- Encourage the reclamation and re-use of derelict / previously developed land
- Reduce waste production and increase reuse and recycling
- Improve air quality and reduce pollution
- Encourage sustainable design and construction

9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure

- Contribute towards the protection and enhancement of Gateshead and Newcastle's geodiversity and biodiversity including all locally and nationally designated sites
- Protect and improve the quality of our groundwater and rivers
- Protect and enhance existing greenspace while promoting the further development of an integrated green infrastructure for Gateshead and Newcastle
- Protect and improve the quality of our soils
- Protect landscape quality and character

Sustainability objectives with an economic thrust:**10. Strengthen our economy**

- Nurture economic growth and improve opportunities for both new and existing businesses
- Enhance the infrastructure required for economic growth
- Enhance connectivity (transport and communications)
- Promote investment in sustainable leisure and tourism
- Raise Gateshead and Newcastle's national and international profile
- Attract and retain innovative and talented individuals

11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market

- Develop appropriate employment opportunities that are accessible, diverse and plentiful
- Contribute towards reducing worklessness
- Increase workforce diversity and ensure equality of opportunities

Glossary to Accompany Sustainability Objectives

This glossary defines the various topics and issues that are captured by each of the sustainability objectives and their associated bullet points. It is intended to act as a checklist of points to be considered, and questions to be asked when appraising objectives and policies within the Plan against each of the Sustainability Objectives/Aims within the Framework.

1. Promote strong and inclusive communities

- Community participation and involvement, developing existing community resources
- Encourage dialogue with communities and involve everyone in community planning
- Involvement of those previously not involved
- Sense of community identity
- Community leadership and representation
- Better outcomes for children and young people
- Good quality, affordable housing in sustainable locations
- Homelessness
- Affordable housing options for all
- Mixed tenure
- Mixed, sustainable and cohesive communities
- Retaining population
- Reducing crime
- Reducing the fear of crime
- Pride in surroundings
- Safer urban environment
- Decreasing levels of anti-social behaviour

2. Ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future development

- Recognise that everyone starts from a different place
- Equality of opportunity
- Diversity in communities
- Integration
- Elimination of discrimination
- Good community relations

3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle

- Education, training and lifelong learning for all
- Barriers to learning and work opportunities
- Skill levels for the relevant industries of Gateshead and Newcastle

4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health

- Access to healthcare provision for all
- Health inequalities
- Health literacy
- Vulnerable groups (including older people, young people, people with a disability, migrants and deprived communities)
- Active lifestyles (walking and cycling)
- Family-friendly social activities
- Access to open space and recreation facilities
- Opportunities to promote mental well-being (gardens and green spaces)

- Healthy diets (access to nutritious food)
- Home grown food (gardens and allotments)

5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity

- Landscape quality and character around towns and villages (rural and urban)
- Historic environment
- Cultural heritage and diversity: traditional community and in-migrants
- Local distinctiveness
- Sense of place

6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services

- Access for all to the full range of “joined up” services
- Enabling people to meet their needs
- Reducing car dependency
- Access to public transport
- Community services and facilities
- Access to open space and/or recreation facilities

7. Adapt to and mitigate against the impacts of climate change

A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change

- Energy efficiency
- Renewable energy
- Reducing emissions of greenhouse gases
- Reducing emissions from traffic
- Reducing car dependency
- Reducing the need to travel
- Encouraging cycling and walking

B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development

- Sustainable Urban Drainage Systems
- Reducing flood risk
- Use of green infrastructure
- Green roofs
- Flood mitigation
- Are the flood risks (depths and hazards), prior to mitigation, significant, and could result in a risk of loss life to people using the site?
- Can the development be made safe once developed and are the residual risks acceptable?
- Is the increase in risk posed by climate change easily adapted to and/or can the development build in climate change resilience?
- Can flood risk to adjacent lands stay the same or be reduced as a result of the development and its mitigation measures?

8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally

- Waste recovery, segregation and recycling
- Waste minimisation
- Development on previously developed land and buildings
- Sustainable design and construction
- Use of sustainable materials

- Improving air quality
- Reducing traffic congestion and vehicle emissions
- Discouraging industrial emissions

9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure

- Greenbelt
- Green spaces/infrastructure
- River and estuarine water quality
- Groundwater quality
- Nature conservation interest
- Species diversity (especially protected species)
- Natural and semi-natural habitats

10. Strengthen our economy

- Local economy – opportunities and constraints
- Infrastructure for economic growth
- Investment in emerging markets – leisure and tourism, knowledge economy, green economy
- National and international profile

11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market

- Diverse and accessible job opportunities
- Worklessness
- New business start-ups
- Support for enterprise
- Economically active population

Table E2 Appraisal Matrix for Housing Land Allocations

Sustainability Objective	Indicative Housing Land Questions
Social	
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities.	• Does the site provide the opportunity of living in a decent and affordable home? • Is the location likely to attract people to stay and work in the area? • Does the site have the potential to support a wider integrated sustainable community? • Does the development of the site have potential through good design to discourage antisocial behaviour and the incidence of crime? • Does the site provide the opportunity for community inputs to decision making? • Does the proposed development help to regenerate derelict land and make use of previously used buildings, which are associated with the local community?
2. Ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future development.	• Does the site provide equal access to essential services and facilities (including shops and transport)? • Will it generate a requirement for the provision of additional facilities and services? • Is the location likely to attract and accommodate people from diverse communities? • Does the site create conditions for supporting well-being and happiness in all communities?
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle.	• Can the site be adequately served by nearby primary and secondary schools or will additional provision be required?
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health.	• Is the site easily accessible and well served by walking and cycle routes? • Is the site easily accessible by sustainable forms of transport and well located in relation to established green infrastructure? • Does the site have adequate access to nearby healthcare facilities or will additional provision be required?
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity.	• Does the site impact on historic and cultural assets? • Does the development encourage engagement with and access to culture and heritage? • Where appropriate, does the site enhance and protect the historical integrity, quality and diversity of Gateshead and Newcastle's townscape?

Sustainability Objective	Indicative Housing Land Questions
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services.	• Does the site provide equal access to essential services and facilities (including shops and transport)? • Will it generate a requirement for the provision of additional facilities and services? • Does the development make efforts to encourage walking, cycling and the use of public transport? • Does the development have good technological (communications) infrastructure?
Environmental	
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change.	• Does the proposed development incorporate energy efficiency measures? • Does the development feature sustainable design and construction and the use of clean technologies? • Does the site utilise locally produced energy from low carbon and renewable resources?
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development.	• Is the development in a flood-risk area now or predicted to be in future? • Does the site feature a sustainable urban drainage scheme? • Does the site take measures to protect and enhance wildlife networks? • Is there evidence of a surface water management plan?
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally.	• Is the development planned on a greenfield site? • Is the development planned on a brownfield site? • Are there any buildings on the site, which could be recycled? • Does the site support reuse and recycling efforts? • Does the development feature sustainable design and construction and the use of clean technologies?
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure.	• Does the development contribute towards the protection and enhancement of Gateshead and Newcastle's geodiversity and biodiversity, including all locally and nationally designated sites? • Does the site impact on the quality of groundwater or rivers? • Does the site take measures to protect or improve the quality of our soils? • Is the site sensitive to safeguarding the landscape quality and character? • Does the development protect and enhance existing greenspace while promoting the further development of an integrated green infrastructure for Gateshead and Newcastle?

Sustainability Objective	Indicative Housing Land Questions
Economic	
10. Strengthen our economy	• Is the site attractive to innovative and talented individuals? • Is it located close to transport links and areas of employment?
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	• Is the site well located in relation to main centres of employment and commerce? • Is the location likely to attract people to stay and work in the area? • Does the site have the potential to support a wider integrated sustainable community?

Key

✓	Likely to be broadly supportive of Sustainability Objective
0	Likely to be broadly neutral
✗	Likely to have a negative effect on Sustainability Objective

Table E3 Appraisal Matrix for Mixed-Use Land Allocations

Sustainability Objective	Indicative Mixed-Use Land Questions
Social	
1. Promote strong and inclusive communities.	• Is the location likely to attract people to stay and work in the area? • Does the site have the potential to support a wider integrated sustainable community? • Does the development of the site have potential through good design to discourage antisocial behaviour and the incidence of crime? • Does the site provide the opportunity for community inputs to decision making? • Does the proposed development help to regenerate derelict land and make use of previously used buildings, which are associated with the local community?
2. Ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future development.	• Does the site provide equal access to essential services and facilities (including shops and transport)? • Will it generate a requirement for the provision of additional facilities and services? • Is the location likely to attract and accommodate people from diverse communities? • Does the site create conditions for supporting well-being and happiness in all communities?
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle.	• Is the site nearby third level training and education institutions and could an employment site promote synergies between education/training and industry?
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health.	• Is the site easily accessible and well served by walking and cycle routes? • Is the site easily accessible by sustainable forms of transport and well located in relation to established green infrastructure? • Does the site have adequate access to nearby healthcare facilities or will additional provision be required?
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity.	• Does the site impact on historic and cultural assets? • Does the development encourage engagement with and access to culture and heritage? • Where appropriate, does the site enhance and protect the historical integrity, quality and diversity of Gateshead and Newcastle's townscape?
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services.	• Does the site provide equal access to workplaces, essential services and facilities (including shops and transport)? • Will it generate a requirement for the provision of additional facilities and services? • Does the development make efforts to encourage walking, cycling and the use of public transport? • Does the development have good technological (communications) infrastructure?

Sustainability Objective	Indicative Mixed-Use Land Questions
Environmental	
7A. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change.	- Does the proposed development incorporate energy efficiency measures? - Does the development feature sustainable design and construction and the use of clean technologies? - Does the site utilise locally produced energy from low carbon and renewable resources?
7B. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development.	- Is the development in a flood-risk area now or predicted to be in future? - Does the site feature a sustainable urban drainage scheme? - Does the site take measures to protect and enhance wildlife networks? - Does the site have a surface water management plan?
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally.	- Is the development planned on a greenfield site? - Is the development planned on a brownfield site? - Are there any buildings on the site, which could be reused? - Does the site support reuse and recycling efforts? - Does the development feature sustainable design and construction and the use of clean technologies?
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure.	- Does the development contribute towards the protection and enhancement of Gateshead and Newcastle's geodiversity and biodiversity, including all locally and nationally designated sites? - Does the site impact on the quality of groundwater or rivers? - Does the site take measures to protect or improve the quality of our soils? - Is the site sensitive to safeguarding the landscape quality and character? - Does the development protect and enhance existing greenspace while promoting the further development of an integrated green infrastructure for Gateshead and Newcastle?
Economic	
10. Strengthen our economy	- Is the site attractive to innovative and talented individuals? - Is it located close to transport links and areas of employment? - Does the development promote investment in sustainable leisure and tourism? - Does the development raise Gateshead and Newcastle's national and international profile?
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market	- Is the site well located in relation to main centres of population, housing, employment and other commercial developments? - Does the site provide appropriate, accessible, diverse and plentiful employment opportunities? - Does the development contribute towards reducing worklessness? - Does the development a small-medium enterprises and business start-ups?

Key

✓	Likely to be broadly supportive of Sustainability Objective
0	Likely to be broadly neutral
✗	Likely to have a negative effect on Sustainability Objective

TESTING THE PLAN OBJECTIVES AGAINST SUSTAINABILITY APPRAISAL FRAMEWORK

It was essential to check that the proposed SA framework was sufficiently wide enough to encompass all the strategic objectives of the Plan that relate to sustainable development. A check was made by comparing the framework with the strategy objectives to confirm that the framework was fit for purpose. The findings are summarised in the table below.

Table E4: Summary Assessment of the Possible Sustainability Effects of the Plan Strategic Objectives

The Plan Strategic Objectives	Sustainability Objectives											
	Social						Environmental				Economic	
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7a	7b	8	9	10	11
Strategic Objective 1: Encourage population growth in order to underpin sustainable economic growth.	~	~	~	~	~	~	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓	✓
Strategic Objective 2: To increase our economic performance, resilience, levels of entrepreneurship, skills and business formation by promoting Gateshead and Newcastle as the strong regional economic focus and by ensuring the supply of suitable, flexible and diverse business accommodation.	✓	~	✓	~	✓x	✓	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓	✓
Strategic Objective 3: To increase our competitiveness by improving and expanding the role of the Urban Core as the regional destination for business, shopping, education, leisure, tourism and as a place to live.	✓	✓	✓	~	✓x	✓	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓	✓
Strategic Objective 4: To strengthen Newcastle's position as the regional retail centre. To ensure the provision of quality District and Local centres with a diverse range of shops and services that are accessible to meet the needs of all local communities.	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓x	✓	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓	✓

The Plan Strategic Objectives	Sustainability Objectives											
	Social						Environmental				Economic	
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7a	7b	8	9	10	11
Strategic Objective 5: Expand leisure, culture and tourism providing for all age groups and diversifying the evening economy.	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓x	✓	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓	✓
Strategic Objective 6: Ensure that our residential offer provides a choice of quality accommodation in sustainable locations to meet people's current and future needs and aspirations, improving opportunities to live in the Urban Core providing a broader range of accommodation including in new neighbourhoods.	✓	✓	~	✓	✓x	✓	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓	✓
Strategic Objective 7: Manage and develop our transport system to support growth and provide sustainable access for all to housing, jobs, services and shops.	✓	✓	✓	✓	~	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Strategic Objective 8: Improve sustainable access to, within and around the Urban Core by promoting fast and direct public transport links to the heart of the Urban Core increasing walking and cycling and minimising through traffic.	✓	✓	✓	✓	~	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Strategic Objective 9: Ensure that development and the use of land sustains and enhances the quality of the natural, built and historic environment, making the	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

The Plan Strategic Objectives	Sustainability Objectives											
	Social						Environmental				Economic	
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7a	7b	8	9	10	11
Urban Core a high quality exemplar for Gateshead and Newcastle and ensuring our communities are attractive, safe and sustainable.												
Strategic Objective 10: Provide the opportunity for a high quality of life for everyone and enhance the wellbeing of people to reduce all inequalities.	✓	✓	✓	✓	~	✓	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓x	✓	✓
Strategic Objective 11: To reduce CO ₂ emission from new development and future growth while adapting to the issues, mitigating adverse impacts and taking advantage of the opportunities presented by climate change.	✓	✓	~	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Strategic Objective 12: Improve the function, usability and provision of our green infrastructure and public spaces by providing a network of green spaces and features which are connected and accessible for all.	✓	✓	~	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	~	~

✓ Positive (compatible)

~ Neutral

✓x Potential conflict or compatibility - outcome would depend on development control

Sustainability Appraisal Objectives

1. Promote strong and inclusive communities
2. Ensure that equality, diversity and integration are embedded in all future development
3. Improve educational achievement and skill levels across Gateshead and Newcastle
4. Improve health and well-being and reduce inequalities in health
5. Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity
6. Ensure good accessibility to jobs, facilities, goods and services
7. Adapt to and mitigate against the impacts of climate change
 - a. Reduce our contribution to the causes of climate change
 - b. Make sure we adapt to the effects of climate change and mitigate against its impacts in future development
8. Live within environmental limits, both locally and globally
9. Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure
10. Strengthen our economy
11. Improve access to a stable and sustainable employment market

Strategic Objectives of the Plan

1. Encourage population growth in order to underpin sustainable economic growth.
2. To increase our economic performance, resilience, levels of entrepreneurship, skills and business formation by promoting Gateshead and Newcastle as the strong regional economic focus and by ensuring the supply of suitable, flexible and diverse business accommodation.
3. To increase our competitiveness by improving and expanding the role of the Urban Core as the regional destination for business, shopping, education, leisure, tourism and as a place to live.
4. To strengthen Newcastle's position as the regional retail centre. To ensure the provision of quality District and Local centres with a diverse range of shops and services that are accessible to meet the needs of all local communities.
5. Expand leisure, culture and tourism providing for all age groups and diversifying the evening economy.
6. Ensure that our residential offer provides a choice of quality accommodation in sustainable locations to meet people's current and future needs and aspirations, improving opportunities to live in the Urban Core providing a broader range of accommodation including in new neighbourhoods.
7. Manage and develop our transport system to support growth and provide sustainable access for all to housing, jobs, services and shops.
8. Improve sustainable access to, within and around the Urban Core by promoting fast and direct public transport links to the heart of the Urban Core increasing walking and cycling and minimising through traffic.
9. Ensure that development and the use of land sustains and enhances the quality of the natural, built and historic environment, making the Urban Core a high quality exemplar for Gateshead and Newcastle and ensuring our communities are attractive, safe and sustainable.
10. Provide the opportunity for a high quality of life for everyone and enhance the wellbeing of people to reduce all inequalities.
11. To reduce CO₂ emission from new development and future growth while adapting to the issues, mitigating adverse impacts and taking advantage of the opportunities presented by climate change.
12. Improve the function, usability and provision of our green infrastructure and public spaces by providing a network of green spaces and features which are connected and accessible for all.

Comments and Recommendations

It was found when comparing the Plan (CS) objectives with the Sustainability Appraisal (SA) objectives that in a number of cases they could be judged either compatible or in conflict depending on future policy wording and development control measures. An example is given below:

Comparing CS Objective 1 with SA Objective 9

Encouraging population growth in order to underpin sustainable economic growth (CS1) is likely to require some level of development (new housing, employment opportunities etc). If development is confined to sites which have little natural or landscape value, and/or the development itself included high quality, sensitive architecture and landscaping of high biodiversity value, then CS1 could be neutral or compatible with regard to SA9 (Protect and enhance our environmental assets and infrastructure) If, however, development occurred on sites of existing conservation or areas of countryside with unique character, or encroached upon green infrastructure or landscape value then SA9 and CS1 would be in conflict.

Comparing CS Objective 3 with SA Objective 5

Improving and expanding the role of the Urban Core as the regional destination for business, shopping, education and tourism is likely to require some level of development (new housing, new offices, business premises employment etc). If development is confined to sites with little historic value or if developments are carried out with sensitivity and in a way that enhances the cultural heritage then CS3 could be neutral or compatible with SA5 (Promote, enhance and respect our culture, heritage and diversity). If however development compromised local character and the built heritage then SA5 and CS3 would be in conflict.

Recommendation

In assessing the sustainability of the Plan it will be vital to ensure explicit reference is made to how future development plans will address these potential sustainability conflicts and to ensure that wording of the Core Strategy and its various policies is unambiguous.

ANNEX F

BIBLIOGRAPHY

Bibliography

This bibliography includes a selection of those documents considered during the development of this Sustainability Report. However, a far greater number of plans, programmes and strategies have been reviewed and taken into full consideration. A full list of these documents is listed and analysed in Annex A – the PPS Review.

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